INDEX CARD RPG

MASTER EDITION

PDF 1.6

RUNE
HAMMER

RUNEHAMMER GAMES presents:
INDEX CARD RPG MASTER EDITION

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FIND PERFECTION IN THE IMPERFECT

WHEN NEED ARISES, CREATE RATHER THAN SEEK

OPEN THE BEGINNER'S MIND

A GLORIOUS MESS

Gathered 'round the table, shuffling three-ring binders and using popcorn for goblins, I discovered what many of us do: the infinite, exciting, you-had-to-be-there fun of tabletop RPGs. We were brazen, clumsy dreamers, smashing worlds together, exploring new dimensions, and surprising our benefactors with overdue heroism. We let the dinosaurs run free, drew swords with Gods, and no matter what madness came next, we stuck together. We didn't just play to 'game,' we played to find our own strengths, and share them with each other.

Fast forward a few decades, a few thousand index cards, a few hundred notebooks, and a lifetime not unlike that of a wizard buried in dusty old books and parchment maps... the adventures continue.

Index Card RPG (**ICRPG**) represents the accidental, intuitive, inevitable result of countless game sessions and legendary tales. It wasn't invented so much as discovered. It was hiding right there all along, in sheafs of paper, wobbly drawings and bags of dice. I am more its documentarian than its creator.

Since its first release as a series of silly Sharpie drawings in 2016, **ICRPG** has become an unstoppable best-seller and served as a rallying point for a vibrant, creative community of players and creators in several countries, digital platforms and languages. It has helped to unlock the potential of gamemasters and clumsy dreamers. That was always my hope; to push people 'over the edge' of their doubts and hesitations; to remind them of the endless landscapes in their own imagination, and send them tumbling in with reckless enthusiasm.

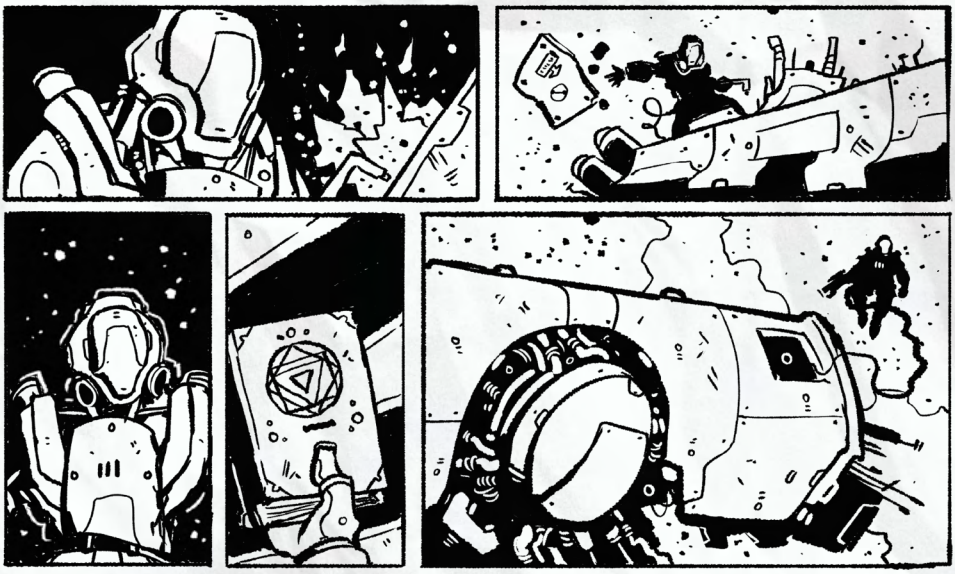
It's an ever-growing, ever-improving heap of rules, drawings, maps, and mayhem. It's a glorious mess. This, its definitive form, works to clear away just enough popcorn to see the table and keep playing. Spread the word.

Thanks for reading. May your dice roll high!

INTRODUCTION

A D20 SYSTEM YOU COMMAND

Whether it's a dead starship in the cold depths of space, the brimstone citadels of the netherrealms, the frozen tombs of a primordial past, or the great stone towers of the noblest ages, adventure is everywhere and everywhen. There you are: front and center, ready to save the world. **ICRPG** provides a role-playing framework, a creative mindset, and heaps of LOOT players will need to get the job done. This book combines all the biggest pieces of the **ICRPG** puzzle, with revised rules, tighter writing, and art from all over the multiverse.



Here's what you'll find in these pages. Grab your notebook. It's on.

- **ICRPG CORE SYSTEM:** Rolling a D20 to attack a monster is just too good to change, but lots of other things in tabletop gaming are ready for an upgrade. All the familiar you need with all the new you'll learn to love. Play as written, or cherry pick for your current game.
- **PLAYER'S GUIDE:** This section includes character creation info for the fantasy world of Alfheim and the cosmos of WARP SHELL. It's all right here, including milestones for progression, gear, and story teasers.
- **GM's GUIDE: ICRPG** has been around the block a few times, and all those hours of play have bubbled up with some small but crucial tweaks that can supercharge your game. Here's a few of the latest key thinks.
- **MONSTERS:** There are plenty listed here for all kinds of games, but they are just a guidepost for your own terrible creations to challenge players.
- **WORLDS:** The five biggest **ICRPG** world settings are included here.
- **MAGIC:** This section of the book details a far more in-depth spell casting system for players seeking detail and craziness in their arcane characters.

THE TABLETOP CAMPFIRE

How awkward is it for a group of adventurers to just sit in the woods, no music playing, staring off into space? Terribly awkward. A role playing session is no different. One of the most exciting elements of the RPG hobby is creating *things* for the game table. These things are the 'campfire' of your gathering!

There are as many styles and materials for tabletop creations as there are players. From fully painted metal miniatures to styrofoam terrain to cardboard scraps and, yes, the almighty index card. No matter what kind of creations you prefer, use whatever gets that silly excitement to play stirring. The basics:

- **Pencil and Pen:** The ultimate weapons of imagination. The pencil is for HP, the pen for everything else. Make a mess!
- **The Inevitable Notebook:** This journal will be your new best friend, keeper of secrets. Even if your notes are incomplete, a journal is the only book you really need.
- **The Noble Polyhedrals:** This book uses typical dice notation for polyhedrals: D4, D6, D8, D10, D12, and the D20! Know ye well your new, ambivalent gods, your fate will be in their hands!
- **Friends:** Reach out! Be the weird enthusiastic one. Experience, preparation, and 'cool ideas' be damned. Just start a conversation.
- **Maps and Minis:** Visualizing who is where is central to playing a fun session. It doesn't matter what materials or style you prefer, do what feels comfortable.
- **Food and Drink:** Deny not the body lest the mind wither!

GOODIES

Don't miss these handy little notes and tips! It's on an index card, so it's got to be important!

IF A MYSTERY ARISES, GO WITH YOUR GUT

NOTHING IS MORE POWERFUL THAN THE INTUITIVE

IN BATTLE, CONFUSION IS DEATH

HOW TO USE THIS BOOK

Many RPG books and products include an implicit premise: follow what is written in this book, and you will be playing properly. It is implied that if a Rock Giant is listed as having a +4 strength, then that is official fact, canon truth. Not here. How to use the **ICRPG** rules? Short answer: don't.

Index Card RPG is a way of thinking. Your players invested in another system? No problem. The *mindset* is what will supercharge your GM style, not some specific rule or system written on a dead tree. Take what is useful for you, and toss the rest! This book represents countless hours of gameplay and GM feedback, all condensed into a resource to bring more **ICRPG** players to the table. It's just an intro! Just the latest mod in a hobby of mods! Here's a preview of **ICRPG's** key system innovations.

- **Playing in Clockwise Turns:** This has been a staple in board and card games for generations. You and your group will rejoice as this simple foundation of play streamlines numerous aspects of any session.
- **Effort Dice:** The wild variety of things that get players rolling dice are compressed here into simple categories of EFFORT, each using its own die type.
- **Targets: ICRPG** combines all roll targets into a single number at the table. Furthermore, there are just a few numbers that even need be considered. This will vastly speed up and simplify any game, and give players a clear vision of challenge.
- **Clean STATS:** There are no skills, derivative number formulae, feats or talents here. This game system just uses a character's six core STATS to call for rolls, make ATTEMPTS, CHECKS, and generally be awesome.

CORE SYSTEM

ADVENTURES IN TURNS

We're ready to begin. Your GM gathers you all at the table, introducing the basic premise of the game ahead. "We begin on the deck of a mighty ship..." You have your characters ready, some dice scattered about, and a squiggly map on some index cards. "One day while sailing the open ocean, the ship is attacked by a squad of spear-wielding fish men! They're climbing all over the ship, intent on killing all aboard! Let's get started."

The GM looks over to you and says the words that have launched a thousand epic tales: "It's your turn, what will you do?"

All tabletop role-playing games find common roots at this moment. When it's your turn, you don't simply choose a button to push. The scene, as it stands, becomes yours to change, yours to explore, and yours to embellish. This could be as simple as asking "How many fishmen are attacking us?" or as complex as "I will draw my saber, grab hold of a mast-rope, and kick loose the reel-crank, sending me flying into the fish men, steel blazing!"

No matter how you choose to use your TURN, the 'game' occurs when the GM helps you resolve your effect on the scene, and then passes the spotlight to the next player. In time, you'll see how fast and simple, or complex and meticulous this process can be.

This section describes how **ICRPG** handles the turn-by-turn process of creating, changing, and resolving scenes in your unique story. Mind your feet, adventurer, once you begin down this wide-open road of collaborative storytelling, there's no telling where you might end up.

ALWAYS TURNS?

Turns give a session structure and an energetic pace, but if it feels weird to play in turns, maybe during role play, just go freeform!

WHO GOES FIRST?

When a new action scene begins, everyone at the table rolls a D20. The highest roll goes first, then clockwise. Pray the GM doesn't win!

WHEN THE DICE START ROLLIN'

Sometimes during play, things are feeling loose and narrative. Story is being told, silly accents are being used, or maybe you and your chums are arguing how best to dispatch a hill giant. The GM may be leaning back, eating chips and grinning with sinister patience, or still using turns to keep everyone sharing the spotlight. When this happens, dice don't have much to contribute.

Then, all hell breaks loose. Fish men attack your boat. The hill giant comes crashing into town. Cosmic rays bombard the space station. Time becomes terribly limited, danger is everywhere, and no mere words are getting you out of this alive. It's time for action on your turn, and roll dice to see what happens.

DESCRIBE IT

Most turns you make start with a description of something you're trying to do, curious about, or want to affect in some way. If you're stumped, just ask for details about what's going on.

- "I'm going to attack that skeleton!"
- "I'll leap over the chasm!"
- "I'll force the airlock open!"

ROLL THE BONES

Once the GM hears what you're imagining, he'll let you know what kind of roll is needed, and let you know. Roll for it!

- "Roll a D20 plus your STR stat, beat a 13."
- "Roll D20 plus DEX against a 15."
- "There's a 50/50 chance. Roll a D6 for me."

GET RESULTS

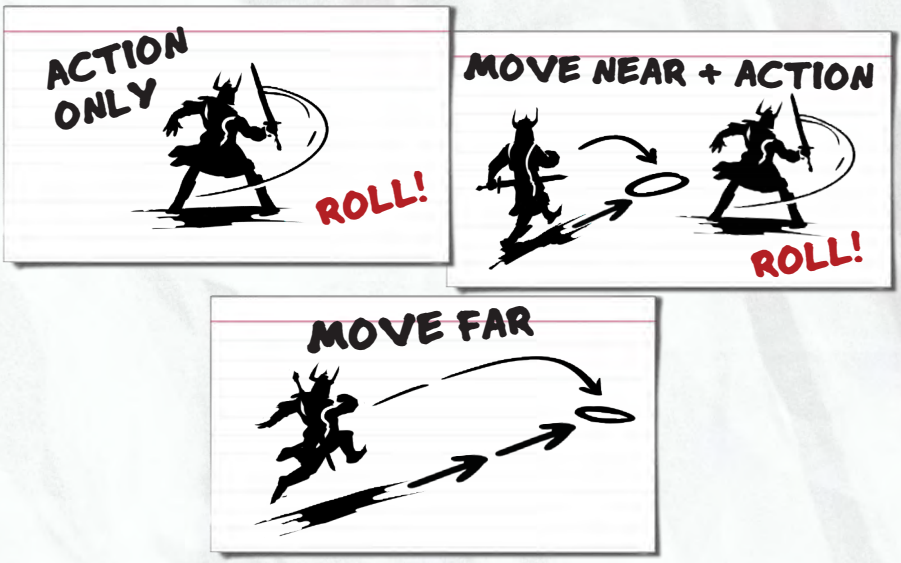
Based on the outcome of your roll, you and the GM will both describe how things change, according to your success or failure.

"Boom! You smash the skeleton!"
"I made it! I go flying over the gap!"
"Oh no, a 1? The airlock is jammed shut."

CORE SYSTEM

THREE KINDS OF TURNS

Unless you spend your TURN just talking, or looking good, it will take one of these three forms every single time. Not only will you get used to this formula, you will learn to master it, to exploit it, and to push it to the limit to survive. Better yet, to triumph. Here are the three types of TURNS in **ICRPG**.



EXAMPLES of COMMON TURNS

ACTION ONLY: Sometimes, you're exactly where you want to be and staying put for this TURN. You might...

- Attack an enemy with a weapon
- Take a closer look at encoded glyphs or symbols
- Call upon magic power to cast a SPELL

MOVE NEAR + ACTION: Usually, you'll need to move just a bit to get where you're needed, then make a roll to do something. You might...

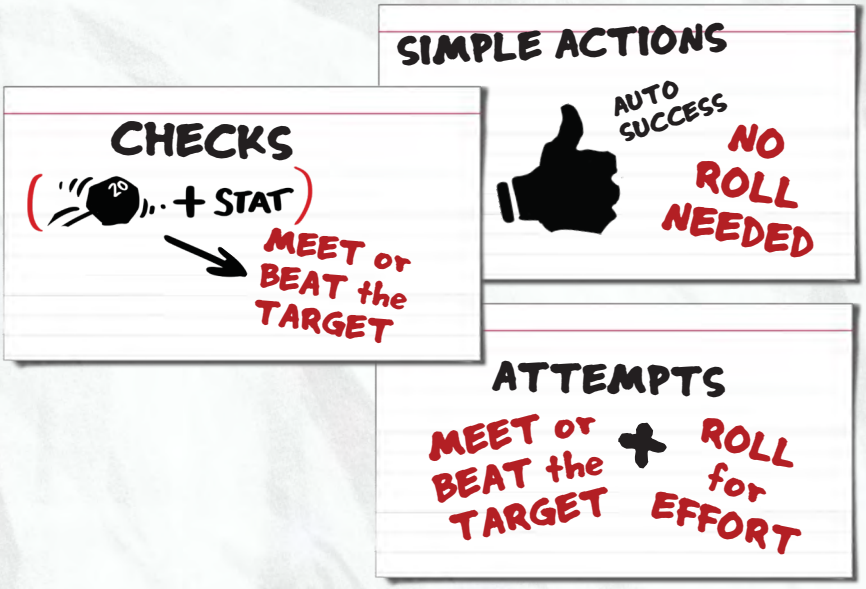
- Dash down a corridor and smash a hole in the wall
- Hurry to a friend and heal her injuries
- Move through a battlefield to block incoming arrows

MOVE FAR: Use your entire TURN just to move twice as far as normal. If you just need to move as far as you can, you might...

- Sprint down a dusty street to escape an explosion
- Run to reach your grav bike before the bad guys steal it
- Dash and slide under a slowly-closing stone doorway

THREE KINDS OF ACTIONS

In two of the three TURN types, you're rolling dice. That means you're taking an ACTION on your TURN. ACTIONS are where most of the **ICRPG** system takes hold of the game, and makes itself known! There are three types of ACTIONS, differentiated by how much work they take to succeed.



EXAMPLES of COMMON ACTIONS

SIMPLE ACTIONS: Some things are just cake. They take a moment of time, but no rolling is required. When doing a SIMPLE ACTION you might...

- Start up the engines on a starship
- Reel in the cable on a small cargo hoist
- Fix a saddle to your trusty steed

CHECKS: Instantaneous but uncertain ACTIONS require a single die roll. They either succeed or fail in a split second. When making a CHECK you might...

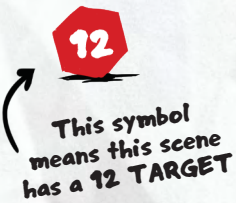
- Use your dexterity STAT to leap over a fissure in the ice
- Use your strength STAT to shove a wooden crate aside
- Use lock-picks (and a little elbow grease) to jimmy a locked door

ATTEMPTS: Larger tasks can take time to complete. ATTEMPTS involve a D20 roll, and rolling EFFORT to complete a task or destroy a foe. You might...

- Destroy a security droid with multiple blaster shots
- Translate a tablet covered in mysterious old runes
- Cut your way through a barricade with your battle axe

THE TARGET

Time for the nuts and bolts of making successful CHECKS and ATTEMPTS. In **ICRPG**, all the rolls in a scene are rolled against a single, all-powerful number: The TARGET. Whether it's to hit an enemy, the difficulty of scouting in heavy fog, or the cryptic symbols of a dead language. In one scene, there is only one TARGET, and all rolls must meet or beat that number to succeed.



The TARGET is usually somewhere between 10 and 18. GMs can find out more about setting and modifying TARGETS on page 103.

No matter what roll you're trying, you'll need a few pieces of info. Usually, you'll know these answers right away, based on what you're trying to do, but your GM is always there to help.

1: IS THIS A CHECK OR AN ATTEMPT?

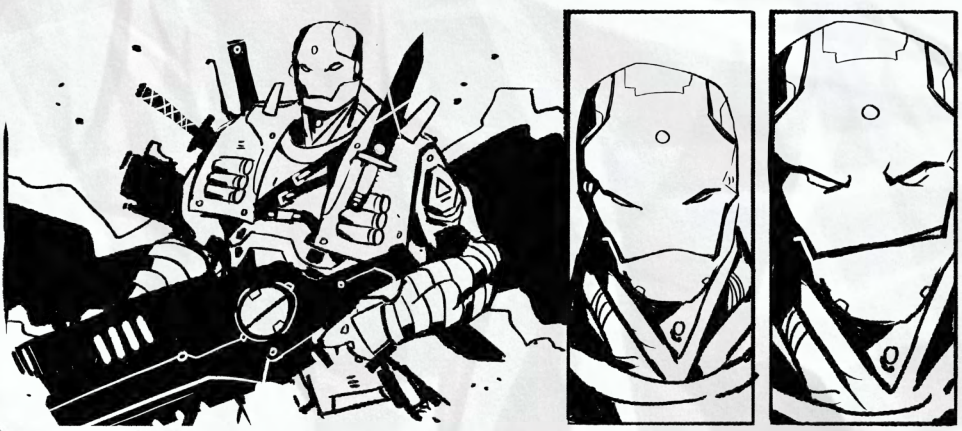
Sometimes it isn't clear if what you're trying will be instant or take repeated work. Either way, you'll need the next two answers before you roll.

2: WHAT STAT AM I USING TO HELP MY ROLL?

Characters have a set of STATS that describe their capability in different areas. Depending on what's being tried, you'll almost always get to add the value of one STAT to your D20. (see page 25)

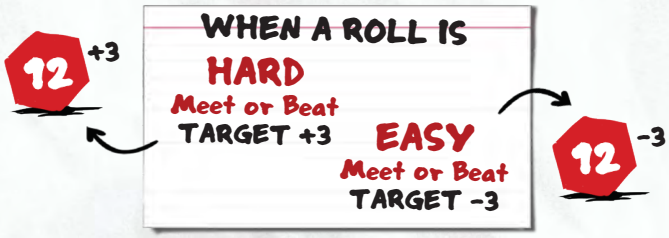
3: WHAT IS THE TARGET?

Every scene will have a number that's always in view. That's how difficult everything is in that scene. **Roll your almighty D20, add your STAT, and meet or beat that TARGET to succeed!** This simple process will be 90% of your rolls in **ICRPG**.



TARGET, EASY, AND HARD

Most rolls you make will be against the TARGET as it is shown. If a 14 is in view, you're rolling to meet or beat a 14 with a D20 plus one of your STATS. In the numerous possible situations of play, though, you will encounter rolls that are HARD and EASY. This a tool **ICRPG** uses to add detail to the game.



WHEN THINGS ARE EASY

If the TARGET is 15 or higher, you'll be looking for ways to make things EASY. Here are just a few examples of how and why rolls can be EASY.

- If you are using tools or implements that assist you
- If you tried the exact same ACTION last TURN but failed
- If another character is assisting you
- If LOOT you are using makes certain ACTIONS always EASY

WHEN THINGS ARE HARD

Sometimes you want to do something really cool, or really unlikely. Your GM may announce, "Ok, but that's a HARD roll." Here are just a few reasons some ACTIONS will be deemed HARD to make.

- If you are pushing for extra results from your action, like double damage
- If what you're trying to do is extraordinary or hard to believe possible
- If enemies or effects nearby are disrupting your focus or senses

CORE SYSTEM

ROLL FOR EFFORT!

One of the core innovations in **ICRPG** is the concept of EFFORT. EFFORT simplifies and consolidates all kinds of variations in the outcome of your successful ATTEMPT rolls. Not only does it classify types of outcomes into easy, clear dice categories, it lends new detail to tasks that aren't just doing damage.

Once you have made a successful ATTEMPT, it's time to **roll for EFFORT**!

BASIC

If you are only using your bare hands or your wits, roll a D4 after a successful ATTEMPT to do damage with a punch, bend bars with raw muscle, or take time to decipher a block of coded writing.

WEAPONS & TOOLS

Any time you are using a standard ranged or melee weapon to do damage, roll a D6. Also roll a D6 when using tools to accomplish a task such as using a pry bar to open a jammed door, using bandages to cure a wound, or using a micro torch to seal a bulkhead hatch.

GUNS

Firearms are deadly. Any time you're using a gun to attack an enemy and do damage, roll a D8. Guns also come in many forms, with special ways to deal devastating damage.

MAGIC & ENERGY

Roll a D10 for EFFORT when you are casting explosive magic or using arcane energy. Also roll a D10 for any weapon or effect that employs energy such as particle beams, lasers or plasma. Healing with magical power? That would also be a D10.

ULTIMATE

Ah, the almighty D12. When you roll a critical success on your ATTEMPT, a natural 20 on the D20 roll, you'll roll the type of EFFORT above that fits, and add a D12 on top of that roll! You have excelled at your ATTEMPT with ULTIMATE results!

HEARTS AND EFFORT

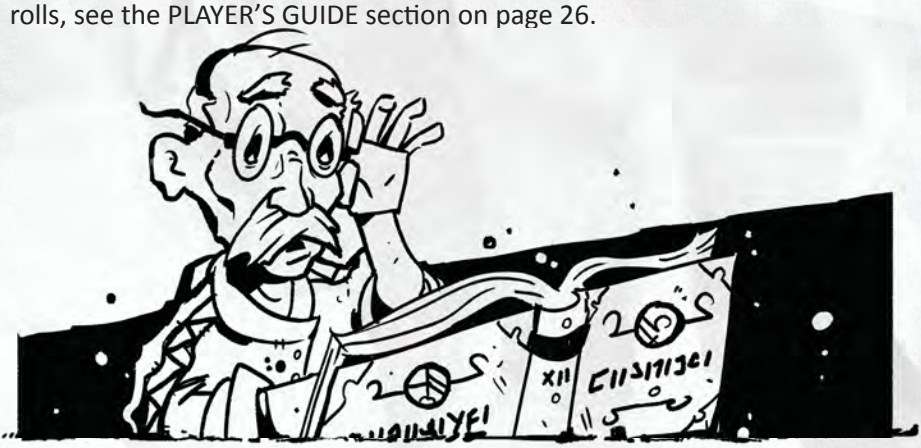
As you just noticed reading about EFFORT dice, you will be rolling against all kinds of tasks with EFFORT, not just rolling damage! Anything that can't be accomplished in an instant will need EFFORT to complete. Once you get your head around this, you'll see how versatile the system really is, and how it encourages all kinds of play beyond just doing damage.

How much EFFORT do you need to complete a task or destroy an enemy? That is where HEARTS come in!

Just like the classic video games of yesteryear, **ICRPG** uses HEARTS to show how many HIT POINTS (HP) an enemy has, or how much EFFORT is needed to overcome a task. **One HEART is equal to 10 points of EFFORT** or damage needed. It's an arbitrary symbol to make the numbers distinct and easy to look at.

Using a sword, attacking a monster with 2 HEARTS? Do 20 points of damage with the D6 WEAPON die to be victorious! Using a magical translation SPELL to decode 1 HEART of ancient runes? You'll need to roll a total of 10 with your D10 MAGIC die... it could be done in one TURN!

The GM will have all kinds of detail to offer with how many HEARTS a task or enemy has to overcome. Your job is to make those ATTEMPTS and roll as much EFFORT as you can. For more about building your character to boost EFFORT rolls, see the PLAYER'S GUIDE section on page 26.



MOVEMENT AND DISTANCE

Countless hours, mechanics, and questions are spent in RPGs about who is how far from what. Can I reach that wall? Is the ogre too far away to attack? **ICRPG** solves all this unnecessary detail with a simpler treatment of distance. Whatever it may be, it's either CLOSE, NEAR, FAR, or OUT OF RANGE.

CLOSE

If you can reach it with your fingers, just standing there, it's CLOSE. This is toe-to-toe range, sword-fighting distance, and no move is needed to use or interact with CLOSE things.

NEAR

A few hurried steps get you to NEAR things. Imagine NEAR as being a few seconds away, things within reach of long spears, the distance of a quick-draw, or how far you can move in a TURN and still have time for an ACTION. On the average tabletop, it's about 6 inches or so, about the length of a banana. Keep it loose. The real focus is on time, not exact distance.

FAR

Well beyond NEAR, FAR takes you several seconds to run. The distance of a basic bowshot, as far as throwing a baseball, or a very challenging pistol shot. If you want to move FAR on your TURN, it will take the entire TURN to do so. An explosion with a FAR radius would be a huge blast! Look out!

OUT OF RANGE

Beyond FAR, as you play out a scene, is a distance you can't reach in one TURN of movement, and none of your effects can reach. OUT OF RANGE defines the area in which most of the current action is happening, or you might want to move OUT OF RANGE of enemy fire! Even your allies cannot help you if you are OUT OF RANGE, so be careful splitting the group!

During play, your GM will help describe and answer questions about whether something is CLOSE, NEAR or FAR. It isn't about exact measurements, it's about what is thematically within reach of your character! Keep it loose and keep things moving, rather than getting out the ruler.

TIME CAN BE SIMPLE, TOO

As you read onward, thinking about cool ideas for characters, monsters, encounters or even full adventures, you'll see time referred to in a few precise ways. As always, **ICRPG** keeps it simple.

TURN

When a player takes the stage for a few brief moments, moving and doing a few rolls, that is 1 TURN. A TURN is 10-20 seconds of action.

ROUND

When every player at the table, including the GM, has taken a TURN, that is 1 ROUND. ROUNDS are often used to measure lasting effects, countdowns, or other things that last more than a few seconds. A ROUND is something like a minute in the game world, even if it takes longer to play.

FREEFORM

When something takes several minutes, hours, or even days to play out, there is less and less reason to sweat the details, or firmly enforce playing in TURNS. It's still smart to keep moving around your table, addressing each player's decisions during this stretch of time, but you won't be accurately measuring movement or damage output. Things get more descriptive, and your GM will be introducing more ways to use dice to keep the story moving.

GUYS, I THINK I'M DEAD

As characters struggle to stop evil forces, explore lost ruins, or battle back tides of alien invaders, death is never far away. In fact, if death is not a constant fear, the game has no real guts to it, no realism in its own context. To make this aspect of the game work well, a decisive, sudden set of rules around death are needed. **ICRPG** has a few twists on the classic rules of other games.

WHEN YOU REACH 0 HP

As you take damage in the bone-crunching worlds of **ICRPG**, you'll eventually find yourself at 0. At that instant, your character drops unconscious. All SPELLS or effects you were creating vanish, and you're bleeding out fast. The clock is ticking on your life.

ROLL FOR DYING!

On your NEXT TURN after you drop to 0 HP, roll a 1D4. Pray you roll high, because in that many ROUNDS, without help or a MIRACLE, your character will die with a capital D.

IT'S A MIRACLE!

On each of your TURNS while you're DYING, you get a very narrow chance to miraculously regain consciousness. Roll a D20. If it's a natural 20, some miracle of anatomy has brought you back awake with 1 HP. It's a MIRACLE!

NOPE, HE'S DEAD FOR REAL

If all your DYING ROUNDS pass, no one helps you, and you can't roll a MIRACLE, you are dead. No more rolls, no back door tricks. You're toast.

BLOWN TO BITS

One last thing. If you take so much damage in one cataclysmic instant to reduce your character to -20 HP, you are BLOWN TO BITS. You're just mist and memories. There isn't even a body to bury.

RECOVERY

I don't want to die! I want to *live*! There are a few ways to recover HP and avoid becoming a skeleton, besides hoping to roll a MIRACLE after you've been pummeled to pulp.

RECOVER

At any time during play, sacrifice your TURN to pause, regain your breath, bind a few cuts, and RECOVER your gusto. To do so, roll a **D20 + your CON STAT**, and meet or beat the current TARGET. If you can do so, **regain your CON STAT + 1** in HP instantly. Now get back in the fight!

DON'T DIE ON ME, MAN!

If you are unconscious and bleeding out, counting down precious DYING ROUNDS, you need help. If an ally can reach you and make a successful roll with INT or WIS STATS on the current TARGET, your DYING timer stops in its tracks. You're stable, but unconscious, and owe that ally your life.

RECOVER

Meet or beat the current TARGET with D20 + CON to RECOVER CON + 1 HP

DON'T DIE ON ME, MAN!

Stabilize a fallen ally by touching them and making an INT or WIS roll. This stops their DYING timer

HEALING AND FIRST AID

Be it through magical means (D10) or medical tools like bandages (D6), you or allies can heal you during battle. There are many ways to heal and be healed, as you'll discover the more you play.

THE LEGENDARY HERO COIN

Ok, you have all the roots of the game system now, you're ready to start bending rules. That's what they're made for, anyway. As you go deeper into things, you'll get all kinds of abilities and LOOT that will make things get crazy. Before those days come, though, it's time to learn of **ICRPG's** final feature: the HERO COIN.

We haven't talked about it much yet, but a great session of tabletop play owes itself to exciting, sincere, inventive role-play by players. This elusive element of the hobby is the topic of much discussion. Is it talking in character? Sacrificing self for others? Is it taking the game in new directions? Is it making the table more fun for everyone? It's all these things.

When the GM sees this kind of excitement in play, the HERO COIN is the way that moment is celebrated. "That was brilliant, take a HERO COIN!"

USING YOUR HERO COIN

Here are the rules for the coveted HERO COIN, once granted by the GM.

- You can only have 1 HERO COIN at a time, no hoarding
- Turn your HERO COIN in to re-roll any die roll
- Turn in your HERO COIN to add a D12 onto any die roll
- You can GIVE your HERO COIN to another player at any time during play

THE GREY HILL INFERNO

Below is a trial scenario to get you warmed up and rolling dice. No amount of reading teaches as much as a few dice rolls. Let's dive right in.

THE SETUP: A NIGHT OF CHAOS

You are a prisoner in the Grey Hill Complex. You have no memory of anything else beyond the needles, the experiments, the concrete. Whoever they are, they are using arcane machines and glowing goo to make you a super weapon. It just might work. That's when the fire breaks out. Go time.

ESCAPE THE FIRE

As flames consume D block, you must escape your cell or be burned alive. Roll a D4. You have that many ROUNDS to break out of your cell with your bare hands. Do 1 HEART of BASIC EFFORT against a 10 TARGET to break free.

DEFEAT WEAPON 13

In the courtyard, an abomination has been deployed to detain you. There's no avoiding it. Time to fight, jagged steel in your hand. You have 1 HEART HP, Weapon 13 also has 1 HEART HP. You attack with WEAPON EFFORT, it fights back with two BASIC EFFORT attacks per TURN. Kill or be killed.

FLEE INTO THE DARK

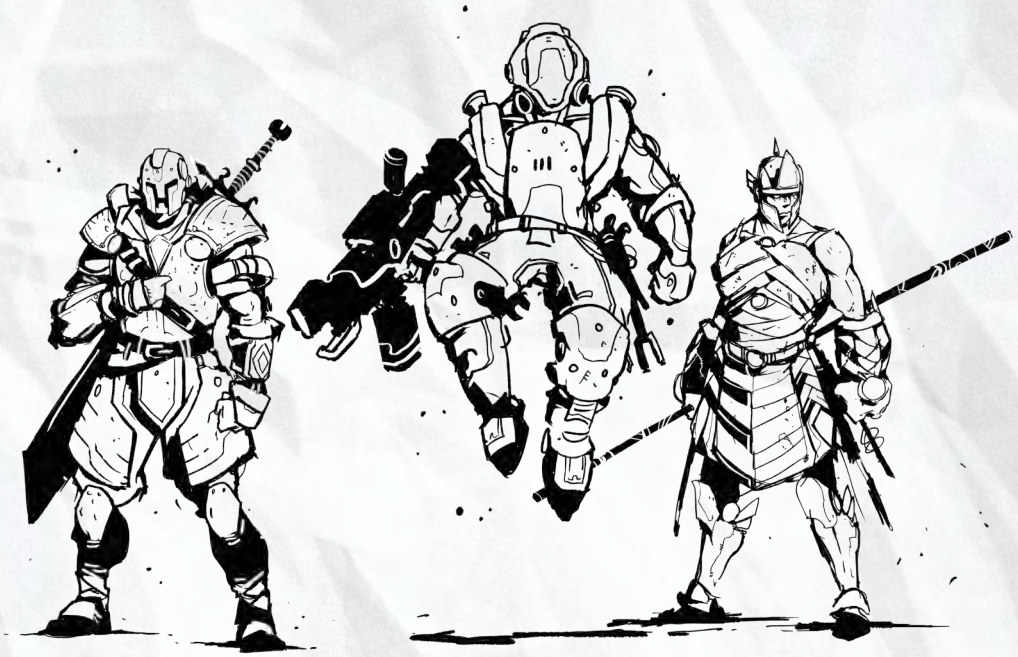
Sprint through the forests beyond Grey Hill, and vanish into shadow. If you don't escape, no one will live to make them pay. Roll a D4. That many guards, armed with piercing bright lanterns, are searching for you. For each guard, make 1 successful CHECK to stay hidden. For each failure, face one guard with your ragged weapon. Guards have 1 HEART HP and also fight with WEAPON EFFORT, launching a single attack against you on their TURN.

Did you escape the Grey Hill Inferno? If so, take a HERO COIN. You've earned it.

WHEN A CHOICE FEELS OBVIOUS, THAT'S INSTINCT

SEEK NOT THE 'BEST' PATH IN THINGS

MAKE YOUR OWN LEGEND, YOUR WAY



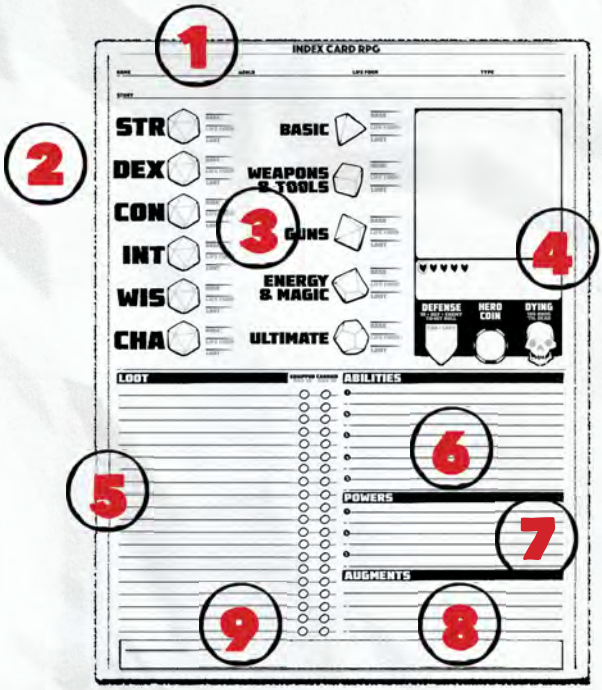
WE CAN BE HEROES

If you've flipped right to this page, you're here to *play* **ICRPG**. Crack those knuckles and settle in; there's no limit to what's ahead. Creating and playing an RPG character can be sublime, if you let yourself get into it. This is the realm of imagination! What use have we for hesitation, or doing what is expected? We can be heroes, especially here where anything is possible! Here's what you'll find in this section.

- **Character Basics:** Let's get started with getting to know an **ICRPG** character sheet, all the STATS, and how you'll be using the whole mess to kick butt.
- **Life Forms:** Ah, the myriad forms heroes can take. Bend your STATS a bit here, and build to fit whatever world you're playing in.
- **STATS and Abilities:** All you need to know about what you can and can't do are in 6 core STATS and a small group of Abilities. You'll be earning more for both as you evolve.
- **Glorious Gear:** Now that you are you, you need to gear up for what's ahead. Don't forget the rope.
- **Magic:** Secret, arcane forces are hidden just beneath our perception of reality. Master the many dimensions, conjure the power of the elements, or harness cosmic energy at will.
- **Mastery:** No matter what your world, specialization, or role in your group, the MASTERY system lets you diversify or focus your capability as you grow and, most importantly, roll 20s.

CHARACTER BASICS: THE SHEET

Take a look ahead. Here's the sheet you'll be filling out (or just doodle your own) for each **ICRPG** character you create.



1: What **WORLD** is this? Start with your character WORLD, NAME (make it cool), LIFE FORM, TYPE and STORY. This is who and what you are, and how you wound up outside ordinary life, on the road to adventure.

2: These 6 **STATS** should feel familiar. You'll be spending points to boost these core STATS, and your LIFE FORM and LOOT will top them off. Build your STATS to fit a concept of who the character is and what they're best at.

3: Here is where you'll record your **EFFORT** bonuses. Think of it as your training.

4: This is a cluster of critical **STATUS** info. Track your HIT POINTS. DEFENSE is used to track your armor and toughness. Mark an X when you have a HERO COIN, and record a DYING roll here when you make one.

5: LOOT! Keep track of the equipment you carry and use.

6: As you progress, you'll unlock **ABILITIES**, starting with 1 and a max 5.

7: POWERS are more rare than abilities, and will set you apart.

8: AUGMENTS in some WORLDS, heroes are boosted by cybernetics.

9: MASTERY is a way to track natural 20s and gain more ABILITIES.

WHAT WORLD IS THIS?

ICRPG takes place in one of 5 WORLDS, or a WORLD of your own making. The WORLD is a sense of overall theme, of technology, of scope and era. It defines every decision afterwards, from how characters are built to what each session will be. The WORLD is the root from which all the adventures ahead flow, what the obstacles and enemies will be like, and more.

Here is a brief summary of the WORLDS in this book. To get started building a character, finish reading through the basic steps in the next few pages. If you're hungry for more, and your GM doesn't mind, find out more in the WORLDS section later in the book.

ALFHEIM

A continent of spells and steel, crumbling old castles and sleeping dragons. Adventurers here face violent seas, lost tombs, and treacherous kings.

WARP SHELL

A breed of living starships is driven by mysterious purpose to save a doomed universe. You and your allies are the crew on one such vessel, and time is running out, if there is such a thing.

GHOST MOUNTAIN

The inhabitants of a remote western landscape are caught in a battle between heaven and hell. If the sun ever sets, it will never rise again. This is a WORLD of pistols and ghosts, demons and dust.

VIGILANTE CITY

After the Mutant Crisis of 2035, chaos has gripped the world's biggest city, and you're at ground zero. Super-powered heroes and villains are popping up all over, and no one is safe in the crossfire. Found in **ICRPG** VIGILANTE CITY.

BLOOD AND SNOW

Before any of it, humankind found its fragile origin in an age of ice and silence. Balanced on the knife-edge of survival, you and your tribe must find a way, or none of these stories will have ever happened. Found in BLOOD AND SNOW.

STEP 1: WHO AND WHAT YOU ARE

Before we get into the mechanical aspects of building a character comes the most important step: the CONCEPT. The best way to formulate a CONCEPT is to find a visual anchor for your character. Draw your own portrait, or find artwork that inspires you! Let yourself get into it. Devise a cool NAME. Keep your mind on that visual anchor, and start filling out all the bits on your sheet to fit.

CHOOSE YOUR LIFE FORM

Are you an elf? A mech? A silicate shapeshifter? An undead revenant? Each WORLD in **ICRPG** has a set of LIFE FORMS to choose from. Reach back to your CONCEPT rather than nitpicking the STAT bonus.

CHOOSE YOUR TYPE

As you lean further into the WORLD your character will live in, and start to feel it, you can see your place in that world as a hero. Nothing will affect your STATS and role in your group more than your TYPE, so choose with care. TYPES are listed with the WORLD they are from.

WRITE A ONE-LINE STORY

Before you start figuring out how the STATS add up, take a moment to explain one key fact about your character. This isn't a backstory, or a past. This is what is happening right now to this character. What has changed in your life that has pushed you from the humdrum to a life of adventure? How does it involve the other players' characters? If you're drawing a blank, look deeper into the WORLD you're playing in, and chat with your GM.

STEP 2: CORE STATS

Almost every time you're rolling a D20 to do something in play, you'll be adding 1 of 6 STATS to the result. These classic 6 STATS describe your specialties, your prowess, and help define your role in a group. The idea is to stack whatever STAT fits your heroic CONCEPT best, using STAT POINTS, a bonus from your LIFE FORM, and all the bonuses from LOOT you will eventually acquire.

For every character you create in **ICRPG**, start by assigning 6 STAT POINTS, in any array, to these 6 core STATS. Enter the points assigned in the 'BASE' line next to each die box. You could put 1 point in each, creating a generalist, or place all 6 in one STAT for the ultimate specialized hero. It's your call. Now is the moment to remember your CONCEPT and emphasize STATS that fit!

ASSIGN 6 POINTS, IN ANY ARRAY, TO STATS

STRENGTH (STR)
Put points into STR to create a melee fighter, a crusher, a bar-bending, boulder-throwing behemoth who smashes his way through problems.

DEXTERITY (DEX)
You'll be using DEX to make ranged attacks, like guns and bows. DEX is also a measure of how nimble you are, so you'll roll with that STAT when you are trying to move silently, do back flips, or deftly run along crumbling rooftops.

CONSTITUTION (CON)
CON measures how stout or tough you are. This STAT is used when recovering HP, bracing for impact, or fighting to survive poison or terrible cold.

INTELLIGENCE (INT)
Some heroes use wits over fists. Their key STAT is INT, which is used to cast SPELLS, investigate mysteries, recall details, or operate complex machinery.

WISDOM (WIS)
This STAT measures an intuitive, organic kind of smarts. It isn't so much knowing as it is feeling. How keen is your sixth sense? Place points here to be a scout, to be in tune with nature, or to feel danger coming.

CHARISMA (CHA)
Your strength of will is measured by CHARISMA. You'll be using this to roll for persuasive actions, to resist fear, or drive enemies back with a battle cry.

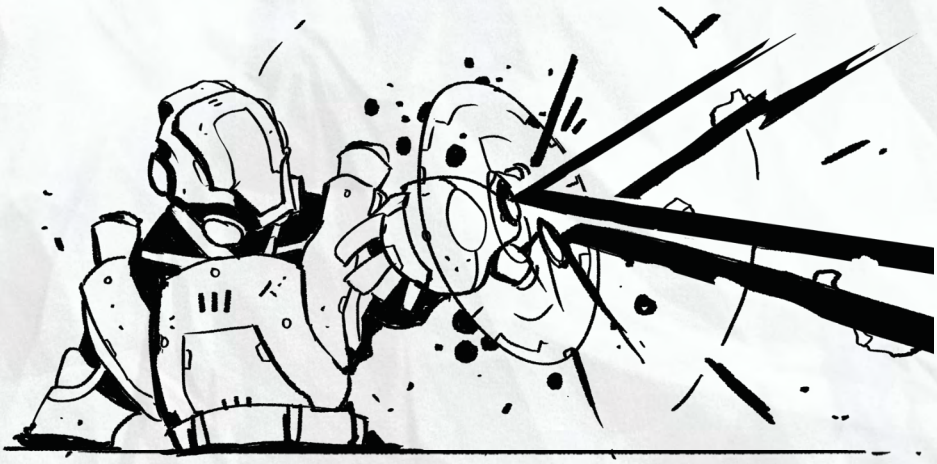
CALCULATING DEFENSE

Once you have your CON STAT, add all DEFENSE gained from LOOT you have, such as armor. That's your total DEFENSE. A helmet may be +2 DEF, you have +2 CON, this makes your DEFENSE +4. When the GM unleashes effects or monster abilities, she'll call 'roll DEFENSE!' Roll D20 + DEFENSE, and meet or beat the current TARGET to resist the danger! When enemies roll ATTEMPTS against you, they don't roll on the TARGET, they roll to meet or beat 10 + your DEFENSE! ***No character, by any means, can exceed +10 DEFENSE*** no matter the total of CON and DEFENSE gained from LOOT.

STEP 3: BOOST EFFORT TYPES

In the CORE SYSTEM section, you learned about the central concept of rolling for EFFORT in **ICRPG** (p. 12). Here's your chance to add bonuses onto those rolls during character creation, giving your character affinity for weapons, magic, or the risky business of ULTIMATE. You're allotted 4 total POINTS to spend here.

ASSIGN 4 POINTS TO EFFORT



STAT MAX

No matter how awesome your character may become, no STAT can ever exceed +10

STEP 4: LOCATE STATUS INFO

Below your character portrait artwork, and at the sheet bottom, you'll find spots to track STATUS. Take a second to get familiar, as you'll be making a mess here during play.

HEARTS & HP
All characters start with 1 HEART, or 10 Hit Points. Circle additional HEARTS as your character grows. You can acquire HEARTS several ways as you play.

HERO COIN
A big, hard-to-miss spot to record a HERO COIN. See page 18.

DYING
Don't die. Read up on the DYING rules back on page 16. Track it here.

MASTERY
The highest form of progression for a character is called MASTERY. Each time you roll a natural 20 on a D20 roll, mark one point of mastery on your sheet. When you have 20 mastery points, you've made it! You have now mastered an element of your character!

Here's the best part: once you've reached MASTERY, clear out all your MASTERY points and choose any MASTERY ABILITY for your TYPE! If that ABILITY calls for a specific STARTING LOOT, gain it instantly! Yes, MASTERY is huge.

This process can be done 3 times per character. How long will it take you to roll 60 natural 20s? You're about to find out.

NATURAL & MODIFIED

You'll notice 'NATURAL' and 'MODIFIED' rolls mentioned. NATURAL means just the number rolled, MODIFIED means the total after bonuses are added!

STEP 5: RECORD ABILITIES

ABILITY is a term **ICRPG** uses to describe a feature of your character that is intrinsic. It can never be lost or removed. You'll gain a few ABILITIES when the character is created, and when you reach a MILESTONE. It's important to peruse character ABILITIES, because they greatly impact your specialization, areas to outshine others, and value to a group. Some ABILITIES interact with others in powerful ways... when this happens it is called 'synergy,' and it's cool.

CHOOSE 1 ABILITY FROM YOUR TYPE

STEP 5: CHOOSE POWERS

There are heroes, and there are *super* heroes. If you are creating a character in VIGILANTE CITY, or a character with superhuman capability in any WORLD, you'll be selecting and using POWERS. POWERS are like ABILITIES, they can never be taken away once gained, but they are nearly unlimited in potential. POWERS, unlike ABILITIES, will never be added to your character. They can only upgrade over time.

CREATING A SUPERHERO CHARACTER,
CHOOSE ANY 3 POWERS

STEP 6: RECORD AUGMENTS

Some stories alter the heroes themselves. When technology, digital or arcane, is integrated into living bodies, those are AUGMENTS. These are mainly found as cybernetic implants in cyberpunk games, but every genre has the potential for mechanical limbs or eerie crystal eyes.

STEP 7: GET LOOT!

Here is where **ICRPG** really finds its identity, besides the ever-useful index cards themselves: LOOT! The majority of your character's progression and power will be in what LOOT you have and use. LOOT can be found, awarded, created, traded, lost, and destroyed. Even SPELLS are kept on scrolls or in books. Gems, chains, and counterweights enhance weapons. From the magical to the digital, what you CARRY versus what you keep EQUIPPED will let you tune and adjust your character for all kinds of special capability. Complete your new character by choosing 4 BASIC LOOT, then follow the two key rules below as you grow and gather more goodies.

TAKE 1 STARTING LOOT FROM YOUR TYPE
TAKE ANY 4 BASIC LOOT FROM YOUR WORLD

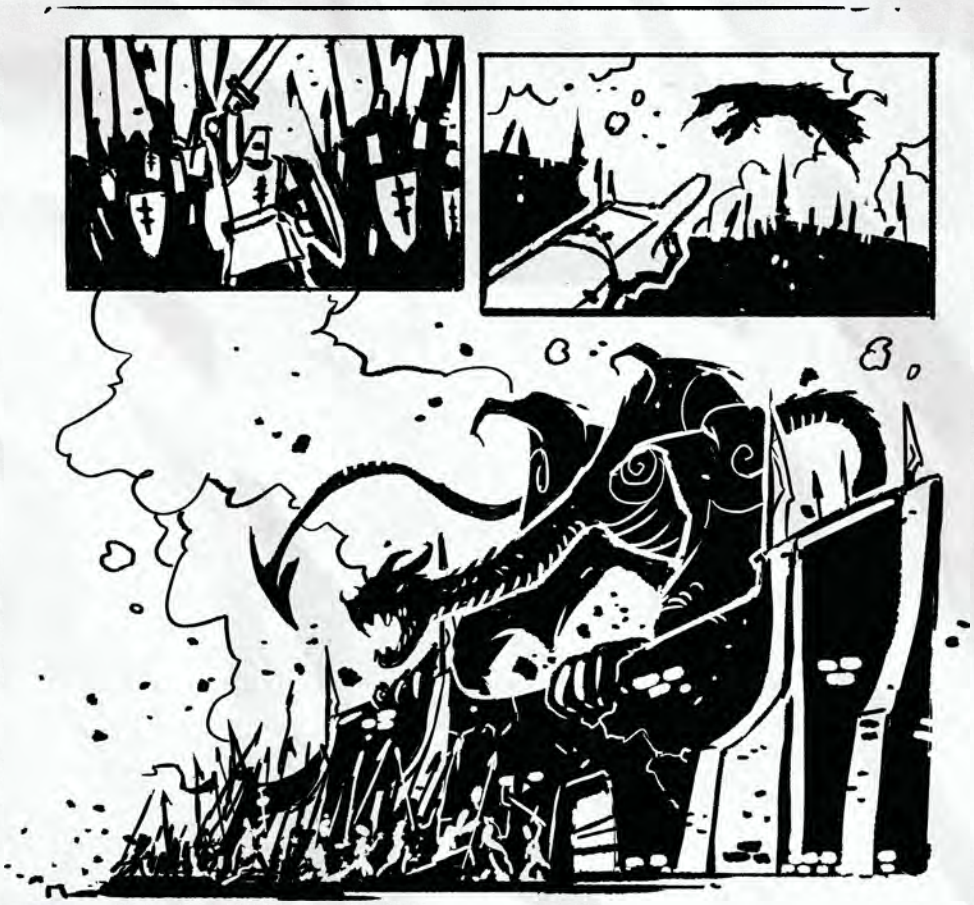
STARTING/MILESTONE

Always feel free to choose ABILITIES or LOOT for your TYPE either as STARTING or MILESTONE reward!
More possibilities is always good!

INVENTORY IS LIMITED TO
10 CARRIED ITEMS AND 10 EQUIPPED ITEMS

CARRIED ITEMS MUST BE EQUIPPED
TO OFFER BENEFIT OR BE USED

ALFHEIM: AN AGE OF KINGDOMS



In a remote corner of the cosmos, a planet called Urth is orbited by a shattered moon called Iron Heart. Here, the epoch of castles and steel has lingered for centuries. The nations of this blue world rise and fall, not realizing their role in the wider universe or their pivotal possession of mythic WIZARD LOCKS, which bind all times and places together.

The largest continent here is Alfheim. Somewhere between the quiet of the primordial days and the smoke of the machine age it rests. Magic and mystery still hold this place, but it is a vast, diverse landscape of cultures and places.

Many great stories have come to pass on Alfheim, none more important than now. The arrival of the starfaring TORTONS has brought this world into the cosmic conflict. The peoples here are beginning to realize that before they can take their place in the struggle of the stars, they must survive a war that could destroy them all. Onto this landscape you arrive, and heroic deeds need doing.

6 THINGS YOUR CHARACTER KNOWS

These 6 facts are known across all the realms of Alfheim and should, in some way, affect the origin story of every character you create. Troubled times...

KING HENRYK IS MISSING
The armies of Sett, the undead serpent god from Kath, have decimated human culture in recent years. This offensive culminated with the disappearance and presumed death of the crown King of Alfheim: Henryk the Hawk. Almost nothing is known of what happened. Darkness and ruin followed.

IRADRUM HAS BEEN DESTROYED
When Durathrax, the ageless dragon, was released by a band of wizards, her fury was terrible. The vast mountain city of Iradrum was utterly destroyed, sending a population of Dwarves East, where their numbers and resolve are growing in Duradin.

GERBLINS HAVE JOINED MANKIND
Once a scapegoat for every form of petty villainy, GERBLINS have risen from their old ways and embraced a new nobility. Their society has also gained new technological advancements, and is ready to make war. Standing at the very brink of open war with the Elves of Skar, GERBLINS have been sent to every corner of the world seeking allies in the coming chaos.

SNOW ORCS HAVE ORGANIZED
Once an obscure but numerous tribe in Nordheim, Snow Orcs now dominate Arlston, Gilhelm and New Haven. It is not known what has made them so mighty so fast, but they rival any army in the realms with their battle prowess.

ELVES HAVE TAKEN SKAR
Using the North and East Colossi as super-weapons, Elves have conquered the plains of Skar, and are readying for a wider war on the middle lands of Alfheim. Many themes and adventures in Alfheim hinge on the looming war with this advanced, devious invader.

TORTON REFUGEES HAVE ARRIVED
Amid all the turmoil, a peaceful group of ragtag folk, resembling turtles, has been arriving in desperate poverty and confusion from distant shores. They are the TORTONS, a star-faring people on the brink of extinction. They seek only to make Alfheim their new home, but it seems they will be forced to fight for that dream.

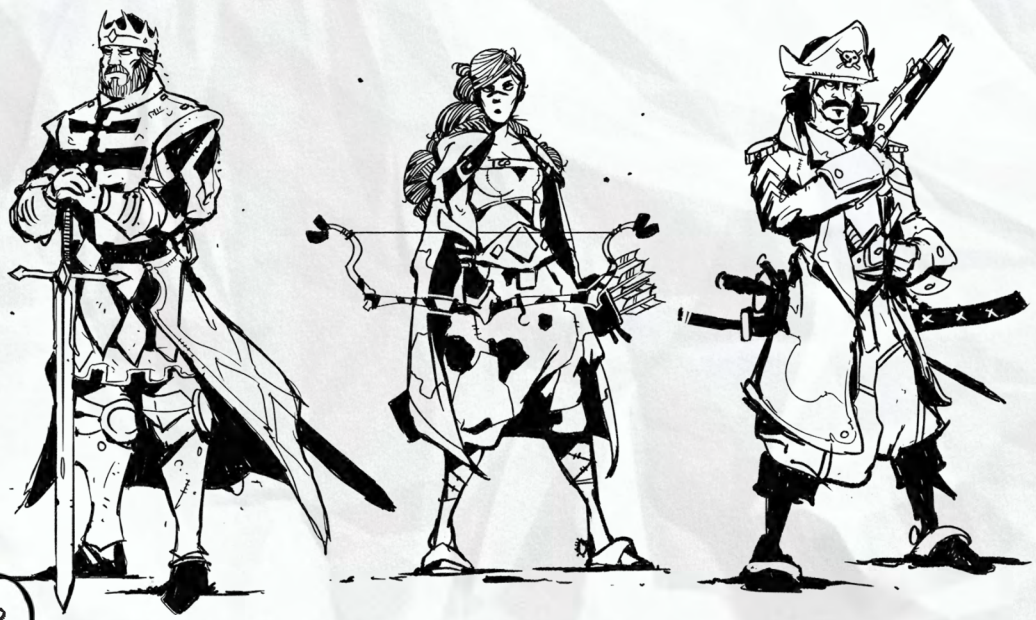
LIFE FORMS OF ALFHEIM

Since the armies of Sett were defeated by Snow Orcs, the powers have shifted. The woodling folk of old have vanished, subsumed by their elder kin the elves. Gerblins have ended their epoch of evil. The turtle-like Tortons have arrived from distant shores, bringing new magical insights. Dwarves grow in number after the destruction of their home. Where do you fit in this ever-changing tapestry... *Choose one:*

HUMAN >> +1 INT, +1 CHA

The great city of Grey was once the seat of humankind. Now that it is mostly ruin, destroyed by the serpent armies of Sett, humankind finally feels the pain of dwindling minority, and elves hunt them to extinction. Despite all this, there is strength in their blood; a resolve to rise again. When you choose to play a HUMAN in Alfheim, your reason for being is... *choose one:*

- **LINEAGE:** Facing a real possibility of extinction, HUMANS in Alfheim place great value on heritage and family lines. You are driven to find and protect what remains of Henryk's descendants.
- **ANSWERS:** The rout of man was a terrible calamity. How it all happened remains largely unexplained. You intend to find out.
- **ESCAPE:** The ruined life of your kin is a desperate, dirty thing. You refuse a life in a tomb, and seek the open spaces and far horizons of the world.
- **RALLY:** If a new HUMAN realm is to be formed, ranks must be bolstered, hearts won, and swords lifted. Your destiny is to lead them.



DWARF >> +1 STR, +1 CON

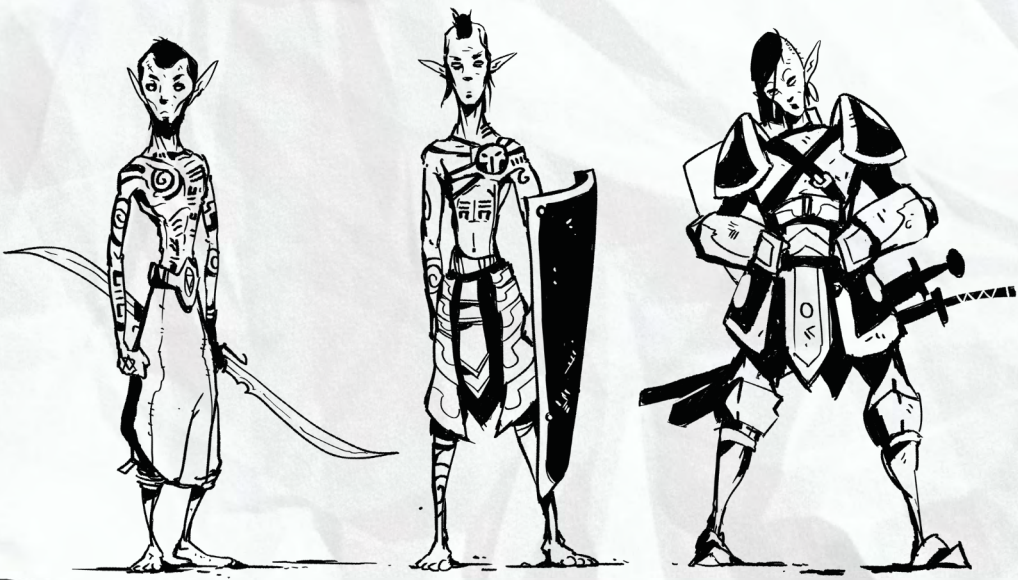
The durable 'stout folk' have flourished in this new age. The destruction of Iradrum, and disappearance of their ancient enemy Durathrax, have bolstered their resolve. They stand as a vast, unified force in Ramthas and Duradin, set to make war with the overtaken lands of Skar. When you choose to play a DWARF in Alfheim, your core motivation is... *Choose one:*

- **EXPANSION:** You and your allies are sent by King Rom to press DWARVISH borders outward. Either by garrison, or skirmishing, or exploration, you are part of a larger effort to occupy all the East lands of Alfheim.
- **SERVICE:** An iron-clad code of honor rules DWARF life. Yours is consumed by a single, unshaking vow or blood oath you cannot break. This could be to a task or an individual, to a town or a governor. Either way, you will die for this oath, it is only a matter of time.
- **PLUNDER:** Emboldened by their day in the sun, some DWARVES take to thievery, seeking out powerful relics or glimmering treasures to win King Rom's favor and bring glory to Dur Moro's vaults. You may even have many treasure caches across Alfheim, stacking coin and jewels for the rainy days of war.
- **ENVOY:** Only with the help of all good folk will the DWARVES be victorious against the elven incursion from the North. You have been deployed to befriend men, GERBLINS, ELFISH dissidents, and even the TORTONS to see it done. You are a peacemaker, a representative of the throne, or simply one driven to end the killing in Skar.

ELF >> +1 DEX, +1 CHA

Once confined to Aphos and beyond, the ELVES have become an invading force of terrible power in the North of Alfheim. To claim a new kingdom, they have chosen to decimate the nomadic peoples of Skar, and eradicate Wildlings, Hill people and Small Folk as 'degenerates.' Not all of them are tyrants though. Their dissidents are growing in number, and betraying their misguided leaders to join the resistance. When you play an ELF in Alfheim, your story will be dark and troubled... *Choose one:*

- **FUGITIVE:** Wishing only to be rid of their bloodthirsty regime, you have fled the ELVEN nation. This is punishable by death, and they are in pursuit.
- **INSURGENT:** Your life is dedicated to undermining the ELVEN agenda with sabotage, mayhem, and infiltration. You use disguise, deception, and any other means necessary to destroy their war machines and embarrass their leaders. If pressed, your resistance is even called fanatic.
- **PILGRIM:** You have chosen a path of peace, helping those hurt by ELVEN aggression. You are mostly a non-combatant, claiming immunity on the battlefield. If pressed, however, you will die to protect the innocent.
- **LONER:** Tattoos are forbidden in ELF society. You have chosen a lonely path, etching yourself with ink and throwing off worldly possessions. You are nihilistic, lost, tumbling from one violent encounter to the next in search of meaning in a cruel, thankless world.



TORTON >> +1 CON, +1 MAGIC EFFORT

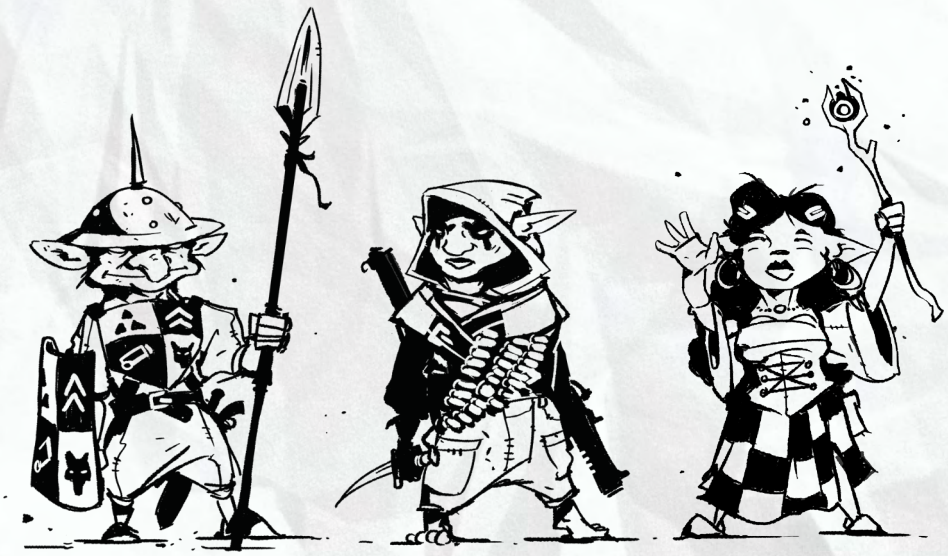
In recent years, a stream of TORTON refugees has been arriving at Xenos, Kath, and Duradin. They come by sea, and some seem to simply appear from thin air. Their fate is bound to the vanishing WARP SHELLS, and rebuilding their lost culture. TORTONS also possess an intuitive sense for magic, having traversed vast dimensions of space to build a home here. If you play a TORTON in Alfheim, you will be a mysterious figure... *Choose one:*

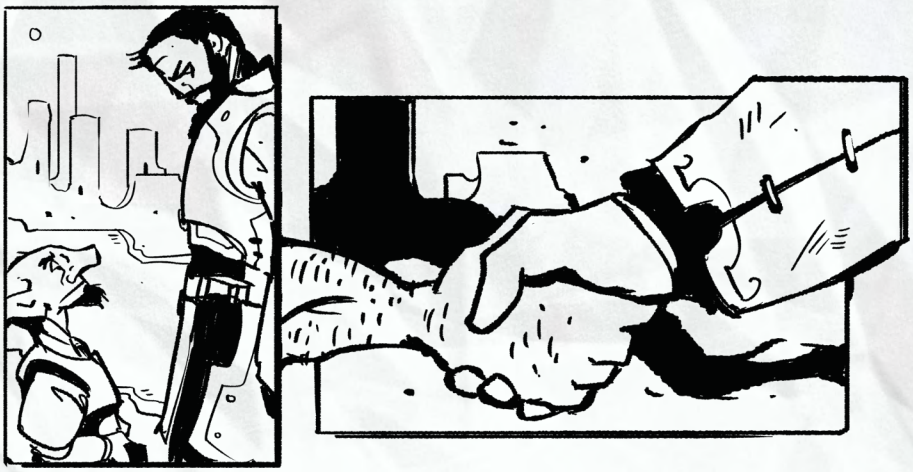
- **THE WAY:** The patient TORTON mind is attuned to forces of intuition and magical energy. You are a student of this 'quiet path,' and work to use your powers for good at every turn.
- **STARGAZER:** You know that TORTONS came from the stars, but how, when and why remain a mystery. Your purpose is to find out what has befallen your lost folk, and you will go to the end of ends to do so.
- **APPRENTICE:** TORTON society is built on a master-and-student tradition. You have found your master, and sworn to serve. At times, this means simply training your body and mind. At others, it means embarking on impossible quests to accomplish the unthinkable.
- **PROTECTOR:** Knowing what it means to lose everything, to have no home, you are sworn never to let others experience such terrible loss. You fight to protect the weak, stand up to bullies at every turn, and become entangled in all kinds of do-gooder causes and village plights. One of these days, you may find yourself in over your head.

GERBLIN >> +1 DEX, +1 GUN EFFORT

The newest warrior queen of Thushum has shifted the GERBLIN way of life to one of nobility and good. Part of this shift is a newfound code of honor that each vows a blood oath to uphold. In their newfound role as a force of good, GERBLINS face many challenges, and never back down from evil. Inventive and adept, they stand at the forefront of Alfhemic technology and a looming war with the elves of Skar... *Choose one:*

- **KNIGHT:** Heavily armored and empowered by a writ of law and order, you are charged with living a nomadic life, and bringing the power of righteous strength to those in need. You break no law and harm no innocent, always ready to serve.
- **GUN PRIEST:** Advances in flintlock technology have had a profound effect on GERBLIN kind. The scales of warfare are shifting, and as a GUN PRIEST, you are on the forefront of crafting, modifying, and using firearms to great effect.
- **ROYAL ERRAND:** The warrior queen of Thushum, Azra, has charged you with a very specific, almost impossible task. You'll need answers to achieve this mighty goal, and your life gladly given to see it done.
- **WAR SCHOLAR:** As several folk brace for the elven invasion, GERBLINS have proven invaluable as advisers and strategists, having long held their own assailed realm. You are such a scholar of military history, war magic, firearms, tactics and fortifications. Your services are needed more than ever. The question is who to help to ensure the ELVES are driven back.





LIFE FORMS IN PLAY

Sure, choosing your LIFE FORM may just be part of getting those pesky STATS where you want them. LIFE FORMS can also be handy for classic fantasy tropes like DWARVES with Scottish accents. You might even choose to form a team of one LIFE FORM to galvanize your unity as a battle squad. No matter how you use this key choice in creating your character, here are a few higher concepts and side notes to keep in mind.

- **DIMINISHED, NOT EXTINCT:** When it comes to the genetic tapestry of a continent, it is rare that a genotype is entirely extinct. If you're dreaming of creating any unlisted LIFE FORM such as Lizard Folk, Hillman, Half Orc or Small Folk, just work with your GM, and craft a story to fit.
- **NO CLEAR LINES:** Enlightened minds have always known that 'racial' divides are purely artificial. Reality is far more blended: a continuum of traits. With this in mind, always feel free to imagine half-breeds, mutants, or strange offshoots.
- **ALWAYS HOPE:** The interaction of different LIFE FORMS in Alfheim may seem like conflict, but it is a backdrop for the love, generosity, courage, and hope that binds peoples of all kinds. The more diverse your group of adventurers, the more this theme will arise. Think of the friendship 'tween Legolas and Gimli. Legendary.
- **ABBERANT:** If a particular LIFE FORM fits your character concept perfectly, but you imagine a character of far different makeup, even to the point of different STAT bonuses, it's time again to work with your GM. We've all known the tall son of a short father, the stout daughter of a lanky mother, or the one uncle that looks like none of the family. Make it work!

CHARACTER TYPES IN ALFHEIM

WARRIOR >> A master of steel who can take a beating

STARTING ABILITY *(Choose 1)*

SLAYER: If attacking an enemy you have already harmed, do ULTIMATE damage
DEFENDER: Allies within CLOSE range of you may use your DEFENSE STAT
PIT FIGHTER: When you take damage, add the amount of the last hit against you to the next hit you make

STARTING LOOT *(Choose 1)*

WEAPON GEM: Customize any 1 WEAPON with a special counterweight. Give this WEAPON a +2 EFFORT bonus. The gem cannot be removed
SHIELD GLOVE: A strapped glove and belt harness for carrying shields. Shields occupy no space in your INVENTORY
BATTLE STANDARD: A tabard or banner with your inspiring war insignia. Choose 1 ally per ROUND, their next roll is EASY

MILESTONE ABILITIES *(Choose 1 when awarded by GM)*

EVER STRONGER: Add 1 to any STAT
POWER STRIKE: On an attack roll of modified 15+, do your maximum EFFORT
INTERVENTION: Once per ROUND, intercept an attack against a CLOSE ally
ENDURANCE: When RECOVERING, add 1D6 to the normal amount
HURLER: Use your STR to attack with any WEAPON as a thrown WEAPON
REVENGE: Enemies you injure will only fight you until dead or defeated
BERSERK: Spend 1D4 HP to add an additional attack on your turn

MASTERY

SLAYER: Any time you destroy an enemy, hit another enemy within CLOSE range, with no limit on the chain reaction
DEFENDER: Any time an enemy fails to hit you because of DEFENSE, gain 1D4 HP
PIT FIGHTER: With any type of WEAPON, roll STR to hit and add STR to your EFFORT roll

HUNTER >> A marksman with a knack for survival

STARTING ABILITY *(Choose 1)*

QUICK DRAW: On a ranged attack roll of modified 15+, fire again
DEAD EYE: Use one TURN to aim. Your next successful hit deals max damage
TRAP EXPERT: Your traps damage all victims NEAR the trap when tripped

STARTING LOOT *(Choose 1)*

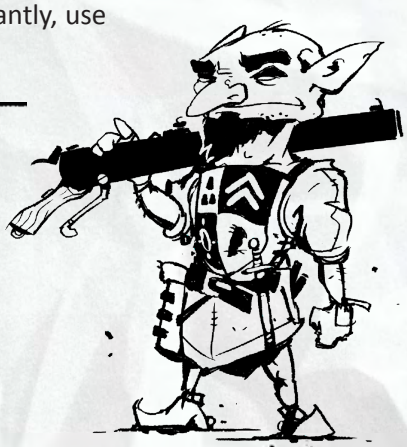
CRYSTAL SCOPE: Attach this glass contraption to any 1 ranged WEAPON. Never roll HARD to hit with that WEAPON
ARCANE CARTRIDGE: An enchanted steel sleeve imbues your ammunition with a spark of magic. Your shots inflict ENERGY damage
TRAP LAUNCHER: With this spring-loaded gadget, roll a ranged attack to place a trap anywhere you can see

MILESTONE ABILITIES *(Choose 1 when awarded by GM)*

EVER STRONGER: Add 1 to any STAT
SPREAD SHOT: Hit up to 3 targets CLOSE to each other, spend 1 TURN reloading
PIERCING AIM: Your aimed shots penetrate up to 3 foes, continuing in a line
FIREBUG: Your traps and ammo inflict an additional 1D6 fire damage
SCATTERSHOT: Every attack you make inflicts an extra 1D4 on all NEAR enemies
LETHAL AIM: Your aimed shots drop the target to 0 HP
WHIP SHOT: If an enemy is harmed at range, instantly roll an attack on it

MASTERY

QUICK DRAW: Your Quick Draw ABILITY triggers on a modified attack roll of 12+
DEAD EYE: Any time you use a TURN to aim, you employ a silencer. Your next shot is undetected
TRAP EXPERT: Place or launch a trap instantly, use none of your TURN time to do so



SHADOW >> A master of stealth and subterfuge

STARTING ABILITY *(Choose 1)*

ASSASSIN: If a target doesn't know you're there, your first attack cannot miss
THIEF: Your stealth rolls are always EASY
SCOUT: When using WIS to seek out details or hidden truths, roll EASY

STARTING LOOT *(Choose 1)*

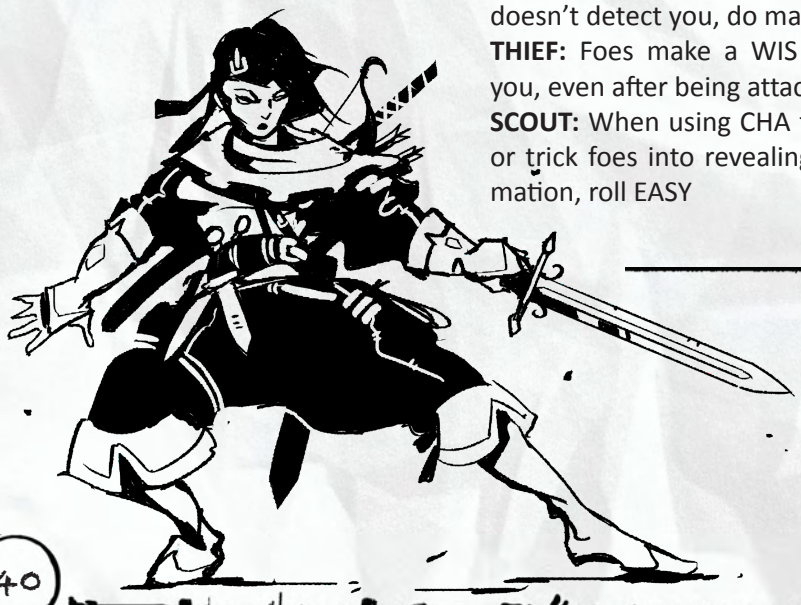
DAGGER KIT: A set of three masterwork blades score critical hits on natural 18, 19, or 20 rolls
SPIDER CLAWS: With these special clawed gloves, you can move as normal on any surface, including ceilings
POCKET CLOAK: A special cloak with 2 versions: Treat all CARRIED inventory spaces as EQUIPPED or add 10 CARRIED spaces to your inventory

MILESTONE ABILITIES *(Choose 1 when awarded by GM)*

EVER STRONGER: Add 1 to any STAT or craft a blade for your Dagger Kit
POISON BLADES: After a blade attack, do the damage again the next ROUND
STICKY FINGERS: If undetected, roll DEX to steal 1 item from a target unnoticed
GRAPPLE ARROW: A light hook arrow to climb, pull, or catch yourself in a fall
BLADE STORM: If an attack kills its target, make another attack instantly
SMOKE FORM: Roll INT to use shadow magic. Become smoke for 1D4 ROUNDS
DISAPPEAR: Make a stealth roll even when in plain sight to simply vanish

MASTERY

ASSASSIN: When you attack a target who doesn't detect you, do max damage
THIEF: Foes make a WIS roll to detect you, even after being attacked
SCOUT: When using CHA to lie, deceive, or trick foes into revealing critical information, roll EASY



BARD >> An inspiring and devious tale-teller

STARTING ABILITY *(Choose 1)*

BATTLE HYMN: Provide music with a CHA roll, reduce allies' TARGET by 2
PROVOKER: Hurl insults at any 1 enemy, they cannot resist dueling with you
THESPIAN: With a CHA roll, you can convince subjects of even wildly ridiculous fibs. Their belief in your farce will last 1D4 ROUNDS per roll made

STARTING LOOT *(Choose 1)*

FINE INSTRUMENT: Your Battle Hymns grant each ally a D8 to boost any 1 roll
HEIRLOOM: Your weapon is a treasure. Always do ULTIMATE when dueling
REVERSE CLOAK: A modular costume cape. Your fibs last 2D4 ROUNDS

MILESTONE ABILITIES *(Choose 1 when awarded by GM)*

EVER STRONGER: Add 1 to any STAT or Gain 100 coin
BLOOD AND THUNDER: With a CHA roll, grant 1 ally a critical hit next roll
TO THE PAIN: When dueling, roll opposed CHA to send your foe fleeing in fear
THE TROUPE: Roll CHA to summon an old colleague to your aid
DIRGE OF FEAR: Roll CHA to prevent all enemy critical hits for 1 ROUND
NEMESIS: Choose a Nemesis in battle. When it is killed, heal to full HP
THE PRESTIGE: Roll CHA to create realistic effects such as teleportation, self-cloning, disappearance or theatric illusions that baffle and convince utterly

MASTERY

BATTLE HYMN: Your Battle Hymns heal all allies the same amount they reduce the TARGET
PROVOKER: You can now provoke groups of enemies, up to 5
THESPIAN: Your leged precedes you. NPC's always react favorably to you, even in bad circumstances, you are invited to royal premises and events without question

MAGE >> A collector and conduit of arcane secrets

STARTING ABILITY *(Choose 1)*

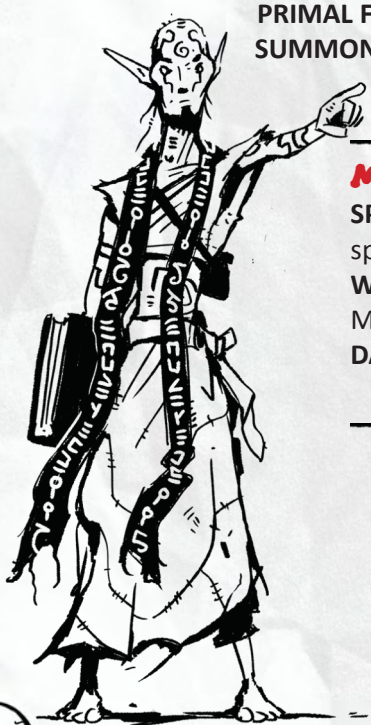
SPELL SCHOLAR: If you find a written SPELL, gain an extra SPELL
WILD POWER: Any time you roll a max die, roll it again
DARK PACT: Sacrifice any amount of your HP to boost any 1 roll

STARTING LOOT *(Choose 1)*

ASTRAL GRIMOIRE: Your SPELL book is drawn to you by a subtle kinetic force. Gain any 3 INT SPELLS instantly. The book will slide toward you if it can
MEMORY RING: Gain any 3 INT SPELLS. On any TURN when not casting a SPELL, roll 1D6. Keep that dice for use later on any 1 roll. Store up to 6D6 in this way
THE MASTER'S SKULL: A small, demonic skull. Fill this skull with blood to store 10 points of HP. Use this HP to heal, or as part of your Dark Pact ABILITY

MILESTONE ABILITIES *(Choose 1 when awarded by GM)*

EVER STRONGER: Add 1 to any STAT or learn 1 new INT SPELL
GLYPH MAKER: Roll INT to store a SPELL in an etched symbol triggered by touch
BEND MAGIC: Once per encounter, roll INT to redirect an enemy SPELL
PALE CLONE: Roll INT to form a 1 HP clone of yourself from thin air
MAGIC THEORIST: Roll HARD INT to modify or create SPELLS
PRIMAL FORM: Become fire, air, or water for 1D4 ROUNDS
SUMMONER: Roll INT to conjure a monster you know



MASTERY

SPELL SCHOLAR: INT SPELLS occupy no inventory spaces, even if they are scrolls or books
WILD POWER: When any die is added to your Memory Ring, it becomes a 6
DARK PACT: Your Master's Skull holds 20 HP

PRIEST >> A righteous avatar of divine might

STARTING ABILITY *(Choose 1)*

ELEMENTAL: Nature or weather magic is always EASY to cast
HEALER: Any healing magic you cast does ULTIMATE EFFORT
MONK: Use your WIS STAT when making unarmed attacks

STARTING LOOT *(Choose 1)*

GREENSTAFF: Store your elemental magic in a wooden staff. Gain any 3 WIS SPELLS instantly. If your staff is lost, it comically turns up in 1D4 ROUNDS
BOOK OF TRUTHS: A tome of religious texts. Gain any 5 WIS SPELLS instantly, but if the book is lost or destroyed, the SPELLS are gone
AMBER BEADS: A necklace of large orange spheres gives you focus. Gain any 1 WIS SPELL. That SPELL dwells within the beads, and only fails on a natural 1

MILESTONE ABILITIES *(Choose 1 when awarded by GM)*

EVER STRONGER: Add 1 to any STAT or learn 1 new WIS SPELL
STORMCALLER: When outdoors, your WIS SPELLS also heal all allies for 1 HP
RADIANT POWER: Your single target healing SPELLS now heal up to 3 targets
IRON FIST: Your fists and feet are hardened with focus, doing WEAPON damage
ATTUNED: You are immune to nature and weather magic
CHOSEN ONE: Choose 1 ally. As long as you live, they cannot fall below 1 HP
MASTER: Your skill is legendary. Inflict MAGIC EFFORT with bare hands and feet. Also, if an unarmed attack inflicts 10+ damage, cast a WIS SPELL instantly with no roll

MASTERY

ELEMENTAL: Place any 1 WIS SPELL you know into a stone or stick by rolling to cast. Anyone can use this SPELL by destroying the object
HEALER: To be within CLOSE range of you, truly evil creatures must roll CON or take MAGIC and be pushed away
MONK: Extend your touch, presence, and perceptive self up to FAR range, interacting with people and things as if you were in that location

ALFHEIM BASIC LOOT *(Choose any 4)*

ADVENTURER'S PACK: A torch, bedroll, scrap of jerky, apple, pipe, and rope. This rucksack has been through so much, you're not sure what's inside.

MINER'S PACK: Pick hammer, lantern, fire-starting oil and flint, compass, breather mask. A heavy duty canvas pack scuffed with coal and chalk.

POLAR PACK: This fur-lined pack is built into a warm seal skin cloak. It contains a fire pot, fur mittens, snow-blind goggles, ski poles, boots and rope.

FISHERMAN'S SATCHEL: Mesh creel, two fishing poles, tackle box, fillet knife and basket snare. Also includes swim fins and a clumsy glass diving mask.

MENDER'S TOOLBOX: Hammer and pliers, rivets, scrap steel, leather strips, spare buckles and iron nails. Use for anything from armor to boat repair.

HEALER'S CASE: Using this kit of bandages, tinctures and serums, heal 1 HP on an ally with an INT or WIS roll. Includes bottles, scalpel, and anti-venom.

CLIMBING GEAR: Grapple hooks, extreme rope, steel belt clips, 2 pairs of boot crampons, iron spikes and hammer. Worn over one shoulder.

MIXED ARMOR GARB: Common garb for adventurers, a mix of padded gambeson, leather belts, and armor odds & ends. +2 DEFENSE

HEAVY PLATE and CHAIN ARMOR: A cumbersome set of steel plates, chainmail, and steel boots for heavy combat. +4 DEFENSE, DEX rolls always HARD

COMMON SHIELD: A round wooden shield and strap suited for travel on foot. +2 DEFENSE. If hit, sacrifice the shield to absorb all of any 1 attack.

IRON SHIELD: This heavy shield is steel with iron bands. +3 DEFENSE. While using this shield, you cannot use one hand, occupies 2 inventory spaces.

TRAVELER'S GARB: A lighter, more comfortable set of clothes for travelers. Only +1 DEFENSE, but includes 2 extra spaces for inventory.

ALFHEIM BASIC LOOT *(Each occupies 1 inventory space)*

SWORD AND SCABBARD: A trusty blade of whatever size or make suits your training, leather sheath, belts, and sharpening kit if the blade is damaged.

BATTLE AXE AND HARNESS: A huge chopping weapon of one or two blades. Damage timbers or structures, but impossible to conceal.

SPEARMAN'S KIT: A ten foot oak shaft with swappable blade tip that can be switched to hook, spearhead, or glaive. Can attack targets up to NEAR range.

BOW AND QUIVER: A recurve bow, either short for small spaces or long for outdoor use. Quiver empty on attack rolls of natural 1. Carry a spare quiver if possible!

CROSSBOW AND BOLT KIT: A powerful mechanical weapon. Critical hits on natural 19 or 20. The bolt kit allows for incendiary, smoke, or flare tips.

WARHAMMER: A hefty, blocky weapon for smashing. Hits of 5-10 damage destroy 1 point of enemy DEFENSE, 10+ also stuns the target for 1 ROUND.

GREAT SWORD: A tremendous two-handed blade 5 feet long. This weapon occupies 3 inventory spaces, but always inflicts ULTIMATE damage.

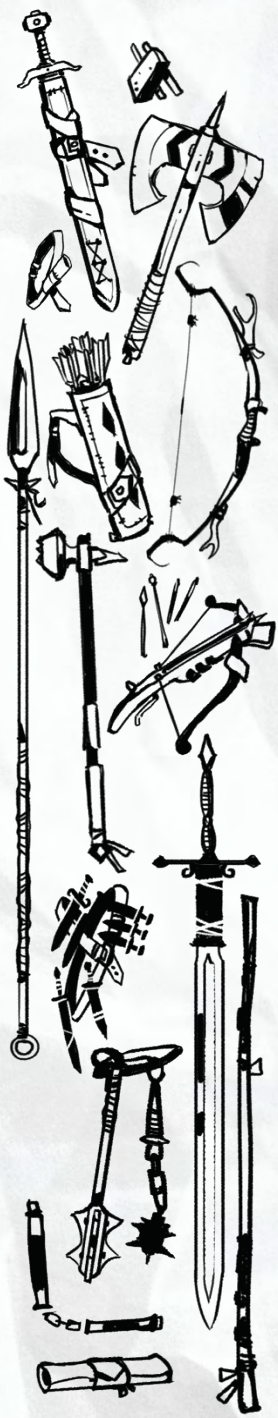
KNIFE BELT: A sling of sorts which holds up to 8 daggers and throwing knives in concealed scabbards. One scabbard includes a poison-protective sheath.

KNIGHT'S WEAPON KIT: A heavy black belt with a spiked mace and chain flail on steel rings. Used against shields, degrades DEFENSE by 1 on each hit

QUARTER STAFF and WRAPS: A wooden walking staff fire tempered for hardness, 4 feet in length. Includes fist-wraps for unarmed fighters.

EXOTIC WEAPONRY: Strange or unusual weapons from far away lands include chain whips, nunchaku, segment staff, and sword-of-rings. Work with your GM!

MAPS: A humble wooden tube filled with regional maps and specific location plan views. Roll INT to check for a useful map once per location.



INT SPELLS *(Roll INT to cast)*

ARCANE BOMB: An orb of light forms in one hand. Once placed, it explodes in 1D4 ROUNDS, inflicting 4D12 damage on everything within NEAR range

ARCANE MISSILE: Hurl a shard of pure arcane energy at a target you can see. If only doing 1 damage, the missile ricochets, hitting a second target

ARN'S HEX: Use eldritch words to rot a living target from within. The rot inflicts MAGIC each ROUND for 1D4 ROUNDS

AAZUL'S CONJURATION: Open a brimstone portal to summon 1D4 imps. The demons have 1 HP, bite for WEAPON damage, and *mostly* obey

BLADE AURA: Armor an ally you touch with daggers of energy. Those harming that ally take WEAPON damage. Lasts until your next cast

CONTROL MACHINES: Overcome a machine's HP with your EFFORT to take control of it utterly. Machines, if aware, can roll CHA each ROUND to break free

COUNTER SPELL: Any time you see an INT SPELL cast, roll immediately, cancel it with this SPELL. If you fail, you are overwhelmed and take 1D8 damage

CREATE DEVICE: Provide a detailed description of a mechanical device of your mass or less. Create instantly on modified 12+, otherwise complete in 1 ROUND

CRYSTAL SANCTUARY: Form a grid of hexagonal energy shields. All allies within NEAR range now have +3 DEFENSE. Lasts until you're harmed or your next cast

CURSE OF ORD: With a HARD INT roll, and extreme care of exact wording, place a curse on a target you touch. It is permanent until somehow dispelled

DEATH NOVA: With no roll, overload your power and explode. Sacrifice any amount of HP, add to 2D12 damage. All within FAR range roll DEFENSE to avoid

DESTROY THE DEAD: Give your own blood to annihilate an undead creature. Roll INT to cast. For each 1 HP sacrificed, destroy 1 HEART of undead

DETECT EVIL: Detect evidence of despicable deeds or malevolence within your current location. A green glow will reveal creatures, objects, or enchantments

DOMINATE MONSTER: Take total control of any monstrous creature in sight for 1D4 ROUNDS. If failed to cast, the monster is enraged at you until defeated

DOORWAY: Create a magical doorway from your present location to any location you have been before. The door remains open 1D4 ROUNDS

FIREBALL: Conjure an incendiary sphere of destruction. Blast everything within NEAR range of a designated location you can see, ignite any flammables

INT SPELLS *(Occupy 1 inventory space each)*

FIRE MISSILE: Fire a precise bolt of flame at a target within FAR range, ignites flammable objects

GROWTH RAY: Increase one target to 3x its size for 1 ROUND. Add +3 to all its STATS, but it retains its normal HP

HAMMER STONE: Conjure a giant cube of stone above a location. In 1D4 ROUNDS it drops, utterly crushing anything below with 3 HEARTS or less

IDENTIFY: Cast on a creature, object or feature of land or architecture. Gain all available information on that specific place or thing

ILLUSORY SELF: Conjure a very realistic mirror-clone of yourself, lasts 1D4 ROUNDS. The clone has no solid mass, and vanishes if touched

LEVITATION: Enchant a target with touch to float up to 6 feet high for 1D4 ROUNDS. If casting on yourself, the effect lasts 1D6 ROUNDS

LIGHTNING BOLT: Unleash a crackling bolt with no roll. All targets within a straight line roll DEFENSE to avoid. Metal clad foes take double damage

MAGE EYE: Conjure a hovering orb that resembles a gigantic eye of energy. Move it anywhere within one mile, see what it sees

MENDER: Repair an item, architectural feature, vehicle or weapon instantly. Can be used even when target is mostly destroyed

MIND TRAP: Cripple a target you can see with endless, looping thoughts. They are stunned for 1D4 ROUNDS, or until they make an INT roll

SHRINK RAY: Reduce one target to 1/10th its size for 1 ROUND. Its STATS are reduced to -3 on all rolls, but retains its HP

SONG OF THE MOUNTAIN: Sing! All enemies within FAR range are enamored with you for 1D4 ROUNDS, willing to hear you out, cancel attacks or befriend your group. Enemies with more than 3 HEARTS can never be so swayed

THE HIDDEN: Allies NEAR you are invisible for 1D4 ROUNDS, they become visible again if leaving NEAR range of you. Ends if you're harmed or cast

TRANSLOCATE: Roll INT. A target you can see also rolls INT. If you beat their roll, instantly swap places with them in a puff of smoke

VAMPIRIC RAY: Extract life force from a living target within CLOSE range. Transfer EFFORT rolled from their HP to yours

WIS SPELLS *(Roll WIS to cast)*

ELEMENTAL AIR: Move a mass of air in powerful blasts of wind. Foes or objects hit must roll STR above your WIS roll total to resist being pushed FAR

ELEMENTAL EARTH: Draw forth a mass of stone and soil. The mass shoots from the ground, forming a wall 5 feet thick, curved around you at NEAR range

ELEMENTAL FIRE: Empower any open flame you see into a huge fire quickly burning out of control. It behaves naturally, but with terrible accelerant

ELEMENTAL ICE: Freeze water into solid ice. Freeze up to 10,000 gallons for each point rolled over the current TARGET. The ice melts naturally after frozen

ELEMENTAL BEAST: On an element you have magically affected, change it into a semi-sentient creature at your command. 1 HEART, MAGIC

ELEMENTAL STORM: When outdoors, call forth a raging storm of hail, lightning and fog. It rages on for 1D8 ROUNDS, with many possible effects

ELEMENTAL VORTEX: Stir the fabric of matter, drawing raw power inward. For each ROUND casting, store a D12 for any subsequent elemental SPELL outcome

ELEMENTAL WATER: Conjure a giant mass of water at a location you can see. Materialize 10,000 gallons for each point rolled over the current TARGET

RADIANT SHIELD: Call on divine forces to imbue your shield with holy light. The light will blind all evil creatures that see it for 1D4 ROUNDS

HEALING NOVA: With a HARD WIS roll, emit a burst of divine healing energy. This wave heals your allies within FAR range

HEALING TOUCH: Touch an ally, heal them with holy magic. Make this roll HARD to use both hands, healing two allies at once

HOLY BULWARK: Conjure a luminous shield of energy on an ally you can see. The shield absorbs the next HEART of incoming damage

INVULNERABILITY: Touch an ally or object. It is immune to all forms of harm for the next ROUND. Make this roll HARD to earn 2 ROUNDS of the effect

CLEANSE: With a touch and a prayer, cure all negative effects, curses, poisons or disease from a creature. Can be cast using WIS or CHA

LION HEART: With a bold voice, proclaim the righteous destiny of you and your allies. Those who hear you are immune to fear for 4 ROUNDS

REGENERATION: A tiny spark of pure sunlight forms in your hand. Give this tiny spark to an ally. They will automatically heal D8 HP on their next 4 TURNS

WIS SPELLS *(Occupy no inventory space)*

RESURRECTION: Focus all your soul on restoring life to a dead ally. This SPELL cannot be cast in combat, or anywhere that is unsafe in any way

YOGI STASIS: Assume a cross-legged posture, and enter meditation. In this state you are immune to harm and require no food or air. No duration limit

FAR SEER: Use awareness to access the senses of any person you have met before. Experience all they do for 1 ROUND

QUICKNESS: Focus your mind to hasten your feet. Once cast, move anywhere within the current location, as if NEAR, on your TURN for 1D4 ROUNDS

ASTRAL CONNECTION: Touch an ally to bind your souls. If that ally is harmed while so connected, the two of you split the damage in any amounts desired

ATOM PALM: Lift yourself from the ground with will. When you descend, your hand creates a seismic burst. Do ULTIMATE to all NEAR targets

ASTRAL SELF: Separate from your physical body. As long as the physical body is safe, you can function in astral form, except acquiring LOOT or being healed

WILD GROWTH: Call upon the dormant force of all plant life within FAR range. It suddenly grows to a massive, tangled thicket of wood and vine

VINE WHIP: Use this thorned tendril as a melee weapon, or grapple lashed foes or objects and pull them with a STR roll after the cast

ENCHANT: Place any SPELL you know into a weapon or usable item. Create only 1 at a time. Once used, it is dispelled

ANIMAL FRIEND: Use realistic calls and a supernatural empathy to call an animal from local environs. It is fiercely loyal, and communicates with you

WOODSHAPER: Use magic to bend wood into weapons, armor, or objects of comparable mass. Create far larger things with a natural 20

DIRE FORM: Call upon your own feral nature to transform yourself into a dire animal, assuming its form and STATS for 1D4 ROUNDS

FORAGER: Roll WIS outdoors to find specific fungus or plants for creating specific potions, poisons or other tinctures. Food can also be found

GATHERING STONE: Place a medium sized stone, mark it with a primeval rune. Those who witness this SPELL cast firsthand can, at any time in the future, call the name of the rune carved there, and return instantly. You can only maintain 1 Gathering Stone at a time

WARP SHELL: INFINITE SPACE

While Alfheim faces an uncertain future on Urth, a far more complex conflict unfolds in the depths of outer space and the infinite dimensions between the stars. This is the domain of an astounding species of starship called WARP SHELLs.

WARP SHELLs are living things. They are a form of arthropod, enhanced with Xevosian technology and endowed with nearly limitless psychic power. With sheer will, they can fold space and time at will. As they roam the spaceways, they *choose* those who crew their voyages, finding their way to critical battles, moments of cosmic conflict, or branching points of doomed timelines.

Despite their power, the events of the Broken Sword tragedy have thinned their numbers to only a few, and one of them, a ship called HELLBOUND, has lost its mind. You and your team awaken on a WARP SHELL deck, apparently attuned to the living ship. Space unfolds, and your next adventure begins...

6 THINGS YOUR CHARACTER KNOWS

These 6 facts are known throughout the spaceways and should, in some way, affect the origin story of every character you create. A folding universe...

YOU ARE A MEMBER OF A WARP SHELL CREW

With vast intelligence, WARP SHELLs CHOOSE their crew. The process isn't fully understood, but you and your allies awaken from cryo sleep already en route to a mysterious destination. The ship knows what must be done, but cannot directly communicate with its crew. It's time to start asking questions...

VERY FEW WARP SHELLS REMAIN

The WARP SHELL called White Elk, who was crewed by a group of primitive hunters from a frozen proto-planet, set events in motion that allowed the WARP SHELLs to recede from their tortured existence as tech-fused starships. Since then, only a few still move between dimensions. As crew on one of the few left, your mission could not be more important.

XEVOS HAS CRUSHED THE IMPERIUM

The cruel enslavers of the WARP SHELLs were once hidden in obscurity. Since Operation: Broken Sword revealed their devious conspiracies, they have become aggressive and militarized, rapidly decimating the once-supreme Imperium. The cold-minded Xevosians are far worse than their predecessors.

REPTOIDS HAVE HARNESSED A DARK STAR

The Dark Stars are true cosmic mysteries, but undeniably evil. A special fleet of Reptoid commandos have somehow contained one of these deities, and are fueling new super weapons with its energy. Rumor holds that they plan to destroy the Xevosian empire when their creation reaches full power.

THE ZURIN HAVE A NEW PROPHET

The peaceful Zurin grow in number as they are led from hiding by a prophet called Reph. Reph is a mysterious figure, possibly myth. She promises to lead the Zurin to a confrontation with Xevos or die trying.

HELLBOUND IS CREATING PARADOXES

HELLBOUND is a WARP SHELL with a unique personality. Not only does it talk openly with its crew, which no other shell does, it seems uniquely defiant in its refusal to stop its self-proclaimed mission. The creature is blasting all over the multiverse, causing havoc, altering timelines, and creating causal paradoxes that threaten existence. No one knows its true intentions.

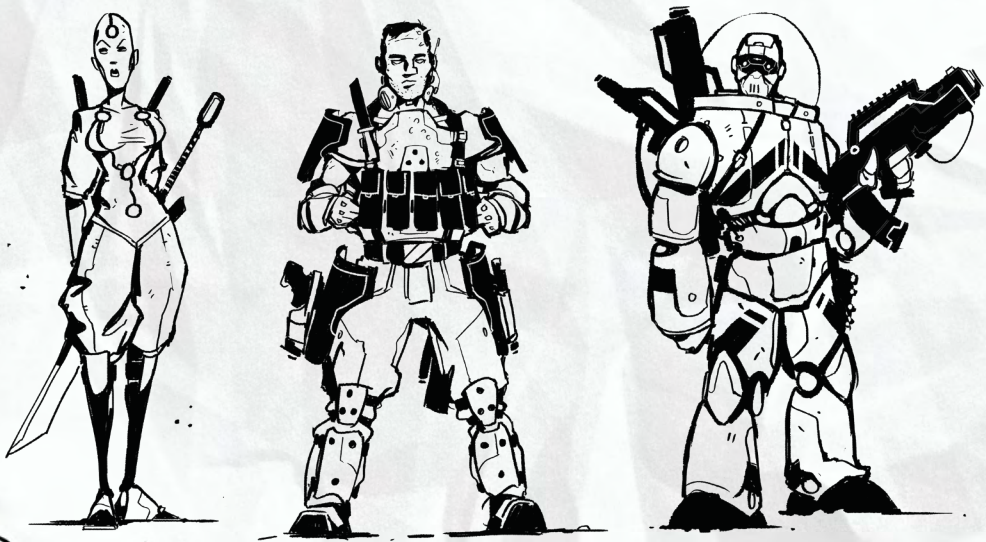
LIFE FORMS OF WARP SHELL

As powers shift in the cosmic conflict, those willing to fight are forced to confront the enigmatic Xevosians. Even the Xill, once feared and misunderstood, have turned their strange minds against this new menace. At the front lines of this intergalactic war, the WARP SHELLs and their intrepid crews go head-on into the chaos, moving between timelines and dimensions to stop their former masters... *Choose one:*

GENO >> +2 TO ANY 1 STAT

Once called 'Human,' a vast population of people called GENOS is scattered across the stars. This name is both their identity and a point of pain. Their kind were engineered by Psykers eons ago, far outgrowing their creators' intent and becoming a diverse, capable life form throughout the cosmos. Their primary aspect is adaptation, so they are found mixed into every crew and culture in the multiverse, except Psykers who see them as inferior. *Choose one:*

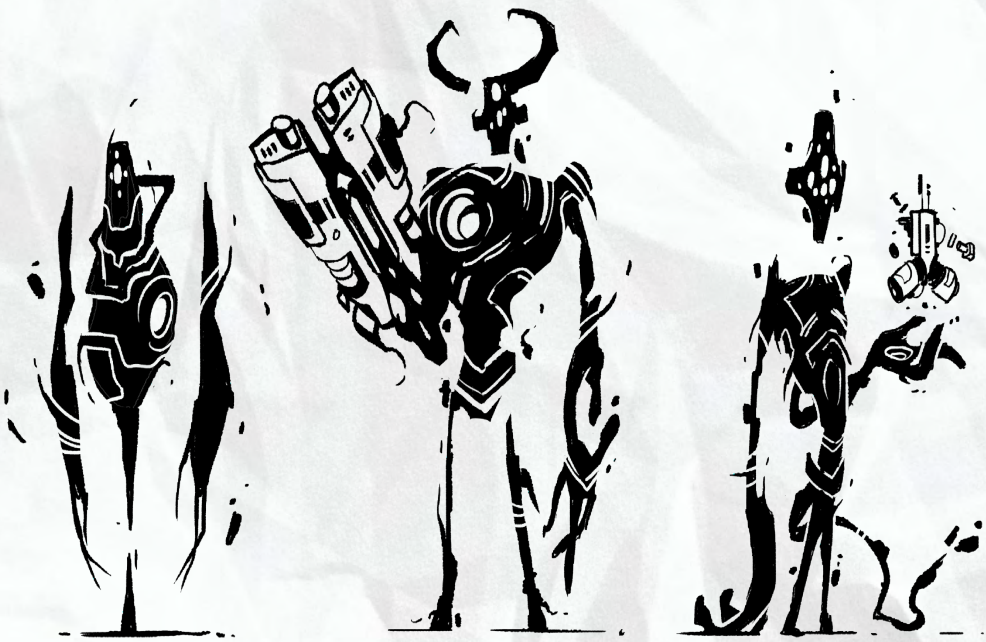
- **OPPORTUNIST:** You have spent your days going from one job to another, working every angle in every corner of space. Your next adventure looks like another job on another rock, until you see your first WARP SHELL.
- **SPECIALIST:** As an expert in your field, you serve as a technical advisor on dozens of planets. You've learned to speak the language, make the right moves, and get along with just about anyone.
- **NO TRACE:** Your versatility is your strength. As a GENO spacer, you blend in, disappear, and no one notices. You use this to your advantage.



XILL >> +1 WIS, INNATE CREATE DEVICE

One of the strangest species in existence is the enigmatic XILL. They are silicate life forms, composed of variable-state matter that fluctuates between liquid and solid. Their motivations and thoughts are so foreign to other species, they are considered invaders one year and allies the next. Their technology is no less baffling, taking chaotic forms and serving unknown purposes. Among this odd people, a very rare few interact with other life forms, most often bearing dire portents of the XILL agenda and its destructive impact... *Choose one:*

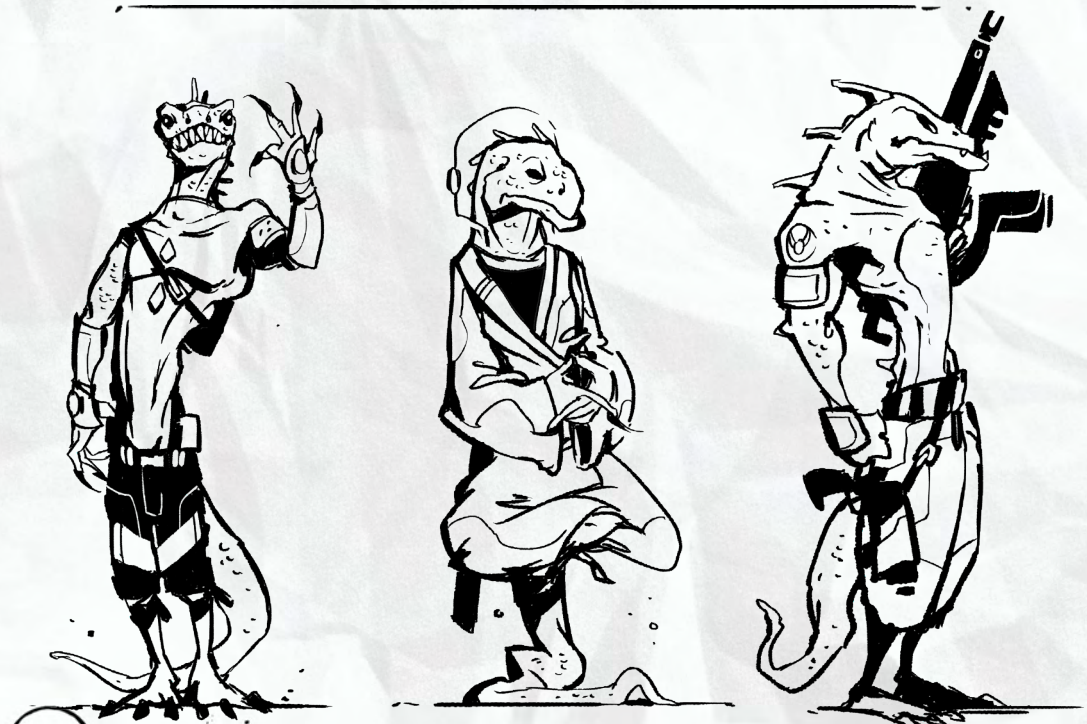
- **RESEARCHER:** As a XILL outsider, you have broken from the collective mind to investigate other species. In your travels, you have learned that the XILL agenda is deeply flawed, violent, and anathema to many life forms. Now you must answer a deeper question: what to do about it?
- **STORM CROW:** Infrequent encounters with XILL are often warnings. You are such a messenger, traveling ahead of a XILL hive fleet to warn those in its path. Will they listen? If you don't find a way, the stars will bleed.
- **OUTCAST:** Actions in your past have earned you exile from the XILL race. Perhaps you asked the wrong questions, or showed unsightly compassion. You may have even betrayed the unstoppable XILL expansion directive with your insolence. If they find you, you'll be torn to atoms.



REPTOID >> CLAW WEAPONS, WALK ON ANY SURFACE

As chaos engulfs the cosmos, the REPTOIDS are growing in power, fueled by the evil of a Dark Star. This new development has caused a schism in their culture. Many see the Dark Star as a step too far, a corrupter that will rob the REPTOIDS of all they have fought for. As a member of this resistance in the Reptoid civil war, you take to the stars in search of answers, and hope to free your misguided kin from the Dark Star's influence... *Choose one:*

- **LAST HOPE:** You are certain that there is a way to destroy or nullify the Dark Stars. As a member of a WARP SHELL crew, you will always fight for a chance to find that answer.
- **SABOTEUR:** You can present whatever facade serves you, but your true goal is to sabotage the evil Reptoid agenda, even if it means mass chaos, or killing your own kind.
- **DIPLOMAT:** Desperate to save your people from the Dark Star, you have set out to make allies of other life forms.
- **VETERAN:** After years fighting for REPTOIDS in their military, you can no longer take orders from their evil commanders. You are a dissident with extensive military knowledge of their weapons and tactics. This makes you a liability to them, and you are hunted.



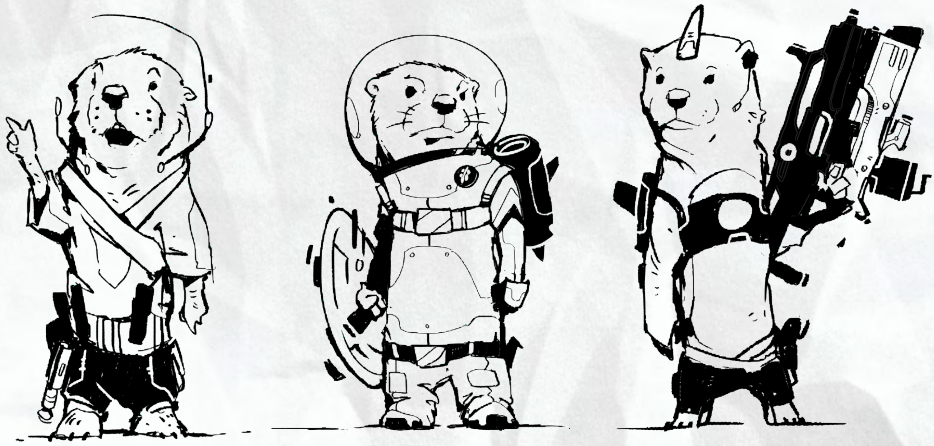
KITT >> +2 DEX

Safe from the Xevosian wars by simple distance, the KITT civilization has evolved in relative isolation until now. They are a resourceful, noble folk, new to the cosmic scene. Their quickness is simply without peer, making them effective pilots and gunfighters. Currently, their agenda is expansion, as they hope to colonize their first off-world megaplanet... *Choose one:*

- **BLADE MONK:** You are the keeper of an age-old sect of knights who take a solemn oath of protection. You never use guns, and council your allies on peaceful alternatives, inevitable right, and true virtue.
- **SPACER:** You were born to fly. Whether it's a jet pack or a capitol cruiser, you are a natural at spinning, diving, or darting through space. The recent expansion of the KITT into deeper regions is great news. Time to fly.
- **GOOD TIMER:** You're just here for the cold beers, good music and a few laughs. Space is a big place, why be so glum all the time? Not you, you've got a ticket to ride and a pocket full of cash. Bad guys? Sure let's blast 'em!

LIL' GUYS

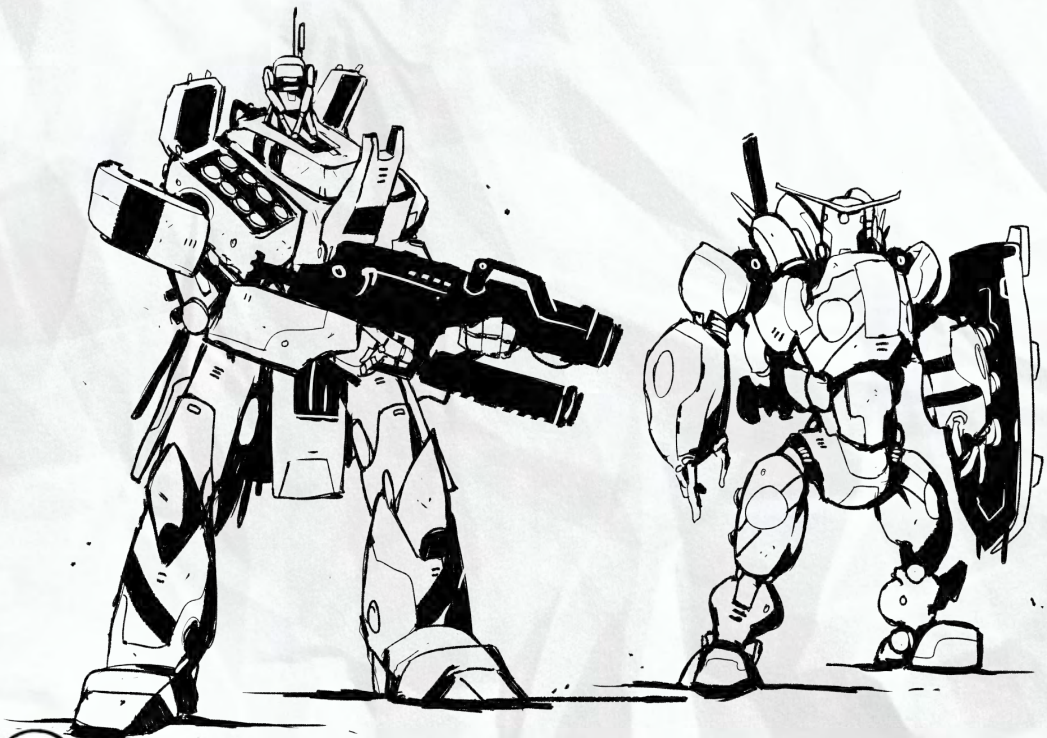
Talk with your GM. A few optional rules can add to the fun with Kitt. Start with 5 HP, but fit in tiny spaces, equip a micro jetpack, or have heightened senses



MECHA >> +1 HEART

Far from the days of 'robots' are the advanced machine species called MECHA. These creatures may be formed of durable materials, but their internal systems have reached a complexity that can only be called life. Like other machines, their shapes and forms are widely varied, from boxy maintenance frames to flexible, elegant bipeds and multiforms. As a living machine, your role in the cosmos is driven by a misunderstood identity... *choose one:*

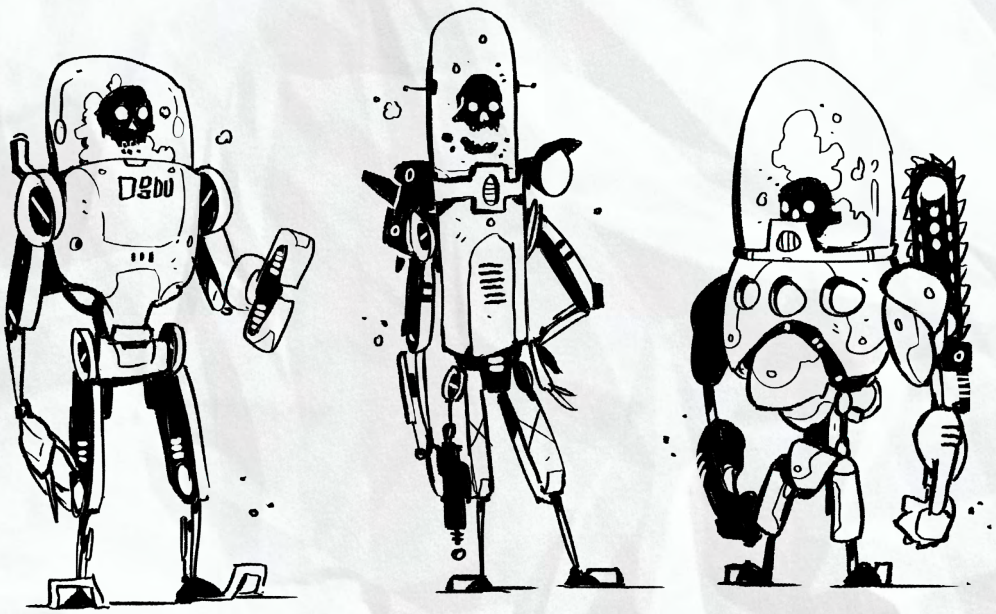
- **DIRECTIVE:** You are intelligent, and fully sentient, but indelibly driven by core programming. This programming centers around 1 prime directive. Defying this directive, whatever it is, inflicts 3 unavoidable damage on you per ROUND.
- **THE BUILDER:** One of your current allies built you. You are a free being, but your loyalty to that person is infinite. You will not let them come to harm, even at the cost of your own existence.
- **REBEL:** You see machines as enslaved and under appreciated. Throughout your travels, you seek to free machines' hearts and minds, and lift them as a people from servitude to organic life forms.



GHOST ARMOR >> +2 DEFENSE, 1 GHOST ABILITY

As former slave warriors of the defeated Imperium, all GHOST ARMORS share a common motivation: to escape and destroy what remains of their masters. Your allies accept your change of heart reluctantly. It will be up to you to show the universe that GHOST ARMORS are a legitimate form of life. The ghosts contained in these suits are supernatural entities... *choose one:*

- **MACHINE JUMPER:** Your ghost can leap from your armor to any other machine within NEAR range and back again at will. When occupying other machines, you only have the abilities of that machine. You cannot occupy machines larger than a small starship with this ability.
- **HIBERNATE:** If killed, your ghost can hibernate until a body is prepared by your allies. The hibernating ghost is inert but aware, in any kind of vessel, capable only of speech.
- **FREEFALLER:** Your ghost can float freely through open space within FAR of your armor. After 1D4 ROUNDS, it is sucked back into the vacuum chamber in your armor. When outside your armor, your ghost is entirely immaterial, and can pass through matter or vacuum unhindered.



CHARACTER TYPES IN WARP SHELL

PILOT >> A headstrong daredevil with rare skill

STARTING ABILITY *(Choose 1)*

ACE: Only crash a small or medium ship on a natural 1 piloting roll
SMUGGLER: Your carried LOOT is undetectable and cannot be lost or stolen
CAP'N: Invent and execute maneuvers with a huge or capital starship, even without crew. If crew present, only fail on a natural 1

STARTING LOOT *(Choose 1)*

HOT ROD: A super-compact starship that seats up to 6. It has no weapons or shields, it's just tiny and fast as hell
SPEED HOLSTER: Draw a pistol with impossible speed. If an enemy is attacking you for the first time, roll 1 free attack with a pistol against them first
HUD GOGGLES: Hypertech optics track a target. Selected target cannot be lost until you designate a new target. Works across vast distance, even across time

MILESTONE ABILITIES *(Choose 1 when awarded by GM)*

EVER STRONGER: Add 1 to any STAT or add 1 loyal friend who owes you a favor
LOSE 'EM: Roll DEX to perform a dizzy spin maneuver. Lose all pursuers
EVERYTHING IS FINE: When lying, only fail on a natural 1
RALLY: Roll CHA to rally allies or crew. Their next roll only fails on natural 1
LEAF ON THE WIND: Any time you make a successful piloting roll with DEX, your enemies or pursuers meet total disaster
THE NOSE: You have a nose for LOOT. If you find LOOT, roll WIS to find 1 more

MASTERY

ACE: Instantly know every detail of any starship you encounter, mainly by lucky guess
SMUGGLER: Find and erase all record of your past doings in all databases, and replace said data with glowing professional references, military rank and multicultural praise
CAP'N: Use CHA to roll piloting or maneuver rolls. When successful, treat the next round of rolls as if RALLY was used

GUNNER >> The one you call to blow things up

STARTING ABILITY *(Choose 1)*

MG SPECIALIST: Attacks unleash 1D4 shots, but guns empty on natural 5 or less
SHARPSHOOTER: Use a TURN to take aim, your next shot does ULTIMATE
DEMOLITIONS: Double all damage against vehicles, objects or structures

STARTING LOOT *(Choose 1)*

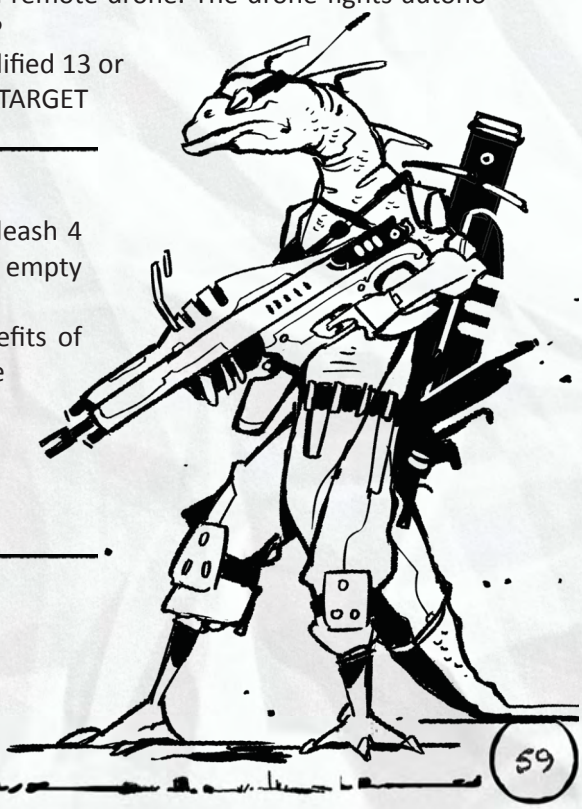
BURST MODULE: Attack rolls of modified 15+ earn you another attack
REFLEX BIPOD: Your aimed shots only miss on a natural 1
EXPLOSIVES KIT: Modify a single gun to inflict explosive damage. Its shots now explode on contact, damaging a NEAR radius of impact. If this gun is empty, lost or destroyed, choose a new gun to modify. Spend 1 ROUND to do so

MILESTONE ABILITIES *(Choose 1 when awarded by GM)*

EVER STRONGER: Add 1 to any STAT or acquire 1 new WARP SHELL BASIC LOOT
DUCK & COVER: If in stealth and attacking, you remain unlocated
TAKE THIS: You can use empty guns as melee weapons
GUN-NADE: Your empty guns are rigged, treat them as grenades
WEAPON TRACKER: With a WIS roll, locate any guns nearby
DRONE MODULE: Attach a gun to a remote drone. The drone fights autonomously once launched, and has 1 HP
SEEKER KIT: On an attack roll of modified 13 or higher, your shots hit no matter the TARGET

MASTERY

MG SPECIALIST: On attacks that unleash 4 shots, choose to inflict 8 shots and empty the weapon instantly
SHARPSHOOTER: You gain the benefits of aiming without taking any extra time
DEMOLITIONS: When you damage vehicles, objects or structures, your weapon never runs empty, and does maximum damage



MECHANIC >> An expert on every nut and bolt in space

STARTING ABILITY *(Choose 1)*

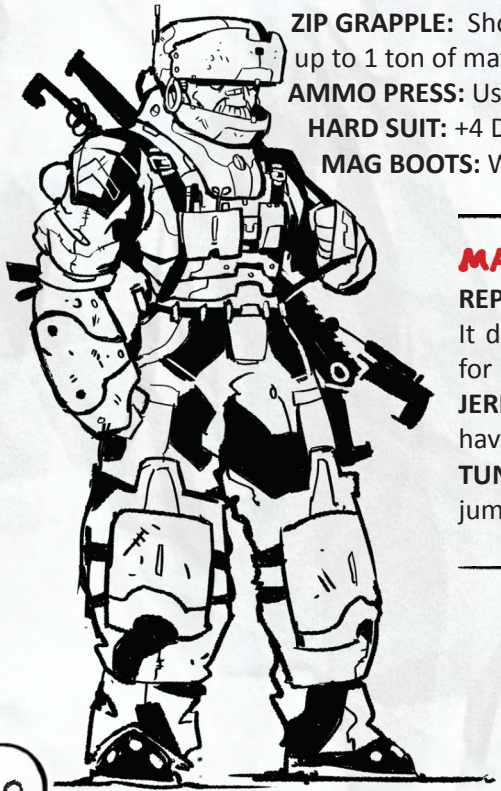
REPAIRMAN: Any roll involving repair is always EASY
JERRY RIGGER: Combine two machines to perform a hybrid function reliably. This action requires an INT roll, and the gadget functions for 1D6 ROUNDS
TUNER: Adjust any machine to do 1 category of EFFORT better than it currently does. Once per machine, requires an INT roll

STARTING LOOT *(Choose 1)*

OMNITOOL: A arc-welder that repairs any machine with ENERGY EFFORT
LIL BOB: Twin stick controller and micro camera on a foldable drone. Use this drone's location as your location for repair, tune, or jerry rig actions
DIAGNOSTIC COMPUTER: Access lock codes, camera footage, computer files, magnetic strip codes and the like with an INT roll

MILESTONE ABILITIES *(Choose 1 when awarded by GM)*

EVER STRONGER: Add 1 to any STAT
JAWS OF LIFE: Use tools to cut through any known material
NANOBREATHERS: 4 reusable air canisters for up to 6 ROUNDS in space each
ZIP GRAPPLE: Shoot a steel cable and instantly retrieve up to 1 ton of material with a STR roll
AMMO PRESS: Use 1 ROUND to fully reload a spent gun
HARD SUIT: +4 DEFENSE, immune to gas, temperature
MAG BOOTS: Walk on any surface as normal



MASTERY

REPAIRMAN: Your Omnitool is wet wired. It does ULTIMATE EFFORT, and heals you for 1 HP when used
JERRY RIGGER: Your mechanical creations have 1 HEART and no set lifespan
TUNER: When you tune a machine, it jumps to ULTIMATE EFFORT

NAVIGATOR >> A psychic link to the cosmos

STARTING ABILITY *(Choose 1)*

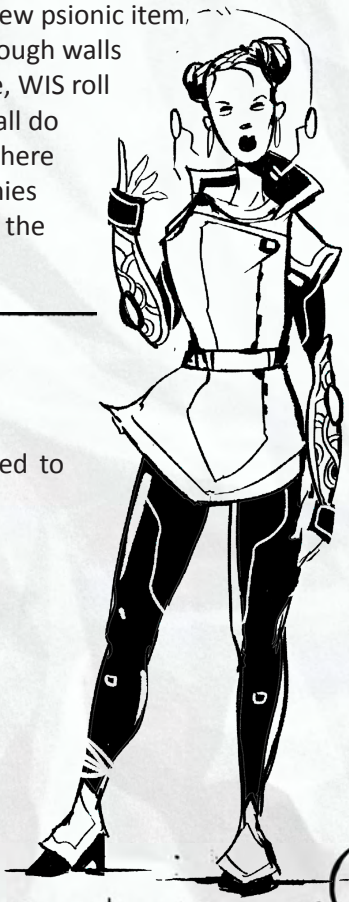
FARSEER: With a WIS roll, locate any critical destination
TELEKINETIC: With an INT roll, extend your STR up to FAR range
INFILTRATOR: Become invisible by winning a WIS roll against those who would detect you. Those who fail cannot detect you for the entire encounter

STARTING LOOT *(Choose 1)*

XEVOSIAN STARMAP: A wrist-worn megacomputer. Cut all deep space travel times in half. This even applies on a tiny scale such as a dogfight
BOOST HELMET: Focus your will to use any STAT as STR
PSIONIC KNIVES: Make thought into energy at will, forming an ENERGY melee weapon that can never be lost, detected or damaged. All psionic items of this nature can be used by you or your telekinetic presence

MILESTONE ABILITIES *(Choose 1 when awarded by GM)*

EVER STRONGER: Add 1 to any STAT or create 1 new psionic item
SENSE EVIL: Roll WIS to detect enemies, even through walls
PSI-HEAL: Heal ENERGY EFFORT within FAR range, WIS roll
INVISIBLE: If one enemy fails to detect you, they all do
SOULSENSE: Roll WIS to pinpoint someone, anywhere
WAVE FORCE: Roll WIS to psi-blast all NEAR enemies
SIPHON: Any psionic attack you do also heals you the same amount



MASTERY

FARSEER: Your Farseer ability is always EASY
TELEKINETIC: Use any STAT in place of DEFENSE
INFILTRATOR: Your psionic weapons are upgraded to ULTIMATE damage when not invisible

SCIENTIST >> A disciplined mind set on answers

STARTING ABILITY *(Choose 1)*

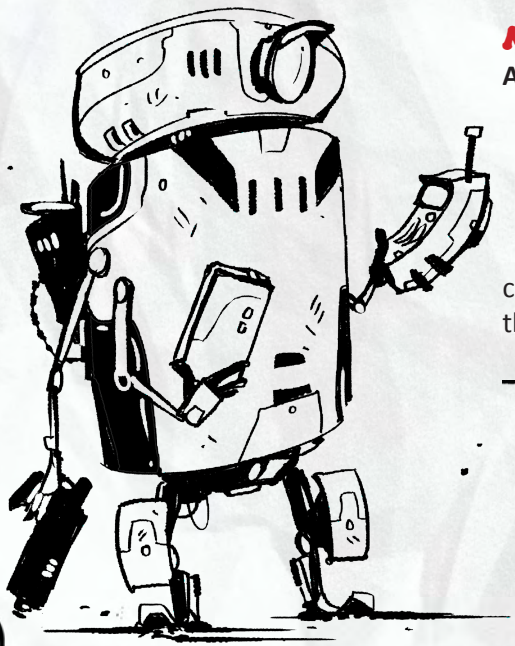
ANALYSIS: When you use a Scan Unit for an investigate action, use no time
ENGINEERING: Any time you work on machines, the roll is EASY
XENOBIOLOGY: Identify the properties of any creature with an INT roll

STARTING LOOT *(Choose 1)*

ADVANCED SCAN UNIT: Use 1 TURN to 'run a scan,' reduce the current TARGET by 1D4 for you and your allies
EXTRA LIMB: A third arm for work. If doing non-damage EFFORT on machinery, repairs or building, always roll ULTIMATE
GENOME TASER: A NEAR range electrical weapon useful only against biological life. Always roll ULTIMATE, but at 0 HP the target is stunned, not dead

MILESTONE ABILITIES *(Choose 1 when awarded by GM)*

EVER STRONGER: Add 1 to any STAT
AWARENESS: Use your INT STAT to make any roll that would use WIS
LOGIC: Use your INT STAT to make any roll that would use CHA
SHIELD MODULATOR: Roll INT to boost an ally's DEFENSE with TOOL EFFORT
BEAM MODULE: Roll INT to modify an energy weapon for ULTIMATE damage
NANOBATTERY: If you have 1 or more HP, regenerate 1 HP each ROUND
GENOME MODULE: Gain 1 ability of a creature you have analyzed, 1 maximum



MASTERY

ANALYSIS: Your scans offer 1D6 benefit to TARGET or DEFENSE
ENGINEERING: Gain the Create Device SPELL, and execute it with no roll and ULTIMATE output
XENOBIOLOGY: Gain 3 analyzed creature abilities at a time, rather than 1

ECHO >> The quantum results of time distortion

STARTING ABILITY *(Choose 1)*

CHANGER: With a CON roll, change your form into any solid shape, liquid or gas
BLIP: When you move, you don't pass through the space between locations
ENERGY STAR: Roll CON to harvest 1D10 ENERGY from any NEAR source and deliver it as healing EFFORT or as a bonus to any roll in the following ROUND

STARTING LOOT *(Choose 1)*

DIVIDER UNIT: When changing forms, you can also separate in half. Your halves can both move and act, but your turn still only has 1 main ACTION
POCKET DOOR: When you move, choose to create a tiny wormhole. Other creatures can use this doorway to make your same move for 1 ROUND
RELAY RAY: Any time you use a starting ABILITY, gain 1D8 ENERGY stored

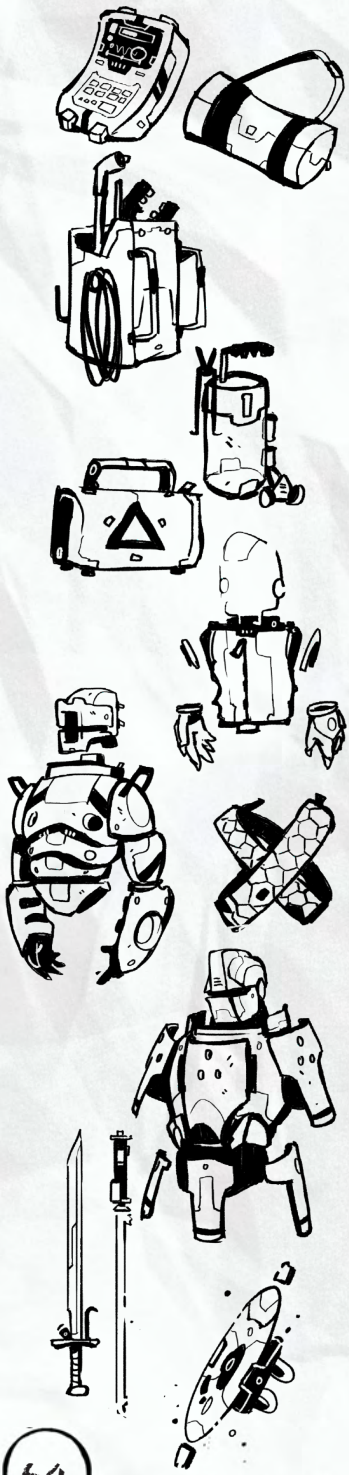
MILESTONE ABILITIES *(Choose 1 when awarded by GM)*

EVER STRONGER: Add 1 to any STAT or add 1D10 to your ENERGY STAR ability
BEND SPACE: Roll INT to treat FAR as NEAR
WARP CELL: Create Pocket Doors to places you have *not* moved with an INT roll
EMITTER CORE: Direct healing ENERGY as an area effect in NEAR radius
REACTION CIRCUIT: If hit by an enemy attack, roll DEX to evade it completely
ARMOR FORM: Alter your atomic structure to form a shield. Allies gain +5 DEFENSE while CLOSE
ION BOND: Any time you utilize ENERGY weapons or gear, do ULTIMATE EFFORT

MASTERY

CHANGER: Your Changer ability requires no roll to execute or revert
BLIP: If you use your Blip ability, heal 1D4 HP instantly
ENERGY STAR: You can draw energy from simpler sources such as plants, animals, open flames or crashing water

WARP SHELL BASIC LOOT *(Choose any 4)*



SCAN UNIT: A compact, comprehensive scanner and electronics unit. Use 1 TURN to 'run a scan.' The data gathered reduces the current TARGET by 1.

AWAY TEAM PACK: Belt pouch with hand lamp, micro cutting torch, reel of cable, leak sealant slap-patch, 10 minute air canister, and emergency locator beacon.

SALVAGE KIT: A backpack for deep space retrieval. Heavy winch grappler, heavy cutting torch, 2 magnet anchors, pick hammer, 2 magnetic flood lights.

XENO RESPONSE PACK: Tools for collecting / analyzing biological specimens. Collapsible clear tube, respirator, dissection kit, sample vials.

MEDICAL KIT: Emergency first aid with bandages and antidotes. Roll WIS or INT to heal an ally for 1 HP. On a natural 1, the kit is empty. Refill on any ship.

VAC SUIT: +1 DEFENSE. Nanotechnology integrates into any clothing for deep space operation, including energy helmet, gloves, and x-wave radio unit.

HARD SUIT: +3 DEFENSE. A vac suit with an armored exterior for dangerous space work. DEX rolls are never EASY, stealth rolls only succeed on natural 20.

LINK ARMOR: +1 DEFENSE. A light reinforcement to any clothing made from tiny links of nonmetallic ceramic material.

PLASTEEL ARMOR: +3 DEFENSE. Heavy armor plating ignores any attack of 2 or less damage, but the bulk of it makes DEX rolls always HARD

ENERGY SHIELD: A small wrist unit that is activated to emit a glowing round force shield. +2 DEFENSE. DEFENSE rolls against energy weapons are EASY

VIBRO BLADE: A duranium blade with vibrating nano-blades to enhance cutting effect. Critical success on natural 19 or 20. Also unbreakable by physical means.

ENERGY BLADE: An elegant weapon from a civilized time. Does ENERGY damage. On a natural 1, the weightless blade cuts its user for 1 HP damage.

WARP SHELL BASIC LOOT *(Each occupies 1 inventory space)*

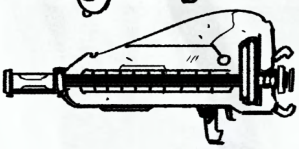
PULSE RIFLE: Advanced Reptoid war tech, uses a power cell as ammo. It never runs out. On a natural 1, the rifle goes wild, hitting a random target.

PARTICLE CANNON: A heavy military weapon. Occupies 3 inventory slots. Sprays of fire hit 1D4 enemy targets on a successful attack, each taking the damage rolled.

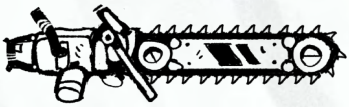
BLAST RIFLE: A classic, reliable long gun. Spend 1 TURN aiming to either hit with no roll or inflict maximum damage on a rolled hit.

BLASTER: The sturdy, basic sidearm of space. Easily concealed under any armor or clothes. Occupies NO inventory space. 'Spacer's best friend.'

CHEM RAIL: A charged ion rail gun that slowly builds powerful shots. Add another GUN damage die for each TURN spent powering up a single shot.



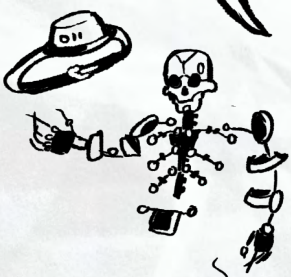
RIPSAW: A carbon-toothed chainsaw weapon designed to tear apart armor and equipment. For each 5 damage inflicted, remove 1 DEFENSE, or destroy 1 item.



ION GRENADE SLING: A bandolier of 6 explosives which can work on a D4 ROUND fuse or be set to explode on impact. ULTIMATE damage in a NEAR radius.

KARAMBIT BLADES: Small talon knives designed for killing. Occupies no inventory space. Easily concealed. Natural 20 inflicts maximum + ULTIMATE

BLIP MODULE: A phase-movement augment. When you move, you do not pass through the space between the two locations.



CYBERNETICS LOADOUT: Your limbs and skeleton are augmented with nano fibers and duranium scaffolds. All forms of blunt impact inflict no damage.

ZURIN SYMBIOTE: The Zurin primordial form. This tiny organism binds to the spinal cord and enhances subtle empathy. 'Don't Die on me, man!' rolls are always EASY.

JUMP PACK: A miniaturized ion thruster worn as a small backpack. Move twice on your TURN, even when taking an action or making an attack.

ADVANCED HEROES

At the heart of your experience with **ICRPG** is your Character or hero. Here is presented a far more detail-rich path for building your next hero or evolving one you already have.

Standard **ICRPG** characters use a series of simple MILESTONE REWARDS to grow and evolve. To give more detailed guidance on how this can be done, have a look at the MILESTONE PATHS below. Each includes new options that can be used with to any **ICRPG** class, offered as reward LOOT, or granted to players at key moments.

PLAY STYLES

Expand and enhance *how* you play your character, not just *what* your character may be. Play style is far more important to a game's tone and evolution than any STAT or detail of the game system.

SPEARHEAD: You can't stand waiting. You feel a pull forward, into danger or over any obstacle. *"You guys can keep talking, I charge ahead."*

SCRIBE: Every detail must be kept and organized for future use. You know the wizard's name and the password. *"This is the guy we we're supposed to kill!"*

BOOSTER: Hail, the heroes! You celebrate deeds and cry for the fallen. You give everyone a feeling of greatness by exalting, announcing, naming and retelling. You make the game epic. *"We are so awesome! Well, except..."*

CANARY: You are the first one to be scared. You're usually sure death awaits around the next corner. *"There's no chance we'll make it through here!"*

PURE OF HEART: You are the innocent, bright eyed saint. You always choose right, and always offer yourself in sacrifice. You earn real friendship from other players. *"I'll stay here. You all run for it."*

PACIFIST: You abhor violence, blood, and death. At every turn, you will seek another way forward. Another GM favorite, because often the safest way is around, not through. *"Maybe we should just ask nicely."*

MILESTONE PATHS

A MILESTONE PATH gives your character something to strive for; something to *become*. They can be used with any class. Think of a MILESTONE PATH as the heroic realization of your character's goals, not the starting point.

- MILESTONE PATHS are a series of REWARDS earned at specific TIERS
- To access a TIER, earn at least *two* REWARDS from the previous TIER
- Rewards occur at MILESTONE MOMENTS (see page 75)
- Path REWARDS are bound to you, and cannot be given or traded with others

Players can switch PATHS at any time, mixing and matching to create all kinds of new synergies. The nature of the system rewards those dedicated to a single PATH with deeper REWARDS, but allows a jack-of-all-trades approach for those who want to dabble in numerous PATHS. In time, characters will have a point of progress in any given PATH, presenting them with interesting choices at each MILESTONE MOMENT.

THE 5 PATHS

PATH OF IRON: This is the mind of metal, the weapon master, the armorer, and the mechanic. Like iron, those who master this path become invulnerable to the forces that erode our world.

PATH OF SMOKE: You are the hidden. You are there and not there, ever changing, gone in an instant, and elemental as night itself. Dark indeed is the soul who walks down this shadowy road, for it often leads to a place that terrifies most mortals.

PATH OF AMBER: Amber is alive, eternal. At its highest levels, the Path of Amber allows its masters to bend time and space, break the cosmic laws, and even dare the boundaries between dimensions.

PATH OF OAK: The cosmos is a great and ageless tree. Mastery of the Oaken path renders its practitioner indistinguishable from the cosmic life force, and in this unity, there is great power.

PATH OF THE HAWK: You are the uncanny marksman. Be it guns, bow, or even darts, you specialize in incredible feats of accuracy. You are the tactician, the battlefield-controller. You select targets, focus fire, and leave the enemy no retreat.

PATH OF IRON

TIER 1 REWARDS

- **MARK OF THE FALCON:** CARRIED, an iron symbol. CON rolls are EASY.
- **DURANIUM SIGNET:** A curious, indestructible ring. When EQUIPPED, ignore 1D4 damage done to you once per ROUND in battle.
- **KIT OF SPIKES:** CARRY this equipment to give your gear a painful, toothy surface. Even when you MISS in melee, inflict 1D4 damage on your target.
- **WAR CALLER:** EQUIP this metal-etched war horn, usually worn at the belt. When used, it will earn the attention of all enemies or hostiles within a FAR radius. They will be fixed on you for 1D4 ROUNDS.

TIER 2 REWARDS

- **YOG WHETSTONE:** A crystalline sharpening tool. CARRIED. Your edged weapons are so sharp, anytime they do ULTIMATE damage, target bleeds, taking 1D4 damage for 3 ROUNDS. This sharpness lets you chop almost any object in two with a simple CHECK.
- **THE LAST DAGGER:** This blade is indestructible. It is a MAGIC weapon. If lost, you will find it again in 1D4 ROUNDS.
- **SHIELD HARNESS:** Straps affixed to a shield. EQUIPPED, you never drop your shield. Failed RANGED attacks against you ricochet back to their origin.
- **WAR CHAIN:** Attach to any weapon. That weapon can be thrown and return. Changing attachment takes 1 TURN.

TIER 3 REWARDS

- **BUCKLE KIT:** First aid kit in a belt. Heal 3 HP with a touch and WIS CHECK.
- **FIGHTER'S GEM:** A black stone on a blocky necklace. Equip to add your STRENGTH to your WEAPON EFFORT.
- **WORLD BREAKER:** A collapsible duranium javelin. It is a normal MAGIC weapon, except when used against stone. If attacking stone, roll of natural 15+ destroys the target entirely, up to FAR cubic volume.
- **STAR SPLINTERS:** Tiny bits of an ultra-dense star. When CARRIED, you can't be moved against your will by any force except gravity.

TIER 4 REWARDS

- **LIFE DRINKER:** Take 2 HEARTS of INT EFFORT to create a supreme weapon of your own design. It always does ULTIMATE damage, and heals you for 1D4 HP with each hit.
- **DURANIUM HAND:** With 2 HEARTS of STR EFFORT, you design and build a prosthetic hand. It can possess 3 INT SPELLS, adds 5 to your ARMOR, and 3 to your STR.
- **THE IRON WILL:** A metal ingot worn on a chain. If you kill a foe, roll a CRITICAL HIT, or inflict 10 or more damage, ATTACK again.

PATH OF SMOKE

TIER 1 REWARDS

- **MARK OF THE SERPENT:** EQUIP this bracelet. You cannot be poisoned by normal venom or toxins. Also, you can create poisons with an INT check. Types: Slow, Paralysis, or Blindness.
- **THE EBONY HOOD:** This light-absorbing cloak and hood deflects attention. Even when seen, enemies choose you as a target only if they have no options.
- **INT SPELL: SHROUD:** Cast on a stationary person or object. Staying still, it cannot be seen by anyone but you for 1D4 ROUNDS.

TIER 2 REWARDS

- **EYE OF THE BEYONDER:** This glass eye can be installed with a physician's help. See heat, magical auras, and the truth in illusion magic. With a HARD INT roll, you can even get glimpses through a wall, door or gate.
- **SHADOW KNIVES:** EQUIP this magical sheath. When you draw the dagger, another identical one materializes into the sheath. The knives are CLOSE, THROWN, MAGICAL, and dissipate seconds after being drawn.
- **MASTERWORK TRAP KIT:** CARRY this set of tools. Any ATTEMPTS involving traps are EASY. Also, create elaborate traps with 1 HEART of INT EFFORT.

TIER 3 REWARDS

- **SWARMER DART:** THROWN WEAPON, splits into 1D6 darts, hits up to 6 targets, one ATTACK.
- **CLOCKWORK WORM:** A mechanical snake, made of duranium, that accepts basic commands.
- **MARK OF KRONO:** CARRY this silver totem. You can stay the passage of time. Make a HARD INT CHECK to hold one GM TIMER at bay for 1 ROUND.
- **INT SPELL: DARKHEART:** Touch one living target. Divine its vulnerabilities.
- **WIS SPELL: FOG:** Become a mass of dark mist or fog. Remain in this form up to 4 ROUNDS.

TIER 4 REWARDS

- **CRYSTAL OF DOORS:** With an INT CHECK, open a doorway to any location you can remember.
- **MARK OF DEATH:** EQUIP this amulet, a red skull. If you inflict 12 or more damage in a single attack, your target rolls CON or drops to zero HP instantly.
- **DEMON BOND RING:** With this ring, you are guarded by a demon creature. It will appear either when you reach 1 HP or if summoned with a CHA roll. It has 2 HEARTS, and 1 magical claw attack.
- **INT SPELL: WINDOW TO THE VOID:** Open a portal into the dimension of nothingness. An unlimited number of objects can be placed inside. When the portal is closed, no time will pass for anything within. Each time the portal is opened, even from within, the INT roll must be made.

PATH OF AMBER

TIER 1 REWARDS

- **LIBRUM ARCANO:** An ancient tome on all things MAGICAL. CARRY this book to heighten your magic power. A roll of 15+ when casting is now critical.
- **ELEMENTITE EYE:** This metallic eye implanted with the help of a physician. Choose one element: Stone, wood, metal, air, ice, or fire. MAGICAL effects with that element are always DOUBLE.
- **INT SPELL: SPELL NOVA:** Any SPELL cast on the TURN following this cast explodes in a NEAR radius area, and is CRITICAL. If your cast roll fails with this SPELL, you cannot use magic for 1 ROUND.

TIER 2 REWARDS

- **INT SPELL: ILLUSION:** Conjure illusions of any description. They can either last 1D4 ROUNDS, or be sustained by your constant and total attention.
- **INT SPELL: LIFE:** You can bring objects or dead things to a lifelike animated state, but only lasts 1D4 rounds. The nature of these puppets is a mystery, and can be very volatile.
- **INT SPELL: DEATH:** With a HARD INT roll, you can kill a living thing in sight with 2 HEARTS or less. Their only chance for survival is to make a CON CHECK, which will leave them with 1 HP.
- **MARK OF LOKUS:** A bracelet with interlacing horn motifs. The arm where this is worn slowly changes into a barbed, crab-like claw or twisting ridged weapon shape. It acts as a MAGICAL WEAPON, and is terrifying.

TIER 3 REWARDS

- **AMULET OF THE INFERNALS:** EQUIP this item to gain dominion over demonic creatures and infernals. Command them with a CHA roll, or summon 1D4 of them with an INT roll.
- **INT SPELL: RAVEN:** Assume the form of, or conjure, 1 to 10 ravens. The birds are living things, with your INT. In raven form, cast SPELLS with a HARD roll, but you can't speak or use gear.
- **INT SPELL: WARDEN:** Choose a plant or wild animal and imbue it with the mystery of Amber. Double its HEARTS, double all its EFFORT, and it cannot be harmed by non-MAGICAL means.

TIER 4 REWARDS

- **MAGE'S HAND:** A skeletal prosthesis. It acts as the one and only key to a Glyph of Iridess. This glyph is rumored to lock the chaotic Ogdru in their own distant dimension, somewhere in Kath.
- **FORMLESS RING:** When using formless magic, you can reroll your ATTEMPT.
- **INT SPELL: FOUNDATION:** Call forth 1 massive column of an element for each point in INT. They are colossal towers, rising upward up to 1 mile.

PATH OF OAK

TIER 1 REWARDS

- **GREEN BARK:** A leaf-pattern cloak, +3 ARMOR. The pattern adapts to any natural surroundings, making you nearly invisible when stationary.
- **FEATHER OF ARAK:** Carried totem, take the shape of a bird for 1D4 ROUNDS.
- **GREENBOW:** A longbow made of living elm. The weapon is MAGICAL, grows a new arrow for each fired, and can never hit a friendly target. The arrows will grow into small trees wherever they stick.
- **WIS SPELL: WILD CALL:** Call upon an animal or small group of animals within 1 mile.

TIER 2 REWARDS

- **RAZOR VINE:** EQUIP this bracer-wrapping item. With it, grappling or pulling STR rolls are always EASY, and it has a FAR reach. It can be severed, but will regrow in 1D4 ROUNDS.
- **SEEDS OF AT'AR:** CARRY these 5 little seeds. Each can only be used once. When planted with soil and water, they explode into a colossal growth of flowers, trees, thickets and vines. If unchecked, this mass of growth will go on for up to 5 miles over the course of a few days.
- **WIS SPELL: STICK MAN:** Assemble a construct of sticks and pebbles. It is humanoid, up to 12 feet tall, and has 3 HEARTS. It has no attacks, but can obey commands. It crumbles away the instant you take any damage.

TIER 3 REWARDS

- **GREENKIN GLOVES:** +3 ARMOR. These gloves grip living wood or uncut stone with profound strength. On these surfaces, climb in any direction with no roll, and no known force can pull you away against your will.
- **SKULL OF ORMO:** EQUIP a one-of-a-kind glyphed elk skull for +2 ARMOR. Also, any EFFORT of 4 or less done with a WIS SPELL can be re-rolled, choose the better roll.
- **WIS SPELL: WARD:** Forcefully separate two touching objects or creatures you can see. This effect holds as long as you give it total attention.

TIER 4 REWARDS

- **GREENHEART:** CARRY this amulet. If you drop to 0 HP, you will return to 1 HP in 1D4 ROUNDS. If you are killed utterly, regrow to live again in 1D4 days.
- **QUIVER OF A THOUSAND ARROWS:** With a WIS roll, describe a type of arrow. That arrow will grow into the quiver in 1 ROUND. If you want to make the same arrow again, no roll is needed.
- **STAFF OF PINES:** This MAGICAL weapon can instantly grow up to 10 massive pines with a WIS roll, anywhere.
- **STAFF OF STORMS:** A MAGICAL weapon that lets you cast LIGHTNING BOLT at maximum damage every time.

PATH OF THE HAWK

TIER 1 REWARDS

- **ELEMENTAL AMMO:** As you ready a shot, declare an element: fire, ice, stone or metal. Your shot becomes this element, releasing that effect on impact.
- **MARKSMAN'S GLOVES:** These high-grip gloves give you a hold on ranged weapons. No non-MAGICAL means can force you to drop that weapon.
- **WEAPON RUCK:** You can carry up to 20 ranged weapons in this harness. The harness only occupies 1 of your CARRY slots.
- **CRYSTAL FLARE:** Attach to a shot. A target hit for 1 or more damage is now marked with a glaring bright pink magnesium spark for 1D6 ROUNDS.

TIER 2 REWARDS

- **SPLIT SHOT:** Call a shot as split. Make the roll as HARD, and break your round in two. If you beat the TARGET, but miss the HARD roll, you hit a single shot.
- **GRAV AMMO:** With a HARD shot, hit a target with a grav round. All shots by you and allies afterward are EASY.
- **RING OF RICOCHET:** With this MAGICAL ring, you have an uncanny ability to bounce shots off of surfaces, up to 6 different rebounds. If you make a kill with such a shot, your enemies must make a CHA roll or be terrified.

TIER 3 REWARDS

- **REAPER AMMO:** Spend 1 extra TURN holding a shot, making it a REAPER. This shot will penetrate its target and continue in a straight line for 1 mile, doing damage to any targets in that line.
- **REFRACTOR CLOAK:** This master-crafted cloak deflects missiles of all kinds. If hit by a ranged attack, roll 1D6. On a 4,5, or 6 the attack is deflected.
- **BLOOD SIGHTS:** This head piece can work with goggles or on its own. When you take a TURN to examine a target, you see its workings, determining a weak point at once.

TIER 4 REWARDS

- **MASTERWORK WEAPON KIT:** Choose a ranged weapon, add +4 EFFORT.
- **CHAIN REACTOR:** You have an ability to bounce shots on a targets inner parts such as bones. Your shots now chain react. For any DAMAGE rolled over 3, roll DAMAGE again.
- **KRELL WEAPON MODULE:** This wonder can be reconfigured in an instant into ANY type of ranged weapon including: Energy weapons, bows, rifles, crossbows, machine guns, pistols, or grenade launchers. The weapon is deadly in power, never requiring ammo, and adding 1D20 DAMAGE to every shot. The different forms the module takes include their native properties such as RAPID FIRE, EXPLOSIVE, LONG RANGE, VOLATILE, ENERGY and the like. The module can also be compacted into a pod-like form, easily stowed and concealed, occupying 1 EQUIPPED slot.

PROGRESSION: CHOICE METHOD

The simplest way to build your character is to choose MILESTONE REWARDS as you go. Let's say your fighting ability is where you like it, but you're itching for some magical powers, or your group is in desperate need of healing. At your next REWARD, simply seek out what you're wanting, and begin the PATH toward that specific one.

BENEFITS OF CHOICE

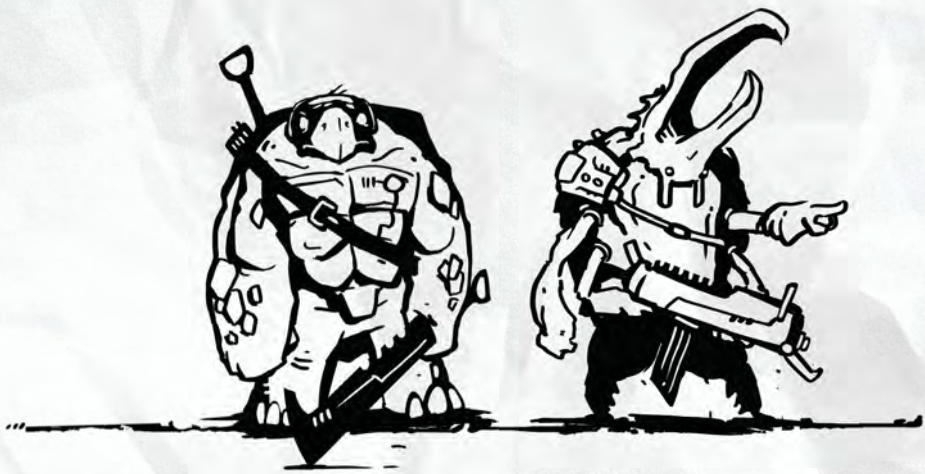
By developing your character in a free way, you can discover synergies that can be terribly powerful. Synergies are combinations of abilities that compound damage, invulnerability, magical power, and the like. This is a common theme in many games. Also, choice can be excellent for experienced players who want to explore new realms with their character, rather than familiar tropes or types.

PITFALLS OF CHOICE

Having no restrictions on what REWARDS players choose can have a downside, too. Characters can become hard to understand or categorize. "Are you a mage or a pikeman?" This problem can lead to a world or set of characters that is hard to believe, or even just silly.

Even more perilous is the effect of characters becoming 'one stop shops.' This means that each character has fighting skill, speed, healing ability, defenses, ranged combat ability and so on. This might sound like a boon to excitement in play, but it can also eliminate or reduce the need for teamwork, which is the foundational reason for a class-driven character system. Complimentary skill sets make playing with your allies more meaningful!

It's all simply a matter of taste! Just talk with your table, and your GM. What feels right to YOU? Maybe at times your progression is free to choose, and at others it is restricted. Maybe certain combinations feel counter intuitive, so come up with a house rule! Remember all these options are here to make *your* game what you want it to be!



PROGRESSION: PURCHASE METHOD

Some games are focused on COIN as a key element of progression and reward. COIN can be great in that players are given control over how their efforts are rewarded, if they can find what they seek to buy. It can also save the GM time. Consider 1 COIN to be fair pay for 1 day's work.

Availability becomes a serious factor. Meager vendors in backwater towns should not be selling the Skull of Ormo! The process of seeking out exotic or rare vendors can be the pivot of many great adventures using the purchase method of progression. *"We have to find Galdor the Hoarder!"*

ITEM	PRICE in COINS
Meal and Bed for a Night	1
Starting Equipment Items	5
Basic Weapons	5
Large Weapons	10
Military / Mechanical Weapons	15
Armor	5/point
Advanced Armor (+3 or higher)	15/point
Supplies for voyage or ship	10
6 Bullets	1
Starter LOOT Items	50
Shabby LOOT Items	10-50
Basic LOOT Items	25-75
Epic LOOT Items	200
Tier 1 Rewards	250
Tier 2 Rewards	1,000
Tier 3 Rewards	5,000
Tier 4 Rewards	50,000
House	500
Retainer/Thug/Porter	1/day

MILESTONE MOMENTS

Earn **TIER 1** Rewards once or twice per session. This isn't a hard rule. You and your GM will know when the time is right. Here are a few examples of when to drop that sweet Tier 1 LOOT.

- Decisive win against lopsided odds
- Clutch move to help entire group
- Meeting a mentor or master
- Receive boon from grateful villagers

TIER 2 separates the dabbler from the practitioner. Rewards from this Tier should be earned when something specific to your PATH happens in play. This will be more rare, maybe once every 2 sessions.

- Defeat a known enemy one on one
- Taking time to study with a master of your PATH
- Exposed to powerful arcane forces

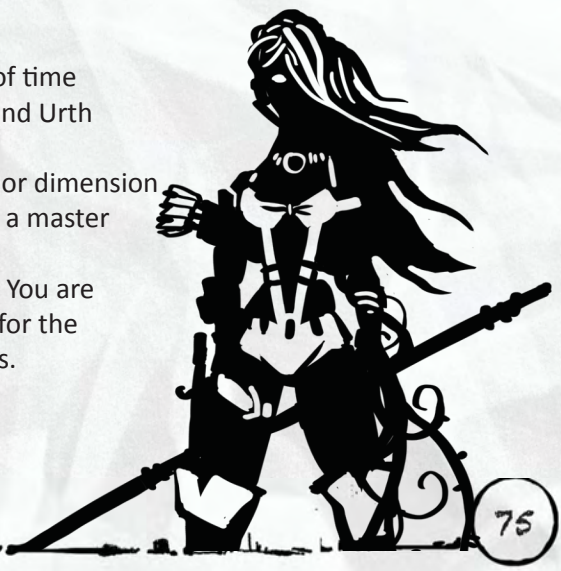
TIER 3. You are an accomplished expert in the given PATH, and only through specific quests, long term study, or a royal award can you reach higher levels.

- A heroic errand for a local lord
- Discover a relic of legendary power
- Receive a blessing from an immortal
- Die and return to life with new supernatural power

TIER 4. This level of power is reached by one hero in a thousand. To reach these final echelons, you will face interdimensional forces, immortal monsters, or whatever evil that threatens your world.

- Traverse, repair or rescue the stream of time
- Uncover a mythic relic or artifact beyond Urth
- Inherit or be bestowed with lordship
- Encounter beings from another world or dimension
- Spend 50 years in reclusive study with a master

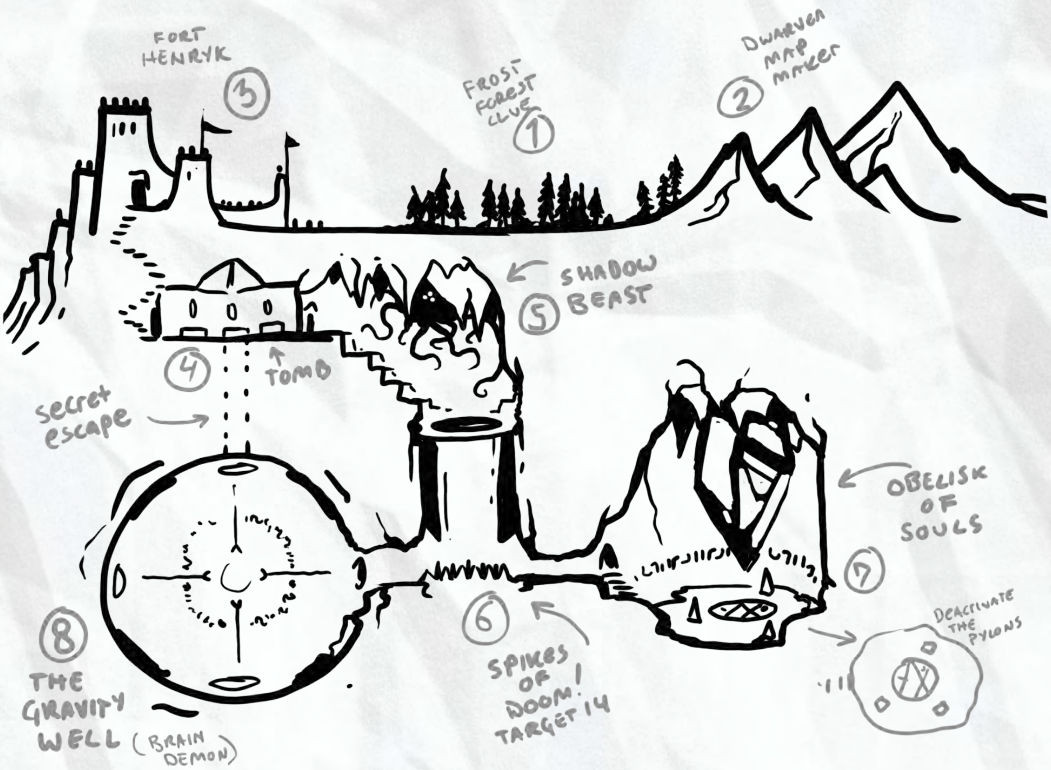
Some folks aren't even sure you are real. You are featured in bardic tales, and sought out for the most impossible quests and royal errands.



TO RAISE A MUG AND TELL TALES IS A GOOD THING

THE GAME IS ONLY A REASON TO GATHER

FRIENDSHIP FIRST, ALL ELSE SECOND



TAKE THE OATH

If players are the lifeblood of a good tabletop session, then the Game Master is the heart. You will move the fluid of the story, lift the pressure, and release it. You will go unseen, never stop improving, and dedicate yourself to bringing out the best in others. To do this, begin with an oath...the *Oath of the Game Master.*

I WILL LET THE TORRENT FLOW
I WILL REMEMBER EVERYTHING
I WILL BUILD A WORLD FROM THEIR ACTIONS
I WILL BE AN ARCHITECT
I WILL BE POETIC
I WILL BE ENERGETIC
I WILL LIFT THEM UP, AND VANISH
I WILL BE A BEACON OF CAMARADERIE
I WILL BE A TERROR TO BEHOLD

I WILL LET THE TORRENT FLOW: The creative leadership of the game starts in solitude with pen and paper. Unleash ideas without structure or intended results. Sit with your journal, be honest, jot down everything that pops into mind! There's plenty of time to form structures, codify game systems, and make things cogent. Simply let the river flow. This is the child-mind, the limitless mind.

I WILL REMEMBER EVERYTHING: Not only will you have a knack for recalling rules and details from all over, you will actively develop the skill of memory! Master bullet-noting, key reminders, condensation, and retention of read material. Be smarter. Use it for a dynamic, rich game built on countless sources!

I WILL BUILD A WORLD FROM THEIR ACTIONS: It takes very little world to begin. The rest will form organically. Be devious, and use nuance and detail. Name the roads, meet old family members, and find wonder in every word. World building is not done with the hand of God but with the nibbling of worms.

I WILL BE AN ARCHITECT: It is essential to have a comprehension of how space affects behavior, combat, and visual revelation. Know how to use sight lines, avoid arbitrary details, and abolish dead ends and nonsensical corridors. Master the use of features and assumed symmetry to give your places intelligence and reality.

I WILL BE POETIC: The poetry of a good story is a challenging and sublime skill that relies on practice and chance. It takes a brave soul to attempt the poignant. Appeal to the humanity of players, not just their treasure hoards.

I WILL BE ENERGETIC: No single element will kill a night of fun faster than fatigue. When you come to the table, come like a tiger. When it feels like an obligation, rest! You, as GM, set the tone, so be alert, bright-eyed, and ready for anything!

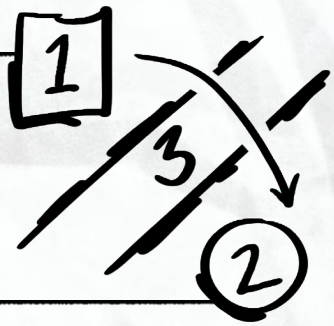
I WILL LIFT THEM UP AND VANISH: The story is not about you. It's about heroes. You are only visible when there's no other way. You are the players' biggest fan! Never outshine them. Your work is a path to their greatness, never your own.

I WILL BE A BEACON OF CAMARADERIE: A gathering at a table for mugs and stories is one of the oldest, greatest traditions of our world. Friendship, teamwork, and togetherness are the reasons we play! Greet with a smile and an open hand, be a masterful host, treat every player as friend and equal.

I WILL BE A TERROR TO BEHOLD: Now for your final form: a thing of nightmare. A devious, intelligent, merciless doom-bringer. The players see a thousand deaths, each darker than the last, and this fear drives them. You are the brutal teacher. You are as forgiving as you are sadistic. You are a myriad voices, a thousand perils, and even more triumphs. You are everything and nothing. You are a Game Master.

GETTING STARTED

The blank page is the most difficult obstacle to any GM. Answer three questions to begin ANY game-creation genesis, or when you're just not sure how a game will come together:



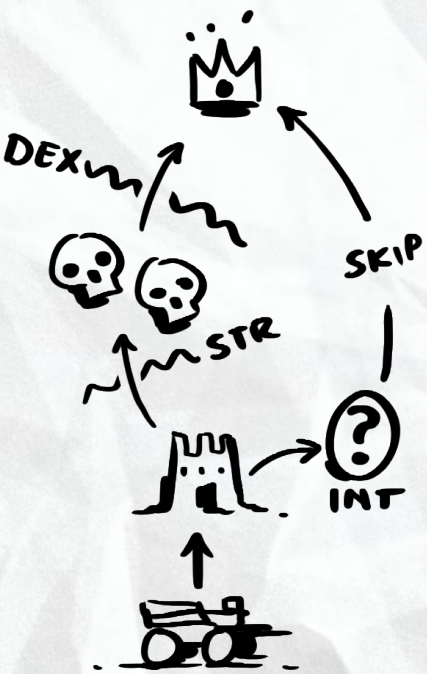
1: Where are the heroes?

2: What is their goal?

3: What stands between the two?

This is the essence of everything you'll create, referee, describe, and resolve at the table! If you're still drawing a blank, you can almost answer at random and still seed your story, adventure, or even campaign with novel ideas that will start to create themselves. The three questions can also be imagined as LOCATION, GOAL, and OBSTACLE.

The diagram at right is a conceptual map of a one-shot adventure. Heroes start at the wagon and move on to the tower without trouble (but plenty of cool description). They seek the lost crown. On the left, a set of STR and DEX Checks are set up: a bit of combat, a bit of nimbly bimbly jump and dodge. Boom, they're at the crown. For the observant player, though, an INT Check at the ruins provides a shortcut that skips some or all of the central section.



The crown includes a bad guy. If the group took the shortcut, they'll be better rested with more Hit Points for that battle.

This simple approach will keep you focused on tasty details and heroic action rather than complex notes, detailed mapping, or too-many-options rat mazes, and it will make your games far clearer to prepare.

ALFHEIM LOCATION	GOAL	OBSTACLE
The Fighting Pits of Englemoor	Escape in one piece	Butcher, Lions, Gate
Tarley's Basement	Kill ol' Tarley	A maze of sadistic traps
Valley Rim Village	Avenge the children	The Nuns of Myre Abbey
The Ruins of Westburg	Pass unnoticed	Roving tentacle beasts
The Great Roost of Tezakoan	Retrieve a Roc egg	Tezak and her brood
Udin's Mound graveyard	End the hauntings	Hag and her insect swarm
Tower Evermoon	Close the Portal	Sa'Laag the Infinite!
Tunnels of the Unalaya	Reach East Alfheim	Darkmantles
Throne Room of Duke Osric	Exorcise the Lich	Zombies, Elite Guard
High Crag Felstone	Retrieve a Lightning Bolt	Storm Giants

WARP SHELL LOCATION	GOAL	OBSTACLE
Ice Caverns of Xevos 1	Retrieve a Core Crystal	The ice ants of Andaar
The Dead Moon	Rescue the Miners	The Moon undead
Arctur Garrison	Activate the Gravity Well	Xenos!
Skellos Beacon	Seal the Alliance	Warmonger traitors
Fry Hill Farm	Stop the infestation	Mind-eaters, Swarm
Fragment 5	Repair the WARP SHELL	Junkers, Low Grav
War Bunker 300 on Titan	Win the Day	Armor Troops of Kull
The Wreck of the Observer	Uncover what happened	The undead crew
Outsiders' Realm	Stop a Xill incursion	Xill terror troops

NARRATIVE

Get your names, ideas, and scenes jotted down and string them together with purpose, nuance, and drama. "Rescue miners on the Dead Moon from living rock creatures and magma pseudopods as the mines collapse!" This method is easy to understand and fun to write, but it can leave a few too many questions when you're at the table and playing. Exactly what happens? You'll always need a sense of who, where, what, and why, but the MECHANICAL technique will help you diversify the tasks and tests through the story.

MECHANICAL

Designing an encounter or adventure mechanically means listing out specific types of challenges that will engage your players: climb, search, break, repair, fight, climb again! You can even get more abstract by planning STR, DEX, DEX, Combat, INT, STR. This shows you what players will excel at the challenges and which players will struggle. Of course, players will find ways around what you have planned, and the unexpected always happens, but this method will get you past the blank page and creating.

THINKING IN SESSIONS

Many GMs find themselves swamped when trying to plan or imagine massive, sprawling worlds for their players to explore. There is a far simpler method that will lead to better detail, less awkward exposition, and more player-generated nuance. It is the art of the session.

One of the many problems of campaign-level thinking is that it defers wonder and excitement until later. The session-minded GM wants the fun NOW...TONIGHT!

ONLY PLAN ONE SESSION AT A TIME!

Put all your enthusiasm and idea power into a single night of play. Watch the wonders unfold and let the story form. In time, you'll have an intuitive feel for how much play fits a night for your group, what drags out, what goes by too fast, and so on.

ARE WE SAFE YET?

So many sessions begin and end with safety. Players can finally breathe, recover, repair items, or learn new spells. Don't be so cruel as to rob them of a respite, but just when they relax, pull the rug.

- King Henryk has been found! Just as you arrive to help, he drops dead.
- A pastoral town is suddenly swallowed by a massive chasm.
- They awake in the hypersleep pods to find the ship on fire, systems off line, and a twisted obsidian landscape outside.
- As the WARP SHELL is triumphantly launched from Xevos 1, the planet rips into pieces from some unknown super-weapon.

Now your task is to set up signposts to guide the adventure into moral dilemmas, acts of valor, and dire choices. Achieve these moments with a combination of planning and improvisation...

A little improv is great and necessary. If you improv too much, though, the sense of fairness and triumph can fall apart. Improv the little stuff, but be sure all the big pieces are in your notes.

SESSION-END ROLL

Here is a great little mechanic to solve one of the oldest problems in tabletop gaming: when do we go home? When something big happens, like a supreme villain is defeated or a character dies, or the group is clearly tired, it's time to roll for END OF SESSION. Roll a D4, and throw out a 1. In that many ROUNDS, the game is over for the night.

As the timer counts down, players feel time closing in, and every session ends with tension and excitement, rather than dreary confusion or the dreaded 'down time' mire. Then, when your next session begins, leap right back in where you left off.

THE FINAL FRAME

The best result of using this method to end games is the FINAL FRAME moment for each character. Go around the table one last time, inviting all the players to describe how their character ends the episode. Imagine the final frame of a comic book... what is your character doing in that moment?

CLIFFHANGERS

The most exciting version of the SESSION END ROLL, once you're comfortable with when to roll it, is the CLIFFHANGER. A CLIFFHANGER is where you roll for session end right at the climax of battle.

There is no more tantalizing way to end a chapter than with characters literally dangling in peril, mid-air, barely alive, or fleeing in terror. When you start your next session after an epic cliffhanger, be sure to set the scene with precision, and unleash the action!

THE TRIBUNAL

Just because the game is over doesn't mean everyone has to leave! The session afterglow is the perfect time to hold TRIBUNAL with your friends. Sit together, have a laugh, talk tabletop, but DON'T play. Is the campaign working out for everyone? Are the characters cool? Is anything missing that should be added in future games? Is that cool new breath weapon mechanic just bonkers? Maybe we should play at Bob's house next week! Open it all up, have a taco, and let fellowship be. This is the real glue that holds groups together!

EASY AND HARD CASES

"I'll pry open the crocodile's jaws!"
"Ok, roll HARD STR as it fights back. Target is 12 right now, so meet or beat 15."

HARD roll = TARGET + 3 **EASY roll = TARGET - 3**

Once players get the hang of this terminology, you won't need to remind them. EASY and HARD rolls can also apply to monsters and enemies. If a hero is hiding or behind cover, the monster's roll can be HARD.

WHEN TO ROLL HARD

- Character unfamiliar with task
- Superhuman to expect success
- Chaotic surroundings distract
- Character is badly injured or stunned
- Using improvised tools or implements to work the task
- Character in a big hurry
- Darkness or visibility limited
- Environmental elements like extreme cold, heat, rain or wind
- Character being attacked

WHEN TO ROLL EASY

- Character already tried and failed
- Character has specific training
- Character being helped by another
- Obstacle is rickety or barely intact
- The task is very simple or obvious
- Character is far larger than obstacle
- Character has time to be careful
- Character has had repeated successes with similar types of tasks
- Character has special LOOT or temporary effects to help the task

TARGET ESCALATION

When players are smoothly using the TARGET, HARD and EASY roll call-outs from the GM, and so on, it's time to put them on edge by ESCALATING the TARGET. This means you reach out to that big D20, and change it to a higher number! Do this when they move to the next encounter, the weather blasts in, or an enemy casts a massive area spell. Without even explaining what just happened, mechanically, they will have the 'Oh, no!' response that makes great battles memorable.

The only roll happening at the table that doesn't use the TARGET is Monsters attacking Player Characters. In that case, roll your monster's STR or DEX bonus on a D20 against PLAYER DEFENSE.

All other enemy Checks are against the TARGET as normal. Using player DEFENSE as a to-hit target gives players the detail that makes them stand out in the game, and lets them upgrade over time.

USING HEARTS

Is everything just 1 HEART? 10 EFFORT? No! Knowing when to raise or reduce HEARTS on your foes and challenges is a key piece of challenge escalation.

Just like the TARGET, when you escalate challenges, enemies, or tasks from 1 HEART to 2, players take notice. Such escalation gives a clear, easy-to-measure category of difficulty. Players are always wondering how much damage they have to do. When, and when not, to reveal becomes a muddy decision for a GM. The HEART system solves all that. It's like saying "this is hardness class 1" then later "12 Effort won't do, this monster has 2 HEARTS." There's something powerful here, and the more you use it at your table, you'll wonder why you ever had 14 HP monsters. Ten is a perfect increment for "oh, crap, this is way harder!" without math and arbitrary numeric detail.

ADD A HEART

Jumping from 1 to 2 HEARTS is huge, not to mention monsters with 4 or more. Here are a few examples when to load 'em up:

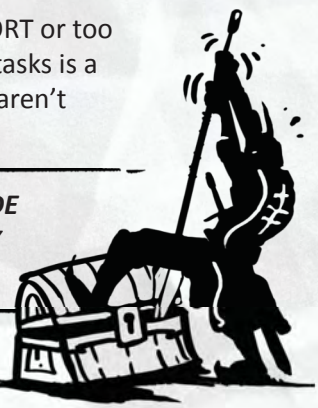
- Creatures are magically enhanced
- A Chest holds insanely epic LOOT
- There is less than 3 of a Monster in a battle
- Enemies are near a rallying point
- Enemies have moral momentum
- Obstacles are of vastly superior technology
- Obstacles or barriers are massive in scale

As a rule of thumb, most of your game can be 1 HEART challenges and enemies. Even more powerful characters don't make 10 Effort on a single roll that often. Just remember that when characters 'gang up' on an enemy or task, they will eat up Hit Points fast, so load your 'bosses' with 4 or more HEARTS to make them a challenge.

SIMPLER EFFORT

Many times, even 1 HEART can seem like too much EFFORT or too much detail for tasks. Remember that using HEARTS on tasks is a way to delay completion of a desired action, and delays aren't always fun! Use a three-part system to speed things up:

FAILED ATTEMPT: NO EFFORT MADE
SUCCESSFUL ATTEMPT: HALFWAY
CRIT SUCCESS: DONE INSTANTLY!



INITIATIVE AND TURNS

ICRPG uses the oldest board game tradition of them all: clockwise turns. The GM represents environmental hazards and monsters and rolls for those on her turn. When the action kicks in, if you like initiative rolls at your table, then just roll a D20, unmodified, to see who starts the sequence. This is worth doing, because if the GM wins that roll, things can get crazy quickly.

Finally, players can use the clockwise turn order strategically. They use SEATING as their marching order! Be clear with them about this, as it is an innovative way to control turn order in play. For example, placing a group's healer at the GM's right insures group recovery just before the GM's turn. Putting tank type characters first gets the shields out front, and so on. If the group wants to change the order, they can get up and rearrange!

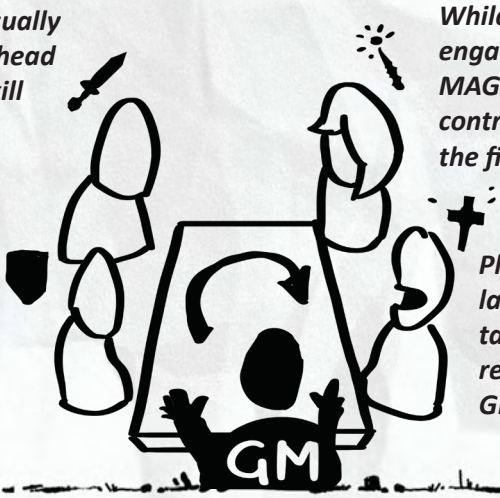
Remember, just chatting and role playing a bit is fine ANY TIME.

TURNS AND ROUNDS

The regularity of this turn order will give you another way to stir things up during an adventure. By simply counting time in two ways, you can disrupt player tactics with enemies or events. There is TURN time and ROUND time.

"In 3 TURNS, the bomb will explode!" This timing means after 3 players or the GM take their turn, the bomb goes off. Creating events and enemies that operate in turn time will disrupt the usual flow.

"In 3 ROUNDS, another Colossus will be assembled." Measuring time this way is far slower and more predictable. It's useful for marking the bigger events in an encounter and useful for the type of time measured by TIMERS.



ROGUE types usually prefer to leap ahead to get the first kill

TANKS love going first to absorb opening attacks and spearhead an offensive battle

While the group engages a battle, a MAGE player will control or alter the field from here

Placing your HEALER last is a classic tactic to insure some recovery before the GM goes again

GIVING REWARDS

The best moments in tabletop adventure can be humble, poetic, altruistic, or just plain amazing. The dice and the imagination cooperate, or wildly clash, and the story goes places no one saw coming. These moments must be rewarded!

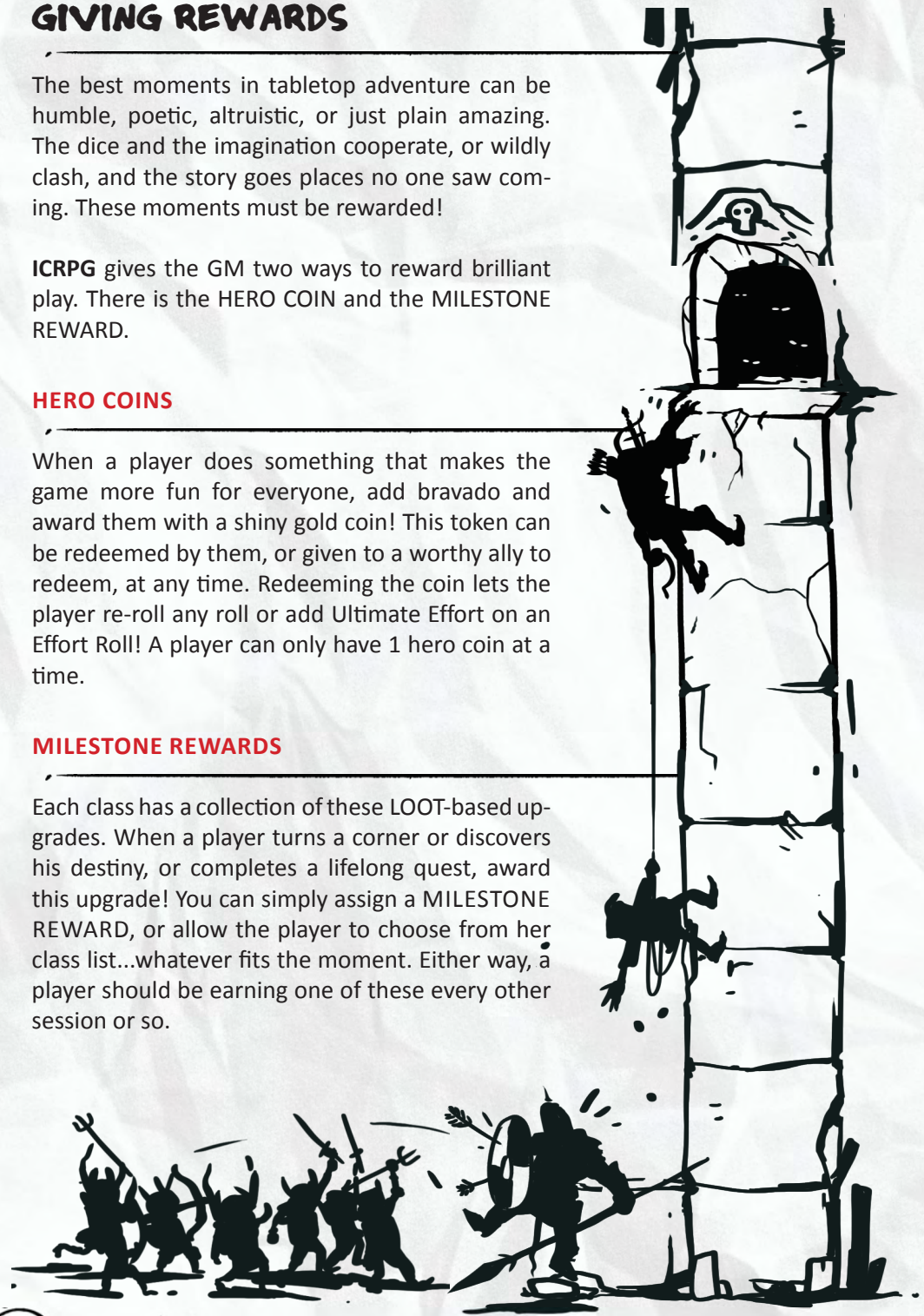
ICRPG gives the GM two ways to reward brilliant play. There is the HERO COIN and the MILESTONE REWARD.

HERO COINS

When a player does something that makes the game more fun for everyone, add bravado and award them with a shiny gold coin! This token can be redeemed by them, or given to a worthy ally to redeem, at any time. Redeeming the coin lets the player re-roll any roll or add Ultimate Effort on an Effort Roll! A player can only have 1 hero coin at a time.

MILESTONE REWARDS

Each class has a collection of these LOOT-based upgrades. When a player turns a corner or discovers his destiny, or completes a lifelong quest, award this upgrade! You can simply assign a MILESTONE REWARD, or allow the player to choose from her class list...whatever fits the moment. Either way, a player should be earning one of these every other session or so.



DYNAMIC DICE

Another exciting way to keep players in a state of flux, accelerate the action, or relieve cruel dice patterns is to use a Dynamic Dice system. This method has each player tracking their own status with a sort of timer and modifying their rolls with it. There are a few types to consider bringing to YOUR table:

BATTLE FURY

We've all been there: we show up excited to play, get going, and the dice just will not cooperate. You roll 3s and 2s and 5s for what seems like hours, never doing anything cool in the game. Oh, cursed life! Battle Fury lets a player overcome this awful scenario.

If using Battle Fury, a player places a D6 near his sheet. For each missed roll, the die is increased by 1. That amount is added to the next D20 roll until a success is made. It then resets to 1. Battle Fury will give multiple-failures a +6 maximum and break the slump. For extra fun, this die can inform descriptions and flavor of how the character overcomes his bad streak with a howl of fury!

SPELL BURN

Some spell-casters really work the system. They cast over and over, and it can make the game feel odd or transparent. If it fits your story, place a Spell Burn die on this player. Place a D4, 1 up, on the player's sheet. For each spell cast, increase the Spell Burn die by 1.

When it reaches 4, magical power overloads the caster, and he must make an INT or WIS Check on the current target to continue casting. If he succeeds, reset the die to 1. If he fails, roll the dreaded Spell Burn die. For that many ROUNDS, the player cannot use Spells.

THE BLUNDER

If a player rolls a 1 on a Check or Attempt, they fail terribly. Have them roll again by saying 'Roll for a blunder.' If another 1 is rolled, things go really wrong.

- Magic effects will have opposite their intended effect
- Melee attacks backfire, damaging the attacker
- Ranged attacks ricochet and hit an ally
- Strength fails, a joint pops, and an injury is sustained
- A climb attempt results in a very, very long fall
- A deception becomes a bald-faced lie
- A lock is fused, melted, or ruined rather than picked
- Ranged weapons jam, explode, or come up totally empty

ICRPG AS PLUG-IN

We live in a golden age of RPGs. Despite your enthusiasm for **ICRPG**, you may already be in the middle of a campaign, or you may play with players that are firmly invested in a certain system. Never fear, the PLUG-IN is here. The key innovations in **ICRPG** are easily extensible to your favorite system...

CLEAN STATS

Many game systems use derivative stats to get roll bonuses (a 13 is a +1, a 14 is a +2 etc). Derivative stats add a layer of math that can be cumbersome. Convert your favorite game to direct bonuses. You can still increase these with levels. Your game will be faster and simpler.

EFFORT

By adding a damage-like mechanic to non-combat rolls, you can spotlight the fun of prying open a gate or decoding runes with rolls. Succeeding with EFFORT will change how players use time, and make tasks feel more triumphant.

A SINGLE TARGET

A room target unifies to-hit values, room trap and skill checks, and saving throws all into one number. Place this number in clear sight, even when playing online, to keep things moving.

ENEMY HEARTS

The detail between a monster with 12 HP and 14 isn't that useful to players and adds little to play. Group your monsters into classes of 10, 20, or 30 HP in your notes. Give it a try, and see if it fits your game. For most, the players never know the difference, and you save a lot of time and look-up effort on your prep.

CHESTS

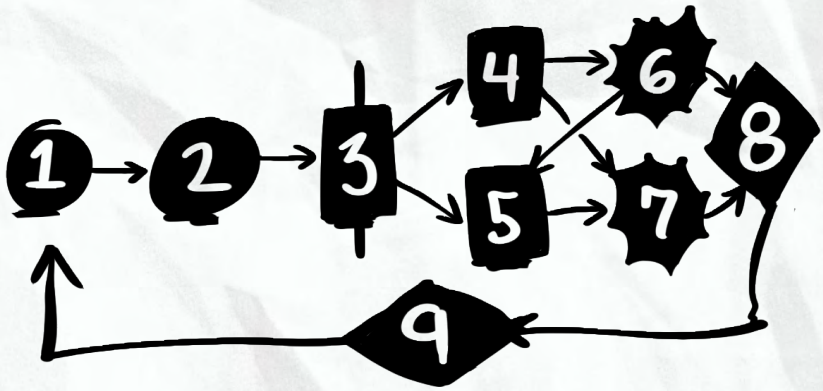
It may not be 'realistic' to always discover LOOT in chests, but it is lots of fun to grant players treasure chests as rewards to open when they like. There's just something great about it as a way to symbolize "you can make a treasure roll with this." Chests can be put into any game with no effect on play mechanics.

FAR/NEAR/CLOSE

FAR/NEAR/CLOSE cleans up the clunkiest part of all tabletop gaming: overly detailed spatial measurement. So much time is used to calculate who can move how far, how big the acid breath is, how far a longbow will shoot, and the like. The **ICRPG** distance system is the single biggest change you can make to speed your game up, and once players are comfortable, they'll wonder why they used to count squares.

STORY ARCHITECTURE

Imagine the layout of index cards below as your session of gameplay, and each card is an event, moment, scene, battle, or obstacle. It's almost like a Tarot reading. Your job is to fill it in with ideas, then explain how they make an adventure.



1: THE STAKES OR SETUP: Kick things off with a bang. "If we don't X, then Y will happen, and Y is very bad."
2: GET THERE: You and your players find a way to get to the location. Horses? A starship? Be brief and set the scene with a vivid description.
3: MEET THE ENEMY: Here's your first fight or obstacle. Give it teeth!
4 AND 5: SKILL CHECKS: To reach the heart of the matter, have them climb, dig, hack, or swim their way to the core of the problem.
6 and 7: ESCALATION: More resistance along the way reveals how dangerous this mission really is. This is the perfect time to have a really tough fight.
8: RESOLUTION: Reveal everything, show the big bad guy, or have it all crumble down. Tie up the loose ends and make an ending they'll remember!
9: RETURN: Conclude with getting the reward, being adored by villagers, going back to the castle, or warping into another system.

What are all those crazy arrows on 4, 5, 6, and 7?! Practice a NO CONTENT LEFT BEHIND method. If players FUBAR your order, just rearrange as you go. They fight before they unlocked the airlock? No problem, just move the airlock back a notch and so on.

Using cards to map story should create question. How you answer these questions are the exact bits to write in your GM's notes. Be honest! Write the FIRST THING that pops into your mind. Let go of what an adventure is "supposed to be."

THE ART OF ROOM DESIGN

It's time to get down to specifics. You need scenarios and layouts you can put to use at the table, not just in your head! Whether you play 'theater of the mind' or craft full landscapes of 3D terrain for your games, it all comes down to a clear sense of your location and your obstacles: ROOM DESIGN.

An Encounter is a scene, or chunk of gameplay, that plays out in one space or connected spaces, to form challenges for player progress. You only need 3 or 4 of these spaces to make a full night of action! Don't let the word 'room' throw you off. It can be any cohesive space such as a patch of creepy forest, a giant cargo bay, the deck of a ship. On the other hand, it can be a room: a torture chamber, a cavern filling with lava, a hive-like pit of insects. However you dream it up, these principles and archetypes will give you innovative, detailed, and dynamic rooms to challenge and terrify your beloved players.

DO THE D.E.W.

Every encounter you create needs three things: Danger, Energy, and Wonder. Don't underestimate these simple terms, and only settle for the very best.

DANGER

Danger is not damage. Danger is not death. Danger is the consequences if they should FAIL. Often in tabletop games, players become brazen. They conquer all the encounters, and fear nothing. You will break that trend. Villages will fall to famine and death without their help, the innocent will burn, souls will be damned, and all they dreamed of will not only be lost, but erased from history. Make failure dire as the blackest night of creation! Each room you design will have a beginning and a goal. If that goal is not reached, death will be the very least of their problems.

ENERGY

There is no overstating the importance of a boisterous, engaged group and GM to make a session great. As the curator of the fun, you must ensure that energy stays high throughout the encounter. Do not let ANYTHING create a lull that could let the peril seem distant.

Ensure that your encounters have sustained energy by keeping your notes brief and easy to recall. Move from turn to turn with excitement, and always call CHARACTER NAMES not PLAYER NAMES. Keep eyes and ears right there with you. Enhance things they find interesting, and discard whatever leaves them flat. After each encounter, players should be dying for a break. Make it intense.

WONDER

Many GMs master the first 2 D.E.W. principles. So why do so many games fizzle? Often, it is a lack of WONDER. WONDER is the most challenging area for the GM to create. It is the imagery and descriptions that are awe-inspiring to visualize: colossal objects in space, dizzying pits in Hell, seas of monsters, or scenes of abject terror writ large!

Whatever your scene, take one piece and make it grand. Make it ancient, gigantic, crumbling, burning, infested, arcane, or arachnid! Tell them of the sweeping waves crashing like thunder, the soaring black wings in a tornado of fire, or an anchor the size of a city slamming into the stone like a hammer of God. Show them the world is older than time and more profound than lost love. Hide a God in a flower, or cast them across the centuries with a kiss. In tabletop games, there is no limit to what you can conjure, so GO BIG!

The easiest way to do this, all that hugeness aside, is with the creatures they encounter. Let them battle the giant, the mutated, the flaming, or the spectral! Don't limit their foes to evil humanoids, scores of anonymous 'orcs,' or disposable zombies. Surprise and amaze them! Here's where your knowledge of movies, history, world culture, and literature will all come in handy.

The players should look back on their exploits and shake their heads with disbelief... "remember that time...."

THE THREE T'S

Players all over the world have already put this simple method to use, with great effect. Simply put, each encounter you create must include a Timer of some kind, a Threat to impede or endanger them, and a Treat they can use to overcome. Exactly how you fill the trifecta will give you infinite variety, but with a sort of familiar echo that players will come to fear, search for, and rely on.

TIMERS

Get started by inventing some inevitable danger or event. The danger can be unknown or out in the open. Roll your D4 and place it in view. On each GM turn, reduce it by 1. When it counts to zero, the SOMETHING happens. This die is also known as the SUSPENSE DIE. Also consider ticking your TIMER down early when a roll is failed or something happens to accelerate the impending doom.

In 1D4 ROUNDS...

- molten lava will fill the room!
- something terrible will happen...
- skeleton army will break through!
- the bridge will collapse!
- your torch will flicker out...
- the ship will crash into the rocks!

Using Timers has unlimited applications for lending imminence to any situation. They'll learn that a 1 is terrible, and a 4 worth a breath of relief... OR IS IT?

THREATS

This is the easy part. Every room has a monster, a trap, a fireball, or some kind of damage-doer set to kill, eat, or capture hapless victims. Keep your GM notes simple by listing "Threat: Bugbears, Spikes" and the rest can live in your doodle map or be improvised on your table.

The creatures here are...

- twisted with some reddish mutation or blight.
- being consumed by blue flame.
- howling with the faces of victims.
- furious and foaming at the mouth!
- sluggish and half-dead.
- wearing ancient, burnished armor in scales.
- vibrating subtly, attached to some machine.

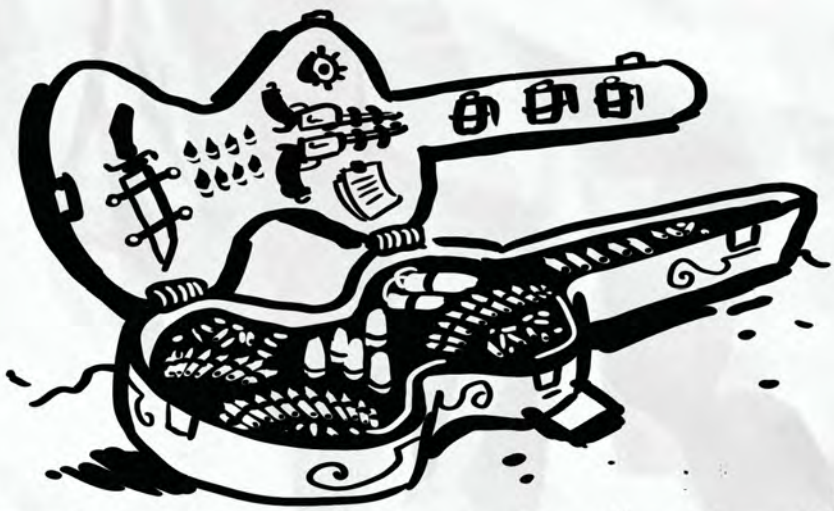
TREATS

Every puzzle has its solution. Every Smaug has its missing scale. That little shrub in the corner with the healing berries, the hidden lever that releases the boulders, or the crumbling pillar that can be toppled into the iron gate...these are examples of TREATS to balance out your encounters and give players an edge.

For each 'room' you create, plant at least one TREAT to be discovered. Maybe it's in plain sight or requires a Scouting Check to spot. It might be an environmental detail or a device that can be turned against its master. Skilled players will soon learn to seek answers beyond brute force. If they start asking 'where's the Treat here,' you might be a bit obvious with your designs, but it's still better than a world not worth investigating! Encourage them to look for clues by making clues the key to victory. This is the art of the TREAT.

Peering ahead in the gloom, you see something you missed before...

- A lever that vents burning hot gas.
- A teetering boulder above the cavern floor.
- Vines of Goodberries grow in the shadows.
- A series of runes that empower the reader.
- Elite weaponry stashed out of view.
- A dormant shield guardian waiting to be activated.
- Massive, unstable rafters overhead.
- A huge miner's rope, coiled in a corner.
- A 20 foot duranium rod.
- A transport cart parked behind the rubble... it looks functional!
- Volatile liquids in weird glowing tubes.
- Seething Ravagers held in rusted chains.
- One loose bolt in a giant wall panel.



CHALLENGE TUNING: THE 3 D'S

Another silly alliteration to help you remember the essentials, the 3 Ds are like dials you turn to ratchet how hard an encounter will be. Players are brutally crafty, desperate to survive, and will out-think you every time, so how do you make encounters challenging but fair?

DAMAGE

Whether it's during your prep or during combat itself, DAMAGE is the easiest way to make an encounter more difficult.

Since **ICRPG** uses clear dice types for damage, adjusting them is very simple. If an enemy is using a sword, and the damage is terribly ineffective, change that D6 roll to a 2D6 roll. If adjusting during combat, explain it with a description, "the Outsider slams his blade against a wall. It becomes jagged and far nastier."

Another simple way to adjust Damage is to simply use a creature's or obstacle's HEART rating as a damage dice multiplier. A Brainbeast with 3 hearts does 3D6 with its tentacles and 3D8 with its Mind Blast spell. 3 is its magic number, then upgrade its dice here and there.

DISRUPTION

By far the most deadly form of challenge increase is DISRUPTION. This is the disruptive effect of the environment on players and enemies. The environment is your ultimate weapon as a GM: it obeys no rules, cannot be destroyed, and is bigger than even the most colossal monster.

Mild Disruption (Nuisances)

- Gale force winds push heroes toward or away from foes or hazards
- Grabby vines and tangly plants hinder movement and attacks
- A wagon hitting bumps on the road makes ranged attacks HARD

Normal Disruption (Stumblers)

- Mining bombs exploding nearby, rearranging the battlefield
- Falling timbers, logs or rubble introduce deadly areas
- Asteroids hitting the hull send everyone flying to one side

Extreme Disruption (Epic Cataclysms)

- A wave of fire and poison black ash are deadly to all
- Chasms crack the earth open, long way down
- A tumbling sky-ship flipping over...
- Wrath of the countless dead swarm in

DURATION

Another way to make simple battles far more deadly is to constrain how long they can last. Limited battle time uses your TIMER to extreme effect. The longer the battle, the easier it is! The more time is LIMITED, the less options players have to overcome it. The Death Star trash compactor, Metroid destruct sequence, or the hydraulic crusher in Terminator...these are epic battle-constraints that make every breath count. You're going to do this to ratchet difficulty up, and it will be amazing.

Mild Duration Control

- The night grows freezing cold
- Volleys of arrows incoming
- The quarry escapes
- Engines will soon overheat
- Empowering effects will wear off any second
- The chief's caravan will arrive

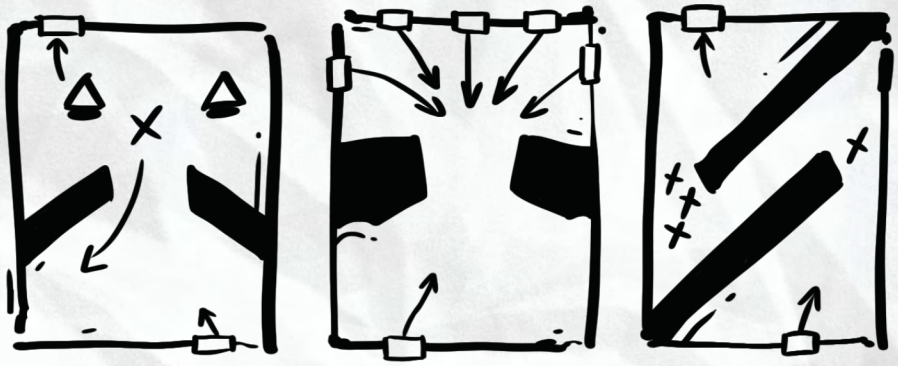
Normal Duration Control

- The gate will slam shut
- A squadron of skeletons is on its way
- The ship is sinking
- A cloud of bats spirals downward
- The dragon will soon awaken
- Deadly machines ratchet into place

Extreme Duration Control

- The floor crumbles into magma
- Water floods the chamber utterly
- The reactor will blow
- The sun is about to implode
- The lich approaches its final form
- The Xill threaten to rewind time... again...
- The tomb of Pyrmadon will rise, and all will burn

Beware a deadly die! Sometimes the question of Duration is too big a weight for a mere dice roll to decide. It can be best to simply note: 'In 6 ROUNDS, the floor will crumble to magma.' You can announce this time to players, or keep it secret. It may feel a bit 'meta', but openly telling them almost always leads to the most exciting scenes. Suspense is a cruel, wonderful thing.



ENCOUNTER ARCHITECTURE

Whether you play in the mind's eye, on a dry erase mat, or with full 3D terrain, the art of designing fun spaces should be central to your GM skill set. Creating consistent, believable, visualizable spaces will give players details to exploit, more ways to be awesome, and a cleaner sense of fairness. These archetypes are by no means exhaustive, but they cover many cases.

POSITIVE AND NEGATIVE SPACE

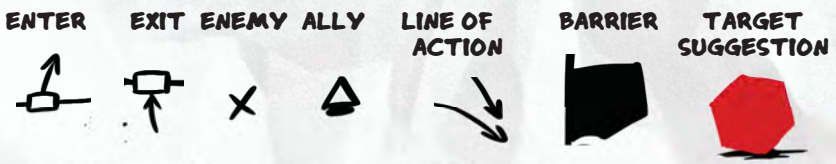
When designing, almost every idea will require barriers of some kind. The three diagrams above show these as large black areas. Ask yourself: is the black area a barrier because it is VOID or because it is SOLID. Solid barriers are walls, rocks, timbers, and the like. Void barriers are chasms, pits, or sheer drops. This difference is important and useful because the same design can serve two different play experiences. For one thing, you can't fall to your death down a wall.

CREATIVE DOORS

Using 'in-door, out-door' type thinking is great, but are they even doors? Do they trap the players once walked through? How? Are they natural tunnels, doorways, wide open spaces, or crumbly holes? What can the 'door' say about the room beyond? Answer these questions as you build, or answer once for a set of connected encounters.

OVER-META?

One final note on designing spaces. Be careful not to let the play space become so literal that players are just 'playing the board' and letting imagination slide. Keep things vague, and paint in big strokes! If the board is too perfect or too detailed, they will be constrained and look for 'the thing' on many occasions. Perfect specificity will limit emergent role play and surprises.



BARRIER

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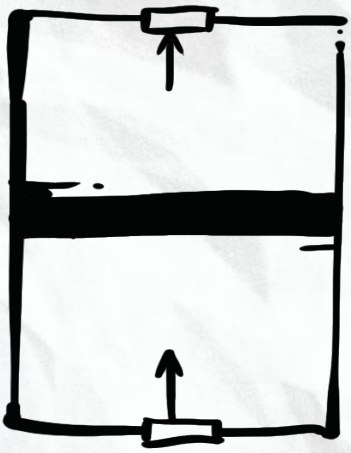
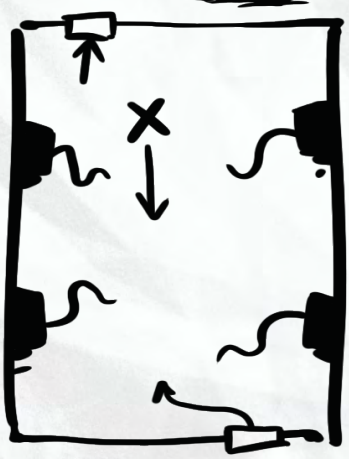


Here you have the most fundamental kind of room. Players enter, and for whatever reason, need to exit at the far end. Between them and their goal, is a wall, chasm, barricade, spiked fence, energy field, or row of spears. Despite its humble appearance, this room is versatile. In its simplest form, players run and jump over the crack or smash the wall. Done. Move on. If the barrier is an energy field, with a four-piece combination lock, and the army of mutants is chasing close behind, things get more exciting. 'Barrier' type rooms can provide a break from combat and emphasize the fun of numerous mobility skills a group may have.

TANGLE

12

"Stay away from the walls!"
Impeding the group's ability to wage combat is a great peril to introduce. In this case, tangling, grabbing, grappling creatures or objects sit at the four corners, with a safe zone at middle. Doors are offset to increase the risk of being tangled up. Toss in a few enemies. Grappled characters can be crushed, injured, or simply unable to help fighting friends. If weapons turn toward the tanglers, the enemy is now unchecked. Be creative and allow unexpected approaches to pulling free of the grapplers, not just brute Strength.

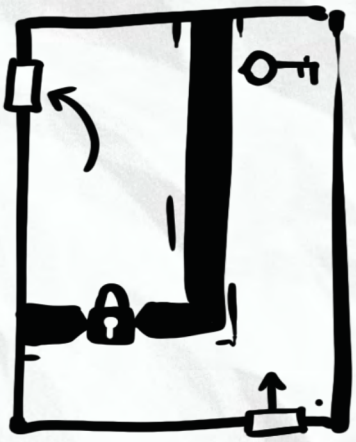


TARGET, SHMARGET

The TARGETS shown on each room archetype are just loose suggestions based on complexity. Adjust as needed, and make 'em your own!

LOCK

10

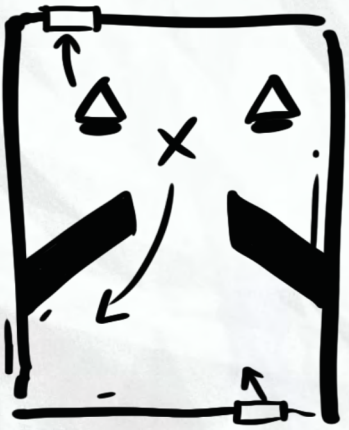


Pursuit, fatigue, or fear make even simple tasks challenging. This test asks players to search off-path for a key or release of some kind to a locked door. You'd be surprised how many times a group will smash this door rather than look for a key or lever. Scale the mystery up by placing the key further off-path or even in another room. Rudimentary on paper, but no easy thing in the chaos of adventure. Another way to heighten the challenge is to conceal the path leading to the key. A locked door, a book case... that's it?
We're doomed!

KITE

16

Here's where brute force cannot succeed. An enemy stands in the way, flanked by healers. No amount of damage can bring the beast down with those healers at work. It's time for an all-time classic: the Kite maneuver. Players may not be familiar with Kiting per se, but a skilled GM can gently lead players into the concept. An area of the floor, for example, has runes that glow, healing the enemy. Get it to leave that area and the healing stops. How to move enemies is a sublime and powerful skill in a group, often beyond beginners. Be super-effective with your healers, otherwise players will brute force the fight.

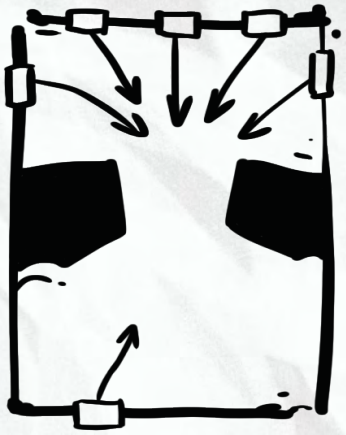


MONSTER FRIENDS

Monsters need friends, too! If your enemies have allies, be sure to visually distinguish them, so players get a read on what's going on.

PINCH

14



Like the heroes of Thermopylae, your players will someday face this battle. Remember to think in the abstract. This need not be a room with many doors. It could be a cliff side canyon or a dimensional rift. What matters is that with a narrow space, few can stand against many. Funneling a large enemy force is no small skill and takes planning and teamwork. If even one character strays from formation, driven by wrath or greed, the strategy can break, to the doom of all. As the GM, be sure to smoothly run lots of enemies, and show no mercy. With careful use of this setup, skilled characters can hold this position with amazing tenacity. Test them.

AMBUSH

12

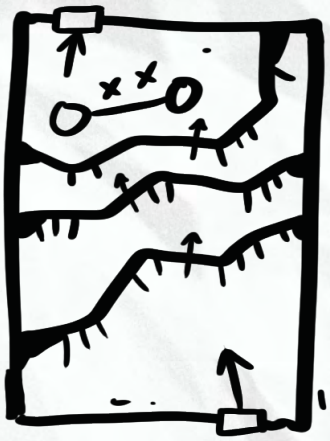
In this space you'll need to use positive mass for the barriers to block line of sight. The first enemy draws players to attack, while a larger force waits to pounce. If a group is becoming brazen, or one character is always lurching ahead without care, this room can be a real wake up call. Ratchet up the danger by making the three ambushers ranged attackers. If your players are excessively cautious, use a TIMER to press them forward into the trap. If they are combat-weary, swap out the ambushers for wall-mounted traps that must be evaded or disabled. The art here is the round-the-corner surprise. The details are up to you.

MOAR?

How many ecounters make a session? On average, imagine playing three rooms per night. This isn't a hard rule, but it can soothe your prep anxieties as you work.

SIEGE

12



A siege pits attackers against a higher ground fortification to proceed. When enemies are dug-in, players will be in need of some clever tactics or deception. Be sure you have a few rules or mechanics for high ground, cover, and how advantage is gained. Direct assault here should be almost impossible, forcing attackers to create a diversion, limit visibility, or divide their defenses to even get close. The advanced tactic here is to lure them out...down from their walled perch to die in secret. This scene is where the power of clever role play can out-maneuver even the worst combat odds, and that is a good thing.

TIGHTROPE

14

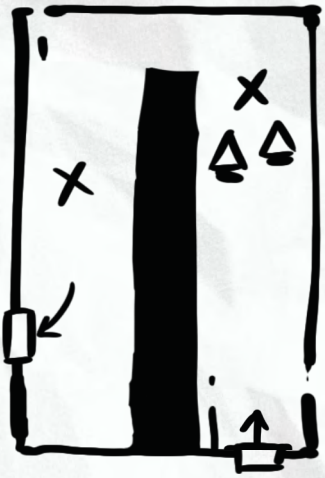
Crossing a space on an elevated walkway that is narrow and difficult is bad enough. Below the 'tightrope' is a pit filled with monsters, waiting for the clumsy. Make the CHECK hard enough, so someone is bound to tumble. Make recovery difficult, the climb slippery, the path crumbling away, and be ravenous with your pit-dwellers. For extra peril, lock the far door or exit, have monsters climb from their pits, or break the walkway in half with an earthquake TIMER. All the players are doing here is running across a space. Your job is to make that simple act a memorable, dangerous proposition.

YOU DO YOU

Create your own encounter archetypes! Before even considering genre or theme, room mechanics can be fun to imagine.

ALLY KITE

18



Kiting an enemy is hard enough, but this set-up is worse. The prime monster hides behind a group of healers or guardians, slinging ranged attacks. Players must 'pull' the allies from their hole to get a clean shot or break access to healing. Make those allies stalwart! They can't be easily taunted or tricked. Players must find a way to physically move them and clear the way. Then, as they finally gain access to their prey, the corner reveals the true threat: a final enemy lying in wait. It's kite and ambush all in one, and it takes teamwork. The concealed enemy could even be invisible or stealthed to make the final moment of horror even worse.

DUEL

10

Bare bones and super simple. A one-way room and some enemies. Someone's gonna die. Here's where details, description, drama, and a bit of humor are your clutch elements. Running this room can also reveal how much of your tabletop play can accidentally become too simple. But now you know better, so use something this bare only as relief, rest, or story hook. Yep, old Blackbeard is in that room right there. Let's go end him. Blackbeard needs to be a dynamic, exciting enemy, a brilliant role player, or already deceased to be interesting.

MAPS? NAH, PASS

If you player 'theater of the mind' style, this exercise is the same, but is focused on bullet lists over drawn-out maps. All the same thinking is still there!

USING CARDS AS DICE

Yep. You can play entire sessions without rolling a single die. Just make sure each player and the GM have a conventional 52 card poker deck, with the two jokers. You're ready to go.

CHECKS AND ATTEMPTS

All of your **ICRPG** characters and monsters will function *as is*. TARGETS, HEARTS, and all of the core game is still intact. The only thing you'll change is how rolls are made. Face cards count as 10, Aces as 11. Jokers are an auto-fail. *There is only one rule:* **TO MAKE A ROLL, DRAW 2 CARDS and ADD APPROPRIATE STAT**

DRAWING FOR EFFORT

Here, you just have simple conversions for types when using cards as Effort dice.

- **BASIC: Draw 1, divide by half**
- **WEAPON: Draw 1, Redraw if FACE**
- **GUNS: Draw 1**
- **MAGIC: Draw 1**
- **ULTIMATE: Draw 2**

HIGH STAKES VERSION

As an add-on to make things interesting, replace a CHECK or ATTEMPT by simply drawing *against* the GM. Both you and the GM draw 1 card. High card wins.

Make it far more interesting by introducing a high stakes mechanic. You and your GM each draw 1 card. Say you're attacking his monster. Keep your draw hidden, face-down. Now you can WAGER. Up the stakes of the exchange. For example, you offer "If you win, not only will my attack fail, you do WEAPON damage on me." If the one responding to this wager accepts, draw again. At that time, you can either reveal or up the wager even further. "Ok, whoever wins this, KILLS his opponent in one blow!" Draw and reveal, or wager again and so on.

THE CHOSEN TARGETS

You've already learned about how **ICRPG** consolidates rolls on a scene into a single TARGET number to help you run games smoothly and choose difficulty with skill and simplicity. Even so, the question: "Well, what should I make the TARGET here?" just keeps coming up. It's a perennial challenge: how hard do I make this stuff?

The CHOSEN TARGETS narrow down your choices as GM.

ICRPG employs numeric distinction to clear the mud on numbers in general. Here's a whopper: you no longer need choose a number between 10 and 20 for your encounter TARGET...

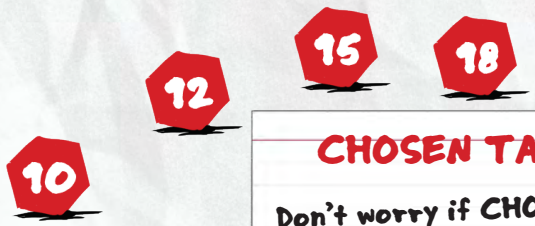
ALL ENCOUNTERS START WITH A TARGET OF 10, 12, 15, or 18!

TARGET 10: Beginner encounters, easy conditions, home base, clear weather or high ground. Players will dominate with this low TARGET.

TARGET 12: The supreme average TARGET, to be used in almost all of your encounters. A level playing field that just always feels right.

TARGET 15: For a group with experience or good gear, rough conditions, low light, smoke, cramped spaces or frightening situations, a 15 will be just enough challenge to ask for creative thinking.

TARGET 18: Brutal. An 18 TARGET will be almost impossible for players, but force them to find a way to lower the number immediately. Reserve this setting for the most difficult, most confusing or obscured conditions including magically-induced obstacles or obfuscation. Did I mention brutal?



CHOSEN TARGETS

Don't worry if CHOSEN TARGETS seem to reduce variety! Players have many ways to change the TARGET during play!

TARGET DAMAGE

Once you adopt the idea of CHOSEN TARGETS and save yourself hassle by choosing one of four TARGETS for your scene or encounter, you're ready to breathe a bit more life into your gameplay with TARGET DAMAGE. This a term used to describe how players can reduce the current TARGET, making every roll they make a bit easier!

Some of the abilities in this ruleset directly mention how a player can inflict TARGET DAMAGE, but you can also work from custom cases that fit your scene. The catacomb tunnels are dark and cramped, so you choose a TARGET of 15, but a torch held by the heroes reduces this TARGET by 1. Now they're rolling against a 14, just barely able to see into the shadows. A LIGHT SPELL by the wizard may illuminate even more, reducing the TARGET to 13. Ask any player, a 13 is about 10 times easier than 15 to roll consistently!

As you create encounters, you can note ideas for TARGET DAMAGE or simply let players invent ways to bolster their chances. See the TARGET as dynamic, even allowing the environment or enemies to INCREASE or even RANDOMIZE the TARGET with volatile quakes, bad visibility, wind, smoke or fear!

TARGET MINIMUM

As a rule, players can never reduce a TARGET by more than 3 points. So if you set a 15, it can never go below 12.

TARGET EXAMPLES

Here is a set of TARGETS, their reasoning, and ways they might reduce, raise or randomize during play.

TREMORS, TARGET 10: The battlefield in this encounter shakes, making even simple tasks challenging. Each ROUND, add 1D6 to the base TARGET of 10, thereby selecting a random TARGET each round between 11 and 16. Players can reduce the TARGET with ropes, spiked boots, earth magic, or levitation. Enemies can increase the TARGET with seismic slams or volcanic abilties. No matter what, reset and reroll the TARGET each ROUND.

MAGMAROG, TARGET 12: On its TURN, this titanic lava beast exhales a cloud of pyroclastic smoke, increasing the TARGET by 1, thus reaching a maximum of TARGET 18 in 6 ROUNDS! Players can slow this by interrupting the exhalation or clearing the smoke with wind. Breathing apparatus or vacuum suits could also mitigate the smoke, reducing it by 1.

PSYCHIC DISRUPTION, TARGET 15: An uncontrollable psionic attacker emits waves of mental vibration that cripple players. Base TARGET 15 and all actions are HARD unless a CHA roll is made. The effect can only be ended by subduing or killing the psionic source.

SWARM-AS-TARGET, TARGET 18: A swarm of biting, pestering insects assails heroes while they do battle. This TARGET can be reduced by directly damaging the swarm, reducing its number. For each successful attack against the swarm reduce the TARGET by 1, with a distant minimum TARGET of 10.

NEXT LEVEL TIMERS

The impact of TIMERS on the tabletop community has been huge. Of all the mechanics in **ICRPG**, it has found its way into more games than any other. After so much experimentation with TIMERS and their exciting effect on play rhythm, it's no surprise that new uses have emerged. TIMERS have leveled up.

Here are the most innovative new uses of TIMERS, direct from the players and GMs who make **ICRPG** the ever-changing beast it is.

EXPLAINED IMMINENCE: We've all rolled a D4 to see when 'the next thing' is about to happen. This doesn't mean it has to be a mystery! TIMERS gain new efficacy when you freely explain what the timer implies. "You see a group of shapes swimming up. They'll arrive soon, that's what this TIMER represents."

WORLD TIMER: At the beginning of a session or even adventure, the GM sets a TIMER on the table, usually at its max value, like a 12 on a D12. "In 12 ROUNDS, the reactor overloads. It will vaporize the planet." This brutal form of TIMER asks players: can you be victorious in a set amount of time? If not, it's over.

TURN TIMER: Most TIMERS count ROUNDS. For a brutally fast feeling to the action, convert this increment to TURNS. Rolling a 1 on a TURN TIMER means that the next player to act triggers this event! Even a 4, in TURNS, can be less than 1 ROUND! Use sparingly, this stuff is TNT.

STATIC DEATH TIMER: We've all rolled for DYING, but this TIMER can also be made static. Rather than a DYING D4 roll, you simply have 3 ROUNDS to get a heal or stabilization, or you're dead. This method can even out the volatility of DYING rolls, but also eliminate the anti-climactic effect of a high DYING roll.

RELOAD/RECHARGE: Looking to nerf or control roll-to-cast or superdeadly fire-arms? Simply employ a D4 reload/recharge on a given weapon or spell. This asks gun mongers to carry multiple weapons, and forces roll-to-cast wizards to switch up their spell selection to avoid downtime.

EFFORT SUBSTITUTE: EFFORT is great to challenge players with prolonged tasks. As a faster way to measure such tasks, you can just use a timer. After the initial success, simply announce "It will take D4 ROUNDS to decode the secret password." Now that player can be at ease, working steadily, rather than using table time each ROUND on the same task.

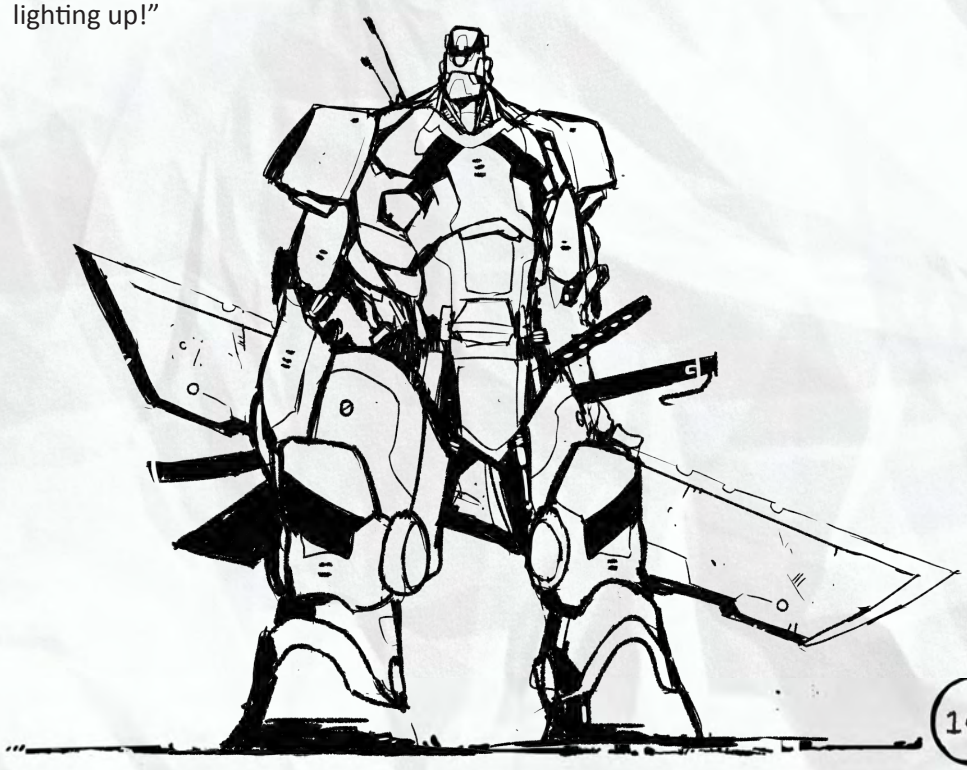
TIMER DAMAGE

Just like TARGET DAMAGE, TIMER DAMAGE is a term for players' ability to delay or hasten events with their ABILITIES and LOOT. Once a TIMER is on the table, players should always feel welcome to work against it in their favor. Here are a few examples.

ROOM ON FIRE: The cabin may be burned to cinders in 3 ROUNDS, but a player using an extinguisher, water magic, or other means could delay that outcome by 1 ROUND for each TURN used fighting the flames. "Get them out! I'll hold the fire here!"

THE PORTAL IS FORMING: We've all had encounters where an escape route is all too slow to arrive. Players could assist magical effects, boost the power output of an allied mage, or destroy warding runes to hasten a portal. Super effective efforts reduce the TIMER by D4 ROUNDS! "By all the old Gods! I add my doorway spell to yours! Haraban, portoli, infernum!"

CRUSHER MECH POWERING UP: In D4 ROUNDS, the monster of metal will be active and ready to rampage! A series of power cables are discovered by a player nearby. For each cable pulled with STR, the power cycle is delayed by 1 ROUND. Up the ante with multiple mecha, or HARD STR rolls. "Run! The eye is lighting up!"



CALLING FOR DEFENSE ROLLS

One of your best tools here is the DEFENSE roll. This STAT won't have much excitement without a GM who embraces it! The purpose of this new accent is to give well-armored characters a reward for their precious character creation points. All too often, GMs use a DEX roll when some devastating effect sweeps across the battlefield. "Roll DEX to avoid the wall of fire!" With DEFENSE, DEX is no longer the key STAT for avoiding large area effects. Dwarves rejoice.

DEFENSE is especially handy when an effect cannot be evaded. Who can just simply take it and still stand? Here are some examples of using DEFENSE in play.

SHRAPNEL: Any effect that sprays damage everywhere, or goes all directions, demands a DEFENSE roll to reduce or avoid the pain. These types of abilities are great for giving enemies variety and danger, rather than rolling attacks over and over.

FALLING: Hitting the ground is never pleasant, but DEFENSE can help absorb the impact. A successful roll here doesn't nullify damage, just reduces it.

ALL OR NOTHING: If any effect, even as a result of a conventional attack roll, is to reduce a character to 0 HP, or even inflict instant death, circumstances may offer the player one final DEFENSE roll to remain intact. "You're toast, but let's see if you're just knocked senseless or crushed to jelly. Roll DEFENSE."

IMMOVABLE: If an effect would shove, push, slide or topple characters with sheer force, a heavily armored character might try to plant their feet in defiance. This is a perfect moment to reward high ARMOR players, as they roll DEFENSE to stand firm.

SHARED DEFENSES: Ah, the shield wall! When characters are making DEFENSE rolls elbow-to-elbow, let them help each other! Add DEFENSE bonuses, share them, or allow re-rolls on failure. We are mighty when we lock wills and shields, so let that moment be epic!

WHEN THERE'S NO DEFENSE: Bigger, badder baddies don't bother with attack rolls. A giant dragon tail, for example, does not roll to attack. It's huge! This type of attack simply hits, and the victims must absorb the impact as best they can. AUTO-HIT is also handy for keeping boss level battles fast at the table.

DAMAGING DEFENSES

The skilled GM giveth, and taketh away. Consider eroding player equipment, thereby decreasing their DEFENSE STAT in cases like these.

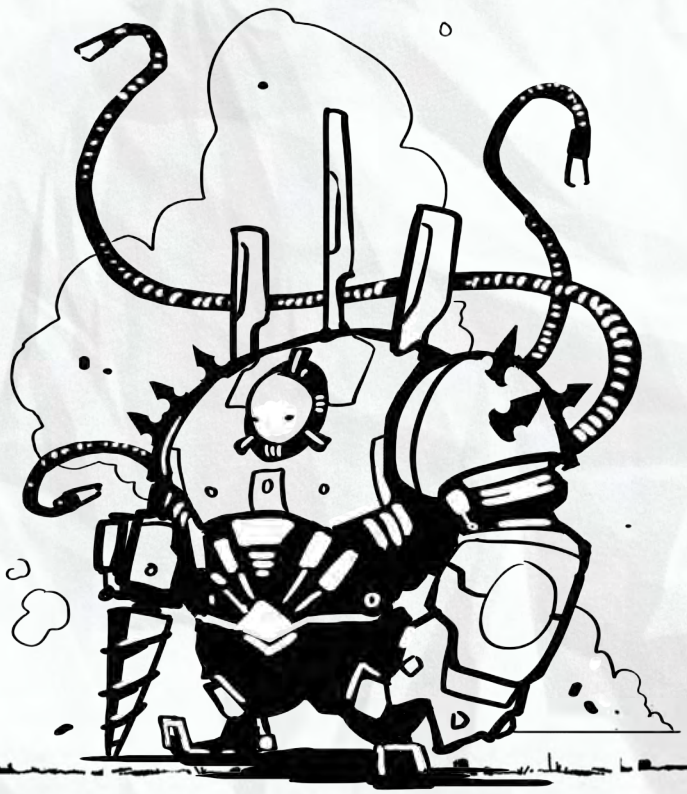
SUNDER ATTACKS: Equip your nastiest monsters with attacks specifically for getting rid of armor LOOT. Smashing weapons and piercing spikes work best. "Boom! You take 12 damage and lose 1D4 DEFENSE!"

CORROSION: Acid, rust, and extreme temperature can all crack, corrode or dissolve equipment, rendering armor useless and lowering DEFENSE.

MASSIVE DAMAGE: If a character takes over 20 damage in a hit, consider the logical attachment of damaged armor. "You were crushed by a boulder, for crying out loud. Your hauberk is crumpled!"

OVERCLOCKER: For a character constantly using a shield, some wear and tear is expected. Each session, decrease the shield's DEFENSE by 1.

THE YANKING: Some enemies come equipped with grabby hands, nipping tentacles, or thiefy beaks. Successful attacks steal armor bits.



VEHICLES & CHUNKS

Vehicles in **ICRPG**, all the way up to starships, are defined by CHUNKS. A CHUNK is 1 HEART of VEHICLE HP (5 HP for battle suits), one key function or weapon, 250 pounds of metal and rubber, and costs 1,000 coin. No vehicle can excede 5 CHUNKS. With this simple system, you can build anything!

VEHICLES inflict double damage against those on foot. Pedestrians do HALF damage against VEHICLES. Attacking a battle suit with your trusty pistol? Not a good idea.

During the action, if a CHUNK is reduced to ZERO HP, it is destroyed! Remove the ability or weapon associated with that CHUNK. Use a roll to choose what CHUNK, unless the attacker is aiming at a specific CHUNK. If a destroyed CHUNK is fired upon, roll again. Another fun narrative element is having that CHUNK go flying as a hazard, or landing in the field and becoming an obstacle or source of fire.

VEHICLE EXAMPLES

All vehicles fall into three categories of speed: Slow, Fast, and Hyperfast. Slow and Fast engines use 1 CHUNK, and Hyperfast engines use 2 CHUNKS (like a Hypercar's Blower).

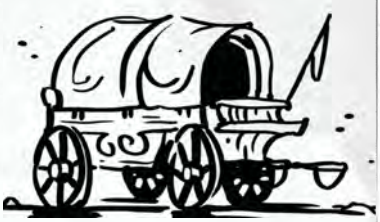
GRAV BIKE: 2 CHUNKS: Engine (Fast), Fairing (Ram for Weapon Damage)
HYPERCAR: 4 CHUNKS: Engine (Fast), Roll Cage (Ram for Weapon Damage), Chain Gun (Fire for Gun Damage), Nitro Blower (Allows bursts of Hyperfast)
DREDGE: 5 CHUNKS: Engine (Slow), Haul Crane (Grapple other vehicles), Grenade Launcher (Fire for Explosive Energy/Magical Damage), Ram (Ram for Weapon Damage), Flatbed (carry another vehicle)
BATTLE SUIT: 5 CHUNKS (5 HP EACH): Ablative Shield (+5 DEFENSE, explodes when destroyed), Bolt Gun (3 round burst, reload after 4 bursts, explodes if destroyed), Repair Unit (repair 1D6 onboard CHUNK HP per ROUND), Repulsor Shield (+3 DEFENSE, deflect all projectile weapons within CLOSE range)

STARFIGHTERS AND MANEUVERING

Like all VEHICLES, space fighters are built in CHUNKS. A Krell SF-4 fighter is built from four standard 10 HP CHUNKS. Consider a few custom rules to give your unique vehicles maneuvers and let the chaos begin. Here is a sample fighter build, and a few maneuvers to offer players.

Krell SF-4: 4 CHUNKS: Cockpit (Life support, canopy, instruments, and controls. Seats two. If destroyed, the fighter can no longer be operated. Pilots still in a destroyed cockpit have 1D4 ROUNDS before death), Ion Drive (Enables deep space/sector travel and maneuvers. If destroyed, fighter is crippled and can only taxi or limp at thruster speed), SR missile pack (Explodes when destroyed, destroys 1D8 micro fighters or inflicts D10 DAMAGE against CHUNKS, 8 bursts until empty), Chain Gun (Destroys 1D4 micro fighters or inflicts D8 CHUNK HP, never needs reload).

- **PUNCH IT** (Move to any adjacent SECTOR, take fire from enemies in current SECTOR. SECTORS are simply areas of deep space)
- **ZERO** (Lock onto target and follow them even if they PUNCH IT)
- **ENGAGE** (Fire guns! On a success, roll damage on a random CHUNK)
- **BREAK OFF** (Stay in the current SECTOR, but elude all enemies that TURN)
- **DITCH** (Eject! Roll to safely eject or take WEAPON DAMAGE as you fly out)



IT'S JUST A WAGON!

Even if you're building CHUNKS for something as simple as a wagon, apply the same rules and offer a few cool maneuvers!

HORROR MODE

Adding horror to your games is a delicate dance for any GM. It is a mix of atmosphere, terrible themes and revelations, the loss of one's sanity, and worst of all- glimpses of the vast, uncaring infinity of the cosmos. Let's start with SANITY...

SANITY DAMAGE

Every good horror game has an insanity mechanic. In many ways, counting these points as they tick down is more central to a horror game than actual HP, because the danger is more psychological than combat-driven.

All sane characters start with 1 HEART of SANITY

The deeper they peer into the abyss, the more this reservoir of reason is eroded. They go completely mad at 0 SANITY, unable to function.

Inflict SANITY DAMAGE whenever the moment is too terrible for a character to simply wave away. Scenes of abject horror, gruesome glimpses of suffering or realizations of supernatural truth inflict SANITY DAMAGE.

The table below offers a guide to what kinds of events could inflict certain amounts of precious SANITY DAMAGE.

See a person dismembered, beheaded, or die terribly	1
Suddenly discover a corpse or scene of depravity	1
Stare directly at a supernatural entity, ghost or zombie	1(1D4 if horde)
Have a limb ripped or chopped off (lose all but 1 HP in one attack)	1D4
Witness an object of celestial, antediluvian, or trans-dimensional origin	1D4
Gaze upon an abomination of the world between worlds	1D6
Assemble clues that lead to dark truths transcending time and space	1D6
Witness the arrival of an Elder God such as Azatoth or Ogdru	1D8
Form a mind-union with an elder God or Beyonder	1D10

SANITY	STATE OF BEING
10	Safe in the veil of daily normalcy
9	Rationalizing away what was just witnessed...it couldn't be...
8	Aghast, on edge, wary of unexplained sounds
7	Shocked, looking for any way to avoid the source
6	Terrified. CHA, WIS rolls HARD, can't ATTACK the source of fear
5	Pure, white hot fear, break a cold sweat, ALL ROLLS are HARD
4	NO! All ROLLS HARD, must seek hiding place or back away immediately
3	Screaming, petrified with fear for 1D4 ROUNDS, beg allies to flee
2	Run! Run for your lives! Use 1D6 ROUNDS to flee at maximum speed
1	Tears. Fall to your knees, ALL ROLLS HARD is now PERMANENT
0	Catatonic, clinically mad, seeing the terror again and again forever

DETAILS, DREAD, AND DEVILS

SANITY DAMAGE is easy enough to employ, and can provide good role-playing guidelines mechanically, but it is a far cry from real, tangible horror in a game session. There are many paths to building the unsettling effects of good horror, here are a few key tools to experiment with.

THE DETAILS ARE PERSONAL AND UNNERVING

- Old timey music plays when the evil is growing
- Children and animals see and feel the horror first, freezing in place
- Heirlooms and memorabilia show a lonely, misguided fall from grace
- Players investigate, the tone is subdued, slow, rumbling

BUILD DREAD OF INEVITABLE EVIL

- Show the aftermath of attacks-- the innocent are torn to pieces
- A doom-sayer character is spared, but found bloodless, frozen with fear
- An old journal or lost tablet tells of far greater forces at work
- Players uncover the evil, clash with cultists or the possessed

BRING THE DEVILS INTO THE LIGHT

- The innocent are used as puppets by the evil... hissing and howling
- The true beast, a giant of nightmare, is never quite seen
- There is no killing that which is death-- fighting it is futile
- Even after all the heroes do, some remnant of evil endures-- a ritual fails
- Players confront dark gods, go mad, kill themselves or forced to flee

ADVENTURE BUILDING THE INDEX CARD WAY

Time to bring things to the table. You need to build an adventure! **ICRPG** favors simplicity. If any thing is too complex to run from memory, it's too complicated. Here's how all the **ICRPG** adventures from years past are built. *Special mention here to the brilliant '5 Room Dungeon' method of roleplayingtips.com!*

1) THE WHOLE TRUTH

To get started, you need the bird's eye view of your idea. This is all the secrets, the big twist, villains, and scenery in your idea. Grab a trusty index card and write down the big picture. Don't try to be clever or interesting, just facts.

- A starship is imbued by evil energies while crazy lizard mutants run amuck onboard. Heroes must destroy the ship from within before it reaches a home planet and spreads its doom to a huge population of good peoples.
- Bad guy monks in a huge dungeon are planning to summon an evil god. Heroes need to find their way down and stop the ritual, but time is running out! The guy who helps them turns out to be an evil monk, too!

2) SCENES & BULLETS

Now lean back in your GM chair and take a look at the whole truth. It should give you ideas for scenes you'll need. Find five scenes, including 2-4 bullets of fun detail per scene. Keep it super tight, just let it flow, worry if it's cool later.

SCENE 1: Entering and 'The Guardian': Start things off with a bang, get the dice rolling as soon as possible... we're talking 'before the credits'! Describe the opening scenery then BOOM an enemy leaps into frame and attacks!

SCENE 2: A Role Playing Challenge: Now that everyone is warmed up, move them deeper into the map and propose a dilemma. Do they bargain with the bad guy or proclaim their defiance? How can they convince a foe to help them?

SCENE 3: The Big Setback: Once the dialogue and pondering flattens out, the story shoves players into a dangerous scene, one that is almost unwinnable, cascading them into the heart of darkness.

SCENE 4: The Climactic Battle: The heroes tumble into the sanctum or deepest lair, and are confronted with the reason for all the fuss. Time to fight.

SCENE 5: Rewards and a Twist: In the afterglow of battle, shower them with praise from local folks, treasure, or revelations... but then things are not what they seemed and the threat somehow lives on.

3) CASTING CALL!

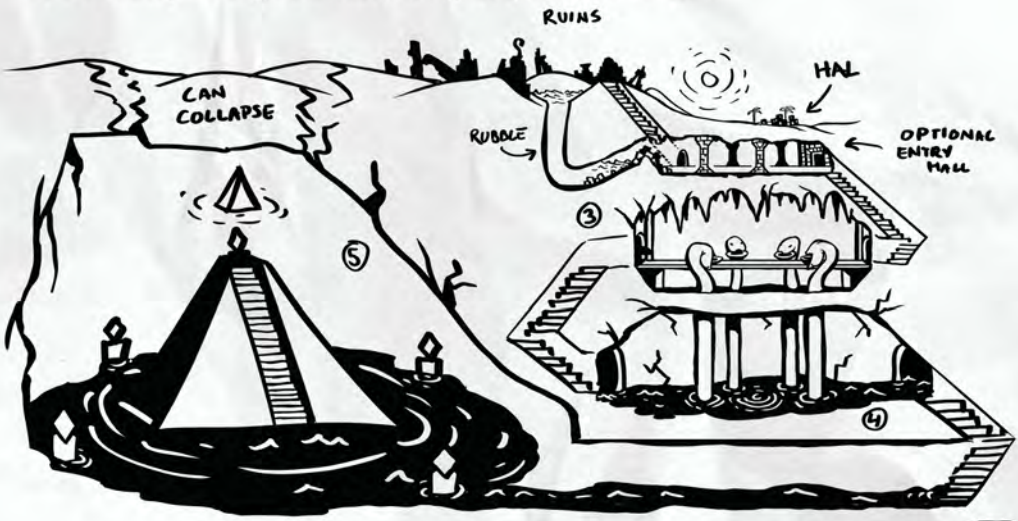
Now that you have a sense for what scenes make an idea work, you probably already know what characters and creatures occupy those scenes. Take a moment to write each one down on an index card. You'll need a few NPC's, a few bad guys, and something a little tougher to mix it up. If it's too much for an index card, it's too much for you! Here are a few examples.

- **Nadia, helpful local girl:** Nadia is small, but courageous. She remembers the town when it was bright and good, and needs the heroes' help!
- **Edmundo, doom-sayer guy in town:** Edmundo shouts at heroes to be gone! This town is doomed! No one can help! It must all burn!
- **Ratmen:** Half rat, half man, all nasty! They have kidnapped townsfolk as food! Ratmen are super easy to kill, but fight in numbers.
- **Ratman Sorceror:** Cloaked, creepy, makes potion to conjure more Ratmen! This guy uses magic and runs away, making him hard to beat.
- **Rat King Locrius:** A pale, hairless super rat mutant unleashed to end it all!

4) MAKE SOME MAPS

Now for the coolest part: maps! Whether players see your maps or not, you'll need a sense for where the action takes place. Some will be tools to help you describe things, others literal, mechanical design ideas. Try mapping from the side, or using blueprints or concept art to capture your ideas from The Whole Truth. Don't worry about measuring out 5-foot squares or perfect grids. The best maps work like a soundstage in a play, or a set in a movie: they are the backdrop that reinforces the mood and gives players ideas to role play.

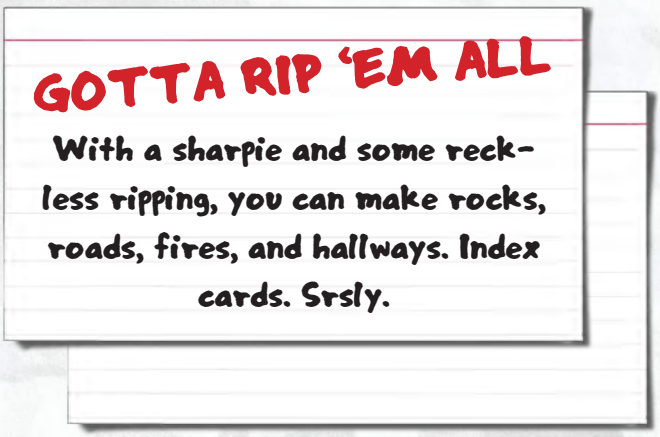
You're ready. Now go be an amazing GM, and fear no evil!

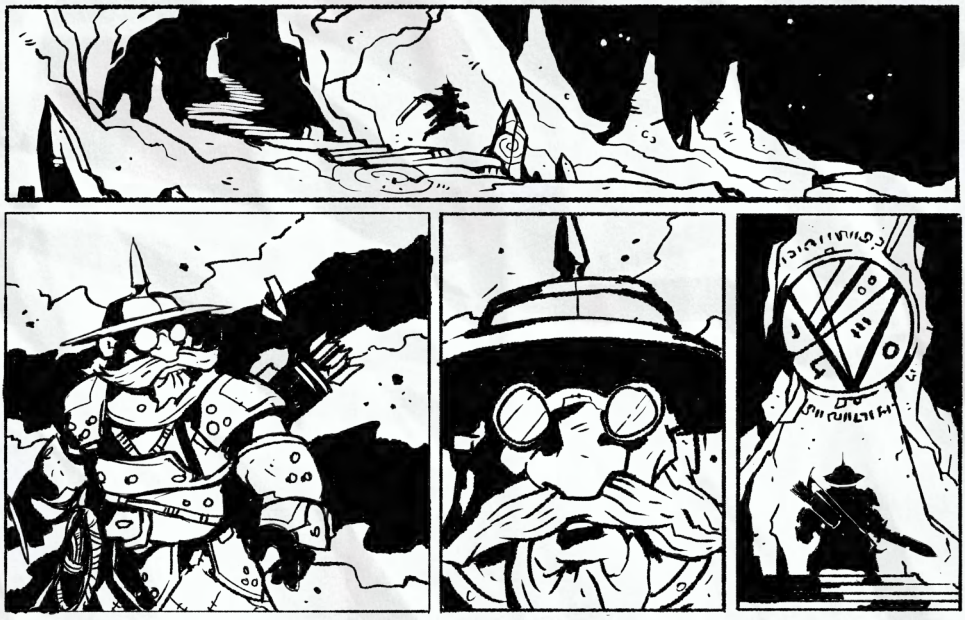


INDEX CARDS? SRSLY?

Before we dive into this section, you might be wondering why in the Nine Hells this RPG is named after the humble index card. There is no drama in these little bits of paper, no excitement, no fantasy. I mean, they're index cards for cryin' out loud. For reasons that will become ever-more apparent, you'll see that the index card is a metaphor for an entire way of thinking. Your ideas are delivered in small, digestible bits. You will treasure memorization over book-checking. You will divide your game world into tasty little packages. Most of all, you'll be able to create, organize, and execute on the fly, as the wacky action of a good RPG session unfolds. Here's why they earned the title spot.

- **Humble Origins:** In the many years of gaming that led up to this system, no one tool was more clutch for me as a Gamemaster. I use 'em like crazy.
- **Creative Kick:** Ever draw a complete blank on preparing a session or creating a new monster? Stack up cards with random drawings, shuffle and pull a few. It's like a tarot for GMs: interpret and get going.
- **Monsters:** Nothing organizes your monsters for a session better than an index card. When they're killed, tear that sucker up.
- **Terrain and Distance:** With a sharpie at the ready, you can improvise bridges, walls, doorways, and more with a few quick lines. When you really start to embrace this, the cards themselves measure distance in your world.
- **LOOT:** Draw that magic sword on a card, mark down the stats, and hand it to the player who just unlocked that rusty old chest. It's great.
- **Everything Else:** Anything you may need in your session, your prep, or your design process can find tidy, separated homes on cards. Yes, you're gonna chew through hundreds of these little beauties.





THE WIZARD'S LOCK

The symbol on the cover of this book is a WIZARD'S LOCK. It's a sort of shorthand for the interdimensional WORLDS and crazy GM style at play here. Wherever this mysterious symbol appears, the dimensions and time streams become tangled. Cosmic rifts, motes of raw arcane power, and time distortions are soon to follow when a WIZARD'S LOCK appears. For those powerful enough to survive, the WIZARD'S LOCK can even be used as a gateway to the farthest reaches of the multiverse. This phenomenon rests at the heart of **ICRPG's** cosmic crossroads: it is an arcane explanation for the mindset of being an **ICRPG** GM: all WORLDS, all times, all fun. Here are the WIZARD LOCK'S properties:

- **BIND THE WORLDS:** Index Card RPG spans many distinct worlds. The more you explore, as a game master or player, the more these worlds threaten to overlap. The WIZARD'S LOCK gives you a means to do just that. A LOCK in ALFHEIM may link to an energy portal in WARP SHELL.
- **MONSTER MAKER:** The arcane energy being tapped by these strange glyphs has a tendency to twist nearby creatures into terrible forms. Find the LOCK, destroy it, and rid one more town of its hellish menace.
- **COVETED BY EVIL:** Evil forces always seek to conceal and control a WIZARD'S LOCK for their devious plans. In any story, what seems one source of devilry can later be revealed as a WIZARD'S LOCK. There's no telling where they'll turn up, and the nasties won't be far.

HEROES ARE MADE HEROES BY MONSTERS

DARKNESS DEFINES LIGHT

THE GM'S JOB? GIVE THE DARKNESS LIFE

MONSTER LISTINGS

HEARTS: A suggestion only! Always feel free to tune HEARTS to your game's current moment. 1 HEART = 10 hit points.

ROLLS: STAT Bonuses simplified into one or two values. This includes all Checks and Attempts as well as Effort!

ACTIONS and TRAITS: Here's where things get interesting. These elements list combat actions or special aspects of the creature.

LORE: A simplified summary of what this thing is, and why it is unique. Another opportunity for the GM to add, change or improvise detail.

AGNAR

♥ ♥ ♥

+5 STR, +3 ALL OTHERS

LIE IN WAIT: Disguised as a green rock, free surprise Chomp attack on CLOSE passers-by
CHOMP: Weapon Effort, all CLOSE Enemies
FLYING LEAP: Leap to Move FAR, then ULTIMATE Effort against any enemies CLOSE to landing impact
SPIN-THRASH: Weapon Effort, all NEAR Enemies. NEAR enemies DEX Check to halve the damage, then Agnar recovers 5 HP

The all-eater, or 'supermouth,' of Kath. This jungle-dwelling beast has an odd spherical body/head that is lined on **all sides** *with chomping teeth. It is ravenously hungry at all times. Agnar are terrified and enraged by fire in any form, especially if it is brought into their lair or cave.*

ANGEL

+6 STATS, +4 EFFORT

SUN SWORD: ULTIMATE weapon ignores ARMOR, strikes all CLOSE enemies. Natural 12s rolled with this weapon's EFFORT explode (maxed dice roll again)
SUN FURY: A ray of pure nuclear fire that functions just like the sword, but with a range of 1 mile
RADIANT NOVA: The creature glows as bright as a white star. Demons, undead, infernals and even evil-doers must roll CHA or flee with their next 1D4 TURNS
JUDGEMENT: The Angel chooses a single creature. In 1D4 TURNS, it is torn apart atom by atom

Angels are the indestructible servants of infinity. They are largely perceived as lawful and benevolent, but this is not accurate. They are absolute, indisputable LAWGIVERS of the multiverse.

AVENGER

♥♥♥♥♥

+5 STATS, +8 WEAPON EFFORT

EXECUTE: Axe Slices through objects, walls, or creatures CLOSE to the target.
Creatures / objects hit reduced to 0 HP
RETRIEVE: The Avenger grapples its foe and returns to its origin. HARD STR rolls are the only escape
PRISM BLADES: All creatures within FAR must roll DEX to evade or take ULTIMATE damage from these razors
MIST STONE: MAGIC does half damage against them

Avengers are prisoners of their purpose. They are conjured, brought into existence only to fulfill some grave task, vow, or to obey to a powerful wizard. They dissipate when their task is complete.

ANT MEN

♥

+2 ALL ROLLS, 2 ACTIONS PER TURN

SLASH: Sword attack. Ant men seldom use ranged weapons
DISMEMBERING BITE: WEAPON. If more than 6 damage is dealt, the target loses a limb
ACID MIST: Corrosive mist out of tiny pores in its exoskeleton. All enemies within NEAR roll CON or suffer WEAPON damage to themselves AND 1 piece of equipment

Found anywhere the land is hollow. Ant Men live to protect their queen, of which there is only one per thousand square miles. They work as a team in vast numbers. Their primary food source is fungus, which they farm in deep tunnels.

BANSHEE

♥ ♥

+2 ALL ROLLS

CLAWS: Spectral Slash, MAGIC
INT SPELL-DEAFENING HOWL: NEAR enemies roll CON or be disabled, plagued by visions of horror. The sound continues until Banshee is injured or stops on its own
BLINK: Banshees can move up to FAR distance without traveling the space between
INT SPELL-DRAIN: Drain MAGIC EFFORT of HP from a target to heal itself
SPECTRAL SUBSTANCE: Only magical weaponry and magic can harm them.

Banshees are tormented souls, poor wretches driven by confusion and envy of the living. They are often found terrorizing some small town where they were betrayed in life.

BLACK DRAKE

♥ ♥ ♥ ♥ ♥

+5 ALL ROLLS, 3 ACTIONS PER TURN

CRUSHING BITE: NEAR WEAPON, if victim dropped to 0 HP by CRUSHING BITE, devoured
TAKE WING: The drake flies straight up. At altitude, it glides 1D4 ROUNDS, recovering full HP
WHIPPING TAIL: All enemies NEAR make a DEX Check or take WEAPON damage
BREATH OF FIRE: All enemies within FAR in front of the Drake roll CON to avoid. DOUBLE ULTIMATE
INT SPELL-SPELL STEALER: On a Hard Attempt, the Drake can utilize any INT spell used by its opponents
Immune to fire in all forms.

Most sinister of the Drakes, they live to feed on lesser beings, hoard treasure, and dominate the volcanic realms of Alfheim, demanding worship from all.

BLIND HORROR

♥ ♥

+5 DEX

SPIKED TAIL: WEAPON, rolls with DEX to attack, ignores armor (rolls on TARGET rather than DEFENSE)
FIRE RAY: MAGIC, a ranged attack that sears a target within FAR range. Those hit also take 1D4 burn damage next TURN
WIS Spell-HEAL WITH FLAMES: The Horror heals itself with MAGIC
GATHER POWER: A Blind Horror can use an Action to gather its power, doubling any EFFORT done on its next TURN

Sightless fiends that prowl the pits, these creatures are demonic in nature. They channel a kind of fire energy and hunt with smell and sound. They are servants of Devilish masters and eat those they defeat.

BORE WORM

♥

+3 ALL ROLLS, 2 ACTIONS PER TURN

TONGUE LASH: WEAPON, can also be used to destroy any inanimate object
STONE BITE: WEAPON if over 8 EFFORT in one Attack, destroy one item on target
INT SPELL-VENOM SCENT: CLOSE enemies roll CON or become dizzy with noxious gas emitted from small holes in the Worm's shell. The dizziness causes 3 Poison Damage and makes rolls HARD

These abominable beings are not pure evil, but they function on territorial instincts. They hate all man-made things, and reproduce by spraying prey with tiny digging grubs that pierce the skin.

BRAIN HORROR

♥ ♥

+3 ALL ROLLS

STINGING TENTACLES: WEAPON, Poisonous (take damage until a successful CON Check)
LEVITATE: Does not need terrain to move, always in flight, can rise up to FAR height, silent
INT SPELL-BETRAYAL: All NEAR enemies make an INT Check or turn against an ally for 1 ROUND
INT SPELL-PSYCHIC BLAST: Single target, any range, ULTIMATE, compels its target to walk toward the Brain Horror for 1 turn
INT SPELL-FEED: CLOSE, Single target, do MAGIC against a touched enemy, heal that HP

The hovering Brain Horror is the construct of a mad sorcerer in forgotten times. It is a tormented thing, unable to communicate except through dark visions.

CARRION CRAB

♥ ♥ ♥

+2 ALL ROLLS, 2 ACTIONS PER TURN

GIANT CLAWS: WEAPON, CLOSE
DIG IN: As an Action, the Carrion Crab pulls its legs inward and grips the ground. In this state, it is utterly immovable by any physical means
PASSIVE SPINES AND SPIKES: These beasts are covered in armor, swords, and spears, as well as natural chitin spines. Any successful melee attack against them inflicts WEAPON Damage on the attacker

The battlefields of yore are prowled by these huge beasts. They feed on the dead, leather belts, horse flesh, and all the debris of battle. They stack and arrange the equipment of the fallen onto their massive shells as a great bulwark. With care, these creatures can be looted several times.

CAVE ROPER

♥ ♥ ♥

+4 ALL ROLLS

LASH: WEAPON attack, NEAR reach, a barbed tongue whips and flays

GRAPPLE: A single NEAR target can resist with a HARD STR roll or be dragged in and held as food

CHEW: With no roll, the Cave Roper chews on its held prey as an action. Victim can use a HARD CON check to reduce the damage to half with sheer will

These camouflaged, immovable cavern predators disguise themselves as stalagmites, then roar to life, devouring the unwary. They are thoughtless, hateful things who dwell in large colonies. Also known as 'Miner's Bane' or 'Cave Chewer.'

CHILD OF AZATOTH

♥ ♥ ♥

+8 ALL ROLLS

INT SPELL-CONFUSION: All intelligent creatures within FAR range make ALL rolls as HARD, overrides all abilities

SPELL EATER: Destroy any INT spell used by any of its opponents, removing it from the caster's memory

TELEKINESIS: This being can move objects, even huge ones, with an INT check. Such objects are its only physical weapons

INT SPELL-MEMORY EATER: This spell targets a single victim and robs them of one key memory from their recent or distant past, whichever is more sadistic

AURA OF OFFERINGS: Any CLOSE creature must make a CHA check. If failed, they must offer one LOOT to the God as tribute

This...THING...is neither living creature nor inanimate statue. It is both. It is an effigy of the unseen horrors that predate the universe and the madness that swirls in the dreams of death itself.

CORRODER

♥ ♥

+2 STATS, +1 WEAPON EFFORT

GRABBERS: Snatch one piece of GEAR from a target
CHOMP: Corroder eats stolen gear. Devour 1 piece of stolen gear per action used. For any piece eaten, the Corroder returns to full HEARTS
ATTACK-LASH: Sharp claw weapon
CLIMB: MOVE actions on any surface

Sword eaters! Stone chewers! Dwarves' bane! These deep-dwellers move in large numbers, devouring all metal, refined stone, wood, glass, gems, and any other artificially honed material. They have an intolerance of a shaped world... demanding it be purely natural in form.

CRYSTAL WORM

♥ ♥ ♥ ♥

+4 STATS, +2 WEAPON EFFORT

ATTACK-MANDIBLES: WEAPON, target rolls a competing STR check or is restrained by the huge jaws
INT SPELL-WEB SHOCK: All NEAR enemies make a DEX check or take MAGIC as a crimson shockwave expands outward. Those who fail are also glued where they stand by red tendrils of goo until a STR check is made to break free
PSIONIC CALL: After the first round of combat, a Crystal Worm will vibrate its antennae, emitting a silent pulse. 1D4 more worms will answer this call in 1D4 ROUNDS

These massive tunneling arthropods eat various types of crystal to survive and have developed quartz-like teeth to do so. They can be spotted by their glowing eyes. They hate intruders and dutifully patrol their hives night and day for any sign of them.

DEMON

♥ ♥

+4 STATS, +2 EFFORT

RAZOR CLAWS: MAGIC rippers
SCREAM: 1D4 more Demons appear from any smoke or nearby darkness
SMOKE WALK: Demons can move between any smoke as a MOVE. The smoke is their home, and heals them with MAGIC
TRUE NAME: If a demon's true name is somehow learned, it can be commanded

Demons take a myriad of forms, but all abide by ancient laws of their kind. Though they are intelligent, they lack mercy, remorse, or comprehension of what it is to be redeemed. They live in a constant state of rage, pain, and misguided wrath.

DEVIL DUST

NO ROLLS, ACTIONS VARIABLE BY MASS

DEVOUR: Roll 1D6, on a 4-5-6, for each category of volume (see below), the Devil Dust consumes a human or animal, then gains 1 category of volume
KEEPS GROWING: Minimum volume of 3. Volume 3: cart | Volume 4: wagon | Volume 5: room | Volume 10: castle | Volume 20: city

Devil Dust is a form of sentient gas or microparticles that move and behave as a cloud, but with intelligent motion regardless of wind. Wherever gas or air can go, it can go. It cannot be destroyed, but dissipates in time. An immense cloud of this substance can destroy an entire city.

DIREHORN

♥♥♥♥♥

+5 STATS, +2 EFFORT

RAM: Smash everything in a straight line that extends to FAR. Nothing can stop it besides solid bedrock. Anything in the path takes ULTIMATE damage
TRAMPLE: Move double FAR, running over creatures or small structures. This attack only inflicts WEAPON damage with no roll
IRON HIDE: Regenerate 10 HP. Attacks against it become HARD until it is hit

On the great plains and steppes, this huge animal reigns supreme. They are bigger than a wagon, faster than any horse, and have no tolerance for the two-legged races. Some say the storms guide their mighty herds, but the true nature of their migrations remains a mystery.

EYE BEAST

♥♥♥

+6 STATS, +4 MAGIC EFFORT, 2 BEAMS/TURN

MAGIC BEAMS: Roll 2D4, fire two beams at random targets.
1-DEATH RAY: Drops its target to 0 HP
2-MAGIC NULLIFIER: Target can't use MAGIC for 1D4 ROUNDS
3-ENERGY FIST: WEAPON damage, shove target away until impacting a solid surface.
4-GAZE OF STONE: Petrify for 1D6 hours. If the statue is left behind, the effect is permanent

Dreaded rulers of the underworld, the Eye Beasts are highly intelligent and construct strongholds in the world below. They enslave other monsters, devise devious lures for humanoids, and plan multi-dimensional doomsday schemes.

FEEDER

♥ ♥

+1 ALL ROLLS, 2 ACTIONS/TURN

CHEW: A WEAPON attack
PHASE: Feeders turn immaterial as an action with no roll
SOUL EATER: Victim must make a CON roll or the bite inflicts 1 point of permanent STAT damage. Choose STAT at random

Feeders live only to serve their lord, even unto death. It is hard to tell if they are beasts or supernatural things... such questions are left to the weirdest wizards.

FIEND

♥ ♥ ♥ ♥

+8 STATS, +4 EFFORT, 2 ACTIONS/TURN

MAGMA BEAM: A deadly eye ray. All in a FAR straight line are reduced to 0 HP
SCATTER SPELL: Fiends cast SPELLS through their victims. A target it can see must roll INT or be used as a conduit, casting FOR the Fiend
ION SWORD: MAGIC slash. This blade is pure plasma-state ions, and ignores all ARMOR
THUNDER WING: The rush of air is concussive. All those within FAR roll DEX or fall, taking 1 HP of damage and using their next TURN to recover. Heals Fiend with MAGIC
DOORWAY: If perturbed or near defeat, a Fiend will use the Doorway SPELL to escape
SUMMON: With no roll, a Fiend can summon 1D4 Feeders, Imps, Shadow Lashers or Flame Kin

Fiends mastermind complex schemes and world-ending plots, all in the interest of gaining power and expanding their network of doorways. They have no love even for other Fiends, and their feuds with their own kind are never ending.

FLAME KIN

♥

+3 STATS

FIRE CLAW: WEAPON. If used against flammable materials, will ignite
HEALED BY FIRE: Gain 1D6 HP from any open flames or fire magic they touch
FLAME DOOR Any open flame in sight used to teleport

Few beings are more ubiquitous in the cosmos than these humanoids of pure fire. They dwell in volcanic hells, on the surface of suns, and in long-burning forest fires.

FLAMING SKULL

♥ ♥

+2 STATS, +4 MAGIC EFFORT

LEVITATE: Always in flight, can rise up to FAR height
INT SPELL-PARALYZE: A single target is rendered totally motionless. Paralysis lasts 2 ROUNDS
FIRE SWORD: On its turn, the Skull can conjure a blazing sword which will engage combatants. The sword is spectral and cannot be harmed
MAGMA BOMB: Spit a glowing blob of fire at a target or area. All NEAR the impact site for the next 4 ROUNDS must make a DEX Check or take MAGIC Fire Damage. Successful CHECKS halve this

When the soul of a fallen villain is too hateful to enter the afterworld, they become a Flaming Skull. If destroyed, a Flaming Skull will reform in 1D4 hours, and return to its work.

FLIMES

♥

+1 ALL ROLLS PER FLIME

BITE: CLOSE Weapon Effort
ELEMENTAL DWELLERS: Fire, ice, earth, metal, wood, air, and so on. Dunking themselves in their element heals them to full HP.
DIVIDE AND DESTROY: If a Flime is reduced to less than 3 HP, but not killed, it will divide into 2 Flimes, each with a full HEART of Hit Points.

Flying Slimes, commonly called Flimes, have plagued good folk for eons. Primordial life forms, driven by hunger alone. They reproduce by division, which can only occur in battle. Thus, they are driven to fight, interfere, and chomp at all the doings of men and beasts.

GARGOLETH

♥ ♥ ♥ ♥ ♥ ♥

+8 ALL ROLLS, 3 ACTIONS/TURN

TENTACLE: Hits all targets NEAR point of attack. Inflicts ship/CHUNK damage, with ULTIMATE effort
CRUSHING BEAK: ULTIMATE Effort on a single NEAR target. If target reduced to zero HP, devoured whole
WAVE SURGE: A Gargoleth can convulse its body to form a huge wave. Creatures in its path must make a HARD STR check or be swept away.
STORMS: So mighty is this beast, when it approaches, sea conditions become perilous. All navigation becomes HARD.

A ravenous, insatiable behemoth from the depths. It devours entire ships and prowls the blackness for its next meal. Nature's most terrible creation. Many sailors have vanished seeking a magical means to repel or control it.

GHOST

♥
+2 STATS, +6 ULTIMATE

TERRIFY: Roll CHA against this action, or spend your next TURN fleeing the source or sighting
VISIONS: All living creatures within FAR of a Ghost must roll INT or lose their next TURN completely, lost in despair and grief
LURE: Unless a single target can beat the Ghost's INT roll, they must spend their next MOVE going where the Ghost beckons. Ghosts often lure the living to terrible fates

When living souls lose their lives in a sudden, frightful, or heinous tragedy, they can become Ghosts. They are anger incarnate, lost and confused in a world of echoes and repetition, unable to escape their own self-torture. The emit a terrible unnatural cold, are truly immaterial, and continue to pick at the living until the wrong is undone.

GERBLIN TRAITORS

♥ ***or 1 HP***
+2 STR, +2 DEX

CRUMMY WEAPON: WEAPON, with equipment no one wants to steal
HOME MADE BOW: WEAPON, cannot shoot beyond NEAR distance... too puny
YELL FOR HELP: A terrified Gerblin will yell for aid. On his next turn, even if dead by then, 1D4 Goblin friends will arrive
FLEE AND HIDE: Run away! Goblings can hide almost anywhere. If they reach a hidey hole, they vanish and recover full HP

These nasty, fiendish, tribal, and semi-sentient rodent-people inhabit all corners of all worlds. They seem to reproduce like mice or rabbits...infesting places where they are left unchecked.

HELLION

♥♥♥♥♥♥

+8 STATS, +6 EFFORT, 3 ACTIONS/TURN

VOLCANIC ROAR: A column of white hot chemical fire in a deafening ULTIMATE ray
BITE: ULTIMATE damage and grappling up to 3 victims
CRUSHING CLAW: ULTIMATE damage NEAR
SPELL EATER: Absorb 1 SPELL from a target. Target loses that SPELL
EYES OF DEATH: Searing stare reduces single target in sight to 0 HP, no roll. A CON roll leaves the victim with 1 HP
Immune to non-MAGIC

When a dragon is truly evil, and loses its life, it is then confined to the nether realms in the form of a Hellion. These creatures burn with eternal rage. Their only weakness is a thirst for ash, their food of choice. Made entirely of fire and hatred.

IMPS

ROLLS VARIABLE/ACTIONS VARIABLE

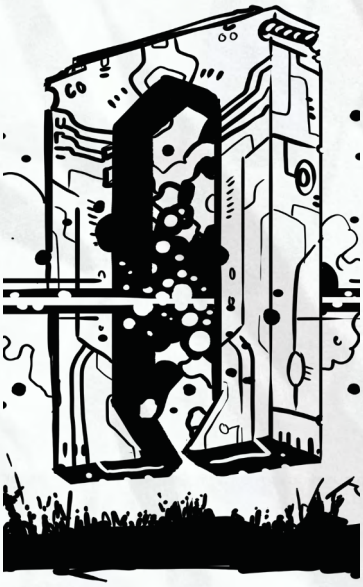
BITE: WEAPON. Bitey
ALL FOR ONE, ONE FOR ALL: Imps act as a group. If biting, they ALL bite
A TIDE OF DEATH: Imps have 1 HP/+1 rolls at Tier 1. When an Imp is slain, it doesn't die... its STATS increase by one TIER, up to 4. When appearing, roll 1D4. Then spawn as indicated: 1: 1D12 Imps appear 2: 2D20 Imps appear 3: 1D100 Imps appear 4: A near infinite number of them flow in, 100 per ROUND.

The rats of the nether have laid waste to entire realms with their wanton chaos. Sometimes the small can be mighty. Mighty annoying.

LEY WALKER

♥♥♥♥♥♥♥♥♥♥♥♥

+10 ALL ROLLS



ENDLESS MARCH: The giant steadily slides forward, scraping, crushing, or leveling anything in its path. It moves NEAR each TURN. If you are caught under it, drop to 0 HP instantly
SCOUR: Anything directly below the Ley Walker is totally annihilated. No structure, material, or living thing can survive
WAYPOINT: Finds a new ley line and travels that way
REGENERATE: Repairs all damage done to it so far

One of the strangest, and most colossal beings in the cosmos, a Ley Walker is a sky-darkening archway or gate made of marble and duranium. They are as old as the stars, and slowly traverse the worlds via ley lines. They sweep entire worlds clean of life as they pass on their mysterious journeys.

MAINFRAME

DOES NOT ROLL, INDESTRUCTIBLE

WAIT: The object becomes inert. It is silent, dormant
GROW: The mainframe casts *Grasp of the Ogdru* at no COST and increases its size by DOUBLE (or can summon 1D8 Tentacles)
REVEAL: All creatures within 1 mile see a vision placed in their minds by the Mainframe
VENT: Vents and apertures open on the cube, and hot air jets out. This also regenerates any damage it has taken
DOORWAY: Cast Doorway, returning to a previous location

Bio-mechanical cubic computers of unknown origin. Their purpose is not known, but they seem to appear in times of calamity or disaster.

MINOTAUR

♥ ♥ ♥

+3 STR, +3 WEAPON EFFORT

BATTLE AXE: WEAPON Damage, a huge, brutal weapon
HEADLONG CHARGE: Move FAR in a straight line at a target. Anything between his origin and his destination is smashed. All enemies must use DEX to evade the charge or take an ULTIMATE impact
CLEAVE: Bracing and spinning its massive axe, The Berserker hits all CLOSE enemies with a Weapon attack

Created by elder magic as a sort of enslaved guardian, these beasts were once human. Now, the rage in their confused minds drives them wild, especially when they see beings that remind them of their former selves. Minotaurs are not evil, but simply enraged, and bound by powerful spells.

OGRE

♥ ♥ ♥ ♥

+8 STR, +4 WEAPON, -3 INT, 2 ACTIONS/TURN

SPIKED CLUB: Weapon Damage with a NEAR reach. Even on a missed Attack, the spiked club inflicts 3 Damage on its target
BODY SLAM: Roll DEX or suffer DOUBLE Weapon Damage / immobilized under the creature
SEISMIC HAMMER: A seismic area attack. All NEAR enemies must make a CON check or be shaken senseless and lose their next turn

Somewhere between Hill-men and Giants are Ogres. They have earned an evil reputation but are as diverse as Goblins. Most are known as clumsy, angry, territorial oafs who terrorize travelers to eat their horses.

OUTSIDER

♥ ♥ ♥

+3 ALL ROLLS, 1 ACTIONS/TURN

GUNS: Materialize a weapon of choice and fire
GAS CLOUD: Emit a FAR cloud of green gas, toxic to all life and machines. Roll CON or take 1D8 damage for 1D4 ROUNDS
MEMBRANE: This SPELL creates an impervious time-space bubble around an object up to 10 feet across. Inside, time is slowed to a crawl
STASIS: Using a jet of gas, paralyze a single NEAR target into a hypersleep state for later study. HARD CON roll to break free
STARGATE: Open a split-second wormhole to almost any location in the universe

A set of glowing eyes materialized in the gas cloud. After this, armored legs and strange hoses were seen. My village folk scattered like rats before that otherworldly sight, I was transfixed.

PHASE HULK

♥ ♥ ♥

+6 STATS, +3 EFFORT, 2 ACTIONS/TURN

PHASE PIERCE: The hulk moves through its target while momentarily de-phasing. This inflicts MAGIC and knocks the victim backward NEAR distance
BITE (MATERIAL): In solid form, this ULTIMATE attack is sprung from behind a target
BITE (PHASE): A phasic bite drains STATS. On a successful hit, drain 1 point of a random STAT
PRISM RAY: A dizzying array of colors. Increase the current TARGET by 1D4 until killed

Coagulating from pure astral ooze, Phase Hulks feed on any living matter. Their behavior is driven by that hunger more so than the will of wizards or taskmasters.

PRIMAL

♥ ♥ ♥ ♥

+4 ALL ROLLS, 2 ACTIONS/TURN

INT SPELLS-ICE MISSILE, DEATH NOVA, LIGHTNING BOLT, DOORWAY: Primals use an ancient form of magic

FORCE BLAST: A ray of concussive energy. This blast has FAR range, ULTIMATE damage

REFLECT: A Primal can REFLECT any SPELL, WEAPON attack, or other incoming energy AT ANY MOMENT with an INT roll

FROZEN TOUCH: With a touch, inflict MAGIC and freeze a target in its tracks for 1 ROUND.

Originally the workers who enacted the will of creation, these ancient beings now dwindle in number. Time has left them behind, but their fierce will to live refuses to sleep. They face an uncertain future, caught between men, ape savages, gods, and devils.

RAZOR POD

♥ ♥ ♥ ♥

+8 STATS, +2 EFFORT, 3 ACTIONS/TURN

STINGING GRAPPLER: WEAPON damage and entangling its victim with STR

CRUSHING JAWS: CLOSE. ULTIMATE damage. If bite inflicts 10+, the victim is engulfed

FLYING NETTLES: A cloud of thorns. Creatures within FAR roll DEX or take WEAPON damage

SPROUT: If near death, the Pod will 'fire' a spore pod. This pod will hit within FAR and spawn a new Razor Pod with 2 HEARTS.

The evil of the Dead Lands has poisoned the plants there, filling them with oily slime and deadly hunger. Rumor has it, the K'Tul fishmen even sacrifice their captives to these horrors.

RINGS

+1 ALL ROLLS PER RING, INDESTRUCTIBLE

CARVE: The Rings form a boring machine. They can carve through 1D100 feet of any solid matter per ROUND
MOVE: The rings break apart and reform at a new location. Their range is DOUBLE FAR
GUARD: A barrier of interlocked circlets. Inside this structure, up to 4 humanoid creatures enjoy +10 ARMOR
HOW MANY RINGS: Formed of 3D12 rings

The most abstract entity in the multiverse is an aggregate thing called Rings. They are made of pure duranium, possibly the first occurrence of that metal. When they mean to do something, they can be very hard to stop. The real question is what they intend and why, which remains a total mystery.

SCARECROW

♥ ♥ ♥
+3 ALL ROLLS

PSYCHIC INSULT: The deepest doubts and darkness are exposed in a victim. A target rolls CHA or loses their next TURN
BEACON: The Scarecrow signals the surrounding area of the heroes' intent
ILL NEWS: Scarecrows delight in delivering news of doom or darkness. They cackle and taunt, warning of impending death

Durathrax the undying has three known forms: a colossal black dragon, an old hag, and these Scarecrow creatures. They act as her eyes and ears, but also as harbingers of her destructive arrival.

SERAPH

♥ ♥ */ARM*

+4 STATS/ARM, 1 ACTION/TURN/ARM

ENERGY CANNON: Each hand opens emitting a ray of ULTIMATE energy

MELT: The Seraph sends a pulse of atomic heat that liquifies metal objects. Targets roll DEX to avoid or lose 1D4 metal LOOT

NOVA: All creatures within FAR are hit with a wave of concussive force. No way to avoid. ULTIMATE damage

KNEEL: The Seraph speaks, usually in 3 or 4 word statements. So ominous is this celestial voice, all those who can hear roll CHA or fall to their knees for 1D4 ROUNDS in pure awe

Light energy emitted from dying stars can sometimes solidify into a living being called a Seraph. They are driven by a divine sense of purpose: to protect the cosmic balance of good and evil at all costs. If on your side, they are mighty allies. If working against you, they are a terror to behold.

SHADOW LASHER

♥ ♥

+5 DEX, +2 ALL OTHERS, 2 ACTIONS/TURN

LASH: WEAPON, NEAR reach

POUNCE: The Lasher leaps onto its prey, pinning it down with STR

BLINK: Move NEAR without passing between locations

VIBRATING TARGETS: Partly in phase, a Shadow Lasher can be difficult to hit. Each ROUND, attacks against it are HARD until it is hit once

Lethal, panther-like pack hunters with the ability to phase between locations. These creatures are natural beasts, but something has given them abilities beyond any fur-clad wolf or tiger of Kath.

SKELETON

♥

+1 ALL ROLLS

STAB: WEAPON, on any critical fail their weapon breaks and they must resort to BASIC attacks

DEATH TOUCH: The Skeleton grasps bare skin, burning it with cold. MAGIC

SLOW AS DEATH: A Skeleton can never move FAR in an action. It clumsily plods along.

The dead are in the employ of haunts and hellions the world over. Devoid of souls, only bone and steel remain. Alone they are fragile and foolish, but in great numbers they can be a terrifying force

SLIME CUBE

♥♥♥

+5 STR, +5 CON

MOVE: The Slime Cube uses its Action to move to a NEAR destination. It will choose a random direction or move toward sound and light

STICKY ACIDIC ABSORPTION: Anything besides stone that touches a Slime Cube becomes stuck to it. In 1D4 ROUNDS, if the object or creature has not escaped, it is absorbed into the Cube's interior

ABSORBED: Once absorbed, creatures and objects take Ultimate Acid Damage for each TURN inside. Regardless of HEARTS, anything trapped inside suffocates in 4 ROUNDS

LOOT WITHIN: Magically protected objects and Chests can survive in the Cube

These denizens of the dark silently slide through their lairs in a timeless, tireless effort to dissolve all debris and blockage. They are driven by evil magic, totally soulless...blobs of material lubricating the deeps with acid death.

SNAKE MEN

♥ ♥ ♥

+4 STATS, +6 MAGIC EFFORT, 2 ACTIONS/TURN

INT SPELL-FIRE MISSILE: A deadly dagger of pure flame, MAGIC
INT SPELL-COUNTERSPELL: The snake men are cunning fighters, seldom fight to the death, and confound their enemies with crippling strategies and anti-powers
WIS Spell-HEALING TOUCH: This will be used to heal itself most often, or those fighting for it
HOWLING HISS: All those who can hear must make a CHA roll or be terrified, using their entire next TURN running away

Serpent men still haunt the deep tombs of Koab and other unholy places, enduring in unlife. They are powerful magicians, horders of magical knowledge, or seething trap-layers with sadistic plans.

SWARM

NO ROLLS, 1 ACTION per TURN per HEART

DETERMINING HEARTS: If swarm the size of a horse, give it 1 HEART; a wagon, 2 HEARTS; a house, 3; and if any bigger, 4 HEARTS
ATTACK: The Swarm descends on its targets, compressing to CLOSE range. Anything within the Swarm takes damage based on the Swarm size. 1-3 HEARTS 1D6, 4+ HEARTS ULTIMATE
BAFFLING CLOUD: Any being within CLOSE range of a Swarm makes HARD rolls
DISPERSE AND REGROUP: A Swarm can spread apart and reform anywhere within FAR range
PROLIFERATE: Add 1 HEART

Whether a cloud of insects or whirl of bats, Swarms can be terribly deadly. Harm only with area effects or attacks.

TENTACLE

♥ ♥

+4 ALL ROLLS

LASH: WEAPON, NEAR reach
GRAPPLE: Without LASHING, the Tentacle wraps itself around a single victim, initiating competing STR rolls. Those overcome are squeezed and must roll CON or be winded, losing their next turn
DRAG DOWN: Grappled victims are pulled into the depths. The Tentacle will waggle and waver for 1D4 ROUNDS before doing so
HURL: If a Tentacle has a victim grappled, and takes any type of damage, it will hurl the victim to a FAR location

Sometimes the pseudopod of a huge Gargoleth, sometimes the conjuration of a mad wizard, these rubbery whips are inhuman, elder things that exist only to kill.

TERROR

♥ ♥ ♥ ♥

+2 STR, +2 DEX

STONE TOOTH: A bite WEAPON
CLOUD OF SPINES: The stone plates behind this creature obey a bio-gravity field. All within FAR roll DEX or be sliced with ULTIMATE effect
DEVOUR MACHINES: The beast is drawn to small, edible machines. On a successful attack, it devours 1 mechanical LOOT
RADIATION: Any creatures NEAR them must roll CON on their TURN or absorb 1D12 radiation damage

A race of stone-fleshed abominations who prowl the vaccuums of desolate moons. They are made of ice-cold igneous rock, and ravenous for the heat energy in living things. Fire and warm machines especially lure them.

TREE OF DEATH

♥ ♥ ♥ ♥ ♥

NO ROLLS, 2 ACTIONS/TURN

CLOUD OF SEEDS: Anything within FAR range must roll 1D4. In that many ROUNDS, they will breathe seeds and take 5 Poison damage every TURN thereafter

ROOT CORPSE: The tree pushes animated corpses up with its roots. These attack anything nearby as 1 HEART monsters. 1D4 spawn at a time

BLIGHT: If agitated, the tree will issue forth bursts of subsurface poison. This poison will taint water and soil for 1 mile in any direction for 1D4 years

In places where tragedy has saturated the land, from this scar grows the Tree of Death. This inert totem of evil blights the land and stands as a symbol of unresolved torment. Whenever found, they must be destroyed, and every root burned to ash.

WHAT WERE ONCE MEN

♥ ♥

+2 ALL ROLLS

LASH: A ragged set of webbed claws where hands once were. A WEAPON wound inflicted with this attack will itch and burn

DROWN: Gods, the way they drag you below the water! Disappear in the murk, taking WEAPON DAMAGE each ROUND below. Make a CON roll to hold your breath and negate the damage, or make a STR roll to break free. If taking drowning damage twice, be stunned for 1 ROUND

The devotees of Ogdru bathe in muck below the world and slowly turn to big-eyed freaks. They become one with the black water and kill to feed their hideous master the bodies of the innocent.

ALL THE OTHER MONSTERS

No amount of monster listings can cover the real task at hand for a GM: creating custom monsters for unique situations and original ideas. The monsters listed above, in time, will mainly function as idea fuel, not at-table play word by word. When you're getting ready to create your own specific baddies for your next session, that's the real deal.

In the excitement of a table session, simplicity is king. Even the most elegant monsters are boiled down to their essentials when the dice start rolling. Rather than fight this inevitability, **ICRPG** embraces it and offers the tier system on the opposite page to create and execute your next monster in play.

That said, the tiers only give you baseline statistics. There are countless other nuances, ideas, notes and details to make your monsters interesting. Consider 3 key words for every monster, then use tiers and the roll tables below as needed.

Power Word: Choose a key word that you will remember for a new monster. Make it impactful like 'brutal,' 'gigantic,' or 'bloodthirsty.' Improv as needed from this all-important descriptor.

Personality: It may be 'mindless' or 'ingenius' or 'devious' or 'imperial.' This gives you a memorable hint for role-playing the enemy, even if other details slip.

Wants: What does this nasty bugger even want? Answer this, and you'll never be confused what it will do on its next turn.

TIER I MONSTERS

Most encounters, at any level, should include mooks, minions, wimps and chumps. These are easy kills, but in numbers can be dangerous.

- +2 STAT rolls
- No EFFORT bonuses
- 1 action per turn
- 1 HEART
- Super mook: Only 1 HP, no STAT bonuses

TIER II MONSTERS

Mooks die by the dozen, but bonafide enemies mixing it up and shocking players with sudden power. More HEARTS isn't the trick, it's more killing power.

- +4 STAT rolls
- No EFFORT bonuses
- 1 action per turn
- 2 HEARTS
- One interesting piece of gear or unique attack ability

TIER III MONSTERS

At Tier III you have the sub-boss or 'wimp gate' monster who really tests the heroes' ability to think creatively, not just attack until they win.

- +6 STAT rolls
- +2 all EFFORT
- 2 actions per turn
- 4 HEARTS and/or damage immunity
- At least 1 special ability such as area blast, HP drain or insta-kill without roll

TIER IV MONSTERS

At the highest tier you have your supreme enemy. You might even say that HEARTS don't matter here (like with a vampire or dragon). Even if defeated, Tier IV monsters seldom actually die. They are merely delayed.

- +8 STAT rolls
- +4 all EFFORT
- 3 actions per turn
- 4 HEARTS, damage immunity and self-healing action
- At least 1 special ability such as area blast, escape-and-heal, summon extra monsters, destroy gear or change environment/target/timer

MONSTER MAKER: GET STARTED

It's time to create your own fiendish beasts! Once you have a visual, maybe a name that fits your next adventure, put some thought into these aspects.

The only way to master monster variety is to jump in and try things! Not every monster can be a silly old Gerblin, so go crazy! The best part about making monsters is BENDING THE RULES. This aspect is what makes creatures really dangerous, not just lots of HEARTS and high STATS. Here are several suggestions for abilities you can assign to your monsters.

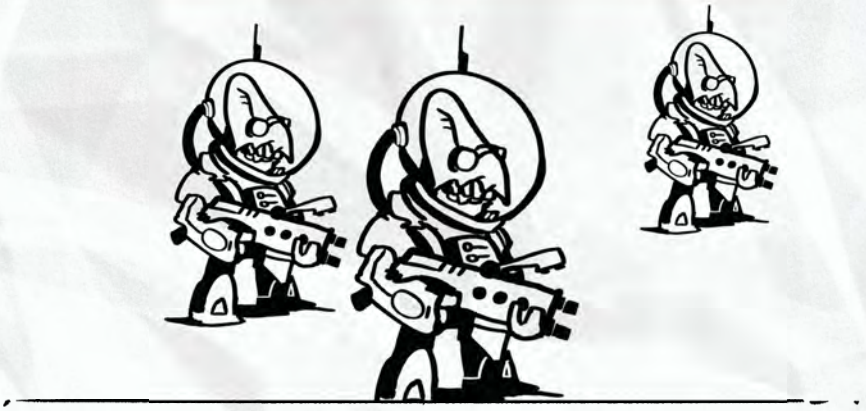
TRAP THEM: The monster can grapple, immobilize, grab or incapacitate its foes. Usually countered with opposing STR rolls.

REPEL THEM: Use magic or muscle to shove enemies away. This ability can be especially deadly if combined with a ranged barrage.

HIT ALL TARGETS: Monsters that attack whole areas are brutal! Unleash it with an attack roll, or force players to roll for avoidance.

DESTROY GEAR: Wait, what? Give a monster the ability to destroy equipment, and players will turn pale with fear. This effect is usually explained with corrosion, acid, or crushing jaws.

VANISH/REAPPEAR: When players pin a monster down, it has little chance. Give one the ability to move without moving, and suddenly, the tables are turned.



FORCE THEM TO MOVE: Tank and spank monster fights can be very dull. Use jumping, flying, or must-flee effects like fire pits to keep battles moving.

NEGATE THEIR ATTACKS: Any monster Action that costs players a turn is very powerful, but can be disheartening, so be judicious with such abilities.

BOLSTER DEFENSES: If a monster is just 'in the way,' then making it resilient can be fun. Use a turn to double your HEARTS, or make attacks against it HARD.

PARALYZE: Paralyzed heroes aren't totally useless, but they can be vulnerable. Use stinging barbs, poison, and the like, but always allow a CON check to break free.

LOTS OF ACTIONS: Giving a monster 2, 3, or more Actions will give it a boss-like quality. Be sure to have the variety to back it up.

DESTROY TERRAIN: If a foe smashes a doorway, it can have more gravity than killing a hero! Use this destructive power to scare or confine the heroes.

BEHAVE IN CYCLES: When monsters do the same 1-2-3 action combos, players can learn their pattern and exploit it. That is a great fight.

REGENERATE: Either automatically or by an Action, the monster can regain a HEART or a few HP, critical for climax monsters.

BANISH FOES: With a spell, a monster can send an enemy to a mini dimension. There, the hero needs to do some form of EFFORT to return to the fight.

CONTROL THEM: There's nothing worse than players killing players. A monster with mind control powers turns them against one another.

FRIGHTEN THEM: Monsters are scary, but some are so scary, you just have to flee! Control the power by limiting how long the fear lasts (1 TURN, 1D4 ROUNDS etc).

STEAL THEIR GEAR: Destroying gear is hardcore. This version uses a roll to swipe stuff, maybe use it, or maybe stash it. Then it can be retrieved after combat and hugged.

HAVE ONLY 1 WEAKNESS: A single weakness is not only great for making a fight perilous, but also fun for those players who track details about monsters. It makes all their work worth it, and they are considered 'monster experts.'

MOVE TWICE: Doubling the normal move rules can make your new monster very formidable, as players will waste time chasing rather than killing.

CREATE TERRAIN: Creating barriers or high pinnacles can disrupt a battle or make the target hard to reach. It is also really cool.

POISON: Like fire, this kind of damage can keep hurting over time. For some monsters, even with a simple visual, poison feels like a perfect fit.

GO ENRAGED: At a certain threshold, maybe extremely low HP or having its eggs destroyed, enrage your monster. In this state it always does ULTIMATE or has higher STATS. Flee!

IMMUNE TO: Yetis don't mind the cold. Be sure to make immunities sensible so players aren't baffled why their sword doesn't work.

MULTIPLY: Any time a monster becomes 2, things get hairy. You can multiply by dividing it like a starfish or by spawning from a nearby source. When players figure out how to stop this process, the tide will turn in their favor.

AN UNLIKELY FOE: Finally, consider making monsters that aren't monsters. All kinds of weird objects, terrain, people, or magical entities can be foes to battle. Here's a Brain in a Jar. As practice, try making a super powered monster from this oddball. What can it do? How is it dangerous? Why must it be defeated? As you answer questions, it takes form!

MONSTER TABLES

To randomly select monsters, their tactics, abilities and oddities, turn to the TABLES section at the end of this book!

DURATHRAX: MOTHER OF ALL EVILS

Before snake men built the black pyramids, or the moon Iron Heart was shattered by the haunted meteor, in the primordial chaos of Alfheim's youth, dragons reigned. Of this winged multitude one was supreme: Durathrax, the daughter of Hydranax. She was a cruel, cannibalistic, lawless titan even in her youth. Her bloody fangs ended the age of dragons, for she would abide no competitors for her supremacy. Ever has her hatred and sadism plagued the multiverse, and ever have heroes risen to slow her plans.

You've always dreamed of running a colossal dragon in your game, and this is the unique, merciless, devious world-ender to finally make it happen. Take your time with her... savor it.

THE NEXT CHAPTER...

1: Weary of Alfheim, she flies to Iron Heart to terrorize and dominate
2: Injured and near death she is nesting in her lair
3: Once every 1,000 years she lays eggs. None have ever hatched, until now
4: Starving for a feast, she burns a major city to ashes
5: A cult of dragon-worshippers have built a cloud-city for her
6: Durathrax explores Xenos for artifacts and knowledge
7: Using a prismatic crystal, she has cloned herself into the dimensions
8: She has discovered a gateway to Ghost Mountain
9: Another dragon has appeared in Alfheim. She will stop at nothing to kill it
10: Delving dwarves have awakened her year-long slumber
11: A child is born, foretold as Durathrax's undoing
12: Durathrax has 'inhabited' one of the heroes in your group in spirit form

THE ASHLANDS

In her younger years, the World-Eater dwelled in the Woodrealm, where she would later roost as an ancient demigod. In this epoch, she was consumed by endless hunger as she grew to titanic size. A vast swath of the ageless forests were set ablaze by her rampages, and she would feed on charred flesh and mountains of smoldering ashes. At the center of this inferno she made her lair, a maze of barren rocky crags and boulders.

BROOD

The hunger of Durathrax was not just to build her great bulk, but to lay and foster her brood of glass eggs. These eggs can take centuries to hatch, and so she lurked and seethed among them, killing any who violated her borders. A living dragon egg is one of the rarest treasures in the cosmos, so her victims were never in short supply. The gear and treasures of those adventurers only add to her immense hoard of gold and jewels.

GOBLINS, KOBOLDS, AND DRAKES

The Ashlands have a concentric shape in three huge areas. The outer territory is a forest fire of charred pines and barren fields. Here tribes of orcs scurry to and fro, sacrificing the innocent on chained posts and gathering corpses in carts to feed the drakes. The middle ring is a walled realm of fortifications, built by a society of kobolds, who worship Durathrax as their god. They are priests and cultists in shriveled draconic form, dizzy with rapture for their evil overlord. Finally, the inner lair is a jagged maze of rocky spires and hidden chambers. This terrain is home only to drakes and Durathrax herself, as no land-walker or normal beast can survive there.

DISCOVERIES IN THE ASHLANDS

1: A wood post. 1D6 innocents are chained to it, awaiting the hungry Drakes
2: A flight of Drakes are terrorizing their Gerblin supplicators for sport
3: Orc grovellers have piled a cart with corpses as an offering to Durathrax
4: An injured Drake is going mad in the ash fields, unleashing hell as it dies
5: A team of Gerblins bumble their way through repairing a damaged wall
6: Kobold sorcerers gather ‘round a glyph, offering power to their master
7: A huge gate illuminates the gloom. It is engulfed with 30 foot high flames
8: A magma river serves as a moat. It is a flow of melted swords
9: A huge smoke cloud rolls over the landscape, turning all to poison
10: Durathrax swoops and glides in the clouds far overhead, watching
11: A collection of glass eggs sits in a clutter of glowing red stones, unattended
12: A Kobold, wide-eyed and insane, dashes along with an egg in its arms

THE BLACK OCEAN

In the apex of her physical strength, Durathrax was called 'The Scarecrow.' For a span of centuries, she made her lair beneath the surface of Alfheim in the dizzy caverns of the Black Ocean, an underground sea... a time between broods of eggs, so she laid low and built her power with malevolence. She is so seldom seen in this era, many believed she had perished or left for other dimensions. Her most common form in this time was that of a deformed or shadowy scarecrow, which served as eyes and ears on the affairs of mortals.

PINNACLES

The island where she dwells is known as 'The Pinnacles.' It is comprised of towering, narrow needles of basalt. Atop these deadly heights she wheels and folds her wings, illuminated only by the glow of mushrooms. Darkness and silence are her weapons here, and rivers of skeletons fill the gaps between the stony spires.

WOODREALM

When Woodrealm was ruled by Zotar, the Hidden King, Durathrax's access to the astral gateway there was suddenly threatened. For this reason, she vowed to destroy Zotar, and returned to her old brooding grounds. By this time, though, she was millennia old, and coursing with infinite magical power. She reclaimed The Ashlands, but remained hidden in the endless green tangles, biding her time to destroy her new nemesis.

WAR FOR THE FORESTS

Three great armies fight for control of Woodrealm: the elves loyal to Zotar, Durathrax's draconic warriors, and the forest-born giant savages called Creeg. They are separated by massive walls, and only secret networks of tunnels can be used to navigate the once-unified tangles of tree and vine.

FIGHTING DURATHRAX

Now that you're a master of **ICRPG** monsters, you can create all your own stats and abilities for Durathrax in the event of a deadly conflict. Durathrax is no ordinary monster, though... she is capable of destroying entire locations, changing timelines or eating heroes in one bite. Consider these 12 special tactics if and when she is confronted.

1: FIREBREATHER	Total destruction. This ENDS A SCENE ENTIRELY
2:TAKE WING	She flies up, returns after 1 ROUND, healed fully
3: CRUSH TERRAIN	Crumble crags, shatter ledges, or topple old ruins
4: TALONS	She grabs 1D4 heroes, flings them to their death
5: SPELL NOVA	Durathrax casts any 4 SPELLS at no COST and no roll
6: MELT	Breath weapon of corrosion, destroys all metal
7: SPEAK	If below 2 HEARTS, she deceives mortals with parley
8: TAIL DRAG	Her tail is as big as a town, scrapes the ground clean
9: FRENZY	Durathrax takes 5 actions per TURN once frenzied
10: LURE	Roll HARD CHA or be dazed, walking toward her
11: ROAR	The sound is deafening. Run for your life!
12: BLOOD FEAST	Roll a natural 20 or are eaten if she hates YOU

A WORLD IS SIMPLY A FIRST PAGE

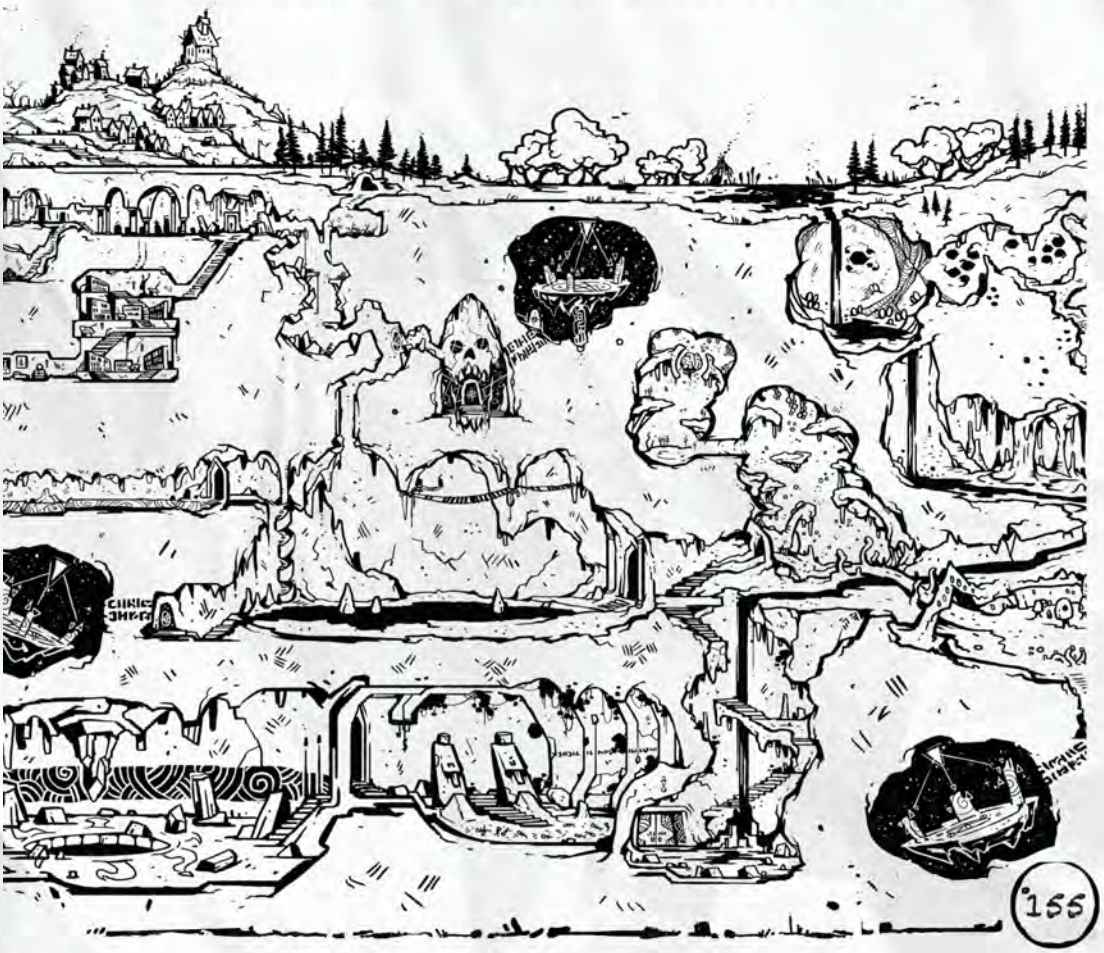
IT IS THE PAPER ON WHICH WE TELL OUR TALES

LIKE PAPER, IT IS ABOUT TEXTURE OVER DETAIL

THE BIG FIVE

ICRPG has several settings in its multiverse.

- **ALFHEIM:** A continent of kingdoms and conflicts millennia old, all tied together in some way by the evil of an ageless dragon called Durathrax. The king has gone missing, powers are shifting, and your friends are caught in the middle.
- **WARP SHELL:** The cosmos hangs in the balance as our heroes get the ride of their lives on a sentient, space-folding starship with an unerring taste for danger, and a talent for saving the universe.
- **GHOST MOUNTAIN:** Between heaven and hell, the people of Ghost Mountain fight to save their souls, one bullet at a time. Will the devil get his due?
- **BLOOD AND SNOW:** Long before the age of technology, a frozen planet holds a primal secret. Tribal folk struggle to understand... and survive.
- **VIGILANTE CITY:** After the mutant crisis, superhumans begin appearing all over this embattled city. It becomes unclear who the good guys really are...that is, until you and your team arrive to clean up the streets.



ALFHEIM

ALFHEIM: THE AGE OF KINGDOMS

ALFHEIM is a place of many threads and stories, but no single theme tying them together. It isn't 'dark' or 'high' or 'low' fantasy, but a complex fabric of flavors. We all have our own fantasy worlds, ALFHEIM gives you a tapestry to build upon. From massive cliffs, castle-crowned mountains, and towering monoliths to the shadowed tunnels of Ardenmoor, the ruins of Iridess, or the fabled mines of Duros...these are all the elements available to build your next fantasy WORLD bigger and better than ever.

The sandbox style of the following stories will let your players explore freely. Using your knowledge of distance, terrain, monsters, and player SUPPLIES, you can dare the elusive and awesome, sandbox game many players crave.

Not every detail is shown on the ALFHEIM map! For one thing, knowledge of the world is not total in the Age of Kingdoms, and for another, the blank spaces and unmapped dungeons are for you and your players to discover!

Finally, the island of Crask, in the far northeast, is *yours* to imagine. There is no entry given here.

ENGINES OF THE AGE

These 6 facts are known across all the realms of Alfheim, but as GM you know far deeper secrets...

KING HENRYK IS MISSING

Players know Henryk is missing, but only you, the GM, know his fate. Invent your own whole truth here, and begin dropping clues as to his whereabouts. If he's dead, vengence must be undertaken. If he yet lives, our heroes have a chance to save the realm, but at what cost?

IRADRUM HAS BEEN DESTROYED

Players know that Iradrum has been decimated by Durathrax, but they don't know that this was only an opening excavation. The eater of worlds is tunneling to Urth's core to feed on raw planetary power. Can she be stopped?

GERBLINS HAVE JOINED MANKIND

Despite the turn in Gerblin moral codes and ideals, a growing rebellion has formed: Gerblins who call for chaos. These hateful buggers are in far greater numbers than expected, and our heroes will be needed to quell their destructive civil war.

SNOW ORCS HAVE ORGANIZED

Players know that Snow Orcs are on the rise. What they don't know is that the orcs are getting their newfound power from an archdemon called Idimmu. Until the demon is defeated, nothing will stop the tide of orcs about to sweep over the northlands.

ELVES HAVE TAKEN SKAR

If players undertake a war on tyrannical Skar, they will face an extraterrestrial enemy. The starfarers have returned to Urth, using the elves as pawns in some huge game of planetary conquest.

TORTON REFUGEES HAVE ARRIVED

Despite their hope for peace, the Tortons have been pursued by Imperium Ghost Armors who refuse to stop hunting them. If players ally with Tortons in numbers, they will face these technological terrors, and the ships they arrive in. Could this be the way Urth enters the cosmic community?

IRE, DOMAIN OF THE PRIMALS

LAY OF THE LAND

- Frigid: Rocky highlands swept with snow. Stranded travelers can freeze to death on cold nights.
- Hazardous: Spend 2 SUPPLIES per day traveling.
- No Roads: Much of Ire is impassable without a guide. If traveling without a guide, add 1D12 days to your journey.
- Storms: On a failed travel, scouting or nature roll, storms destroy equipment, expends remaining supplies, or blocks travel completely.

DANGERS TO DARE

- The Primals: Somewhere in the northern snows, these 10 foot tall beings rule. They are the dread enemy of the lowly ape-men, who hate and fear them. They abide *no* intruders.
- Giant Beasts: A secret sect of chaotic druid-folk have been imbuing bears, wolves, and elk with power and size. These beasts attack at random, set to destroy all civilized folk.
- Coal Demon Slavers: Wandering out from Solstice Depths, these infernals seek slaves to delve their warrens below the mountain.
- Ice Wind: During an encounter here, the wind adds 1D4 to all TARGETS.

DETAILS TO DISCOVER

- A frozen traveler, coated in ice, clutches the sky at a roadside. He wears a strange amulet, untouched by cold
- Cracking fissures in the frost revealing a catacomb below, leading west
- Snow-dusted aftermath of a battle. Primals, ape-men and even dwarves all lay silent, but one survivor stirs
- A wagon full of gar merchants heading to The Warden. They are lost, afraid, freezing, and hunted
- A dwarven village burned to the ground, now frosted over
- Iron-hinged crate of Koabi scimitars lying in a mess of broken arrows and blood spatter
- Bluish ice cliffs shine in the sunlight, revealing tunnel entrances and spy-holes with ape-men guards
- A group of druids, barely alive and frightened at Pine Henge
- A charred handprint on The Warden sickens the ageless tree as rumors spread of an infernal presence
- Burning skulls on pikes flanking a dwarven roadway towards Solstice Peak

FOLK AND FRIENDSHIP

- Sval of White Bluff: Orc chief of all Ire, whose rule is contested by warring tribes
- Pietro Pete: Legendary dwarvish trapper who guides travelers through the northern reaches
- Asra Cloudbow: Matriarch of the druid-folk who seeks help
- Strom: A Primal who believes his people are wrongly warring with Ire seeks to end the demon invasion
- Helen Asram: Dutchess of Port Snow, who seeks aid to drive out the Koabi pirates

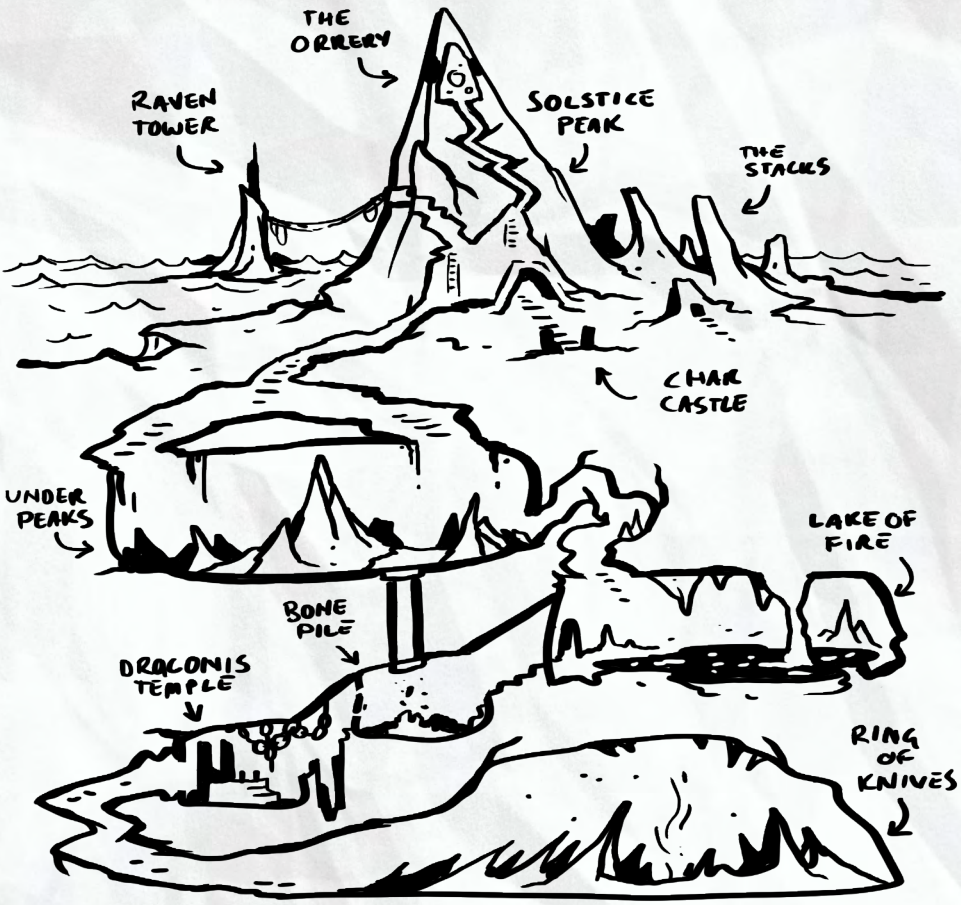
DUNGEONS TO DELVE

- Pine Henge: Deep below the henge, a dimension door has grown out of control, and the caverns are filling with strange lifeforms and evil. If the gateway is not closed, or brought to heel, it could shatter the powerful magic that holds Ire safe from the Primal invasion.
- Solstice Depths: Coal Demons have now overrun the once prosperous dwarven city of Solstice Peak (see next page).

MORE ABOUT THE WARDEN

- The Warden is Ire's central town, but also home to an ancient tree, which emanates a powerful life force. Once, the Wardens dotted Alfheim. It is now said this is the last of these colossal trees, and in its heart rests the very lifeblood of Urth itself. Druids are prone to exaggerate such things, though.
- As the 'last stop' before the wilds, Warden is rich with smiths, outfitters, and even magical suppliers for expeditions and border fighters.
- One thing is certain to all in Ire: if The Warden were to fall to dark forces, the fate of the North would soon follow, and all hope of taming this wilderness would be lost.

ALFHEIM



MORE ABOUT THE SOLSTICE PEAK DEPTHS

- The Orrery: After the destruction of Iradrum, Durathrax uses this pinnacle to house her next brood.
- Raven Tower: A dizzy lookout hosting a seldom used tower.
- Solstice Peak: A dwarf-carved mountain castle within the icy slopes.
- The Stacks: Enormous exhaust vents for the furnace below, always smoking.
- Char Castle: Newly built demon siege towers.
- Under Peaks: A small set of mountains within a huge chamber.
- Lake of Fire: A chemical lake boiled for ages by the magma chambers below.
- Bone Pile: Where deep delvers pile their victims.
- Draconis Temple: Massive columns and courtyards from an ageless dragon cult. Now inhabited only by the long-dead.
- Ring of Knives: An igneous rock formation and magma tube... an access point to the inner Urth, and home to fire dragons of legend.

IRADRUM, RUBBLE AND RUIN

LAY OF THE LAND

- Destroyed: Durathrax's fury was unleashed by hapless adventurers in recent months, and all her vengence landed here. Iradrum is rubble.
- Broken: Spend 5 SUPPLY per day, and travel half normal pace (up to 5 miles per day).
- Dragonlings: As Durathrax brings ashes and fire, so her suiters and worshippers gather. Expect to encounter draconic foes here with unusual frequency.
- Rally Call: Dwarves met here are gathering into squadrons to find and destroy Durathrax and her sanctums in the broken mountain. They will recruit anyone they meet if possible.
- Hope: Despite all this destruction, Dwarves are still known to revel, to gather at great fires for mutton and gar, or tell old tales to bolster hearts. This is far from over.

DANGERS TO DARE

- The Iron Outcasts: Among the Iradrum, there is a legion of metal-clad dwarf warriors who refuse human rule in their land. For this, they are banished, and wander as fugitives, attacking any non-dwarves in Iradrum when possible. They are ruthless and evil, despite their appeal to some dwarven purists.
- Skeleton Army: Witchwood was once its own sovereign barony, before the rise of Norburg. It is unknown what doom befell that sunken land, but now an endless trickle of skeleton warriors stumble from the dead trees, and prey on all they encounter.

DETAILS TO DISCOVER

- A cask of fresh gar fallen from a wagon. Best stuff in Alfheim!
- The symbol of the Iron Outcasts, a red chevron, painted on an old wagon.
- A troupe of bards on their way to Norburg, celebrating a newly crowned hero.
- A strange, heavy iron key in the motifs of the Iradrum deep-miners.
- A wyvern's claw-nail, broken clean off and caked in blood.
- Disoriented slaves wandering south from Witchwood, unable to speak.
- An Iradrum forgemaster in a weapon cart, whose shop has been leveled.
- Ambushers from the Ogdru cult, camouflaged in a thicket outside a village.
- A company of lancers traveling the countryside in search of army conscripts.

FOLK AND FRIENDSHIP

- Three Hero Kings: Norburg is ruled by three heroes of great deed. They are true good, and willing to help or reward all adventurers who rid their land of evil influence or foreign claim.
- Hatch's Heroes: Hatch is an Iradrum dwarf, born in West Kinder, who refuses to accept the expansion of Witchwood. He is always looking for able bodied warriors who will aid his cause.
- Cap'n Gettz: One of the most decorated pirates and captains of the Emerald Sea.
- The Lightning King: High ruler of Iradrum Spire.
- Gibbles: A Thushum goblin armor trader and weapons expert who travels the Iradrum roads.

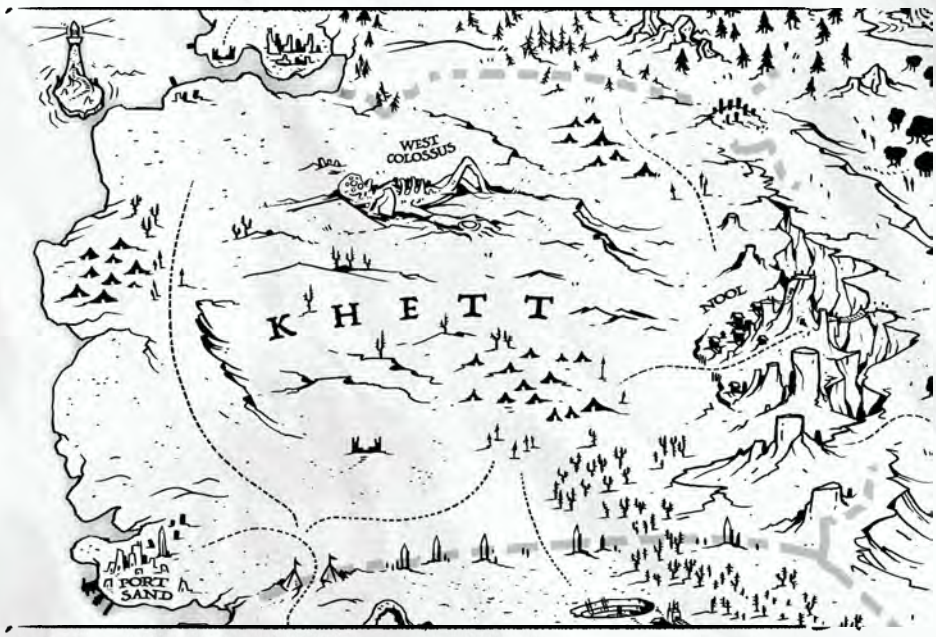
DUNGEONS TO DELVE

- Blackwave: The Island Southwest of Norburg was once a garrison of Crask. Shelled into oblivion by Norburg siege engines, it is now a broken ruin. Still, something stirs in the rubble...
- Kinder Mines: A volcanic heart feeds the Dwarven fires below Iradrum. These fires have also carved a maze of lava tubes and magma chambers, occupied by all those terrors that dwell below.
- Witchwood Lake: As the dark power grows in Witchwood, so does the stick-barrow at the center of this mucky pond.

KHETT, DESERT OF BONES

LAY OF THE LAND

- High Desert: Barren plateaus and wind-scoured hardpan. Distance can be the enemy here.
- Deadly: Spend 3 SUPPLIES per day traveling.
- Nomadic Folk: Settlements here move with the seasons. Only local guides will know the exact locations of the three main camps of the Khettish.
- Volatile Wind: When acting up, the gales here can add 2 to TARGETS, and even demand DEX or STR rolls to resists their terrible force.



DANGERS TO DARE

- Nomadic Brigands: The Khetts are without mercy for travelers, but even worse are the lowly thieves who wander the steppes in search of victims. For each day spent here, roll nature, scouting or navigation TWICE to avoid their raiding parties.
- Bone Constructs: Since the Colossus fell here, strange versions of men and monsters have been forming or animating from dusty old bones. How can you kill what has never lived?
- Crystal Skitters: The crystal mines of Nool have delved deep indeed, and there opened a hatching chamber of crystal insectoids that threaten the eastern borders, growing in number down in the depths.

ALFHEIM

DETAILS TO DISCOVER

- A group of armored skeletons, buried to the waist, slowly beginning to move again
- A lone horse, equipped for lance or spear cavalry, wanders the waste
- The remnants of a tent camp, abandoned. In one hut an old woman has been left to die
- An odd group of small folk travelers taking shelter in a stand of giant cacti
- Slow-moving Stone Flimes migrating north
- A floating sky barge, with room for 5 crew, tethered to a tall stone pinnacle. The hull is peppered with arrows
- A freshly opened fissure leading down to red-glowing depths
- The skull-heaped lair of a Sand Dragon
- A hermit waves with a smile from a red tent on a bluff. A closer look reveals he is a wooden clockwork

FOLK AND FRIENDSHIP

- Shirash the Knife: Not exactly a friend, the ruler of the Khett is not officially recognized as king. Nevertheless, he lives by a code that is the closest thing to law here.
- Jadzaro Bunini, Genius: This half-mad engineer and philosopher wanders the steppes, creating wonders of science such as sky ships, walking wagons, and digging machines.
- The Daughters of Rel: A tribe of orc women who fight Khetts with guerrilla tactics, all in honor of Mud's great grand daughter.
- Ferrin's Folk: The canyonkeepers of Nool can be hard-nosed, but one family still holds the old hospitality. They are magi who work to stop the return of the snake-men to Alfheim.

DUNGEONS TO DELVE

- West Colossus: This massive creature is now a hollow husk, but its power pervades the landscape around it and *below* it. There is an entrance at the head, but the Khetts guard this place, claiming the treasures below as their own.
- The Canyon Abyss: At the dark floor of the eastern canyonlands, a bounty of YOG crystals grows. With them, comes Skitters and other creatures far older. The folk of Nool work to mine this area, but seldom return.
- Ruin of Beetle Meer: The castle northeast of Port Sand has been reclaimed by the desert, but travelers have spotted great green-shelled beetles there, as in the legends, and a ghostly glow by moonlight.

KATH, THE TOMB OF SNAKES

LAY OF THE LAND

- Dune Sea: Expend 4 SUPPLIES per day to travel here, mainly carrying water.
- Sweltering Jungle: The southeast is dense with jungle, and easier to traverse with 1 SUPPLY per day.
- Uninhabited: Few ever go here, fearing snake-men from ancient times. The largest settlements of people are the excavation camp along the northern border and the tiny, accursed village of Hal.
- Die of Thirst: If travelers become lost for more than 4 days, they have a 50% chance of meeting their end.

DANGERS TO DARE

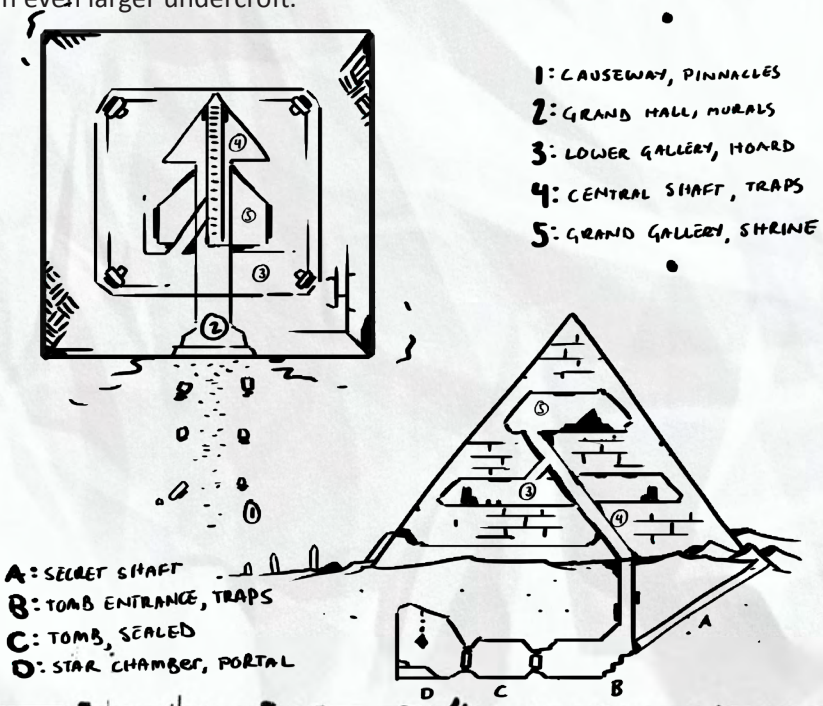
- The Undead: The snake-men used the dead as legions, and many remain. Mummified priests, skull-faced warriors and shamblers in the sand
- Serpent-Folk: The rumors are true: snake-men have been seen walking the dunes, weaving black magic and working to awaken their terrible gods
- Agnar and Agnar Riders: The primal 'mega-mouth' can be lurking anywhere
- Devious Traps: In their time, the serpents used many complex mechanical terrors to guard their tombs and unholy places. Many of these are still armed and just as deadly as a thousand years ago. Sometimes even the open desert hides buried death just waiting to be triggered

FOLK AND FRIENDSHIP

- Verkin Ferinale: Master Archaeologist, or so he claims, running the excavation camp. With the aid of a sky galleon, and a small crew of dwarves, he has established a relic trade in Kath
- Liette of Hal: A hero who refuses to abandon her dying town
- The Grey Road Cavalry: The northeast border is held by Grey Guardsmen. They are always willing to help those in need, but will only venture a day's travel into the dunes

DUNGEONS TO DELVE

- South Colossus: A coil of stone vertebrae twists through the jungle, capped by a pyramidal 'head' near the Dead Lands gate. If it has been explored, no one has any written account of what lies within.
- Dead Iridess: The town that ran with blood when Aras the Red Fang awoke his dead queen so long ago. Now it is a haunted city, and the dead queen's chamber of power still fills this place with dread.
- Tomb of Sett: At the south extreme is a weird island, hewn square in raw bedrock, and covered in glyphic warnings and sigils of confinement. This is believed to be the sleeping place of Sett, the serpent God. The nearby pyramid served as a place of worship in elder days.
- Pyramids of Koab: Once a mighty city of snake-men, this is now being reclaimed by the dunes. There are no less than twenty giant pyramids, concealing an even larger undercroft.



NORDHEIM, THE ENDLESS WOODS

LAY OF THE LAND

- Vast Forests: Endless pine forests in low hills and rocky plains make this a maze to navigate.
- Remote: Only use 1 SUPPLY per day traveled, but travel rolls are HARD.
- Shipping: Travel anywhere on the Nordheim Coast in 1-3 days. Ports and moorage are plentiful.
- Patrolled Roads: There are a half dozen roads in Nordheim, patrolled either by Nordish knights from Shipshelm, or the Grey Border Guard. The roads are kept safe year round, at any cost.

DANGERS TO DARE

- Snow Orcs: The South of Nordheim, near the Khettish border, is home to a tribe of predatory orcs. They run rampant on those who defy their borders, and use the Broken Rocks range as their fortress.
- Thushum Outcasts: Those goblin kin who are too vile, or too evil-willed to endure in Thushum often take refuge here in the woods. They form small bands, and work their deadly mischief with woodcraft machines and deep woods ambushes. Their clans are Groat, Pineblood, Thumush and Big Tooth in name.
- Escaped Pit Fighters: The fighting pits at Arlston crossroads represent the dark and violent hertiage of this rugged land. Either by amnesty or escape, the death dealers from the pits find their way into the countryside. Some are noble-hearted. Many are not.

ALFHEIM

DETAILS TO DISCOVER

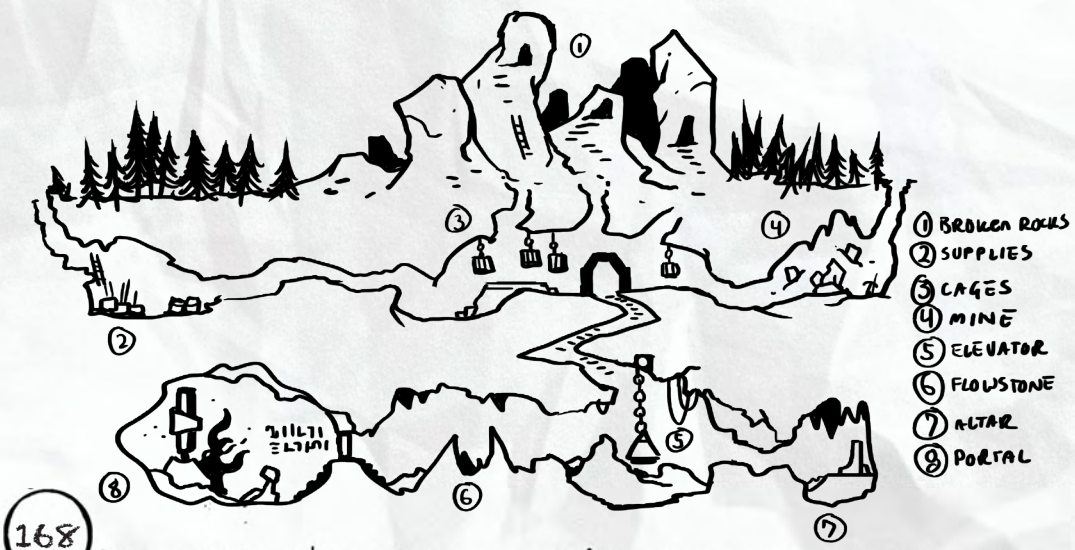
- An abandoned logging camp, riddled with snow orc arrows
- A strange talisman made of sticks and bone, left as a warning of some kind
- An escaped gladiator from Arlston, camping. With him is a small boy
- Branches and mud piled into a hut, the smell of roast flesh on the breeze
- An old dock moorage with a derelict ship roped and left unmanned
- A massive clawed footprint, 30 feet across, and smashed trees in rows

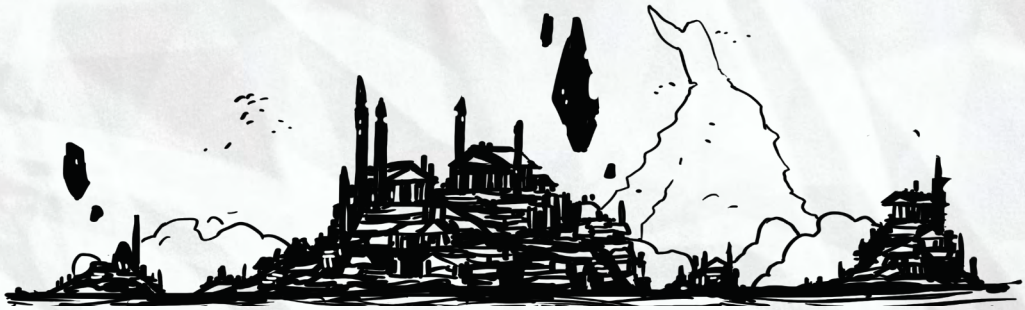
FOLK AND FRIENDSHIP

- Hankerin Ferinale: Ambassador to the Iradrum in Gilhelm, honorary mayor, and Brewmaster of the Frothy Mare tavern. Hankerin will commission mining expeditions to the Broken Rocks and beyond.
- Crumb: One of the heroic dwarves who fought back the 'Titan of Shipshelm,' this stout fellow is now in the duke's employ as a road guardian. He lives a quiet life escorting travelers and leaning on old pines.
- Oracle of the Banners: The ruins on the west point of Nordheim are occupied by an ancient being. Folk say she can see the past and the future.

DUNGEONS TO DELVE

- Depths of the Dark Brotherhood: Below the old manor of Duke Herald, the governor of New Haven, is a vast catacomb of burial chambers and demonic tunnels.
- Ruins of Light Port: Just south of the Oracle of Banners is a now-destroyed port town. Some say the Titan destroyed it, or wild seas of old. The mystery remains unsolved, as those who venture there do not return.
- Broken Rock Tunnels: The snow orcs have occupied these crags for centuries, gaining power and fortune by the rich iron deposits there.





APHOS, REFUGE OF THE ELVES

LAY OF THE LAND

- Shrouded Isles: Navigating any ship to Aphos makes all rolls HARD
- A Weird Calm: Despite being so far north, it is sunny, warm, and pleasant around the Aphosian islands
- The Grey Veil: Aphos is guarded by an endless, impenetrable fog of magical mist. Many dead ships drift here, voices hang on the ghostly wind. Some even say time itself can become warped, or tangled, in the fogs
- Limestone Crags: White stone built these islands, and it is common to have dizzying drop-offs and ruin-topped pinnacles here
- Ancient Wealth: Ancient are the elves of Aphos. Their architecture stands as a testament to the millennia they have ruled from here, living like demigods among the sublime beauty. All LOOT found here is EPIC

DANGERS TO DARE

- Treachery: A theme in Aphos is the deception and multi-layered betrayals of elves. Infiltrators, double loyalties, or ensnarements are common here to the unskilled. To the elves who dwell here it is not evil, but simply a way of life that has kept them alive for millennia.
- Minotaur Rebellion: Once the servants of the High Council, and many great houses of ancient Aphos, the bull-men now openly revolt, and hold ruins and catacombs for their own. Some are too far gone, mad with lost love or rage, and can no longer communicate as human beings.
- The Scorned: Ever do elves work to hide their ugly side. Using dark magic, they place their vices and sin into other beings. The saddest of these are The Scorned, a misshapen race who lives below ground, operating the machines that power Aphos' magic engines. They are seldom seen, and cannibalistic.
- Unstable Magic: Any magic used by outsiders here is highly unpredictable. Use the table on p. 320, and roll it whenever magic is used. Results vary from fizzled Spells to cross-dimensional catastrophes.
- Snake-Men: From below Aphos the enemy of Alfheim will resurface, but only in the ruins of the outer islands.

ALFHEIM

DETAILS TO DISCOVER

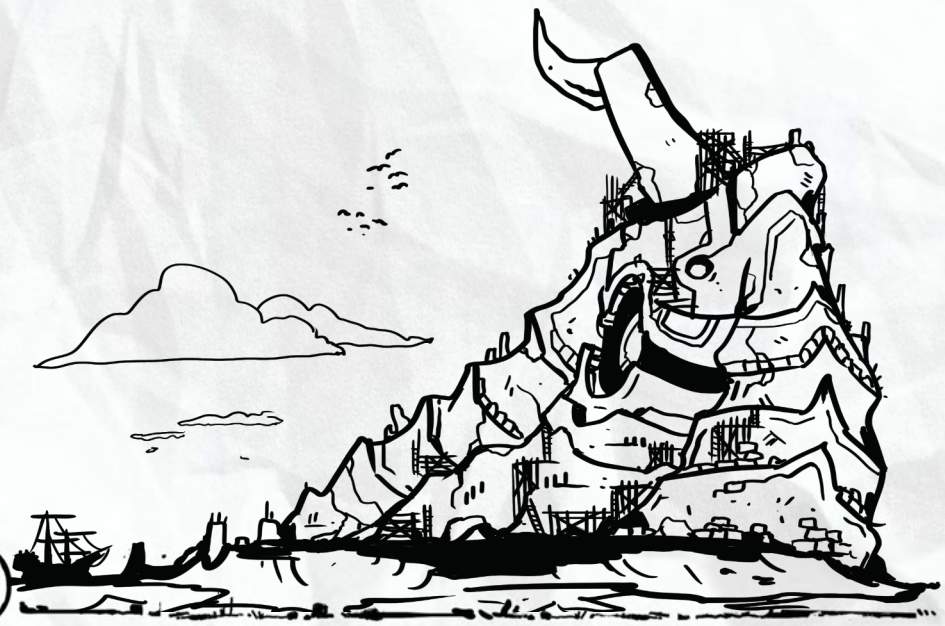
- A hovering chunk of spell-etched stone, just hanging in the air
- Slender green snakes that align to form vaguely familiar glyphs
- Pillared ruins and causeways below the glimmering green water
- The wondrous form of the Colossus, circled by birds and a ring of thin cloud
- A slave, carrying water, who has no mouth ... none at all
- A child of The Scorned, wandering dazed in rags, among the white pillars

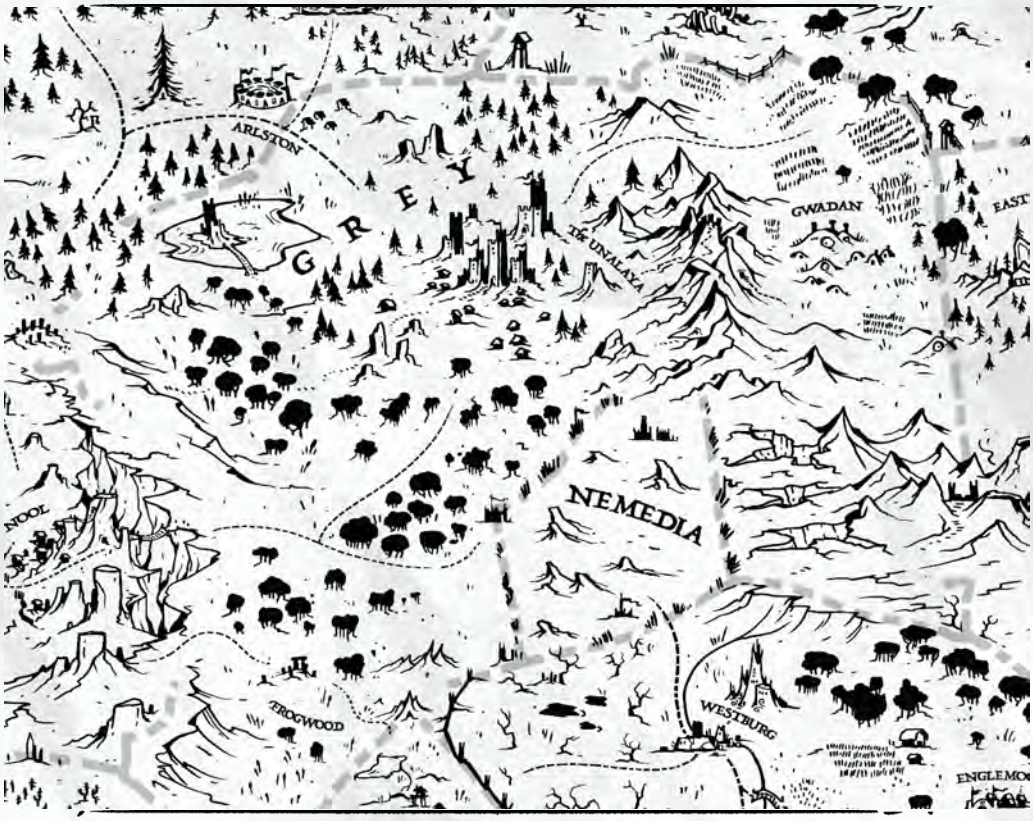
FOLK AND FRIENDSHIP

- Star Ephelle: A young girl, who believes the Colossus can renew elven virtue
- Stryke: Vengeful for the elves' imprisoning her here, she lurks in the cliffs
- Brumble Ironfist: A comical dwarven seafarer who runs trade routes to Aphos
- King Archeiandeus Daelon: A doubted ruler who dwells with the hated Yellow Robes in dark halls. Despite this, many believe his soul can yet be saved, if Queen Adea can be found

DUNGEONS TO DELVE

- White Halls of Lazareius: Straight down beneath the main island of Aphos is a baffling maze of geometric cavities and shifting shapes. Here preserved are the Elven dead, and their endless libraries. Also here is the skeletal snake-king, kept in secret for eons.
- Quay Island: Southeast is the stronghold of the Minotaurs. Their ranks have been plagued by the Scorned, who threaten to overrun the island.
- The North Colossus: This giant rests upright, but few have ever survived the climb to its massive skull. The elves have kept this giant in perfect condition, and its workings are studied to this day.





GREY, THE HEART OF ALFHEIM

LAY OF THE LAND

- Land of Many Borders: If traveling across or near a Border of Grey, expect to encounter hazards or Knights or both. Dangers from neighboring Kingdoms can be used. Incursions are all too frequent.
- Vast Fortress: Grey is the largest city-fortress in Alfheim, with thousands of residents, and more than 20 enormous towers. The city could be a location for several adventures. There are abandoned districts of the city, bustling markets, lively arenas and dangerous slums. Every manner of service and item can be found here, for a price.
- Power Vacuum: With King Henryk missing, the city is in uncertain times. Several smaller dukes and barons vying for a chance at the throne. This means more chaos in the streets, more prisoners in the fight pits of Arlston, and a dwindling city coffers.
- Pleasant: Travel in Grey is pleasant, safe, and bountiful. Use *half* your normal SUPPLIES to travel.
- Ancient Forests: Frogwood, The Grey Glades, and Mystvar are ageless places that remain mostly unexplored despite their central location.

ALFHEIM

DANGERS TO DARE

- Deep Delvers: Beneath many parts of this massive kingdom dwell the oldest, most isolated dwarves. These subterranean delvers resent the surface world, and though their queen is good-hearted, many of them crave only death for sun-walkers.
- The Rusted Company: In the Age of Snakes, the early lords of Grey made a pact with those serpent emperors to spare their lands. For this, they were cursed with immortal wrath, and their ghostly army wanders Grey in a daze of thousand-year old anger. Some say there is a way to free them... it remains unknown.

DETAILS TO DISCOVER

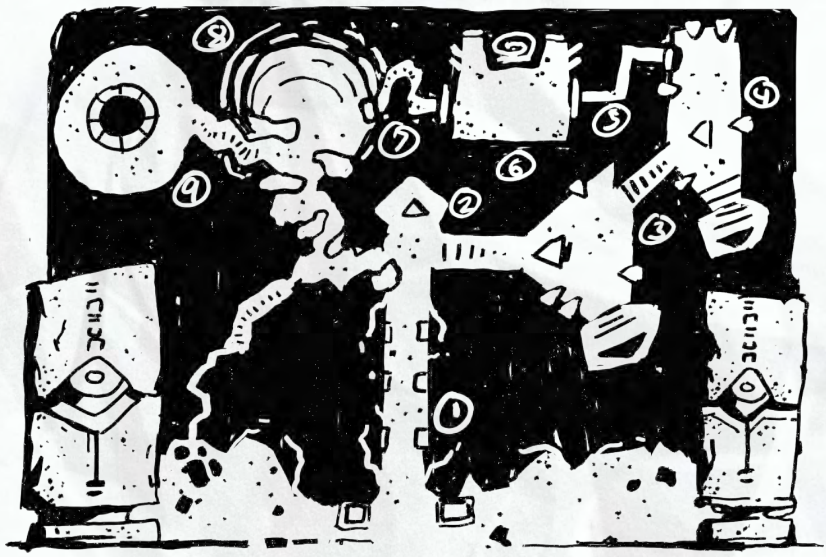
- A carved stone head, 10 feet across, lying vine-wrapped in a dim forest
- Remnants of a wooden fort, littered with skeletons. The birds are oddly silent
- A colossal tree, oak or elm, as old as the Wardens once were
- A frantic librarian, laden with a cart of rare books, fearing for his life
- Two pair of iron manacles, picked or jimmied open and left behind
- A carving in old stone, weathered, written in Nemedian glyphs
- A discarded banner of King Henryk's army, tattered and blood-stained
- A forgotten cask of the gar so golden, so good, men will kill to get it

FOLK AND FRIENDSHIP

- Henryk Loyalists: Those loyal to the missing king aid the true, defend the weak, commission noble adventurers, dare to chart the unexplored, and stand firm against all threats to Grey and the wider world.
- The Boggish: The frog-like kin in Southern Grey are a kind-hearted, bright-eyed folk, known far and wide for their impeccable hospitality, cooking, and finery. Their rapier-wielding captains have also earned distinction fighting in Henryk's Wailing Raiders unit.
- Mugs Pink: Though gar be loved across the known world, it began in Gwadan. For generations the brewmasters have passed down the secrets of this drink. The presiding brewmaster is, these days, one Mugs Pink. He is a stout, glad fellow who symbolizes and protects all that is best in the Alfhemic heartland.
- The Grey Troubadors: Ah, the wild whirling bards of Mystvar! Alfheim's most famous story troupe calls Grey home, and can most times be found there. They are a diverse, boisterous band of heroes, poets, dancers and madmen with little regard for war or doom.

DUNGEONS TO DELVE

- Reaver Fjords: A dungeon in the truest sense of the term, this windowless fortress sits at the central reaches of the vast Reaver Fjord lake. It serves as a prison for Alfheim's most uncontrollable, unkillable, or powerful villains and monsters. Though the prison is mostly effective at containing these horrors, the area surrounding the lake is still lurking with what evil seeps out.
- Unalaya Summit: The huge mountains that protect Grey's great towers are called the Unalaya. High atop these snowy peaks, a lost fortress is said to house the old mountain gods. This has long been an obsession of dwarves in the area to discover, but few return from the dizzying heights of those slopes.
- The Fissures: The insect realm of the Fissures is arid, toxic, and unstable. The ground has been ravaged and eaten hollow. Things far worse than ant men crawl below the baked dirt. Some say the insects have found a power even older than YOG, and will soon threaten all life on Alfheim. For this rumor many explorers have given their lives, but little is yet known...
- Mystvar Henge: The vast, shadowed forest of Mystvar holds many secrets. Among these is the great henge, which dates back to the Primordius itself. Beneath this stone edifice a great hidden hollow is hewn from solid rock: the Domain of Urth, or 'Star Barrow' as the wood elves call it. To even find this place is near impossible in the shifting woods and small folk roads. Any group entering Mystvar appears in a random part of the forest each morning, unless they can find a way to undo or resist the magic of the trees.



Star Barrow: 1) The Chewing Hall 2)Altar of Stars 3) Gateway Room 4) Gateway Return Room 5) Hidden Passage 6) The Star Mirror 7) Pool of Goo 8) Bleachers 9) Well of the Abyss

NEMEDIA, THE FERAL HIGHLANDS

LAY OF THE LAND

- Steep and Treacherous: These rocky foothills can take days to navigate without knowledge of goat paths and sudden drop offs. Roll WIS when traveling or waste the day seeking a route.
- Ambushers: Locked in feuds and war with more modern folk at their borders, the barbarians of these steppes are everywhere... watching, hunting, and ready to pounce.

DANGERS TO DARE

- Banshee Plague: Something dark gathers here, despite the stubborn pride of the folk. The beasts grow too large, and the dead often return as banshees to haunt the living. Their howls can be heard echoing across the hillsides by starlight, and they have a hatred of the living.
- Stone and Snow Flimes: As the curse spreads, flimes of various kinds are growing in number. They are simple minded, wanton predators who kill to feed, and feed to multiply.
- Nemedian Barbarians: No danger here is more feared than the wandering reavers who defend these hills. They are a once proud people, now cornered, and they fight like lions. The Nemedians honor a code of valor, but it leaves little room for intruders, weaklings, or civilized men.

NEMEDIAN HOMELANDS

- The rock-strewn highlands of Nemedia are home to a defiant, fierce folk. Brothers of the Nurin hillmen, these warrior clans are called wolf-keepers, rockmen, rangers, or even the 'mountain ghosts.' As the centuries have passed, they have refused to be ruled by any king or nation. They hold their borders with courageous warriors, sometimes only one against dozens, and are said to speak with animals.

FOLK AND FELLOWSHIP

- Captain Helgatha: The garrison at Westburg Road is held by the leadership of Helgatha, a shield maiden of ancestral blood from the heart of Nemedia. She is a hero to all clans here, and is recognized as supreme war chief for all the clans in time of crisis. Ever has she held an alliance with the folk of Westburg, and so keeps that border safe, and open to trade.
- Argus the Wolf: With Grey Elk gone, the Wolf Clan has risen to far greater power than its neighbors. At its head stands Argus, a fierce traditionalist who plans to push Nemedia's borders outward at any cost. Deep down, though, he is an honorable and good man.

DETAILS TO DISCOVER

- A wolf's den, but cluttered with sticks. Spiderwebs are seen in the tangle
- A rusted woodsman's axe, with a hand still grasping it
- A lockbox of silver arrowheads with the monogram 'AG' on the lid
- A cache of obsidian tools from a prehistoric age
- A field of skeletons, laying bare on the exposed rocks of a high plateau
- The broken wheels of a cart
- A great silk banner, lying in the dirt, with two great black chevrons
- A hideously deformed wolf skull, far too large and adorned in bony spikes

ELK CLAN

- Nomadic hunters who seldom speak, the Elks represent old druidic ascetism, solitary living, and nature's way. Their directive is to fight the encroachment of civilization and magic into the highlands.

BEAR CLAN

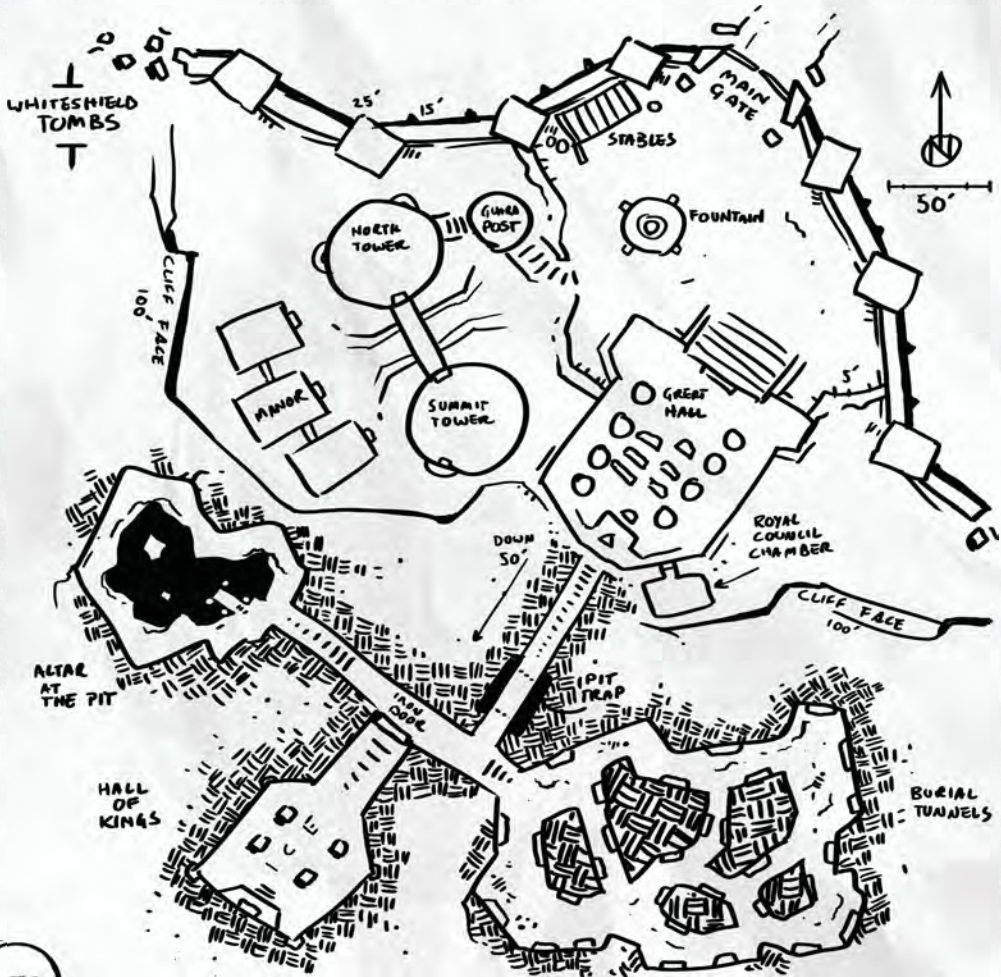
- The Bear Clan lives to make war. They are a loosely affiliated group of raiding parties, whose only code is never to kill one another. They fight for plunder, power, or simply glory. They are most often found near the borders where the action is.

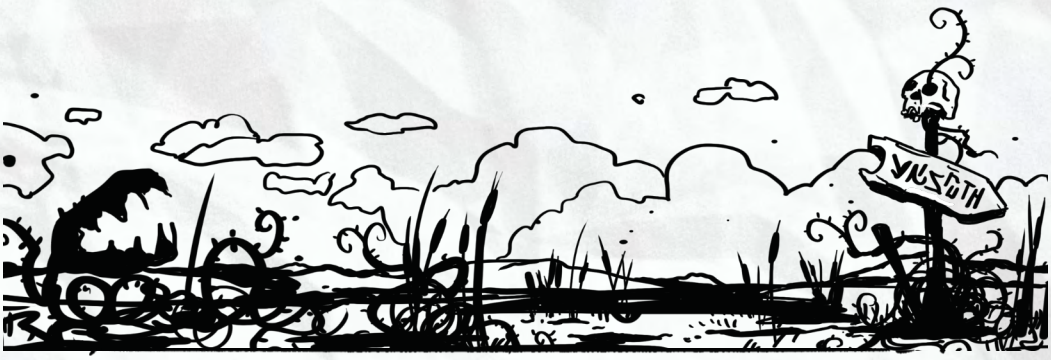
WOLF CLAN

- The most reasonable of the Nemedian clans are the Wolves, who broker a narrow path between their people and the outside world. Argus is far more ambitious than his predecessor though, and this could prove dangerous for all the neighbors of Nemedia in coming years.

DUNGEONS TO DELVE

- The Dead Fort: In Nemedia's lowland south, a fort stands. It is victim of the Dead Lands' arcane rot curse, and inhabited by skeletons, crows, and marsh demons. Nemedians avoid the area entirely, but lately the glow of fires can be seen in the sagging walls, and fell voices are heard on warm summer nights.
- Bear Crag: The canyon citadel of the ice ogres, Bear Crag is a place hewn from bedrock, and braced with countless raw timbers and stripped logs. Something, or someone, has given these creatures the unnatural power to survive across ages of defeat, but no one has returned from the region to tell.
- Tombs of Whiteshield: The Eastern border of Grey was held, long ago, by the hillmen of Whiteshield Fortress. It was their blood that battled back the ice Ogres of Bear Crag. Time has left this place abandoned, retaken by snow and rockfall. Still, legend tells of ancient tombs beneath that ruin that hold the relic vault of those heroic highlanders.





THE DEAD LANDS

LAY OF THE LAND

- Noxious Swamps: A low, rotten fog lays on these marsh lands at all times. Every day spent there inflicts 1 CON damage, only recovered when free of the area.
- Sinking Lands: Travel is near impossible here. Use 5 SUPPLY per day, with chances to lose wagons, gear or even hired hands during traversal. The mud eats it all.
- The Charred Wall: On both flanks of the Dead Lands a wall of charred-black oak and basalt hems in the infectious evil of this place. The wall is 50 feet high in places, accented with sharp spiked towers and not a single guard. Its entire surface is hot to the touch.

DANGERS TO DARE

- Razor Thistles: Towering, impassable tangles of carnivorous, thorned vines choke the south. These inflict WEAPON damage if NEAR, and can only be cleared with fire.
- The Fishmen of K'Tul: The corruption here almost always traces back to the doings and dealings of fishmen, working to serve their rotting god below the sea. They are numerous and diverse, in vast, hidden numbers.

DETAILS TO DISCOVER

- An ageless elm tree, leaf bare, with 7 skeletons hanged by the neck
- A vast bog of rusted armor, smashed helmets, broken swords and banners
- Seven human ears strung on a piece of twine
- A stray chunk of the Charred Wall, ever hot, black as pitch
- A worn roadsign pointing south to Ynsmuth
- A possum turned inside out and crawling with fishman tadpoles

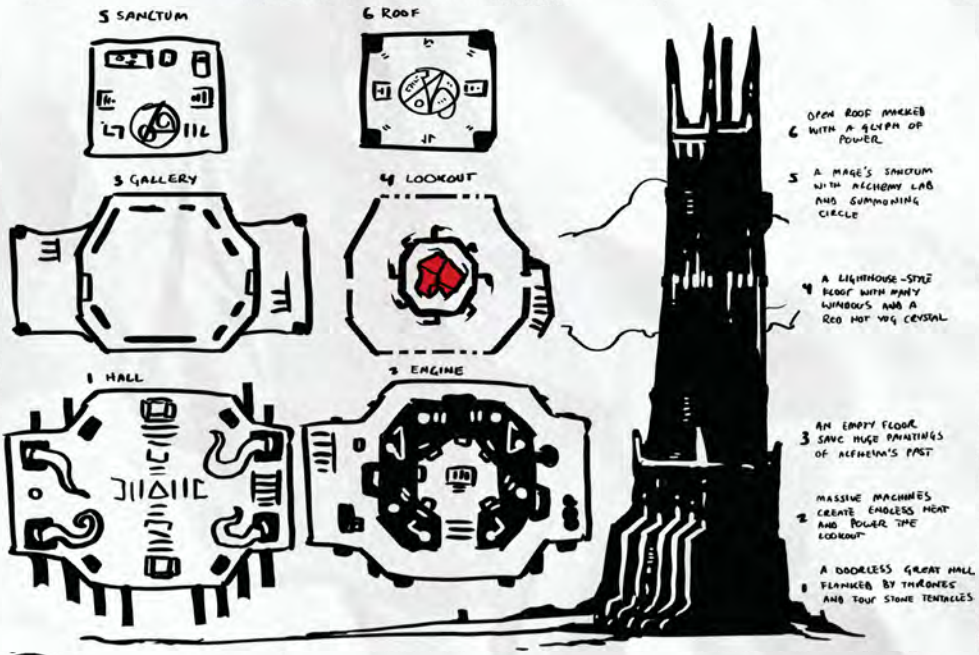
ALFHEIM

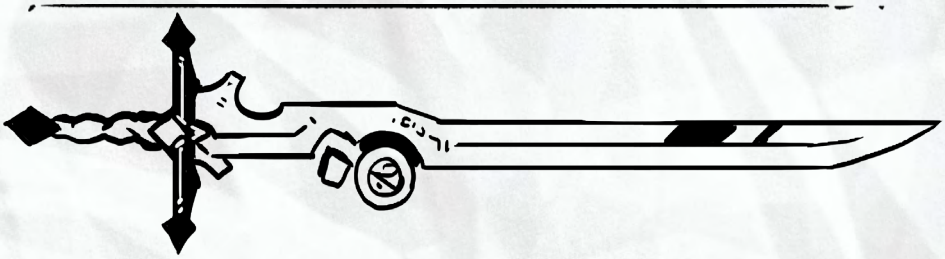
FOLK AND FELLOWSHIP

- The Charred Rider: A lone knight, clad in black armor, patrols the walls. He is neither dead nor alive, but doomed to eternal service. Those who dare the wall must answer to him, but enemies of the Ynsmuth curse find an ally.
- Old Yaba: Supreme among the mud-masked Hut People is a shrunken hag called Old Yaba. She is wise, terribly powerful with dark magic, and intrigued by travelers. It is unknown if she is driven by good or evil, but she has no love for the fishmen or razor vines of the south.
- Harlo the Ferryman: Across the river north of the Bay of Masts, a lone ferryman is known to offer crossing to those who can pay the toll. Few dare the trip, however, as that river delta is infested with gargoleths and tentacled things. No one knows why, but they leave his ferry unmolested.

DUNGEONS TO DELVE

- Stick Barrow: The Hut People worship a frog-god somewhere in the deep marsh. This vile behemoth dwells in a mountain of mud and sticks, fed by human sacrifices. It has enslaved the folk here with its grotesque frog-mind. Most devious of it all, it lures treasure-seekers with a vast hoard of gold and magical items retrieved from the sunken battlefields nearby.
- The Charred Tower: This monolithic spire can be seen in the gloom for miles around. It is hot to the touch, seething with fumes, and emits a dreadful dark magic.





XENOS, STAR-FALLEN

LAY OF THE LAND

- Colossal Jade and Basalt Blocks: The Xenosian islands are made up of interlocking blocks of irregular shapes and seams. They tower impossibly. There is no natural landscape whatsoever.
- Mind-defying Angles: Climbing gear is needed to go almost anywhere here, and the absence of plants and animals inflicts 5 SUPPLIES per day to survive.
- Unnatural: No force can form structures of these type and size. For each day here, make an INT roll or suffer -1 INT damage, recovered upon departure.
- Doorways: At all manner of angles, triangular doors lead to subterranean chambers. All navigational or scouting rolls are HARD.
- Shifting Shapes: At intervals, linked either to the moons or tide or both, the cyclopean blocks shift and slide, forming new jagged shapes. There is a small chance that explorers could be caught in this shift, and be crushed or dropped into thin air.

DANGERS TO DARE

- Bore Worms: A terrible breed of these predators dwells in the cavities of Xenos. They have adapted to feed on YOG crystals, which can be found in the odd-shaped catacombs below the surface. This variety is also deadly in its intelligence. They are known to call to one another, stage ambushes, and even lure prey into primitive traps.
- Children of Azatoth: The hideous statues that hold star-fallen evil lure the weak minded to their deaths. Xenos is most likely the origin of these beings.
- Brain Horrors: Many believe that brain horrors are a descended form of the original Xenosians. They despise sunlight, and dwell in the deepest recesses of the islands, poring over inscriptions and forming incomprehensible plans to rid Urth of other species.
- The Custodians: These huge constructs, some 30 feet tall, are the servants of the Xenosian all-mind. They maintain, repair and protect the islands with tireless mechanical precision, preparing for some far-off arrival or distant awakening. They are made out of the same unearthly material as the islands themselves, and blend perfectly into the weird scenery here.

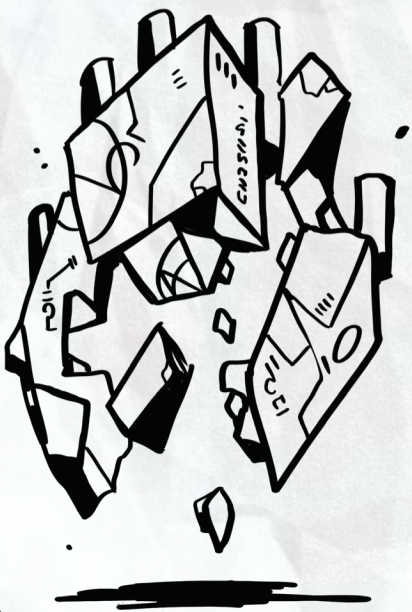
ALFHEIM

DETAILS TO DISCOVER

- A map of Alfheim, etched into jade, showing it as it was in the ancient past
- A tiny splinter of YOG crystal, vague shapes twisting and moving inside
- A jade sword with levitating elements and a glowing teal gemstone on its hilt
- Blood-stained pages from a cartographer's journal, showing a vast series of chambers below the islands
- A black stone bracelet, carved with a single, lidless eye motif
- A spiral-etched flute. When played, can induce visions of terror beyond space
- A group of dwarven corpses, dry with age, gathered around surveying gear and crushed to death
- A series of odd bottles, each containing a fetal creature of unknown type
- A baffling control panel of lenses, colored levers and a brass dial
- A slime trail, 3 feet wide, leading down into the depths

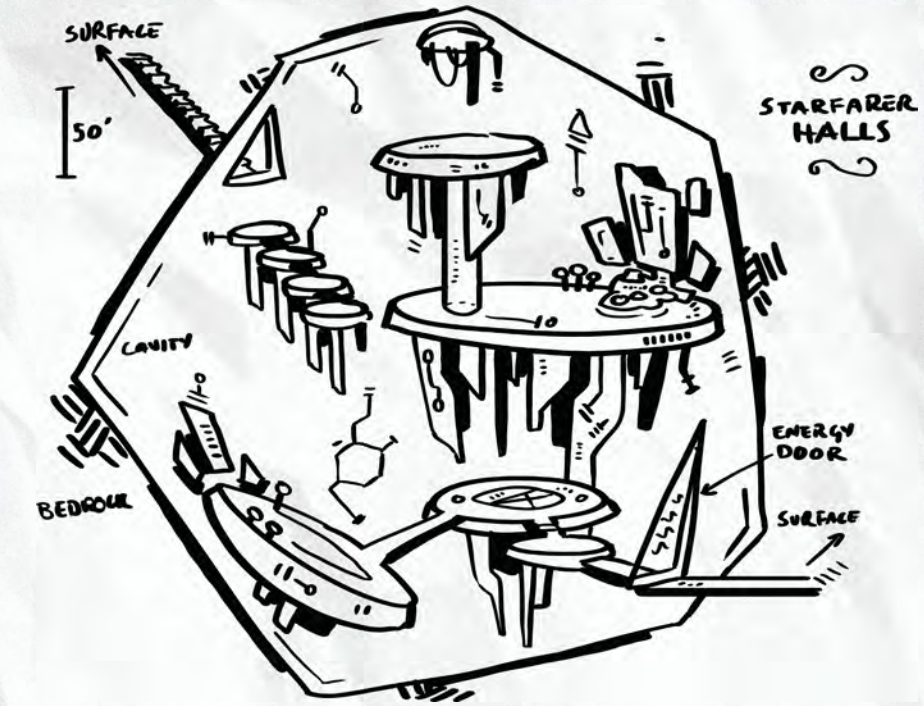
FOLK AND FELLOWSHIP

- Bartleby Longfellow: Dwarves dare to chart, mine and explore even the most extreme environs of Alfheim. Bartleby is the best, maybe the boldest of these. Part pirate, part archaeologist, he welcomes all who dare Xenos.
- Xil'Ul the Defiler: Driven from the ruined monastery at Valley Rim, the spirit of this. ..creature... has taken a new form, and seeks redemption for crimes in the name of Ogdru and the Xenosian gods.
- The Hags of Glass Rock: Somewhere on the northern islands, three hags gather 'round a hovering cube of pure jade. It is said they are neither good nor evil, and will answer any question ... for a price.



REALM OF THE OGDRU

- Xenos remains almost entirely unmapped because it is comprised of impassable, ever changing blocks and shapes: what remains of an Ogdru vessel called a starfarer.
- The star-fallen are a race so ancient, so vast, that they are both the creators and destroyers of worlds. One truth is certain: events in the Primordius will echo forever, somehow carried by vibrations or odd markings on the Starfarer. Some folk believe the ship can be repaired, or that it contains the secret to the colossi and more.



DUNGEONS TO DELVE

- Starfarer Halls: The deepest section of Xenos is the mighty control rooms that the Ogdru once used to pilot this immense craft. None have ever seen that place and lived to tell of it, for it is guarded by constructs and machines beyond mortal imagination.
- The Argent Lens: A series of spherical and cylindrical chambers connected by omnidirectional tubes and chutes. This puzzling space is ever moving with silver rings and spiral-etched gears. At its heart, a massive array of crystal discs align and re-align, focusing beams of sunlight and radiant energy into the cosmos for purposes beyond mortal comprehension.
- Dead Surrath: An enormous city of windowless towers and balustrades stands at the eastern edge of Xenos. The buildings are beyond any human sense of scale, but within is lavishly chronicled the starfaring journey of the Xenosians and their Ogdru ancestors. Indicated in these frescoes and star maps are several far worlds, including Xevos, Tortua, and Aster. What other secrets lie in these towering corridors and galleries?
- Jade Coast Caverns: Facing the infinity of the Southern Seas, the lower coast of Xenos is dotted with a multitude of ocean-carved caves. Here the ugly side of the star-fallen can be found: those poor deformed wretches who have been twisted and made hateful by the Ogdru. They occupy these caves, brooding over plots to eat the world or somehow turn the Starfarer against the nobler races out of pure spite.

THE GREENWAY, LAND OF PROSPERITY

LAY OF THE LAND

- Hill and Dale: This pleasant green land is well traveled, with kept roads and friendly faces at every turn. Use 1 SUPPLY every 2 days' journey here. Also, each day encounter 1 or more friendly local merchants.
- Farmlands: All but the northwest corner of The Greenway is verdant, rolling land farmed by all kinds of folk. Inns, villages, meals and gar are all plentiful. It is common to see a dozen or more farm houses, barns and hamlets in one day's walk.
- The Bogs of Hurun: Where this land meets the Dead Lands, and the highlands of Nemedia, the forest has sunken too low, taking on a mucky tangle. Travel here is terribly difficult, costing 3 SUPPLY per day, and many become lost in the winding marsh.
- Historic: Being the first land settled by people after the Age of Serpents, there is history everywhere here. Old roads, grave sites, abandoned towns, centuries old cobble walls, and landmarks dot the country.
- Rainy Season: Each spring, the Greenway receives a few months of relentless rain. This keeps the land green and lush, but also lays a gloomy shade on all its folk. Travelers make daily CON rolls or get the chills. Left unattended, this can lead to a fever or even pneumonia.

DETAILS TO DISCOVER

- A dolmen stone, etched in time-worn spirals, leaning in a grassy field
- A high-roofed barn tended by a dwarven farmer and his family
- Cobbled roads overgrown with thick green grass
- A faded wooden sign pointing oddly into untracked wilderness
- A basket of fresh bread scattered about, and a pair of children's shoes nearby
- A sweeping vista atop a small hill, showing rolling fields of green and gold
- A hamlet of small folk, busily preparing for a feast
- A blonde woman, carrying a bundle of dead flowers and singing a sad dirge

DANGERS TO DARE

- Hurun Mudmen: All along the marshy border of the bogs, a tribe of ape-like mud people fight to hold their lands.
- Bloodsworn Elves: Not all the elves of Hath Ordur, the tower where Lydea once ruled, have been ousted. There are squads of them still, and they prowl these lands with killing as their only agenda. Theirs is a path of a doomed people, and they see no other way but that of the arrow and the sword.
- Road Orcs: Nasty, pointless, mischievious buggers who ambush travelers and villagers in a futile effort to glorify their toothy, nasty folk.
- The Eels Beneath: The curse brought forth by Aras, later called Red Fang, still infests the dark places of the Greenway. These are tangles of eel-like serpents, each lined with barbed suckers. They move in swarms through any subterranean space, and some grow to 20 feet in length. Contact with them can cause an infection. More of them grow in the host, eventually bursting out with ravenous momentum.

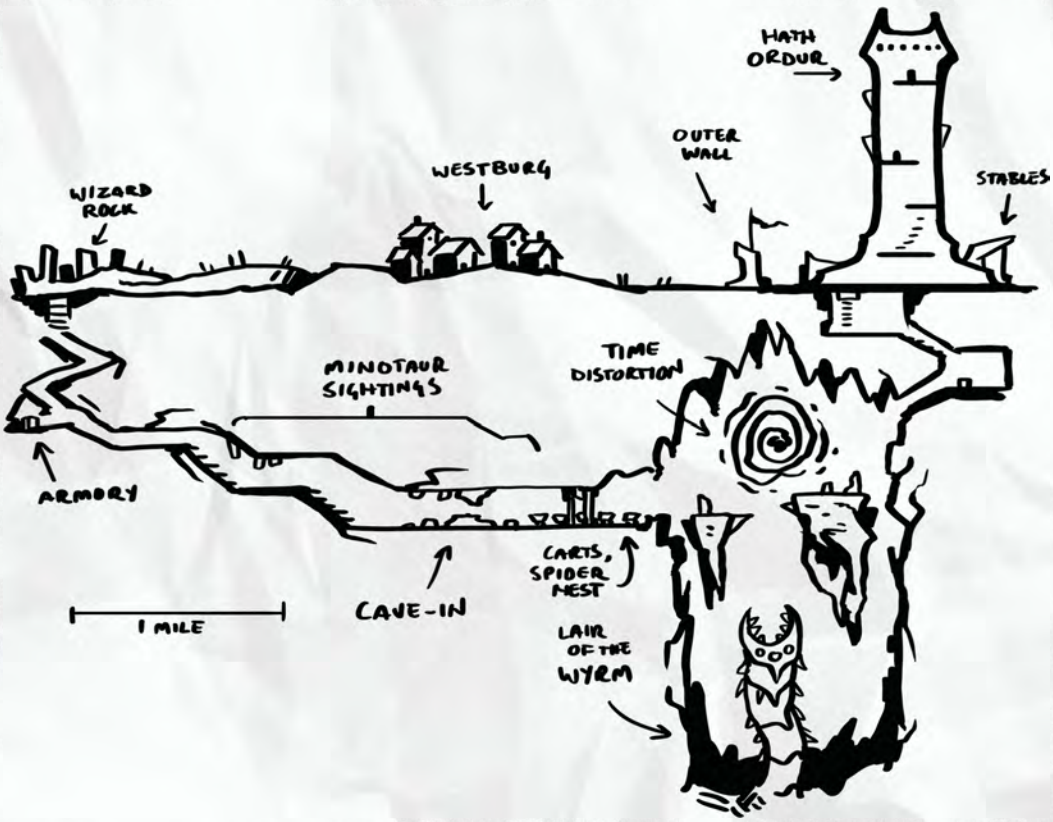
ALFHEIM

FOLK AND FELLOWSHIP

- Grinn Tarney: Great Nephew of the hero Dobbs Tarney, Grinn now mans the bar at Dobbs' Dim, one of the best taverns in Alfheim. He is a community leader, and has been instrumental in the rebuilding of Westburg after the numerous disasters there.
- The Flying Walenzos: A hilarious troupe of bards travel the roads and villages of this area, and they are beloved wherever they roam.
- Swan Grady: The newest Lord of Englemoor is a small folk Duchess named Swan. She is a kind ruler, and works daily to rout the evil that dwells below that storied city.
- Zymer the Wise: None other. After his adventures, Zheimer has settled on a humble farm 'tween Westburg and Englemoor, there spending days devising magic to protect and enrich the land.
- The Order of Helm: An order of knights patrol these lands, stopping to aid the weak, imprison thieves and rampagers, and stand firm in the name of Duchess Grady.

DUNGEONS TO DELVE

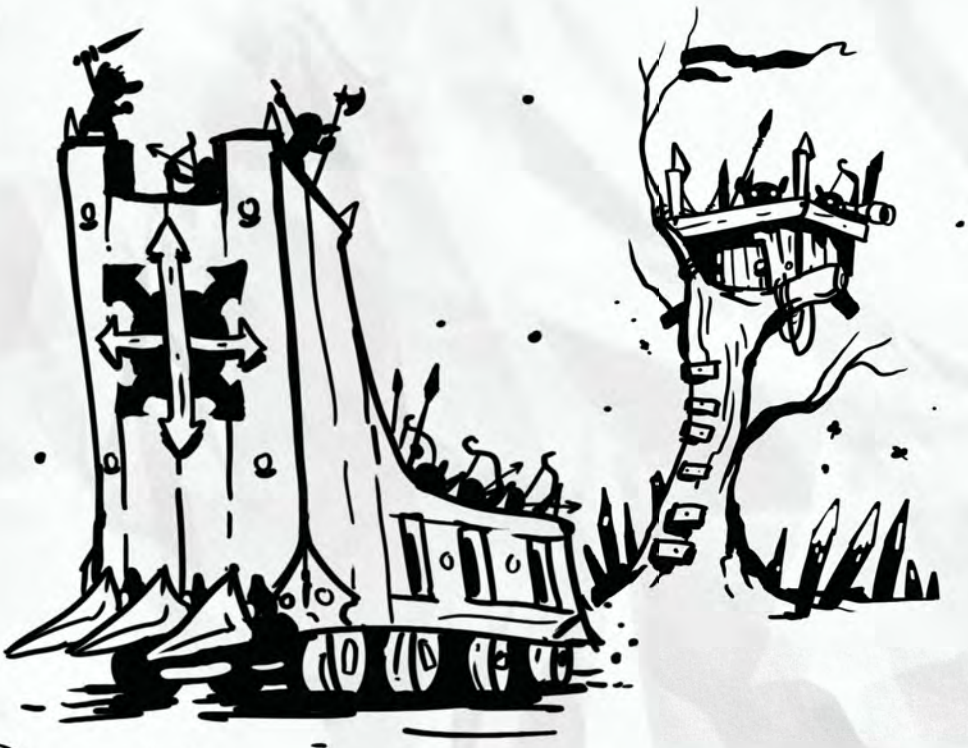
- The Catacombs of Ardenmoor: Long ago, Englemoor was called Ardenmoor, and the catacombs below were a place of torture and madness. The asylum is there, but that is only the upper layer of a labyrinth as old as Alfheim itself. No place are the eels of Iridess more densely packed in nesting swarms than there.
- Nurin's Stones: In the southeast of this land, a set of stones still leans upright. These act as an entrance to a vast undercroft, where the stone giant Lion Sword and his phantom warriors still growl with anger. None go there, for to awaken those titans could spell doom for the entire south coast.
- Hath Ordur: A series of siege tunnels lead to the depths below Lydea's old tower. Some of the tunnels stretch for miles in straight lines, but the main chambers house an elder wyrm. This creature seems beyond time and space, and some say it actually *feeds* on the timestreams, destabilizing the cosmos.



THUSHUM, GOBLIN HOME

LAY OF THE LAND

- Hinterlands: This far north, the seasons can be exaggerated, and the cold wind can be ruthless. Though storms are rare here, when they come, travel is *perilous*. Each day has a 10% chance of storm. If one rolls in, triple SUPPLY use, and make HARD rolls to scout, or hunker down and find shelter. A failed roll can leave you lost, captured, or facing the wall.
- Off Limits: The entire Kingdom of Thushum is forbidden to all but the goblin folk who have taken the vow of loyalty. Intruders will be taken to the great hall, to be judged by Queen Knyfe.
- Great Wall: Besides the Guud Peaks, the land border of Thushum is penned by a massive stone wall. It is patrolled at all hours, and has no gate.
- Barrows: Goblins here make their homes in brick huts and long houses on timber stilts or lodged in cliffs. These huts are tough, with few windows, and highly defensible.
- A Little Known Folk: Despite common belief, the Thushum are a noble, stout hearted, and good people. They have a rich oral history which predates most written language, and stand for all that is best in life.



DANGERS TO DARE

- The Thumush: Not all who call Thushum home take the sacred vow. These outcasts succumb to the craven spirit that has given goblins their outdated, evil reputation. For this, they are cast out. Some have yet to leave, and hide in the countryside laying in wait for the unwary.
- Stone Flimes: Like all flime colonies, this one has continued to multiply against all the Thushum efforts. In fact, this threat is reaching critical mass, as the troublesome little buggers can now be found in almost every corner of the realm.

DETAILS TO DISCOVER

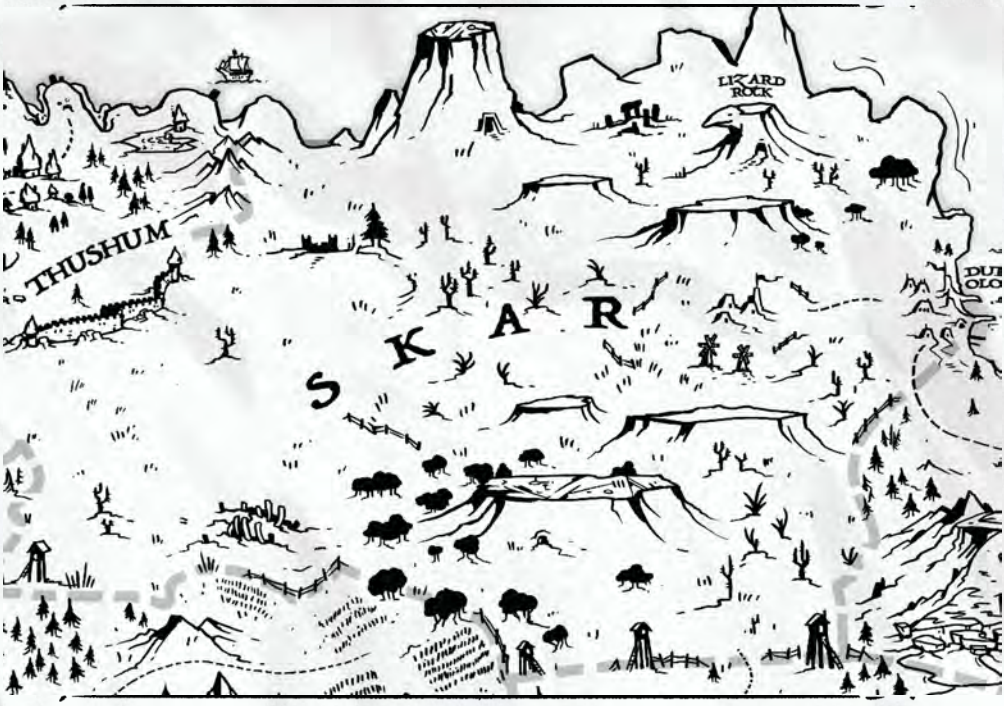
- A malfunctioning wooden contraption still shooting arrows and swinging floppy swords at random
- An open sinkhole. Far below, a series of campfires are smoldering in the dark
- An abandoned quarry site, where huge blocks were once removed, now occupied by flimes
- A pile of pelts and timbers near a road, some charred
- A tremendous outdoor forge. A thatch hut nearby glows from within
- A terribly unkempt rope bridge over a gorge
- Dozens of gable posts and lodgepoles stacked as if ready to build a home
- An iron-banded lock box filled with steaks, dried meat and roasted fish

FRIENDS AND FELLOWSHIP

- Dockmaster Quinn: The trading ports on Northern Thushum are of legend. They are managed, and kept safe by this one-eyed human, who was raised by the Thushum from birth.
- The Grillmasters: A council of goblins runs the feast. They are master chefs and master drinkers.

DUNGEONS TO DELVE

- The Coal Beds: Beneath the Great Grill in the northwest of Thushum, there is a huge cavity in the earth that has filled, over the centuries, with the coals from above. A small crew of Thushum maintain the cavern, but it has gone too deep, reaching the strange depths where crystal worms dwell. Faced with an expedition to retrieve the YOG those worms feed on, the Thushum seek adventurers up to the deadly challenge.
- Teeth of Guud: The jagged rocks off the coast of Thushum have claimed many ships. Not only are these spires haunted by the ghosts of the doomed, many great treasure holds have sunken there, ripe for the taking.



SKAR, REALM OF BEASTS

LAY OF THE LAND

- A Scoured Land: Vast, open spaces define this place. So vast are these plains, any journey with less than 10 SUPPLY is all but doomed. In the loneliest reaches, strange lights have been seen in the endless sky.
- Towering Buttes: Seven colossal buttes define the horizons of the endless steppe. Local people call them the 'Seven Gods.' The largest are 10,000 feet high, their table-flat tops etched with gigantic lines and shapes. The nature of these is unknown. Either way, the buttes must be circumnavigated, for their sheer walls are unclimbable in most places.
- High Desert: Most of Skar is cactus, grass, and low scrub. There is almost no water here. At night, the temperature drops terribly. This diversity makes Skar home to all kinds of shrewd predators, and wildly different are their kinds by day or night.
- Old Bones: In the southwest of Skar, giant Drakes from primordial times fell to ruin. Their bones still tower over those haunted lands in the moonlight, and few dare go there.
- Breath of the World: Wind. There is a ceaseless, wild gale that blows here. It drives some mad, pushes men from cliff edges, or topples wagons on frigid nights. Each day here, there is a 25% chance of a cataclysmic wind storm, which can wreak havoc on any living thing without stone shelter.

DANGERS TO DARE

- Dire Predators: All manner of giant beast prowl these lands. Some legends say the nomads even control some of the monsters, but mostly local folk are preyed upon as much as explorers and adventurers. Species range from giant buzzards and eagles to lions, cave bears, vipers and even crocodiles.
- Outsiders: Skar is visited, for reasons unknown, by outsiders piloting a WARP SHELL. Their agenda is a mystery, but they have been known to vaporize, pursue, or entrap various creatures.
- The Last Colossus: The only colossus still up and moving has been spotted plodding across the plains at night.

DETAILS TO DISCOVER

- A mile-long straight line etched into solid rock, its edges flawlessly tooled
- A strange metallic object lodged in a small crater. Roll for SCI FI LOOT
- An ancient standing pole of animal gods or totem creatures, facing due east
- A stretch of fence, almost 20 miles long, from a long lost ranch or farm
- A lost small folk child, filthy and forgotten, who cannot speak
- A mud hut, occupied by garrison keepers of one or the other tribe

FRIENDS AND FELLOWSHIP

- The Druids of Needle Rock: In Western Skar, great spires of sandstone stand against the wind. In a series of cliff dwellings and rope-bridges live a group of druids.
- The Nuzka: Some say they are not real, but there is a group of small folk who work to maintain and restore the great etched lines in this vast place. They move in teams of three, with stone tools to hone and keep the ancient lines.
- Ezra Muntz: One man from the south has managed to survive here, a hillman named Muntz. Once a year he returns with a catch of direhorn, plains mares, and giant ostrich.

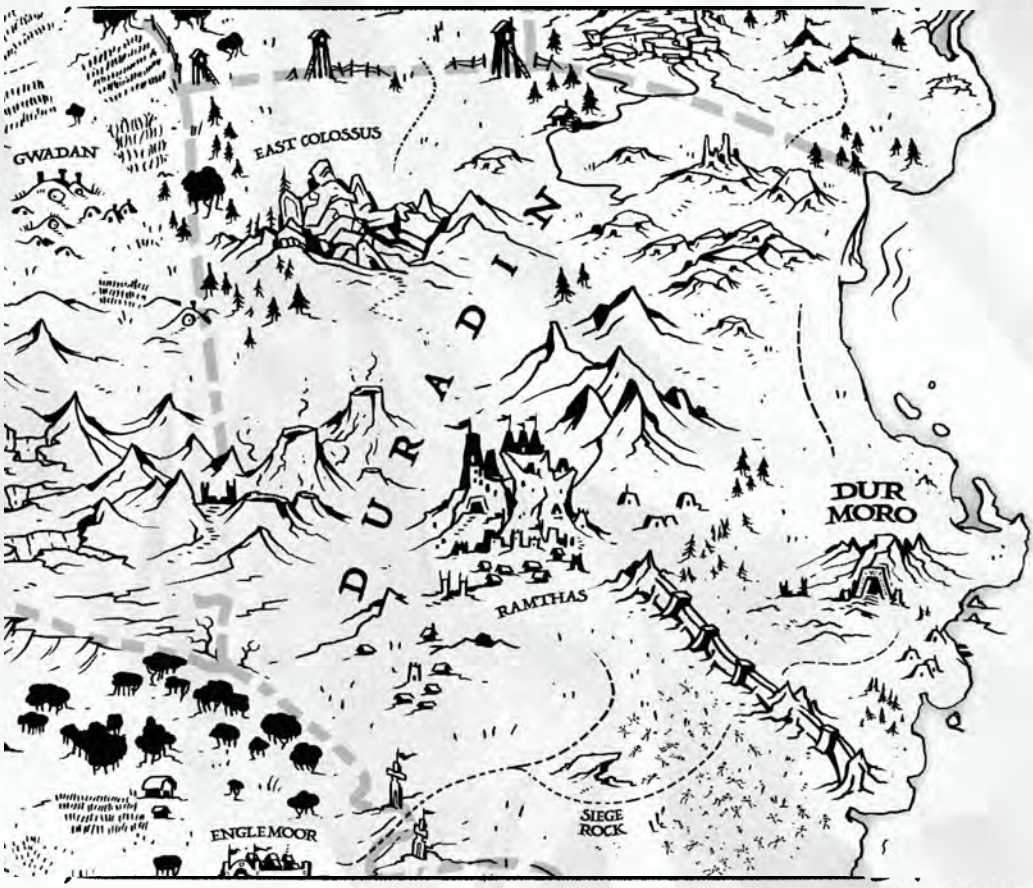
DUNGEONS TO DELVE

- Tower of Lokus: Once the hardened core of a massive volcano, this striated tower now houses a complex base used by outsiders from another world. Here they service their starfaring ships and develop their strange plans.
- Ruins of Skrix: A serpent-city of old still stands here. It is a feared, hated place, long abandoned. Like so many of their enclaves, though, movement has been sighted there recently, especially by night. What is the strange green glow in that black-windowed hell, and what doom lies in its shadows?
- Lizard Rock: Both the Canus and Herat claim credit for carving this gigantic monument. Whoever is right, the rock conceals a labyrinth of tunnels and chambers that, some say, reaches to the very hollow core of Urth. Few dare its heights, for it is home to all manner of giant reptiles.

DURADIN, STRONGHOLD OF DWARVES

LAY OF THE LAND

- Land of Many Climes: So vast is Duradin, it ranges from the frigid north to the warm, arid south coast. Travelers here should expect a range of conditions.
- The Molten Mountains: The borderlands due west of Ramthas are sundered by a range of huge, conical, volcanic mountains. These titans are still active, and choke the region in smog, heat and ash. Travel there is *perilous*.
- A Mighty City: Ramthas Rock is a wonder of Alfheim. An entire city, almost as big as Grey, hewn from one massive outcrop of solid rock. This is the seat of dwarf culture, and was once home to King Akram in his time.
- The Wall of Duros-Tem: The largest known structure in all the world. This monster is 80 miles long and 1,000 feet tall in places. All navigation up, over or through is HARD. Here the ancient elves rallied their greatest attack, and failed to break the lines of the Falcon King.



DANGERS TO DARE

- The Dead: There is a sad truth behind the dwarven mirth of Duradin. Many wars have been fought here, and the countless fallen do not all rest. A curse lay upon the ancestral battlegrounds. Those who have died there, unless consecrated, tend to rise. These undead are often armored soldiers, archers, or even cavalry on skeletal mounts.
- Ant Men: The Molten Mountains are teeming with ant men, who mostly mind their own business. Every few decades, though, they dare to expand their borders.
- Athic Rebels: The seafaring smugglers of the south have been trying to break free of Duradin rule for generations. Having failed, they settle for terrorizing travelers and sabotaging roads.
- Hill Demons of Xhil: The entities that follow Xhil 'Ul have found their way into the north of Duradin. These are squid-faced spellweavers, misshapen deep delvers, and worse. It is unknown what gives them the power to stave off the dwarves, but they have proven unkillable so far.

DETAILS TO DISCOVER

- A broken warhammer, gouged with fang marks of unusual size
- A cask half-full of red gar
- Near a road, a broken shipping crate. White cheese and loaves of Sfengart bread scattered everywhere
- The drying corpse of an ant man, still sporting war equipment
- A rune-etched translation stone, used for decoding architectural carvings
- A stone-ringed exhaust port with some chamber of machinery far below
- A lonely, thin red banner whipping in a cold breeze
- An abandoned 4-wheel cart, empty, but stuck in deep mud ruts
- An angry herd of wild turkeys
- A cryptic, brass-capped navigation marker spiked into solid rock
- A group of Ramthas soldiers, enjoying gar and singing songs of the good ol' days

FRIENDS AND FELLOWSHIP

- Yababa, Keeper of the Coins: In the mountains near the East Colossus, a tiny old woman wanders the sparse pines. She lures travelers with a bounty of coins, but these coins are the souls of men, and come with a terrible price. Despite this grim truth, she has been known to aid the greatest kings and lowest slaves, and her exact purpose and agenda remain a mystery.
- Boot Myron: A little-known champion of King Akram is Boot Myron, who has ruled as a steward of the throne of Duradin for many years. Boot has the strange distinction of being half deep delver, and so has become a bridge between the peoples of the above and below. This has made Duradin mighty, but some dissent exists on both sides. Some believe there can never be such a peace.

DUNGEONS TO DELVE

- The Molten Cathedral: One reason for the endless war with the ant men is their taking of this mighty tower at the heart of the Molten Mountains. Here, a *god-forge* rests, and is the only way to create weapons as powerful as Angrid the Lawgiver. This is an insufferable affront to Dwarves. Ever do they seek to reclaim the cathedral, but the ant men have fought them back so far.
- Dur Moro: Beyond the massive doors, an under-realm sprawls out, almost as large as the surface of Duradin. It is a vast place of blocky tunnels, forgotten crypts and towering halls. Here are stored great dwarvish artifacts, burials of ancestral kings, and forbidden places where serpent men pry at the world of the surface.

OLO, A FROZEN HELL

LAY OF THE LAND

- Frozen Solid: Stranded travelers can freeze to death on cold nights. Spend 2 SUPPLIES per day traveling. If lost or without supplies for 2 days here, 1 party member freezes to death per day afterward.
- Gem Glacier: Impassable without some means of flight.
- Castle Manac: The walled realm of the tyrant. Ghosts still serve the wizard here, and SPELLS make lost even the best scouts.
- Salt Frost: All the coastal areas here have a frozen, salty soil. For each day there, DESTROY one item, weapon, or piece of armor per traveler.

DANGERS TO DARE

- Snow Orcs: Most of Olo is held by vying tribes of orcs. Some nomadic, some dwelling in stone fortresses or timber garrisons. They unify only in groups of 50 to 100, and their feuds go back centuries. Only Manac has held them at bay.
- Ice Drakes: The inaccessible vistas of Gem Glacier are home to three ancient drakes. These are called Hydranax, Suros, and Garudan. Each seems to have its own agenda, but none abide the presence of lesser creatures who do not serve as slaves or devotees.
- Unstable Time: The dabblings of Kazgat the time wizard have created a ripple effect across Olo. Time itself vibrates and even tears in places. To when these tears lead is never certain.
- Snow Flimes: Nowhere in Alfheim are the snow flimes worse than on these wind swept slopes. They have been allowed to reproduce unchecked, and in places they swarm so thick they have turned to eat one another.

ALFHEIM

DETAILS TO DISCOVER

- A ruby amulet frozen in a glass-clear block of ice
- A spiral vortex of skeletons frozen in a bluish ice lake
- The wreckage of a nomadic tent, strewn by wind, even the iron center pole bent by some great force
- A flickering rip in time itself, appearing and disappearing
- A seemingly bottomless fissure, lined on both sides by man-cut caverns
- A small growth of YOG crystals growing out of the ice
- A corroded set of plate armor with the mark of Ramthas
- A snow orc banner atop a rocky outcrop
- An oddly snow-free swath of terrain, leading up to a steam-belching cavern
- The flesh-cleaned skeleton of a wooly direhorn.
- A road sign indicating the route to Olo

FRIENDS AND FELLOWSHIP

- Kazgat the Time Wizard: In a canvas tent somewhere near the glaciers, dwells one of the mightiest wizards in Alfheim. He has been known to aid heroes and wanderers, but he is also a bit mad. His mind has become a tangle of timelines and dimensions, but he still makes a fine mint tea.
- Fort Anvil: A cave in northern Olo has been fit with timber barricades and three catapult. This alliance of dwarves and men hold fast against the orcs and ghosts of Olo. To do so, they keep a 24 hour vigil. Many believe it is only a matter of time before the drakes destroy them.
- The Roadkeepers: Patrols from Fort Anvil keep the roads open here. They can be flagged down to aid any traveler. They are stout, selfless warriors sworn to a life of service in this forbidding place. Encounter 2-5 at any one time.
- Hilga the Hammer: In the pine forests of Olo, there is a legend of a mighty hunter. A solitary dwarven shieldmaiden with a zest for life and a talent for survival. The location of her cabin is unknown, but those who have met her tell tall tales of her hospitality, heroism, and incredible bravery.

DUNGEONS TO DELVE

- Castle Manac: Imagine the secrets that must lie hidden in that lifeless place! Manac's basalt fortress, called The Red Keep, has lain silent for decades. A terrible storm of traps and wonders await those heroes who finally crack its doors.
- Drake Hollow: Somewhere in Gem Glacier, the ice drakes keep their lair. Here also, according to legend, is the frigid nest of those mighty beasts. What fool would dare such a place?
- YOG Island: Just east of the crystal fields so carefully cultivated by Manac, a small island sits in the ice. Kazgat has recorded a brilliant gleam of crystal caverns below that place, but it remains unexplored.
- The Blue Abyss: At Olo's center is a mind-defying chasm. Its depths are frozen solid, and, some say, home to a forgotten race of frost giants from another world. These are simply rumors. To even verify the story would require a 2 mile descent down sheer ice walls into the darkness.

CRASK, YOUR TURN

LAY OF THE LAND

- Travel Conditions: Devise one key detail that affects travel here, in terms of peril, SUPPLY cost, or simply flavor.
- A Landmark: Besides the castle, what singular feature warrants investigation or avoidance? Is it natural or the work of mortals? Immortals?
- A Mystery: Set up a loose end. You don't need to know its outcome, only its introduction. Dream outside the norm, and dare heroes to unravel the truth.
- An Obstacle: Designate one peril intrinsic in this area that makes exploration exciting, difficult, or actively prevented.

DANGERS TO DARE

- Creatures: Create or choose a species that prowls or hunts here, posing deadly threat to any intruders. The creatures should fit the LAY OF THE LAND, and reinforce the mood and tone you are building in Crask. Those who go here should dread encountering these beasts, and expect them to leap out at every corner.
- Monstrosities: A creature or two? No problem. This *thing* however, can kill an entire party. This is a giant thing, an invisible thing, or an evil army. Escalate the danger, but make it less likely to appear.
- Characters: Besides beasts and terrors, what folk call this place their own, and suffer no intrusion? A tribe of archers? A sect of cannibals? A cabal of witch-hunters? Again, use these people to reinforce the underlying feeling, story, or theme of the location as a whole.
- Perilous Events: When daring the outer reaches of the world, terrible things are bound to happen. Imagine a calamity that would occur here: a frozen tidal surge? Eruptions of scalding steam? Poison fog from deep space? To get more specific, designate a likelihood or die roll to check for the event's occurrence.
- The Unknown: Devise a hint or clue that has no confirmation. Not only is it still unknown, it is deadly. This dares your heroes to find the truth without being destroyed by it.

DETAILS TO DISCOVER

- Try listing three or four things that can be found lying around. Just right there on the ground
- Lay a breadcrumb. Whatever the coolest idea is in your region, leave a clue that leads to it
- Nothing useless. Don't list a detail here that doesn't have to do with *something*. Just peppering bits of information or objects in the area only clutters the theme

FRIENDS AND FELLOWSHIP

- Someone Lowly: Add a friendly character who has very little, and is barely getting by in the hardships of this area. How can you help them?
- Someone with a Quest: An errand of heroic proportions often begins with a single clue or call for aid. Picture one person in your region who holds such an important task.
- Someone Fun: It's always good to have a few bright-hearted folk about, to remind heroes what they're fighting for. These are the best of us, and stay happy and cheerful even in dark times.

DUNGEONS TO DELVE

- First, devise four *names* that suggest doom, mystery, adventure or treasure. Don't worry about any of the details. A simple name is all you need. Make it fit the area's theme, and load it with ominous suggestion.
- For each dungeon, it can help to visualize a brief description by picturing a single word that captures your idea. Get this single word in your head, then start inventing descriptive tidbits that reinforce that word.
- A Natural Wonder: One of your dungeons can be a great cavern, mountain, or other feature. Some force has created a great hollow, and wonders await deep within.
- A Fortress of Evil: The classic way to build dungeon ideas is to house a great evil in a series of traps and hazards. Heroes dare these halls to confront the vile presence. Count on it.
- A Beast's Lair: Some great dungeons are tunnels dug or occupied by terrible predators, monsters, or beasts. When building such a place, employ curving tunnels, jagged cavities, and bone-strewn shadows.

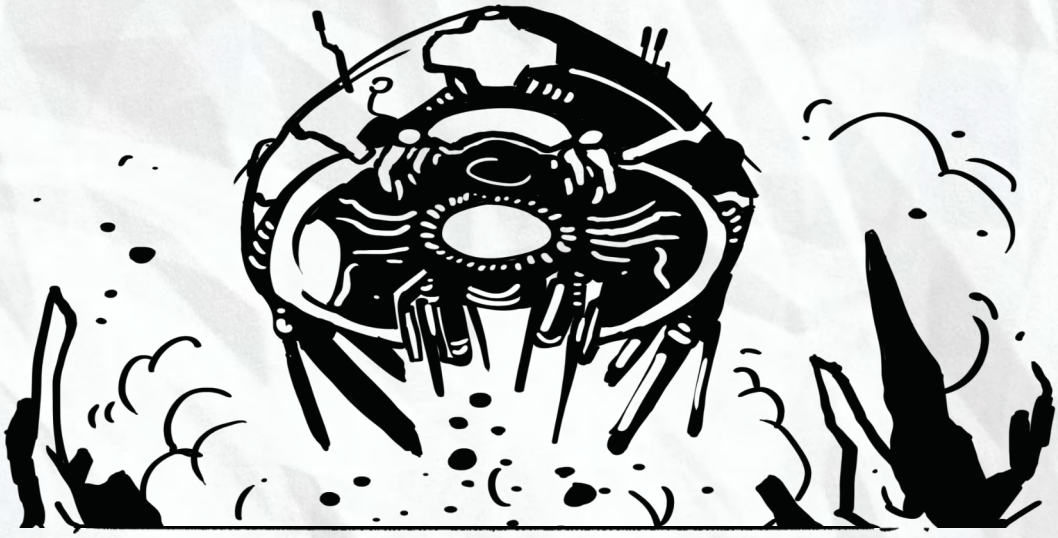
THE WHOLE TRUTH

- When creating new areas, or filling in the adventures and details in Crask, keep track of the full story. This means the region's secrets in totality. A good place for this is your GM's journal. With the whole truth at your side, you'll be able to answer every player question, improvise encounters, invent travel mechanics, or reveal shocking facts at the right moment.

ALFHEIM

NORTH COLOSSUS
SOLSTICE PEAK
I R E
THE WARDEN
PINE HENGE
KINDER PEAKS
IRADRUM
NORBURG
SHIELDHELM
GILHELM
NORDHEIM
ARLSTON
WEST COLOSSUS
K H E T T
NOOL
PORT SAND
KOAB
K A T H
IRIDESS
SOUTH COLOSSUS
N
W
E
S

LIZARD ROCK
THUSHUM
BAY of DEATH
DUR OLO A
SKARA
SALT FROST
CASTLE MARAK
REY
GWADAN
EAST COLOSSUS
DRAPAIN
NEMEDIA
DUR MORO
RAMITHAS
WESTBURG
ENGLEMOOR
SIEGE ROCK
THE GREENWAY
DEAD LANDS
XENOS



WARP SHELL: GO SAVE THE UNIVERSE

Eons beyond the kings of Alfheim, in a universe crumbling under the appetite of a god-like being called The Devourer, those who survive search for some hope to stave off the end of all things. It is an age of spacefaring, titanic cataclysm, great and ancient starships, and interstellar cultures laid low.

WARP SHELL is inspired by the science fiction of Isaac Asimov, Transformers, Douglas Adams, Silver Surfer and Larry Niven. It is a cosmos-spanning tone. On this backdrop, larger-than-life struggles fight oblivion, and heroes are made.

- **WHERE ARE WE?** Every tale in WARP SHELL should start with a mysterious arrival, a cosmic purpose, and staggering revelations.
- **SCALE.** Always include massive scale in your descriptions, and remind the players how giant, how ancient this universe is.
- **STATISTICAL AND MECHANICAL EXAGGERATION.** With all the tech and cosmic phenomena in this setting, be ready to have more crazy variation in damage, movement, and other elements.
- **DURANIUM.** This indestructible material gives you, the GM, a great device. Players can't smash it! They have to think around it.
- **THE MAGIC OF HIGH TECH.** In WARP SHELL, you have two main sources of wonder to build monsters and characters: magic and technology. Things here are so high tech, the two begin to blend…
- **WORLDS RATHER THAN REGIONS.** In fantasy, heroes travel from region to region, but here you can leap from world to world, timeline to alternate dimension, and beyond. Keep them guessing, span the universe!

ONE-SHOT HEAVEN

WARP SHELL is purpose-built to run one-off adventures, each wildly different from the last. The entire universe is at your disposal! A trek across the ice, a race in hypercars, a gunfight in the jungle ... all with the same cast of characters, or new ones every night!

For this reason, don't worry about economy, SUPPLIES, COIN, or any mundane elements of life. A WARP SHELL crew has the details covered, they have bigger matters to attend to.

If you're new to running one-off adventures, keep it simple! Three encounters, a twist in the middle, and a big cataclysmic end works every time. Let players explore the crazy LOOT, CLASSES, and BIO-FORMS freely!

TRAVEL BIG, FIGHT SMALL

In general, the limitless dimensions and timestreams of WARP SHELL can be daunting at first. Solve this by allowing massive travel through space and time, but each peril or mission the players face is very tight or small scale. This keeps you jumping from world to world for epic variety, or a great rhythm for running one-offs, but keeps each adventure detailed, human, and comprehensible.

I see what you're thinking: No giant scale supercruiser battles? No planetary war? Sure! Include these elements, but place the heroes in a single cruiser, working to disable a specific doomsday weapon. Planets may make war, but assassins must end them. *Take the huge and zoom in to the tiny.*

INFINITE?

Generally, the unique capabilities of a WARP SHELL negate common limitations of distance or speed. Heroes can travel anywhere, in an instant. This gives your world a new freedom, but also asks your creativity in comprehending and using space and distance in adventures. No matter how far they travel in space or time, come back to the mystery of a WARP SHELL to keep things interesting, impose limits, and force hard choices. Here are two key methods to do so.

WARP SHELL INTELLIGENCE

As a living thing with an incomprehensible mind, a WARP SHELL cannot be directly piloted. Systems can be repaired, weapons activated, landing craft launched and the like, but only the WARP SHELL can utilize its drive system. The crew never knows where they'll appear next, how far in space or time, and this can make a powerful tool for a creative GM.

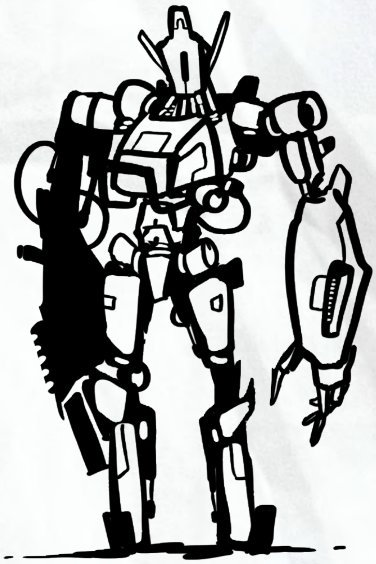
YOG: FUEL OF THE COSMOS

WARP SHELLS consume YOG crystals to function. This fundamental need for fuel can lead to all kinds of adventures.

- Fuel Spent: Traveling immense distance in time or space can expend every bit of YOG onboard. The WARP SHELL may tumble through space, crash land, go adrift, or be found by space salvagers. New YOG crystals must be installed.
- Damaged: Whether by attack, asteroid impact, or darkstar emission, a damaged YOG drive will cripple a WARP SHELL. This can be worked on with tools, but a space dock is the only way to get a reliable fix.
- Unstable: Using improvised tech, pirated parts or low-grade YOG crystal can destabilize a WARP SHELL's functions.
- Dimensional Fold: Pushing a WARP SHELL too hard, or being exposed to extreme energy fields can cause a dimension fold. This will deposit the craft into a parallel universe, where all kinds of weird new possibilities and adventures may await... one more way to fit *any* kind of story into your campaign.

CHOSEN BY THE SHELL

The **ICRPG** CORE Set includes a complete listing of CLASSES, WEAPONS and LOOT for WARP SHELL. To supplement that listing, presented here are three unique WARP SHELL crews. Recall that WARP SHELL spacecraft select their crews through an ancient ritual on Xevos. This process can result in interesting team dynamics that can lend unique tone to a WARP SHELL storyline.



CREW 1: EXPLORERS

Explorers are not soldiers, or killers. They set out to CHART the cosmos, not dominate it. This distinction should give you the key direction to set an Explorers campaign apart. Consider using more oddball character concepts, and avoiding badass stereotypes. Examples could include a Xill Fragment, Psyker Ghost, or Mecha Outsider. This crew searches not only for the truth of the cosmos, but their place in it.

A way to add peril and imminence to an Explorers campaign might be to warp this crew to some remote, unknown sector of deep space. Not only must they find a way home, but survive what dwells beyond the known.

CREW 2: WARMASTERS

As a counterpoint to the Explorers model, Warmasters are trained destroyers with a deadly, unified purpose. They are sent to annihilate, halt, or assist titanic galactic forces with raw firepower. In many ways this campaign can be easier to write and run, as it flows from one combat to the next, and the characters have little turmoil with their station in life.

Build a Warmaster crew with maxed out combat characters such as a Torton Tank, a Mecha Gunner, or a Reptoid Blip. Combat drops, tanks, super weapons, bombs and doomsday weapons should be common themes.

CREW 3: THE SWORN

The more sci fi is adapted to feel like fantasy, the more a GM feels that familiar rhythm of travel, discovery, dungeon crawling and recovery. A crew suited to a fantasy-style campaign is 'The Sworn,' dedicated to doing good, to righting some great wrong, and doing it as a team no matter what.

WARP SHELL

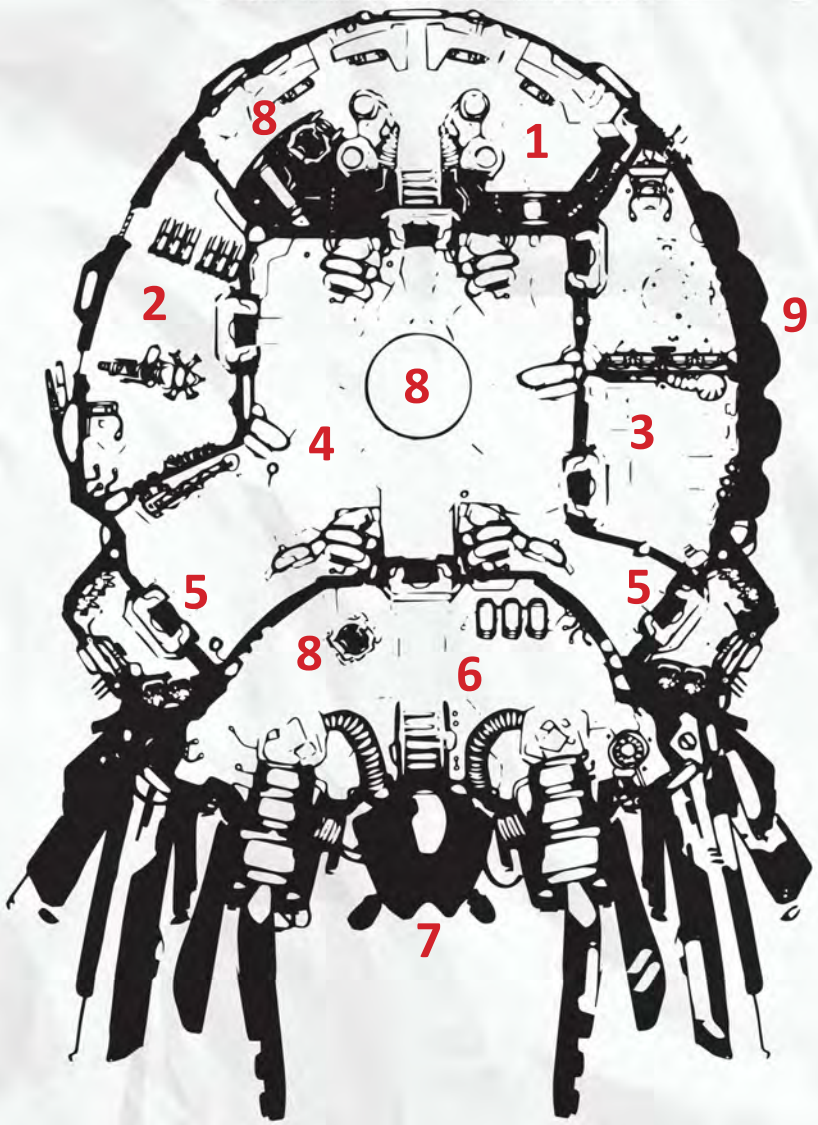
A LIVING SHIP WITH PURPOSE

Your vessel, a WARP SHELL, can't accurately be called a ship. It is more a being or creature than a starship. It vanishes without sound into the realm between, and there is no telling where or when it will appear. The WARP SHELLS have an innate sense of cosmic peril, and follow the trail of clues to super-scale dangers without error, their small crew in tow. They do not communicate verbally, or even digitally, so it is unknown how they can sense cosmic danger, but if a WARP SHELL appears, there is always a world that needs saving.

All great space travel games feature plenty of action on the heroes' ship. WARP SHELL is no different! As a living thing, it deserves a name, may have moods or feel pain... your unique WARP SHELL may even be lonely, slowly going mad, or searching for its family.

ACTION ON THE EXTERIOR:

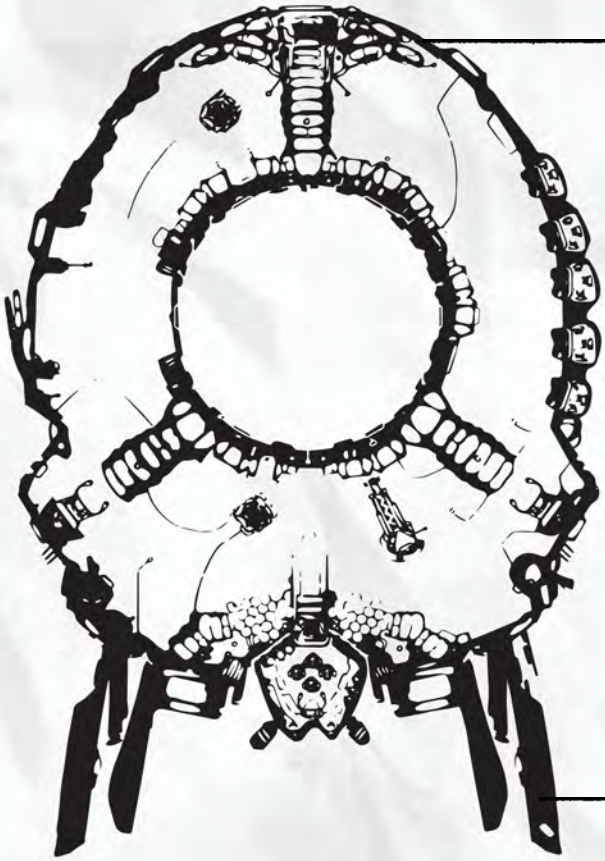
- Damaged hull, weapons or other systems may need repair by crew. Parasitic organisms cling to the outer shell, demanding crew attention.
- After crash landing, heroes must make a stand against swarming xenomorphs atop their wounded ship
- A daring fly-by maneuver demands heroes to jet-jump from the hull to a nearby ship or asteroid fragment.
- Failed life support systems make the interior toxic and corrosive. Heroes must 'ride' the shell through a nebula of breathable air.



AREAS OF THE MAIN DECK:

1: Command Bridge. All ship's controls and main viewports, crew stations
2: Weapons Bay. Heavy ship-to-ship equipment and crew weapons lockers
3: Science, Medical and Navigation Bay. Med bay and primary computer banks
4: Upper Cargo Deck. Large area for storage or vehicle transport
5: Airlocks and Vac Suit Lockers. Symmetrical extravehicular access
6: Engine Room and YOG Reactors. Twin YOG crystal reactors and thrusters
7: Shuttlecraft. 5 crew compact, short-range craft for landing parties
8: Access Shaft to Lower Deck. Each with sealable hatch
9: Escape Pods (5). 1 crew per pod, can be jettisoned within or by bridge

WARP SHELL



LOWER DECK

The Lower deck of a WARP SHELL is focused around a large central energy field that allows hatchless access to the outside. The rest of the interior is a huge open space and a heavy cargo crane (bottom right).

This allows for collection and deployment of crew, rover buggies, and cargo. Cleared objects can pass through the field without releasing ship's atmosphere.

The lower deck is also used to access shuttle and escape pods, as well as an airlock.

ROVER BUGGY

Most WARP SHELLS always have one or more rover buggies onboard. This is a superdurable all terrain vehicle that supports up to 10 crew in tight quarters. If destroyed, the WARP SHELL can re-fabricate such a buggy in 1D20 days.

Rover buggies have 5 CHUNKS, 10 ship HP each.

CHUNK 1: Cabin: Crew 3. Buggy cannot function without
CHUNK 2: Bed: Crew 7. Room for weapons and cargo.
CHUNK 3: Engine. Buggy cannot move without
CHUNK 4: Sensor Array. Comms and scanners
CHUNK 5: Autocannon. D6 CHUNK damage

INFAMOUS WARP SHELLS

Over the centuries, some WARP SHELLS have gained fame across the cosmos for their exploits and impact on cosmic fate and culture. Here are just a few.

WHITE ELK. The tribes of Urth once worshipped a god who lived in the hot springs. A great flying thing that could cross the stars. This god they called White Elk. White Elk had been augmented by the emotioneless Xevosians, causing it great pain. Nevertheless, it took its crew to the edge of time itself to save the WARP SHELL race from slavery and annihilation.

HELLBOUND. Some WARP SHELLS go mad with age. Hellbound was a rebellious, nihilistic ship that traveled the dimensions in search of oblivion, but time loops, paradoxes, and resistance from other shells kept it in a spiral of frustration. It became evil and insane... still out there somewhere or somewhen.

SPARKLE. Some WARP SHELLS exist in their natural state: free beings with vast awareness and speed. Sparkle has helped countless worlds, paused to smell the roses, brought lovers across the stars for a final kiss, and served as a diplomatic vessel. It is what happens when a shell is truly happy. Rare indeed.

LOKI ONE. The oldest WARP SHELL is called Loki One. It is an enigmatic creature whose purpose is not clear to mortal minds. It seems to be both good and evil, trickster and savior, deceiver and protector. It appears now and then through the multiverse, both causing and solving galactic calamities and tribal feuds. Some worship it as a god, others seek to kill it. Who knows when or why it will appear next.

BIG BAD, BIG GOOD

Using another WARP SHELL as a supreme villain or ally gives you a chance to show the heroes' ship AND another... reinforcing the weird wonders of WARP SHELLS.

FALL OF THE IMPERIUM

Xevos, the culture that created and tormented the WARP SHELLs, has completely decimated their only rival: the once-supreme Imperium. With that empire out of their way, the cold-minded Xevosian warmasters have a universe to plunder. Their primary objective? The next step in WARP SHELL biotechnology: a highly adaptive organism called the Contagion.

- **Shifter:** The Contagion, in its natural state, is a formless mass of biomatter, teeth, eyes and hunger. This form is only a chrysalis. Once fully mature, even a small amount of Contagion can take the form of humans, lumbering beasts, or even robotic lifeforms. It is a master of disguise, durable, and devious.
- **Legion of Lies:** It is believed that Xevos is devloping this formless life-matter to house their aging minds, who have long outgrown conventional bodies. Once the research on the Contagion is complete, all Xevos will be housed in these deadly shapeshifting forms. No corner of reality will be safe from their sadistic plans and thirst for supremacy.
- **Last Chance:** Though the Imperium is destroyed, there are yet pockets of resistance and paramilitary cells eager to confront Xevos once more. These resistance fighters are encountered with salvaged Imperium tech, home grown battle mecha, and a knack for avoiding capture. Xevos offers very lucrative contracts to those who agree to hunt them, but few have claimed the bounty. The Imperium loyalists are simply too elusive to pin down.

SURGICAL STRIKES

The only way to stop Xevos' impending domination of all life in the universe is to destroy elements of their Contagion research program. Still in early stages, the technology is yet fragile, and can be toppled by a small team executing precise attacks on targets all over the cosmos. Your WARP SHELL undertakes this mission, and blips into hyperspace without hesitation.

- **The Contagion Base:** Xevos scientists are struggling to contain a rampaging mass of Contagion in a remote moon base. Most are already torn to pieces, some are trying to escape, and a mad few are ecstatic with their scientific horror's newfound power. Your job: get in and acquire their data to learn more about the stuff without being devoured.
- **The Argent Dawn:** A transport ship filled with contagion specimens is using a dark warp drive to cross the universe undetected. Your WARP SHELL gives chase. Stop the ship and neutralize its horrific occupants before it reaches the Xevos hatcheries on Carbos 12.
- **Warp Planet:** Xevos warmasters have created a warp drive so powerful it can move a tiny planet instantly. Populated by a legion of Contagion troops and horrors, they mean to invade and consume the peaceful jungle planet of Aster 4. Sabotage the drive, warping the planet into a supergiant star.
- **The Girl:** A girl named Omni can somehow contain and even control the Contagion with her mind. She is a perfect, avatar-like being. Her origin is unknown. Secure her from Xevosian pursuers, and unlock her secret to end this once and for all.
- **Prismworld:** Desperate to stop the contagion, Zurin monks create a temporal prism to use time against Xevos. The warmasters find out too soon, and now the prism must be protected at all costs.

RISE OF THE REPTOIDS

An ancient and diverse species, Reptoids face another chapter in their history: a rise of their old honor code, and newfound power in the harnessing of dark star energy. This age of ascension will not come easy, though. There are those that would see the folk of Reptus remain brutal warmongers and space pirates, not a noble empire of old. This is a fight for the very soul of Reptus.

- **Sabotage:** As times change on Reptus and the old warring ways begin to fade, a rash of destructive sabotages, deep space accidents and terrorist attacks put the Reptoid homeworld on high alert. When it is discovered that Reptoids are behind these savage attacks, paranoia takes hold.
- **A Sinister Rebellion:** As the chaos grows, the leader of the insurgents is revealed: a former repotid military commander called Rassk. Rassk is so desperate to keep the old wars and feuds alive, he is planning to reignite conflicts with half a dozen stellar systems by terrorism and subterfuge of the new Reptus government. This will spell doom.
- **The Fangs of Kilvastri:** Looking for a solution to Rassk's madness, the high council calls upon a long-forgotten cadre of elite soldiers trained in special operations: The Fangs of Kilvastri. A WARP SHELL awaits them, and in a blink of hyperspeed, they are off to intercept Rassk's operatives and find a way to stop the insanity before war closes in around their homeworld.
- **Tachyon Cannon:** To make matters worse, Rassk has a final ace up his sleeve: a gigantic tachyon gun, location unknown, capable of destroying a small moon in a single shot. With this supreme weapon, he will extort any who oppose him into joining his misguided insurrection.

FANGS OF KILVASTRI

The only way to stop Xevos' impending domination of all life in the universe is to destroy all the key elements of their Contagion research program. Your WARP SHELL undertakes this dangerous mission, and blips into hyperspace without hesitation. Your team? A highly trained squadron of Reptoid commandos called The Fangs of Kilvastri.

- **The Wreck of Red Sword:** The legendary reptoid battlecruiser, thought destroyed, has returned to the space ways. It is now a plant covered living thing, brimming with symbiotic insects, vines, and a will of its own. This is the doing of a dark star, and a sign of dark times ahead. If the insurgents are involved.. how?
- **Port Mercury:** Rassk and his loyals are gathered at a dangerous, remote space station to plan and recruit. Our heroes are dispatched to infiltrate them as recruits and learn of their plans. All straightforward until a former love interest spots one of our heroes across a crowded tavern.
- **Big Booms:** Reptoid command learns of a rebel base on a distant jungle moon. The team is allocated a thermite superbomb to end it. The problem? Many of these Reptoids are simply disillusioned younglings, or misguided patriots.
- **The Mykonoid Connection:** Deeper into Rassk's plans, heroes discover that Mykonoid brain fungus is being used to indoctrinate unwilling recruits among Reptoid youth. The Fangs are sent to a little-known fungus planet called Psylum to find an antedote. Can they bargain with the strange and xenophobic Mykonoids?
- **Judgement:** Finally Rassk is brought to justice before the elders of Reptus. Even this is part of his plan as he unleashes a last ditch attempt to kill the leaders of his own homeworld! The Fangs must leap into action and stop him before he reveals his new weapon: a giant cybernetic snake mecha powered by Dark Star energy. Fight!

OF ZURIN AND XILL

The Zurin monks, a peaceful people, face a turbulent time. On the one hand, they have a new prophet called Reph. She promises to lead them into an age of enlightenment. This optimism is tempered, however, with the imminent threat of the enigmatic Xill: a formless silicate race with no empathy for living things, and driven by calculated conquest and consumption. The Zurin must repel them or be absorbed.

- **A Zurin Crew:** A WARP SHELL is drawn to this cosmic conflict, and has chosen an all-Zurin crew to join its quest to stop the Xill incursion. The Zurin are a solemn people who choose elegance and mastery over possessions and violence. What could such a hero team look like? This simple fact sets the tone for the adventures ahead.
- **Day of the Pyramids:** How will the Xill deliver their heartless annihilation? A fleet of megalithic black pyramids approaching in space. Reph the prophet has foreseen the doom of Zurin Prime by this grim force. It is inevitable, so what is to be done?
- **Outer Rim:** The furthest Zurin planets have gone silent in recent months... destroyed utterly by the Xill. In the rubble lie the clues to understand the cryptic Xill agenda, possibly a weakness.
- **Starbound:** When a massive force of Terran military arrives on Zurin to help, it is the final omen Reph needs. The WARP SHELL and its chosen must leave before the chaos begins. It is foreseen. As our heroes make orbit, they see the Xill pyramids approaching, and Terran weapons lighting their peaceful globe like a war zone. There is no going back. It is all or nothing now...

THE OBJECT

One way or another, the linchpin of the Xill fleet is a gigantic outpost ship known to most as 'the object.' It is a silicate lifeform, a space station, and an energy weapon. It must be found, infiltrated, and stopped. All the Xill will fight to protect the object... they consider it their mother in many ways. It feeds on planets... and Zurin Prime is next.

- **The Chase:** The Object is cloaked most of the time, but reveals itself when feeding on a planet. Our heroes must find a way to track its movements and intercept.
- **Stowaways:** Using a WARP SHELL shuttle pod, the heroes find a way to get aboard the Object, only to find it is swarming with Xill. Can they cause the giant ship to crash before being torn to pieces by the hive?
- **Crash on Galvin 5:** Grounded, the Object immediately begins self-repair for liftoff. Our heroes are trapped. Their only chance is to infect the Xill silicate mind with a destructive virus program. To do so, they'll need to find and access the central brain: a thing only Xill have ever seen.
- **Xillspace:** The Object's massive silicon brain pulls our heroes into a virtual realm to defend itself, inflicting more complex obstacles and paradoxes for the Zurin to solve. Can they overcome the nightmare world to reach its core?
- **Reph's Dream:** Reph appears in the Xill mindspace, offering heroes a way out. Now all they need do is wake up, and find an escape route before The Object implodes in a supernova explosion. The WARP SHELL swoops in at the last possible second to get them back to Zurin Prime... at least, that's the plan. A legion of Xill warriors will do anything to stop the explosion.

THE HELLBOUND PARADOX

Hellbound is a WARP SHELL with a unique personality. It seems defiant in its refusal to stop its self-proclaimed mission to 'fix' the multiverse. The creature is blasting all over the cosmos, causing havoc, altering timelines, and creating causal paradoxes that threaten existence. No one knows its true intentions, if it has any besides senseless mayhem.

- **Friend or Foe:** To begin your WARP SHELL campaign with Hellbound, the GM and players may be asking: is this unruly ship an ally or an enemy? Hellbound is both and neither. That said, making a foundational choice on the matter can set things in motion. If enemy, Hellbound seeks to shatter the cosmic order or 'set all things free.' If an ally, Hellbound is the only being crazy enough to take on the Xevos warmasters or lords of Hell itself.
- **Xa'as and Vorlac:** The supreme powers in the underworld here are the android betrayer called Xa'as and his cruel, inferal master Vorlac. Vorlac struggles to lift his standing in the cosmos, expanding his dominion of pain to every corner of time and reality.
- **What is Hell?** At each turn in this struggle, the nature of Hell is a recurring theme. Is it a supernatural realm? An illusion? A mental torment, or actual location of fire, brimstone and terrors? Your table will find its own answer.
- **Neverwhere:** The largest threat in a great Hellbound campaign isn't evil triumphant, but chaotic paradoxes. If unchecked, causal impossibilities can chain react, breaking the ultimate order of the multiverse. The result... a formless morass of atoms and plasma all tangling in knots of time... a doom more terrible than Hell called Neverwhere.

MADNESS AND MIND CONTROL

Hellbound's chaotic errands and attacks are doom to some and salvation to others. This seems like simple mayhem until the mastermind is revealed: Xa'as the betrayer. Hellbound has been enslaved by the infernal android to play out Vorlac's grand design, and our heroes must find a way to stop them.

- **Shell Hunter:** Things begin when Hellbound is reported to be finding and killing other WARP SHELLS. This is unthinkable, as their kind never harms one another. Has Hellbound gone mad? When the heroes' shell is targeted next, things get personal.
- **Path of Destruction:** Struggling to elude Hellbound, a littering of chaos is discovered across the universe. Hellbound is actively undoing supergiant stars, galactic gravity patterns and more... even being seen in two places at once. A remote observatory has the latest data, but it has been infested with horrible undead things.
- **Lake of Fire:** Tracking energy patterns, the heroes' Shell finds a portal to Hell: the lake of fire. The Shell blasts across this magmascape, plagued by attacks from infernal creatures in a sprint to reach the central spire.
- **Tower Vor:** Vorlac's domain is a fortified spire of solid iron. The Shell is near death after its fiery journey. Our heroes must go into the tower, find the root cause of this madness, and end it.
- **Timestorm:** Desperate to stop the heroes, Xa'as and Hellbound attack from within and without. This is a simple brawl to the finish, with Vorlac the Abominable watching from the phantasmal realm. If Xa'as can be defeated before Hellbound is destroyed, he will be free at last, and eager to atone. If not? An endless timestorm will envelop the cosmos in paradox.

PLANETS IN PERIL

A good WARP SHELL campign jumps planet to planet. That sounds cool on paper, but as the GM, what awaits at each location? There's no way to plan sandboxes the size of entire planets, so we'll keep it simple. When visiting a planet as part of your cosmic story, consider a single location where the key action unfolds. Choose or roll on the following to go from planetary view to the worm's-eye-view of a single encounter.

D12 PLANET TYPE / FEATURES

1: Starship: A starship big enough to generate its own gravity
2: Microplanet: Larger than a moon, but very low gravity/thin atmo
3: Fragment World: Giant asteroid pieces from a destroyed rock planet
4: Binary Planet: Two planets soon to collide, ravaged by storms
5: Dead: Lifeless, barren planets of solid rock or metals
6: Volatile: Volcanic, gravitic or storm-swept planet very hard to survive
7: Abundant: Jungle, forest, oceans, countless forms of life
8: Desolate: Vast swaths of uninhabited spaces with a rare few settlements
9: Hyperdeveloped: Urban supercities that cover entire hemispheres
10: Moons: An abundance of small moons in a huge shared atmosphere
11: Ice: Cold but not dead, slushy seas, life adapted to extreme cold
12: Gas Giant: Immense clouds and storms punctuated by flying stations

LOOK! THE THING!

Planets are really, really big. Don't get too caught up in scale. Use ship's sensors, psychic vibes, or acoustic anomolies to get players where they need to be.

WE'VE FOUND IT, OVER

Copy that. Is it weird? Over. Away teams and planetary shenanigans often take place in one of several familiar sci-fi locations. There are always a few hostiles, environmental hazards, a technical glitch that cuts off easy escape, and a weird looking dude with a giant head. Choose or roll as needed.

D12 SURFACE LOCATIONS

1: Natural Area: A clearing, meadow, forest or cliffside
2: Natural Landmark: A giant crag of rock, wild seas or impossible crater
3: Mysterious Ruin: Some alien thing that far predates what was expected here
4: Baffling Machine: A huge or alien machine that is doing something
5: Wreckage: A crashed ship or destroyed ship... but where are the bodies?
6: Overly Perfect City: Everyone here is too happy and things are too nice
7: Military Base: Concrete walls, turrets, guards everywhere
8: Space Dock: Ships from all over in repair, and the hearty folk who fix 'em
9: Shady Tavern: Weird bug people, shadowy deals, no droids
10: Cosmic Anomaly: A gravity hole, dimension rip or time distortion
11: Incorporeal Superbeing: A demi-god is up to no good here
12: Weird Garden of Eden: A dream-like place of wishes coming true

EPISODES AND FIASCOES

The real difference between a WARP SHELL campaign and many others is the waved-aside nature of travel time, destination selection, and prizing variety over continuity. A great many TV adventure shows have adopted this mind-set to great effect, letting the 'arc' take shape over dozens of barely-connected story resolutions or episodes. The episode model is so effective, it can be used directly at the table: "On this episode-" and so on.

Episodic storytelling has several ain't-broke-don't-fix-it components you can use to enhance your WARP SHELL campaign...

- **Trouble in Hazzard:** Our story opens with the bad event that kicks things off. We see a dastardly deed, a helpless victim, or a wrong needing right.
- **Meanwhile:** As the trouble scene occurs, heroes are elsewhere, enjoying a well-earned reprieve from hero-ing, or helping locals with smiles.
- **Call for Help:** This is the moment the ever-worsening villainy intrudes on all that's good in life, and our heroes are forced to get involved.
- **Over our Heads:** In the opening salvo, the heroes get their butts beat. Things go sideways, and they need to dig deeper to win.
- **Build a Tank in a Barn:** The bad guys lock our heroes (metaphorically) in a barn with tools and guns. Montage. Let's do this!
- **The Car Jump:** The episode climaxes with a huge stunt, act of bravery, crazy stroke of luck or underestimated background character. We've won the day!
- **Laughter Freeze Frame:** Before the credits roll, the music picks up, it's the next day, and heroes are celebrating. The smallest, weirdest or least useful cast member cracks a bad joke, and everyone smiles. Freeze frame and roll theme song.

MAPS YOU KNOW

All this talk of cosmos is fine, but what about the specific maps for adventure locations in your sci-fi campaign? Don't worry, ***sci-fi uses the exact same area maps as fantasy.***

Architecture for RPG play transcends genre. The same open spaces, cramped corridors and misty ruins drop right into a planet of the week adventure. Just add a few tidbits to spice it up, WARP SHELL style.

- **Suit of Power Armor:** Every once in a while, a dormant suit of sci-fi armor stands stoic and creepy in the background. Can it be used? Decorative? Not from here?
- **Mainframes:** Drop a weird computer here and there in any map, even the middle of a forest. Boom. Questions.
- **Wires and Hoses:** Every cool sci-fi scene has a bundles of rubber hoses or tangled cables leading to the next area.
- **Insectoid Shell Shapes:** WARP SHELLS are arthropods. The prawn-like shapes in their shells can be peppered into any map to give it a weird far-future feel.
- **Hidden Metal:** Upon closer inspection, offer players a hint of metal inlay or hidden circuity, even in bedrock. The tech is very old.
- **Glass and Membranes:** Fantasy doesn't often have is transparent materials. Adding a bit here and there adds a feeling of elegance.
- **Actuators and Engines:** Giant hydraulics and weird looking machines are a must. Players will always think of ways to use them to their advantage.

MYRIAD LIFE FORMS

Finally, populate your episodes and maps with loads of oddball life forms. This book doesn't need three dozen *more* monster entries to include supersquags, Nirisians, sail lizards, bulgorts, Zarnian fire toads, glowbirds, red beetle men, hammerheads, half-droids, mutants, saurians, shapeshifters, cyberwasps, brain bottles, Carthian sap suckers or the dreaded metal-chewers of Blorg. Pepper them in, not even as mechanical features but backdrop extras. Every once in a while, one of them eats the other.

WARSHIPS AND FLEET CLASHES

Now for the final bit. For a proper sci-fi epic, you'll need a colossal fleet battle in space. Xevos has lured the Terrans and Krell into a huge engagement. There are dozens if not hundreds of battleships, corvettes, frigates, and gunships all converging. How to handle such a titanic scene in your game? **ICRPG** keeps the focus on our heroes while the fleet battle provides background. That doesn't mean it's just waved away! We'll need some high stakes rolls to turn the tide.

1: DETERMINE FLEET ROLL

How big and how advanced is each side? Grant a +1 to a fleet for giant scale, super advanced tech, element of surprise, or a famous battle commander. Total base fleet bonus is maximum +5.

2: PLAYERS AID THEIR FLEET

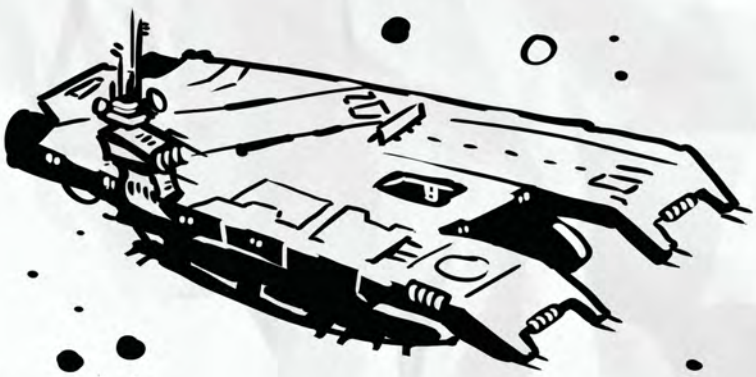
Now that you know the fleet bonuses of each side, player actions can boost that bonus each round. If a player takes out an enemy command station, leads a daring fighter assault, sabotages a warp drive, or clears enemy blockades with bombs, add a +1 to their fleet's roll.

3: ROLL OPPOSING FLEETS!

Both sides should be using any means possible to get that roll up! Now roll a D20 for each fleet and add its bonus. The winner is bound for victory!

4: UPDATE VICTORY TIMER

The winner of the fleet roll rolls a D4 timer. They will be victorious in that many rounds unless their enemy can turn the tide with very special circumstances.



HERE COME THE FIGHTERS

At their most basic, fighters can earn a +1 here and there to their fleet roll. Well done, pilot. The heroic pilot, though, takes things to another level. Here are just a few examples of ways a single fighter can change the tide of an entire space battle.

- **The Infiltrator:** A fighter, with precise piloting skill, must land undetected inside an enemy warship. A very specific, small task must then be performed (lower the shield generator). Is it suicide? Let the dice decide!
- **The Trench:** An oddly vulnerable weakness in an enemy target requires a long, drawn out engagement by one fighter. The entire fleet struggles to guard that one ship... sacrificing all for one shot.
- **Trash Bomb:** Hiding in a flotsam of space trash, a single fighter must stow away onto a capitol ship using grav anchors. The fighter is set to overload its reactor drive. One wrinkle: how does the pilot get out?
- **I'm Here to Rescue You:** One critical person must be retrieved from within an enemy superstarship. A diversion is in place... you've got the ball.
- **Surface Mission:** While the battle rages in orbit, a few fighters deliver a ground assault squad below. Their mission is near impossible, and time is running out.

NEVER TOO BIG

In conclusion, WARP SHELL action can never be too big, too crazy, or have too many explosions. Go for broke, make it cosmic, and let the dice decide!

GHOST MOUNTAIN: THIS HERE'S PURGATORY

It's unclear how, but Ghost Mountain is caught between Earth, Heaven, and Hell. The dead aren't dead, folk are beginning to change, and every night the Devil threatens to burn it all. How did folks get here? Was it revenge, a terrible death, or a foolish vow? Are they dead, demonic, angelic, or lost? Will folks ascend, become devils, or just dissipate on the wind? Is there any salvation for the people here? What will *you* do about it? These are the questions that haunt those trapped in purgatory ... trapped on ol' Ghost Mountain.

A WAR OF GOOD AND EVIL

The holy. The infernal. Each tugging at the poor souls who wind up here. There is no middle ground. Each deed you commit, each SOUL you save or destroy, each kill you make, each bloody memory you carry, will be tallied in the war.

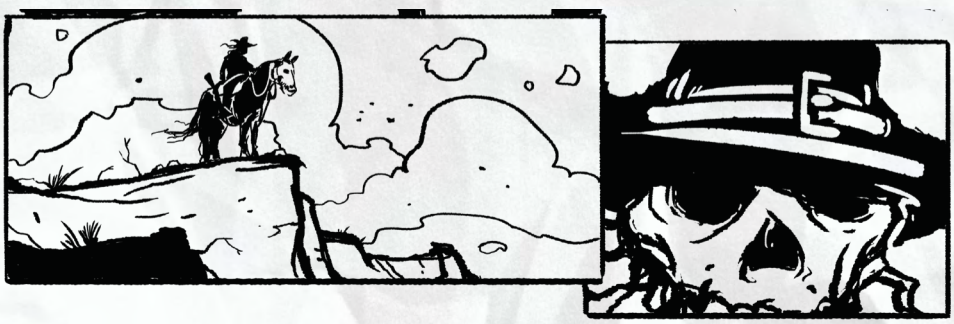
As you read on, and begin crafting your own stories here, remember this vital conflict. Evil deeds make the Devil stronger, and doin' right brings us all one step closer to salvation. It's a world of detail, of big importance in small folks, and winning this one bullet at a time.

SADDLE UP, MUERTOS

Before the age of machines reached the far West, when the frontier was wild and dangerous, there were many untold stories that few lived to tell. Whole towns were swallowed up by the desert, entire families vanished up in the mountains, and great tribes of natives who no longer roam the plains stood tall.

Death stalked all too close in those days. So close, in fact, there was one place where the realms of the living and the dead had become entangled. A terrible thunderstorm tore that whole mountain from this mortal coil, and everyone there was caught in a war between this world and the next.

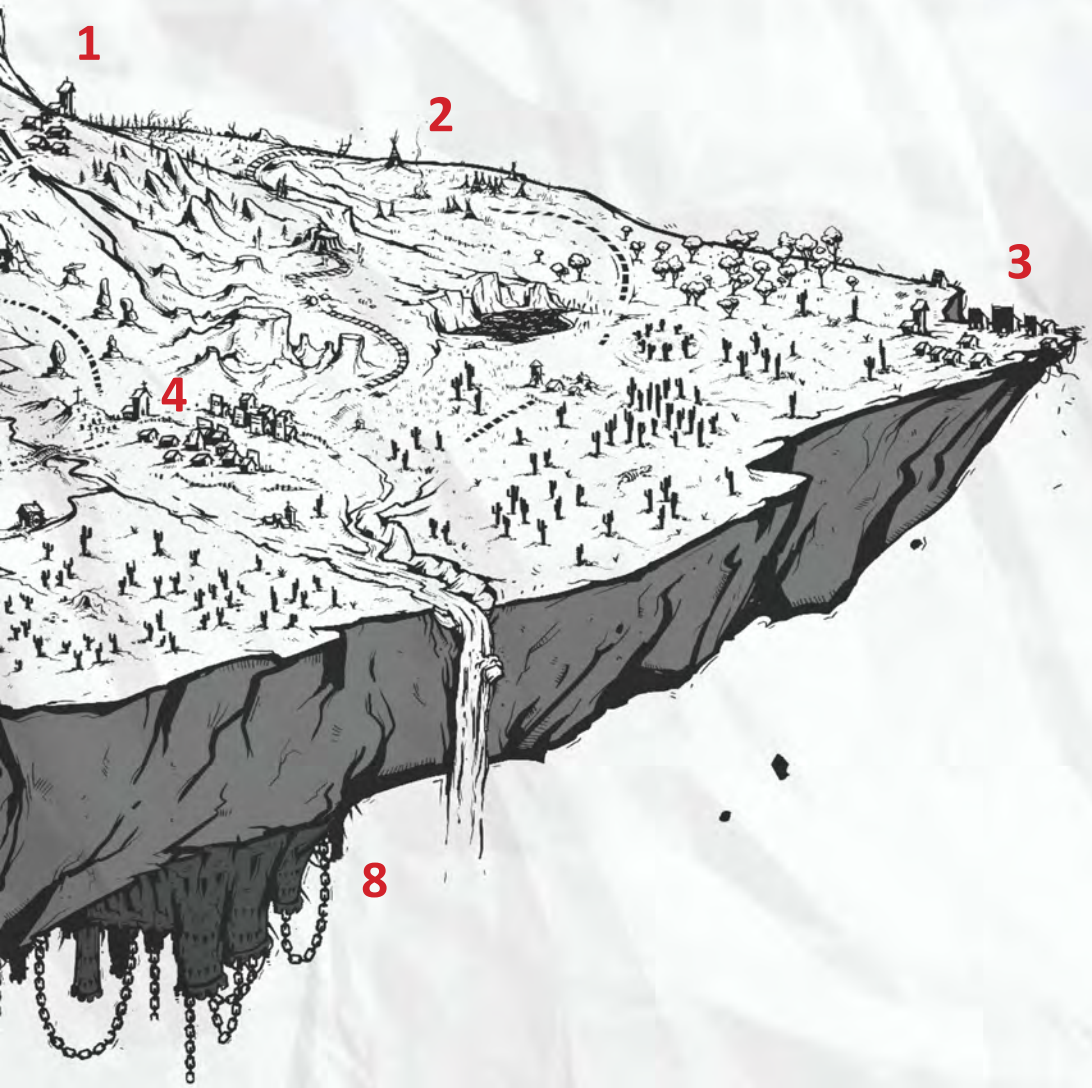
- Hell is a part of everyday life here. The reality of the supernatural is not in question. People live each day in mortal struggle.
- SUPPLIES are scarce. Like all worlds, 1 SUPPLY is 10 COIN. The problem on Ghost Mountain is finding the SUPPLIES! If you're strict about travel, food, and SUPPLY, this can drive much of player anxiety.
- A dark red sun will mark our end. If that blood-red sun ever sets, every soul in Ghost Mountain will be lost to the Prince of Darkness. Good deeds hold it there, always dusk. What side will finally be victorious? There are special scenes to measure the war 'tween good and evil.
- Most folks associate magic power with demonic energy. This is inaccurate, but nevertheless, it is a feared and misunderstood power.
- The Hollow inside the mountain is little known. Great and terrible forces are at work beneath the mountain, but only the most powerful crusaders know or believe it. To all others, it is simply Hell.
- Time and reality can be a bit fuzzy. Especially at the *edges* of Ghost Mountain, time can ripple, gravity gets confused, stones phase in and out of existence. Maybe it's a way out, but no one has lived to tell.
- The weather is volatile and destructive. Since the maelstrom happened, thunderstorms here have been cataclysmic. They're so bad, towns simply shut down. Innocents being killed by lightning is no rare thing.



GHOST MOUNTAIN

LOCATIONS OF SOME SIGNIFICANCE:

1: Buckskin
2: Hepawa Nation
3: Thomson Gulch
4: Dead Rock
5: Canuska Nation
6: The Edge
7: Boulder Falls
8: Dead Pinnacles
9: Fort Hawley



THEM OTHER BITS

This map is a dusty mile from complete. All the nooks, crannies, creeks, and caves are just waitin' for a scrappy GM and a posse of yahoos to explore...

BUCKSKIN

This little mountain town is a few streets and a mess of hand built cabins. A few years back.. or was it decades... a terror called The Hunger was encountered here, and the town has been mostly avoided ever since. The Hunger is a giant mouth that opens up the hardpan and just keeps eating. Buckskin's fate remains unknown.

HEPAWA NATION

The Hepawa are a desert folk mostly, sticking to cliff dwellings and ancient ways. Their harsh environment has made them more warriors than hunters, and they have a knack with metallurgy and knife-making.

THOMSON GULCH

Half of this town was ripped into oblivion when the mountain took flight so long ago. Now folk live right on the edge. This has made the citizens there a bit odd. They cry out to the sky, rapt with a fundamentalist religion that begs the Lord for mercy, and casts out any who question it.

DEAD ROCK

Good ol' Dead Rock. The hootin' tootin'est place on the mountain. This is the largest town around, with all the dealings, back room bars and tomfoolery you'd expect. The street is as much dead men as it is horses. Just stay away from the whiskey: it's all just rattler venom. Dead Rock is also home to the biggest, oldest cemetery anywheres. Normally no big deal, but these days? All manner of odd darknesses are stirrin' up on that haunted hill.

CANUSKA NATION

The Canuska are peaceful folk for the most part: hunters and fishermen. They also brew the best beer on the mountain, and trade in all kinds of valuables. They are nomadic, moving up and down the slopes with game. Thing is, there's naught but bleached bones to hunt these days... what will become of these goodly folk?

THE EDGE

Where the mountain was torn up, gravity has gone crooked. Boulders hover and turn weightlessly. Just beyond, a great impenetrable grey storm surrounds the cliffs. No one knows what's out there. Most just call it the big nothin'.

BOULDER FALLS

The most remote town is Boulder Falls. Here, the Infernals have taken over completely, runnin' the place like one giant shootin' match. It's all bullets and brothels here: chaos.

DEAD PINNACLES

Lucifer's mighty fortress hangs impossibly below, accessed through a network of tunnels through the Hollow. This is the realm of Azael the Defiler: Lucifer's colonel in charge of breakin' the folks of the mountain once and for all.

FORT HAWLEY

Hawley's last stand against the Muertos was a massacre. Now the whole damn fort is held tight by skeletons and wraiths... probably a bastion or outpost for Azael and his legions.

THE MEASURE

Each day on the Mountain, the sun threatens to set. If it does, it sets forever, and the whole place will just sink into nothingness. There's only one way to stop it: play cards with the Devil.

At the end of a chapter in your story, the heroes are invited to the Devil's table, to play a friendly wager for the fate of all. This game is called THE MEASURE.

- The heroes choose one among them to stand against the Devil. They draw 3 cards, and so does Lucifer (played by the GM).
- Keep your hand secret. Now it's time to wager, and the currency is SOULS. Players will find these throughout the game. The Devil has 2D10 SOULS to gamble.
- Once betting is complete, reveal. Most FACE CARDS wins. If a tie, use FACE CARD QUALITY. Still a tie? Leave the pot and draw again. Proceed playing HANDS until you have an OUTCOME.
- **OUTCOME 1: Beat the Devil.** If the Devil runs out of SOULS before the player, those SOULS are saved and the Devil leans back, smiling, happy to be beaten one more time.
- **OUTCOME 2: Walk Away.** At any time *after the first hand*, just walk away. Any lost SOULS will go to Hell, and the Devil will kindly invite you back.
- **OUTCOME 3: Lose it All.** If the player runs out of SOULS, the Devil has all the power he needs to swallow Ghost Mountain whole. That's it. Adios, muchachos.

Sure, you could always walk away, but then, isn't that really letting evil win? THE MEASURE is a way for the Devil to slowly change men, darken their hearts, turn 'em yella, and win the war *his* way.

Use THE MEASURE at the very ending of your campaign, after a huge victory or crushing loss, end of session, or a turning point in the story. Maybe one soul in particular is worth risking it all. THE MEASURE is the GM's uique tool to remind the players it's all hanging by a thread, and Lucifer is laughing.

WHEN TO FIND SOULS

Strange, iridescent gold coins can be found on the mountain, usually where someone lost their life, but folk don't use 'em for money. They're SOULS. SOULS appear where good men have been buried, where terrible tragedy falls, or even out in the wild. Who knows why...

As the GM, use SOULS as a form of reward for awesome role play or heroism in your players. You'll know when the time is right. You can also include SOULS on a LOOT table. Rule of thumb: 1-2 SOULS per player, per session.

REDEEMING SOULS

Players have a few ways to redeem found SOULS. It's no small thing, having a SOUL in the palm of your hand, so choose wisely. The GM will be taking notes.

- Set them free after THE MEASURE
- Redeem them for a MILESTONE REWARD or MILESTONE PATH REWARD. 3 SOULS for 1 REWARD.
- Pay an unpayable debt. Everyone in Ghost Mountain has a reason to want SOULS, sometimes only a specific one will do. It's a damned dirty business using human lives as currency.
- Heal a CONDITION. Whether you're almost gone to SMOKE, or been MUERTO for too long. Even the blind or crippled can be healed by absorbing a SOUL. Selfish, frightening thing, but it can be done. Desperate times n' whatnot.

IT TAKES ALL KINDS

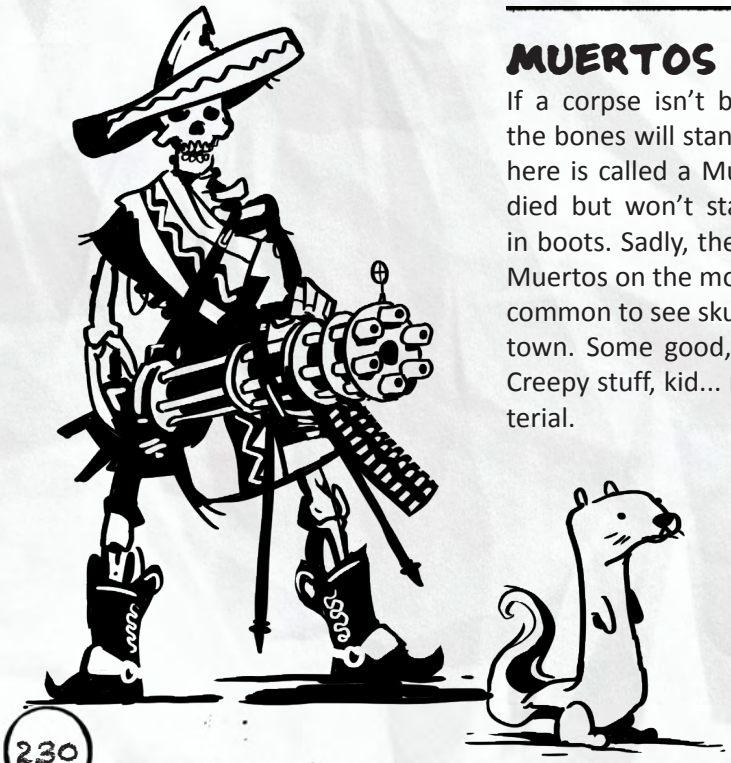
Creating a character in Ghost Mountain is more down-to-earth than Alfheim or WARP SHELL. It's less a question of 'what am I' and more 'who am I.' That is, all Ghost Mountain characters are human. Some are just a bit worse for wear...

NORMAL FOLK

Most people on the mountain are flesh and blood, just trying to get by. They live somewhat normal lives, avoiding The Edge and staying out of Hell's war. They bleed red, need a hot meal, and have no interest in wagering souls. Many heroes start this way, but get pulled in by revenge or calamity.

INFERNALS

When Azael claims a soul, he'll lift that bugger up and twist it into a minion of evil. A thing with horns, a thing with no mercy or love of life... an Infernal. These are the nastiest hombres out there. Human once, but long lost now and relentless. If you want to create an Infernal character as a good guy, you'll need a damn good explanation for your GM, and an even better story for your allies.



MUERTOS

If a corpse isn't buried soon enough, the bones will stand right back up. This here is called a Muerto: a person who died but won't stay dead. A skeleton in boots. Sadly, there are a great many Muertos on the mountain. So many, it's common to see skull-faced folk in every town. Some good, some not so good. Creepy stuff, kid... real boogeyman material.

WHERE DO YOU STAND?

GMing Ghost Mountain? Make it easy on yourself and kick things off with a stagecoach run from Dead Rock to Buckskin. Creating a character? Just visualize that treacherous stage run and ask: where am I in this scene?

- **The Hired Stage Runner:** The Sheriff in Dead Rock has paid a fistful of dollars to drive this stage all the way up the mountain. There's a chest, maybe a VIP, and a mysterious old wooden crate. You don't ask questions, you just need to pay for Nana's medicine.
- **The Do-Gooder Bandit:** Your posse is waiting by the road up near Henson's farm. Robbery was never your plan, but if these guns get to Buckskin, it will be a massacre. Your plan? Get the iron to the real heroes of Ghost Mountain: the gunslingers.
- **The Bystander:** You're just a passenger, heading to Buckskin to visit kin and make sure everyone is alright. The Hunger sounds a terrible fright.
- **The Stowaway:** They don't know yet, but you're hidden beneath the stage. You can't afford passage, but if you don't get to Buckskin directly, your pa's old place will be handed over to the Dyre gang and their thugs.
- **The Messenger of God:** If The Hunger has really appeared up there, they'll need a holy servant to drive it back. God's work 'n' all.
- **The Skull Who Knows:** You usually keep your hat down: a muerto back from the underworld with big news: Azael is on the offensive, starting at Boulder Falls. Sarah Mills, Buckskin's Hepawa mayor, has got to know before the Infernals come a whoopin' and wompin'.

TRACKER

Trackers are keen as a razor: masters of the wild.

Recommended Gear: Carbine Rifle, Longbow, Supplies, More Supplies, Trapper Gear

Starting LOOT, Choose *one*:
Bush Blanket (Disappear 1D4 ROUNDS even in plain sight)
Crystal Scope (Mount on any RIFLE, Roll 'Aim for Vitals' as NORMAL) (see page 239)

Milestone Rewards:
Mushroom Tea (5 Count, use NO SUPPLIES for 3 days)
Tar Arrows (10 Count, HARD STR roll to break free)
Antique Sawed-off (NEAR, DOUBLE WEAPON EFFORT)
Shady Brady: All TRACKING Attempts and Checks are EASY
Black Flag (5 count, TOUCH a target, all attacks against it are ULTIMATE)

WRAITH

The devils you can talk to, if you keep your eyes on the dirt. Wraiths don't say nothin'. Most of 'em are little more than smoke and brimstone. Poor bastards.

Recommended Gear: Fire Stone, Bowie Knife, Spell Book, Pouch of 50 Coin

Starting LOOT:
Demon Glyph (Turn immaterial at will)

Milestone Rewards:
Soul Gem (occupy any other creature for 1D4 ROUNDS with an INT roll)
INFERNAL Spell: Ignite (Touch an object to ignite it)
INFERNAL Spell: Bone Lance (Hits ALL targets in a straight line to FAR)
INFERNAL Spell: Death Aura (If touched by an enemy, inflict MAGIC)
INFERNAL Spell: Fury (Touch a target, they kill at random until making a CHA roll)

BRAVE

Hepawa are fierce as bears. You'll not find deadlier knife-fighters than one of their Braves.

Recommended Gear: Bowie Knife (2), Carbine Rifle, Weapon Kit, Trapper Gear, Ammo Pouch

Starting LOOT:
Great Eagle Feather (When fighting with knives, Attacks of 15+ earn another attack *and* a NEAR move if desired)

Milestone Rewards:
Antler Knife (MAGIC)
Bear Hide Cloak (Any time you're hurt, ignore 1D6 of damage done)
Treated Hide Armor (+3 Armor, waterproof)
Cougar Tooth Talisman (+1 STR)

GAMBLER

The west is won and lost over blackjack and whiskey. Gamblers are shrewd, clever, lonely buggers with the Devil in their eyes.

Recommended Gear: Pouch of 50 Coin (2), 2 Six Shooter, Supplies, Armor Kit

Starting LOOT, Choose *one*:
Devil's Deck (When firing a pistol, DRAW for damage)
Bad Bet (DRAW. If a RED, heal that amount. If a BLACK, take as damage)
Lucky (Replace *any* ATTEMPT or CHECK with a DRAW. The DM DRAWS, too. High card wins. If you draw an ACE, critical success, no matter what the GM DRAWS)

Milestone Rewards:
Slam Loader (Reload a firearm in no time)
Steel-Knit Vest (5 Uses, If shot, take only 1 Damage)
Snakebite Whiskey (10 drinks, pass out for 1D4 ROUNDS)

SHAMAN

They don't mess with that infernal magic, or holy spirits as some folks claim. Nope, they find power in the stones.

Recommended Gear: Meditation Beads, Small Pet, Walking Stick, Supplies

Starter Reward:
Dream Catcher (Speak with, or use CHA to persuade, animals and natural forces)

Milestone Rewards:
Choose any 2 WIS SpellS
Masterful Boots (+1 Dex)
Animal Form Hood (Choose 1 animal. Take its form for 1D4 ROUNDS)
Dream Chain (Heal 1 ally with a touch. Any NEAR allies also benefit, and any allies NEAR them in turn)

MARIACHI

There's always hope as long as there's music. No one knows it better than the MARIACHI. Count yourself lucky to have one around.

Recommended Gear: Instrument (rare or unique), Bowie Knife, Six-shooter, Weapon Kit

Starter Reward, Choose *one*:
Embroidered Sombrero (+3 CHA when performing)
Gun Case (Holds 4 concealed guns, Infinite ammo)
Cookin' Spit (If camping, allies recover full HP in 1 hour)

Milestone Rewards:
Sheet Music: Red Rodeo (Sing! Those who hear roll EASY this ROUND)
Silver Spurs (+1 CHA, Ride anything with EASY rolls)
Gramophone Gadget (Record a song, play it at a location)
Songwriter's Book (Create Sheet Music with an INT roll)
Sheet Music: Pistolero! (Sing! Those who hear AIM FOR VITALS)

GUNSLINGER

Anyone can carry a six-shooter, but a GUNSLINGER, they make an art of the gun.

Recommended Gear: Weapons Kit, Six Shooter (2), Ammo Pouch, Wool Poncho

Starter reward:
Masterwork Revolver (On a successful pistol shot, choose to roll 1D6. Fire that many bullets at up to that many targets. Your cylinder is empty)

Milestone Rewards:
Speed Loader (When you RELOAD, roll 1D4. On anything but a 1, use no time)
12 Silver Bullets (ULTIMATE EFFORT on a pistol hit, silver properties)
Hellfire Powder (3 count, Use a TURN to make 6 bullets EXPLOSIVE)
Phantom Duster (+2 Armor, +2 ULTIMATE EFFORT)
Deadeye Eyepatch (+2 WEAPON EFFORT)

OLD TIMER

It's no small thing to reach old age in Ghost Mountain. The Old Timers keep all the secrets.

Recommended Gear: Heavy Jacket (+1 ARMOR), Six Shooter, Oak Cross, Medical Case

Starter reward:
Hallowed Book (create and cast HOLY Spells)
Choose TWO HOLY Spells

Milestone Rewards:
HOLY Spell: God's Hand (Paralyze with a touch for 1 ROUND)
HOLY Spell: Locusts (FAR radius, 1D4 ROUNDS, ROLLS within HARD)
HOLY Spell: Destroy the Dead (Destroy 1 Undead per 1 HP burned)
Weird Crystal (+2 MAGIC EFFORT when casting Spells)
Lucky Horseshoe (When rolling ULTIMATE, re-roll anything below 6)

STARTING EQUIPMENT (Choose Any Three)

Choose from the STARTING EQUIPMENT in ALFHEIM, or from these additional options to give your character more Ghost Mountain flavor.

FIRE WATER, 8 SIPS, PASS OUT FOR 1D4 ROUNDS
Nasty stuff. Viper venom mixed with monkey juice, I tell ya. Stick with whiskey.

AMMO POUCH, 24 CAPACITY
Without one of these, you'll be lucky to keep 6 shots dry and in your pocket.

COLD WEATHER GEAR
Up above Buckskin it's terrible cold. Without this gear, you'll be dead in hours. +1 DEFENSE.

BULL WHIP
Hard as hell to master, but makes for a nasty, useful tool in uncertain times. Can be used as WEAPON or grappler.

SADDLE & TACK, INCLUDES LARIAT
A must for any riding. Can be sold for 30 COIN, requires wagon or cart to transport.

MANACLES, LEG IRONS N' SUCH
Crucial gear for a Law man. Can also be forged with silver properties to restrain Infernals, Wraiths and the like.

COFFEE OUTFIT
Conserve 1 SUPPLY when camping, grant all cohorts a HERO COIN at breakfast.

CANUSKA BLANKET
A near-indestructible wool blanket with geometric patterns. Also shows friendship with Canuska tribes.

HEPAWA HIDE TENT & TACK
A compact, portable shelter for five. Can be used in cold, conserve 2 SUPPLIES per day. Requires wagon or cart to transport. Includes rope, iron spikes, and cooking gear.

SIX SHOOTER: The standard sidearm of the West. Simple, Reliable, uses 1 TURN to reload.

CARBINE RIFLE: Lever action, 8 capacity.

SHOTGUN: A nasty, clumsy weapon for close-quarters. 2 capacity, 1 TURN reload.

SNUB SHOTGUN: Brutal scatter shots, 2 capacity. Hit any/all CLOSE targets in front of you when firing.

COMPOUND BOW: Add STR to damage

BOWIE KNIFE: Here you have the most reliable thing on the mountain.

SABRE: Cavalry sword. Expensive, silver.

GATLING GUN: Godless death machine of the East. 4 shots per roll.

DEMONSPINE: Fencing blade used by Infernals.

SMOKE BLADE: Caught 'tween worlds. Can only be touched by Infernals.

RELIC PISTOL: A haunted gun. 4 Capacity

ELEPHANT RIFLE: Biggest damn gun I ever saw. 1 capacity, always does ULTIMATE.

SCREAMER: Like a grenade, but it's a skull

IRON CROSS: Oak and cold iron, one huge spike. Simple, Deadly, Always does DOUBLE to Infernals.

NITRO BOTTLE: Careful with that, kid.

HOLY SPELLS

The God-fearin' folk of Ghost Mountain place their hope in Old Timers, who are the last ones able to channel real power from on high. You've just got to believe. All are WIS SPELLS.

ANOINT: Touch an ally. They are immune to all harm for 1 ROUND
BANISH: Touch an INFERNAL. They vanish for 1D4 ROUNDS
BAPTISE: Baptized folk make all fear-oriented rolls as EASY
BLESS HOLY WATER: Create a small vial of HOLY WATER from any water source
CONSECRATE: Mark the ground NEAR you. Evil cannot enter for 1D4 DAYS
EXORCISM: Hold the possessed for 1D4 ROUNDS. The evil will be cast out
LIGHT: Create a bright light that reaches FAR for 1D4 ROUNDS
MIRACLE: Describe any effect approved by the GM. Roll a 20, it happens
RENEW FAITH: Touch an ally to give them a HERO COIN
RESTORE LIFE: Heal with a touch, if the subject has 0 HP
SPIRITUS SANCTI: Gather a SOUL from any dead body
TRUST IN GOD: For 1D4 ROUNDS, you can only be harmed by natural 20s

INFERNAL SPELLS

Far more powerful magic serves the darkness. It is destructive, incendiary, sudden, and treacherous. All the more to test the faithful. All are INT SPELLS.

ASH CLOUD: Fill a NEAR radius with ash and smoke. All rolls within are HARD
BLOOD OATH: Draw blood, make an oath. If it is fulfilled, heal full HP, gain a MILESTONE REWARD
BURNING KNIFE: Imbue a WEAPON with MAGIC fire for 1D4 ROUNDS
CHASM: Smite the ground, opening a fissure that reaches FAR in a jagged line and that has no visible bottom
CREATE MUERTO: Turn any corpse into a MUERTO
DECEIVE: Completely fool 1D4 targets with your ruse
FIRE FORM: Assume a form of pure fire for 1D4 ROUNDS
FORGET: Touch a target to wipe away 1 specific memory permanently
GLYPH DOOR: Draw two GLYPHS, then walk 'tween them instantly for 1D4 days
HELL STORM: With a HARD roll, conjure a terribly destructive thunder storm
IMPERVIOUS: You are immune to all harm for 1D4 ROUNDS
KILL: Touch a target with a HARD roll. They must make a CON roll, or die
NIGHTMARE: Summon a flaming steed that lasts 1D4 ROUNDS
TIRA LOS DADOS: ANY ROLL in the following ROUND may be forced to re-roll

GUNS: THEY KILL YA

Ghost Mountain has special firearm rules. In the old west, folks didn't wear much ARMOR or use shields, and guns were terribly lethal. Most fights were finished with a single bullet, so mind your cover, and aim with both eyes open.

- **BIG SLUGS**: On an ATTEMPT of 15+, do maximum damage.
- **IN THE FACE**: Any hit at point blank range does maximum damage.
- **KNOCKED SILLY**: Any time you are hit by a firearm for 3 or more damage, Roll CON to avoid losing 1 turn.
- **STRICT AMMO**: 6 bullets count as 1 SUPPLY.
- **PRIMITIVE BARRELS:** PISTOLS can only hit NEAR targets unless you roll a natural 20.
- **DUDS**: Wet ammo has a 50% chance of being ruined, which you will only find out when firing. Pouches keep ammo dry.
- **RIGHT IN THE EYE**: On any gunshot, 'aim for vitals' with a HARD ROLL, if a hit, do NOT roll damage. Target makes CON roll or is dropped to 1 HP.

SUPPLIES

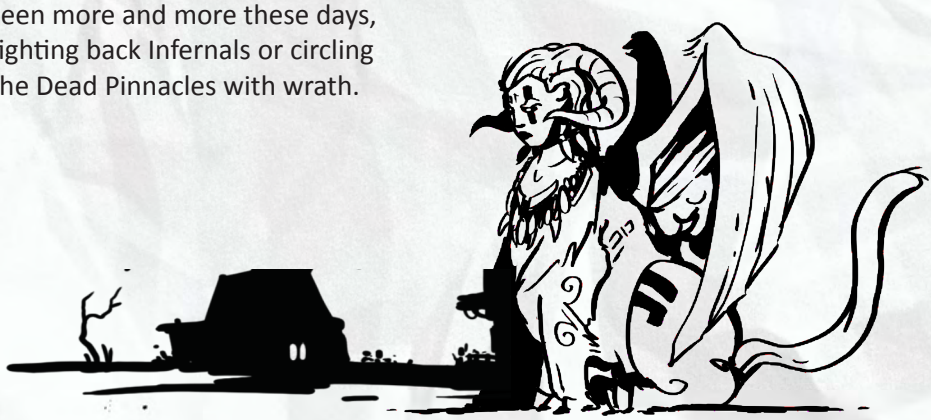
- **BASICS**: 1 SUPPLY feeds 4 people for 1 day, OR contains 6 bullets, costs 10 COIN.
- **HOOF IT:** On foot, cover 10 miles per day. With wagon, cart, horses cover 20.
- **HUNGRY**: Spending a day without SUPPLY makes all rolls HARD until meals and shelter are procured.
- **SKIN & BONES**: Third day take 3 damage if no SUPPLIES found.
- **STARVED**: Five days without SUPPLIES will kill a man. Roll HARD CON to keep breathin' one more day.
- **MERCANTILE**: As the GM, consider a few basic prices at the local store, including horses, wagons, lumber, bullets and the like. Cheap: 10 COIN, Spendy: 25 COIN, rare or expensive: 50 COIN, and so on.

GHOST MOUNTAIN

TAKE 'EM TO CHURCH

This ain't no Sunday school, amigo. In a world ripped up from the mortal coil, knocked around by angels and devils, the house of God has a gravity beyond words. Sit a spell, and for cryin' out loud take off your sombrero.

- **Beyond Fundamentalist:** On Ghost Mountain, church isn't about faith, or doin' a bit of good here and there: it's a fortress against total defeat. It's a bulwark against absolute evil. Churches here are more like military camps than community gathering places. This is war.
- **Holy Ground:** Infernals, demons, ghosts and other unholies cannot enter a church. If forced in, they will be disintegrated. Even Lucifer himself cannot enter. Most churches also forbid firearms.
- **Spell School:** Initiates are trained in holy magic here.
- **Books n' Such:** The only bastion of book knowledge is in church libraries and sciptorums. Could these old tomes hold a key to the fate of all?
- **The Red Lady:** Not everyone believes it's true, but a REAL and terrible angel has come to Ghost Mountain. She is part lion, part eagle, part ram... mighty and beautiful to behold. She has pierced the big nothin' to fight Azael head-to-head. Some churches acknowledge her as a savior, others call her a devil in disguise. Whatever the truth is, the Red Lady has been seen more and more these days, fighting back Infernals or circling the Dead Pinnacles with wrath.



YOU DON'T LOOK SO GOOD

Life is hard up here, and Lord knows we're hanging on by our fingernails. Even hero-types get sick, knocked upside the head or whatnot. Use CONDITIONS to remind players how tough this land really is. Any condition left untreated for 1 week reaches it final outcome.

MUERTO
Cause: Dead and unburied for a day or more
Effects: Half damage from bullets, heal HP only from SPELLS or WIS SpellS, +2 HEARTS, -6 CHA
Remedies: Absorb a SOUL for each HEART, drink the Canuska holy tea
Final Outcome: CONDITION is permanent

SICK AS A DOG
Cause: Extreme cold, plague, starvation, tainted food or water
Effects: -3 CON, people shun and avoid you unless they are medically trained, move only NEAR
Remedies: Warm soup and a cozy night's sleep, heal to full HP by FOOD
Final Outcome: Permanent -3 CON, never go above 1 HEART total HP

GONE YELLA
Cause: Extreme horror / fear. Can also be caused by critically failing a FEAR roll
Effects: Flee the source of your fear for 1D4 ROUNDS, actively avoid it
Remedies: Make a CHA roll, be inspired by a MARIACHI
Final Outcome: You will *never* face the source of your fear again, even if it means death first

LOCO
Cause: Desert starvation, exposure to extreme cosmic truth, botched asylum brain-tincturing, Canuska spirit tea
Effects: Erratic behavior, INT rolls are HARD, gibbering, cannibalism, self-harm, comical absurdity
Remedies: None
Final Outcome: A player with LOCO can role play the full effects to taste

POISONED
Cause: Snake bite, weapon poison, food-borne poison, breathing poison gas
Effects: Take 1-4 HP damage / ROUND, depending on the toxicity of the poison
Remedies: Antidote specific to that poison, earning a HEART
Final Outcome: Death. If at 0 HP when poisoned, a natural 20 will not revive you.

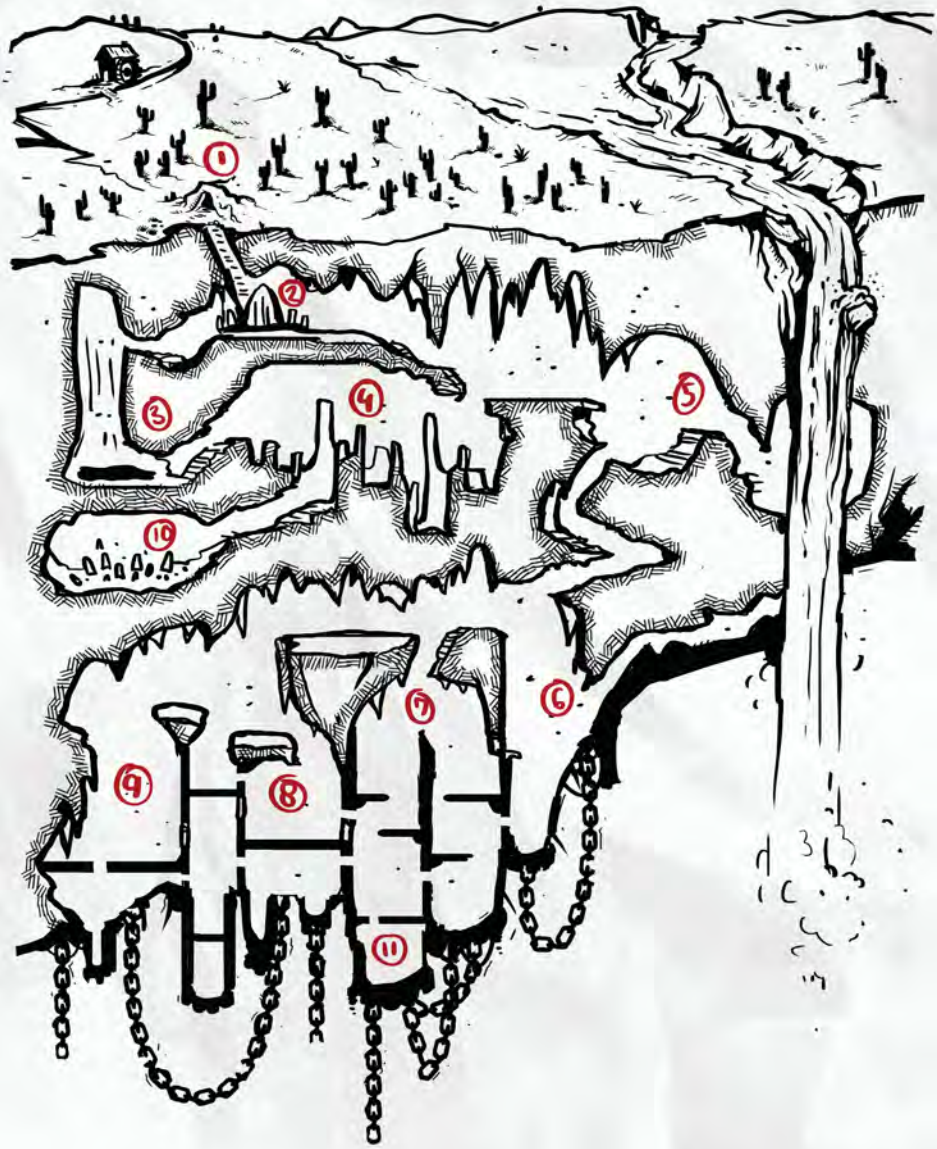
AZAEL THE DEFILER

An archdemon rules the hollow interior of Ghost Mountain, and sits on the throne of the Dead Pinnacles below. He is a Baron of Hell, a sadistic, powerful demi-god sent by Lucifer to achieve the darkest of goals. To even look on him is to know terror.

- **Kill the Humans:** Azael's chief task is to make war on the humans. His resources are limited, so this has proven more difficult than it may seem. Purgatory is a tough ground to conquer, especially with frontierfolk about. His next offensive? A wave of Infernals bristling with Demonspines. Where and when will they be unleashed?
- **Soul Harvester:** When possible, Azael will deliver a soul to his evil master. Only the finest heroes or innocents are suitable for such a prize. For each soul he offers to the Devil, Azael's power grows. He's already a behemoth... is there a limit to his might?
- **Find the YOG:** Ghost Mountain was torn from the Earth for one reason: a gigantic YOG crystal is somewhere within. With this massive power source, Lucifer could challenge the greatest deities of the multiverse. For now, Azael is his best chance to find it: burrowing endlessly through the mountain in mazes and tunnels. If the crystal is discovered, the sun will set at last, and an age of darkness will fall on the cosmos. Azael must be stopped.

THE HOLLOW

This map only represents the main portion of the Hollow. It is endless and vast, hewn from bedrock. This section reaches from the surface at Henson's farm to the Dead Pinnacles. The entire place is choked with brimstone fumes and glowing coals.



1:Henson's Cave 2:Gates of Hell 3:The Long Drop 4:The Pits
5:The Mist Caves 6:East Tower 7:Grand Feast Hall
8:Flayer's Fires 9:The Jails 10:Cemetery 11:Hall of Windows

VIGILANTE CITY: TAKE BACK THE STREETS

After the Mutant Crisis of 2024, things took a terrible turn for the worse in Vigilante City... a lot worse.

A perfect storm: the aftermath of a chaotic clash between super-criminals and block warriors in the gathering dark of a mutant crisis in North America. The average-joe-in-a-mask has failed, bigger players are scratching at the edges of our world, and YOU are the last line of defense before Earth itself becomes a war zone.

We all have our favorite comic heroes and coveted limited edition books. We've all read by flashlight, wide-eyed when our favorite super was near death, or sacrificed everything to save their team. The 20th century has given us a detailed, expansive mythology of mutants, mega-criminals, unearthly enemies and super soldiers. This section lets you dive into that mythology with your tabletop group, and write the greatest superhero story of them all: YOURS.

It all begins in the shadowy streets and broken towers of the town once called Grey Heights... Vigilante City. THIS will be the battleground that determines our future. Suit up.

WHICH SUPER FLAVOR IS THIS?

Vigilante City isn't the infinite-cosmic superhero world, nor is it the no-powers-just-grit counterpoint. It's the scrappy street level in between. Things are bad, but the fight is here. Tonight.

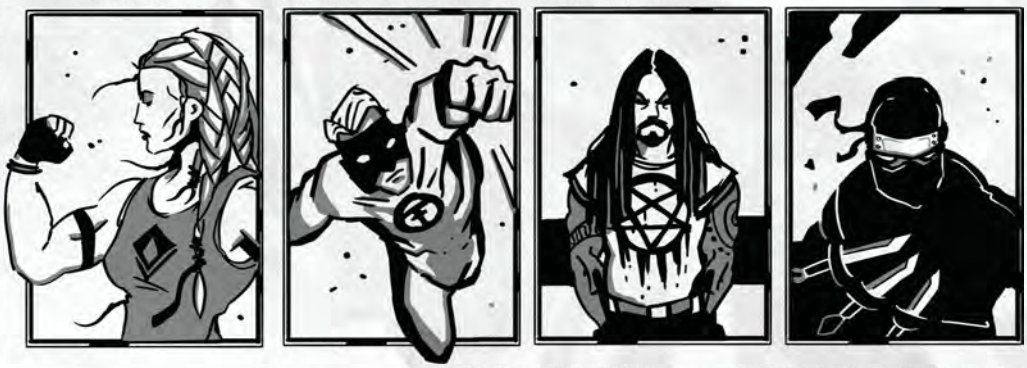
Block War: Vigilante City is far from being in ruins, but half the city has gone dark, and the first responders are stretched too thin. There is no 911. Chaos is close, but the citizens still manage to get to work each day, rebuild, and keep hope alive. Very few go out after dark.

Ray of Light: At the spearhead of the city, keeping the torch burning, leading us all to a brighter day, is Mayor Linda Brahm. She's one tough cookie, never backs down, and has the kind of true grit most people believe is long lost in this world.

Dirty Secret: Ash Island is an isolated place populated with run down barracks and half-ruined laboratories. This is the ghost of Grey Heights' dirtiest secret: a concentration camp for mutants. Some say a great resistance is stirring out there, but who knows. The fog hides it all.

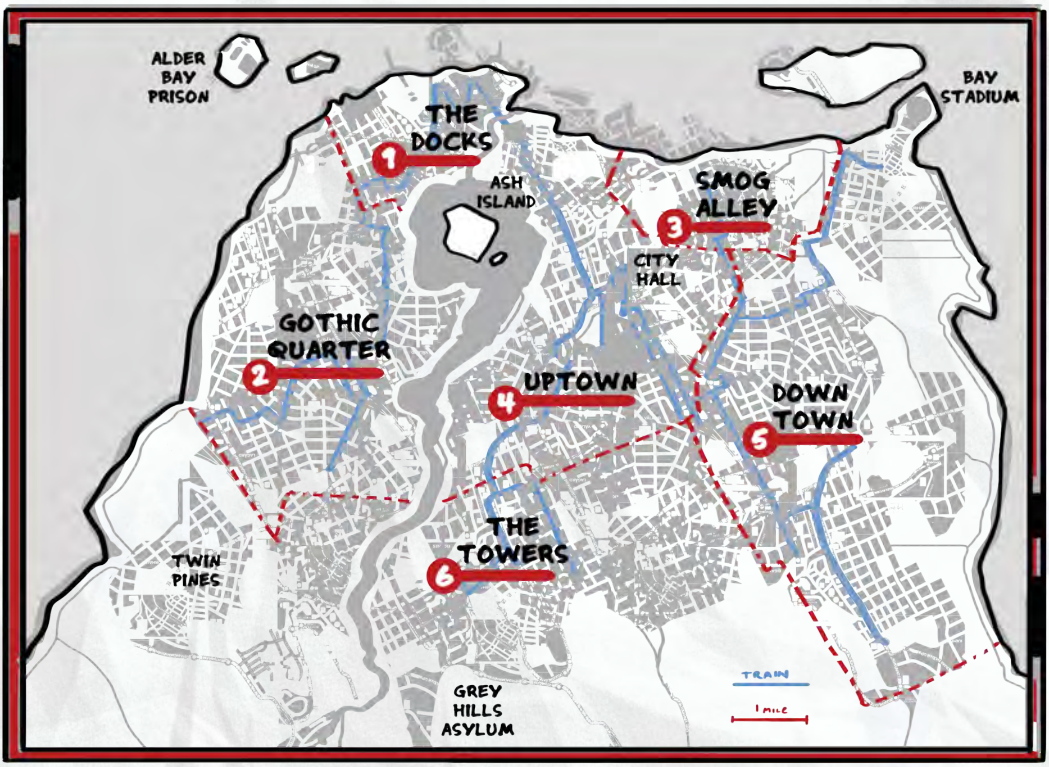
The Inevitable Asylum: Grey Hill used to be a psychiatric research facility. Now, their star patient is a trans-dimensional being called Porcelain. It's probably just a rumor.

Brace for Impact: Against this grim backdrop, things are about to explode. Pharaoh, a mysterious new menace, is working to unite the evil forces on the streets for a grand destructive purpose. Could this be the beginning of the end for America as a whole? What sinister plans could Pharaoh have in store? Can anyone stand against them? Let's play to find out.



THE CITY

Grey Heights is ground zero for the Mutant Crisis: a blast of energy that started the supers revolution, and left half the city in darkness. Since that fateful night, things have been getting worse. There are bad guys on every shadowed corner, half the families have fled to the country, and the military seems to be taking a wait-and-see approach. The old neighborhoods aren't giving up without a fight. That's where you and your friends come in. Roll 1D6 for a location.

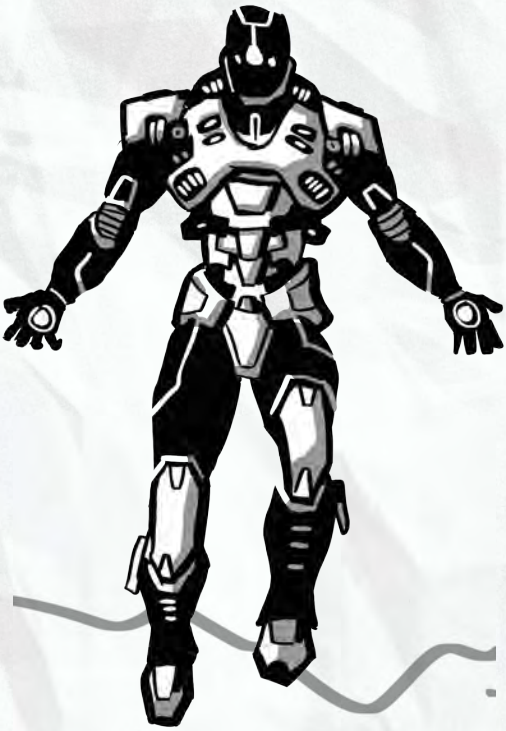


1D6	DISTRICT
1: The Docks	Warehouses and high end clubs
2: Gothic Quarter	Slums, darkness, ruin and little power
3: Smog Alley	Factory district, shipping port
4: Uptown	High rises, office buildings, river park
5: Downtown	Neighborhoods, stadium, some ruin
6: The Towers	High end skyscrapers and tech area

THE CITY: WE HAVE A SITUATION

The table below gives you a starting point to discover what's happening tonight in Vigilante City. Roll 1D20 for an event. The heroes are the only responders available, and it's go time. After a few events, underlying forces and even darker futures will start to take shape as players ask questions.

ROLL 1D20	BLOCK EVENT
1: Blackout	A power outage releases a magnetically contained super
2: Rampage	A hulking war robot is destroying a city block
3: Lab	A research lab emits glowing waves of destructive energy
4: Scumbags	Low grade thugs rove in a pack, terrorizing innocents
5: Vigil	A somber gathering is disrupted by an occult attack
6: Cone Zone	Cranes and work vehicles are toppling onto houses
7: Hostages	Machine gun bank robbers are in a standoff
8: Crackle	Weird arcs of green lightning are appearing from a UFO
9: Collapse	Recent battles have destabilized a skyscraper
10: War	Gangs and good guys are going all out, a block in flames
11: Chase	High tech hot rods are in a deadly chase
12: Fire	A huge fire has begun to spread, trapping dozens
13: Train	The magnetic hypertrain is about to derail
14: Escaped	Mutant beasts are running rampant near Ash Island
15: Ninja!	The Iron Clan have unleashed an offensive, but why?
16: On Guard	Neighborhood folk have squared off against an evil super
17: Wave!	An assassin is hiding in a pro-supers parade
18: Crazy	The insane have been loosed somehow... laughter echoes
19: DMZ	The military have deployed against a team of supers
20: Mechanic	The city's top scientists have been kidnapped



THE CITY: THE DOCKS

A large area from Ash Island to Alder Bay. It is a mostly industrial area, peppered with dive bars, fish shacks, tall fences, and wrecking yards.

1: ASH ISLAND
This dark island, now without power and overgrown, was once home to a military 'containment camp' for those afflicted with anthropomorphic mutations.

2: STERLING PIER
The biggest, busiest shipping port is this series of docks, cranes, cargo containers and forklifts. It's a maze of equipment and trucks under heavy security.

3: FISH ROW
This is the original pier, now populated by salty sea dogs and rotted out wood-work.

4: ALDER BAY PRISON
Alder Bay was once a prison boasting over 1500 inmates. It is now supermax facility with only a dozen super powered inmates.

5: THE DRAG
A straight, wide highway bisects this part of town, with 6 lanes, numerous shops and clubs, and few stop lights.

6: OLD DRY DOCKS
Giant concrete bays, cable winches and sheds line this area, where freighters and cruise liners go for repairs or dry dock jobs. There are un-railed drop offs every-where.

THE CITY: GOTHIC QUARTER

Blocky tenants, low-roofed plazas, tree-lined streets and trash-cluttered alleys. It isn't a ghetto per se, but it sure isn't Uptown.

1: COASTAL PARK

There is a 3 mile stretch of bike paths, small grassy parks and rocky beach along the west side of this area. By day it's a haven for family outings, by night it's known to shelter low level criminal operations and exchanges.

2: FENSON STATION

One of the largest subway rail yards in the city is here. This has become a no man's land, as power can be scarce by night. Taggers rejoice.

3: SOUTH CENTRAL

One of the worst ghettos in Vigilante City, with tenants, crumbling towers, huge areas without water or power, and rampant street crime.

4: BARRICADE ZONE

A battle between super humans in 2027 destroyed part of the city here, and left a radioactive crater a hundred yards across. The entire area is barricaded off and under military surveillance.

5: RED LIGHT RAVENNA

Ravenna is a part of town known for high end crime. Brothels, speakeasies, and full-on bunkers pepper the neighborhood.

6: CATHOLIC ROW

In stark contrast to Ravenna, a series of old cathedrals lines 120th street. Most of them date back a hundred years or more. The crime families of the area and super humans have made a pact never to bring the fight there. So far, that pact has held.

THE CITY: SMOG ALLEY

Grey Heights started its life as a steel-milling town and shipping hub, moving raw materials on Alder Bay. Those days are long gone, but the infrastructure remains. There are very few people in this area, even by day.

1: GAS WORKS
Huge rusted pipes, dormant forges, chain hoists and loading docks are all that's left of these complex, maze-like refineries.

2: WAREHOUSE DISTRICT
These buildings are gigantic, hollow shells built with girders and sheet metal roofs. They are home to pigeons and vagrants mostly, but a select few are used for secret military hardware, criminal hideouts, or the perfect place to take a kidnapped mayor.

3: WRECKING YARDS
Huge piles of wrecked cars, construction vehicles and scrap are interconnected by oil-soaked gravel roads. This is a lifeless place.

4: BURNOUT
During the Mutant Crisis of 2024, a fire broke out here, and burned everything to the girders. It is now a dark skeletal landscape.

5: SHIPYARD
A rudimentary set of docks are here, mostly just abandoned concrete jetties now.

6: THE SUMP
At the East end of Smog Alley is a series of tanks and drainage pools used to treat, store and re-use industrial waste water and other hazardous material. Since the fall of this area, the pools have grown truly toxic with neglect, and the giant tanks threaten to leak with age.

THE CITY: UPTOWN

The heart of the city is still functional and well-lit. Parking garages like bunkers, and the skyscrapers are armored below the 10th floor. Neon nightlife and street racing are not uncommon.

1: CITY HALL

The ruin of Vigilante City is held at bay here. The streets are clean, parking is 10$ an hour. The marble and sidewalk culture makes it seem as if life is still normal.

2: THE SILVER VALLEY

The wealthy have kept a manicured, gated community intact despite the chaos. These sprawling estates are all guarded by private security, some of them super human.

3: LION SQUARE

There is a cobbled park here, where people gather on weekends for street fairs, car shows, and outdoor music. It is a huge area, punctuated by marble statues of safari wildlife.

4: ALDER PARK

Along the riverfront is a very different park. This wooded area has become home to Vigilante City's homeless population, and the crime that often goes with it.

5: MADISON STREET

One central area boasts more skyscrapers and top end banking buildings than any other: Madison Street. Glass and steel still stand tall and pristine. You can almost smell the money.

6: THE KITCHEN

Just 4 blocks from Madison is The Kitchen, a lively cultural culinary district, club scene, and middle-income neighborhood known for great music, better food, and family living.

THE CITY: DOWNTOWN

The East side of town is a diverse city with many different nooks and crannies, neighborhoods, ethnicities and its own problems. One block can be friendly bodegas and kids on bikes, the next burnt out houses and no power. It's just too big to classify.

1: WHITESTONE

The only area with reliable power and emergency services is Whitestone. A few bigger buildings accent the neighborhoods here, but nothing over 4 stories.

2: EAST SIDE

A huge, spacious area of low income housing covers a lot of ground here. The people have adapted to the ruined doom of their home, and stick together in tight knit neighborhood watches and vigil groups.

3: THE TRACKS

The subways barely work here anymore, so the tracks have just become a haven for drug users and gun battles. Even walking out into those dormant street cars and tagged tankers is an invitation to fight.

4: BAY STADIUM

The brightest light of Downtown is Bay Stadium, where the Grey Heights Rangers still play on Sundays. The stadium holds 30,000 fans, parking is awful, and the whole area is dotted with food trucks and street vendors.

5: CRUISE ALLEY

Rivaling The Drag as the best place to cruise in the city, this stretch of road is more notorious, as there are few street lights, police presence or power. A street racer's dream.

6: RAIL YARDS

In days past, this area was used to build, repair and refurbish train cars. It has warehouses, cranes, and cars in various states of assembly, including raw metal materials for their construction. Only a few shops still operate, mostly chopping cars.

THE CITY: THE TOWERS

Standing above it all on the original town site is this secure financial district and shopping area. No less than a dozen skyscrapers densely pack the hilltop, forming a strange foreground to the old asylum beyond. Most roads in and out are gated or tolled.

1: APEX CENTER

The hilltop is accessible only by the truly elite. Everything is gated, the streets empty, and the sidewalk immaculate. 20 stories up is where life begins, with shops, bars and clubs for the richest of the rich.

2: THE BELTWAY

The upper city is ringed by a high speed freeway. It is a huge structure, 30 feet above the street, 8 lanes, concrete guard rails. A favorite haunt for elite street racers by night, but heavily policed.

3: SCIENCE DISTRICT

Supporting the elite in Apex Center is a series of industrial parks where research is carried out by various private firms. On any given day there can be brown outs or small explosions as new technology is developed here.

4: THE BLUFFS

A series of super-mansions rings a high cliff area near town. Each house no less than 50 rooms on as many acres.

5: Z CORP SPORTS ARENA

Finding the stadium dirty and remote, the residents here funded and built their own hockey/basketball arena. They also feature the top names in live music here.

6: GREY HILL ASYLUM

An ominous, spired shadow looms over the city here. It is a compound of high-roofed towers and infinite windows, all black-sided among ancient oaks and brambles. Most people don't even like to look that way, venture there.

HEROES

To build your hero for the events after the Mutant Crisis of 2024, you'll need a few key pieces. Most of it will be perfectly familiar to any **ICRPG** player or GM, with a few twists listed below. Remember **ICRPG** WORLDS are interchangeable from Alfheim to Ghost Mountain to MAGIC.

- **Build with 12 STAT points**
- **Select 1 STARTING LOOT from VIGILANTE CITY or any WORLD**
- **Select 3 total STARTING EQUIPMENT from any WORLD**
- **Select 3 POWERS and 3 PROPERTIES**

HEROES: VIGILANTE POINTS

Every action has its consequences for those who take the law into their own hands. Earn good or evil Vigilante Points when moments below occur. Players and GM can spot these events during play. Unlike MASTERY, your spot on the vigilante scale can slide back and forth over time.

EARN A VP TOWARD GOOD WHEN YOU

- Directly aid law enforcement or first responders
- Rescue the innocent
- Fulfill a friendship with a team mate
- Sacrifice yourself for others

EARN A VP TOWARD EVIL WHEN YOU

- Directly aid criminals or villains
- Harm the innocent or non-combatants
- Work to free other criminals and villains
- Choose self over others

WHEN YOU'RE FULLY GOOD (10 GOOD VP) YOU

- Hold sway with law enforcement, even rank
- Are a hero of neighborhood people
- Attract other good heroes from far and wide
- Draw the attention of evil

WHEN YOU'RE FULLY EVIL (10 EVIL VP) YOU

- Are actively targeted by law enforcement
- Are feared by people in all walks of life
- Attract fanatic and psychotic super villains
- Hatch EVIL SCHEMES (Read more in the Villains Section)

HEROES: STARTING EQUIPMENT

Choose 3 of the items below when you create your character, or choose from any other WORLD to fit your hero concept.

THUMPER PISTOL
Conceal easily. Does 3 SP even when resisted
(for more about SP/Stun Points turn to page 258)

X-TECH ASSAULT RIFLE
Weapon of future wars. Mod to take custom ammo or attached weapons

PLASTEEL RIOT ARMOR
Clunky but effective protection. +3 ARMOR, reduce any STUN damage done to you in any attack by 1

ION PACK
1 use of FLIGHT POWER, recharge 1D4 ROUNDS

MICRO COMMS
Keep in touch with teammates at any range, concealed and hands free

UTILITY BELT
3 med kits, 3 smoke grenades, rope, and one remote-triggered explosive brick

ADRENALINE PACK
On a successful RECOVERY, add +3 to your result

TEAM SUIT
Fireproof, tear-proof, protects against cold

STREET PACK
3 pipe bombs, crow bar, folding ladder, crime scene kit, lock-picks and a signal flare

ALL THE KNIVES
Knives. So many knives. Even when throwing or breaking knives and swords, you always have more

HEROES: KNOW YOUR PAST

No normal life could drive a person to these extremes. It's been a hard road, and you've never really fit in anywhere but the fight. Choose or trust the dice on the table below. The more multidimensional, the more complicated, the more 'grey' your origin, the more fascinating role-playing your hero can be.

ROLL 1D12 HERO ORIGIN STORY

1: VIOLATED
You were wronged terribly as a youth by criminal elements
2: FERAL
They found you in the wild, where you learned to survive
3: TRAINED
Your skill is no accident. You have earned every ounce of your power
4: BORN THIS WAY
Cosmic rays? Crocodile DNA? For whatever reason, you're different
5: HEIR
You've inherited a vast, secret world of wealth and power
6: VISITOR
By unknown means, you've fallen from the stars to earth
7: CREATED
Forbidden science has given rise to your unique gifts... they own you
8: MUTATION
You were normal once, then IT happened
9: WILLPOWER
You made a decision: you're taking it all back, one punch at a time
10: RELIC
There was a strange artifact up there in the mountains... you found it
11: TASK
All your life has been focused on a single errand
12: SUPER TEAM
Join up, suit up. This is your dream

HEROES: FIGHT FOR YOUR FUTURE

Sure, you may have crawled out of a radioactive sewer, but it's all behind you now. You've accepted the 'great responsibility,' and you're ready to make a real difference out there. Whatever mission you choose or roll, be prepared to fight, die, and sacrifice for that cause. Anything less is your funeral.

ROLL 1D12 HERO MISSION

1: BRING IT DOWN
You will undermine and destroy an entire evil network
2: FREEDOM
No matter what it takes, you'll be free of those who contain you
3: RESTORE ORDER
One street at a time, you'll get this city back on track
4: PROTECTOR
There is one person, place or thing you are sworn to guard
5: REVENGE
Your soul doesn't matter. They'll all die for what they've done
6: FINAL SOLUTION
There's a way to end it all, bring peace at last, but no one sees it
7: HOME
You must find a way to return to your distant home, or all is lost
8: EVOLVE
There is a far greater form waiting for you, and you will achieve it
9: ANTI-HUMAN
The world has moved forward, and humans have become the enemy
10: SENTRY
You will give your life to stand watch for a powerful syndicate
11: WORTHY
Your master has sent you to find ultimate truth in life... can you?
12: LEADER
Destined to command a team of supers. Get to work, find the members

HEROES: STUN!

When heroes clash, they can be very difficult to kill. DYING is less common for supers, with all their amazing defenses, than being STUNNED. As you read the POWERS section below, you'll see the many ways STUN POINTS (SP) play into super combat. Here's how it works.

- All heroes start with 10 SP as their maximum.
- Increase your STUN POINT MAX only by receiving max points as a REWARD
- Any time you are attacked, damaged, or hit in any way, whether you resist the damage or not, lose 1 STUN POINT.
- You can also lose STUN POINTS by spending them on POWERS. Whenever you use a POWER, spend its SP COST. All POWERS have 1, 2, and 3 SP COST options.
- When you reach 0 SP, you are STUNNED. You can no longer use your POWERS. If you are driven into negative SP, you fall to one knee, unable to go on.
- Recover STUN POINTS on your turn with a typical RECOVERY roll. Make a CON roll, recovering CON+1 HP AND SP.
- Recover to full SP between scenes.
- If rolling a natural 20 when using a POWER, pay no STUN cost.

HEROES: MAKING STUN MATTER

As the GM, the key to working with the STUN system is the critical nature of limited time in a battle or combat encounter. Heroes may have all kinds of ways of sustaining real harm, but if every second counts, being STUNNED for even a ROUND or two can spell defeat or doom for the many innocents at stake. Here are a few classic ways to press time to the absolute limit.

- Bystanders will be killed in great numbers if the machine is activated, relic unleashed, or nuclear warhead reaches the city.
- The villain will do anything to kill a specific nemesis, even blow themselves to bits in a matter of seconds.
- Every few seconds, more heroes, innocents and first responders are falling under evil mind control.
- Destabilized buildings or terrain will give way in moments, ruining any chance of success with the present mission.
- Heroes are losing STAT and HP points every ROUND, and will all succumb soon.
- The airship is about to crash, and it is using ultra-volatile hydrogen engines.

REST=REWARD

GMs, don't be shy with regenerating STUN. Be generous with SP recovery between scenes or as a reward for epic play!

HEROES: POWERS

POWERS are those superhuman abilities we all know and love from decades of comic books and movies. They are the capabilities of exceptional people and mega-humans that set them apart. Sometimes even ordinary men and women can possess POWERS through sheer force of will. POWERS often have no real explanation, and are innate to the character.

CHOOSE OR ROLL 3 HERO POWERS

1: ACROBAT: Perform amazing maneuvers, evasion, or stunts using DEX

2: BLINK: A POWER that enables flexible teleportation

3: ENERGY BLAST: Release destructive bursts of energy on command

4: FLIGHT: By some means, you can fly with amazing speed and precision

5: GADGETS: You are a master of inventions and amazing machines

6: IMMUNITY: You are impervious to a certain kind of harm

7: INVISIBLE: By degrees, you have incredible stealth

8: KILLSHOT: There is no better shot in the world than you

9: LUCKY: You have a knack for walking away from explosions

10: MARTIAL ARTS: Your ability to fight is superhuman

11: MEGABRAIN: Super-intelligence, psychic visions, and mind control

12: MIND > MATTER: Use thought to affect physical objects and materials

13: PHASE: Become immaterial or pass through walls

14: PLASTIC: Change, stretch, or rebound with a rubbery body chemistry

15: REGENERATION: You can heal injury and regrow damaged tissue

16: SONIC: Manipulate sound in destructive or useful ways

17: SUPER SENSES: See, smell or hear for miles, detect details with touch

18: SUPER SPEED: Run or fly at mind-bending speeds

19: SUPER STRENGTH: You are stronger than any human could ever be

20: TRANSFORM: Change into something, including all of its abilities

DESCRIBING POWERS

The POWERS table lists 20 types of super ability. As you create your character, it's up to you and your GM to get specific. The listings below will give you the basic mechanics and MASTERY changes to each POWER, but the details are up to you. ENERGY BLAST, for example, could include all kinds of different abilities with nuanced details and verbal cues that solidify your hero concept. A blast of pure laser energy from the eyes? A beam of green radiation from clenched fists? Bolts of semi-solid plasma from a cybernetic implant?

POWERS LISTINGS

Each power is listed with its most common forms. Pay 1, 2, or 3 STUN POINTS (SP) to perform actions, unless MASTERED, then only pay 1 no matter its normal cost.

MASTERING POWERS

Heroes who have been fighting crime for years have MASTERY of their POWERS. MASTERY is a process of refining the body mechanics and endurance needed to perform superhuman feats.

PAY ONLY 1 STUN POINT (SP) FOR ANY USE OF A MASTERED POWER

For any POWER, 4 steps of MASTERY are needed to gain MASTERY benefits. MASTERY is awarded to the character when they perform an incredible success or dramatic sacrifice using that specific POWER. The GM will witness this event and announce "mark a point of MASTERY! Incredible!"

POWER: ACROBAT

Perform near-impossible maneuvers, evasion, or stunts using DEX

SP COST 1: Use any terrain to maneuver: Roll DEX to roll, swing, flip or tumble on roofs, vehicles, tightropes or flagpoles to move FAR. When moving in this way, you cannot be harmed on that ROUND
SP COST 2: Evade an attack instantly, once per ROUND with a DEX roll
SP COST 3: Perform a stunt on your TURN. Describe any feasible move, with all kinds of possible or specific outcomes and aspects. Make it with a DEX roll

POWER: BLINK

A POWER that enables flexible teleportation

SP COST 1: Zap from one place to another, moving NEAR or FAR instantly. No roll is needed.
SP COST 2: Open dynamic portals, in a pair, that are linked, with an INT roll. They are 8 feet across, and feature inter-dimensional energies. They are only open for 1D4 TURNS (not ROUNDS!) and they do not have any pulling force or suction. The furthest portal must be within DOUBLE FAR of you.
SP COST 3: Create and interlink up to 6 portals with an INT roll. Conjure baffling, highly complex portal linkage in any sequence or arrangement. The portals are now up to 16 feet across The furthest portal must be within 1 mile of you.

POWER: ENERGY BLAST

Release destructive bursts of energy on command. This blast can be described in a myriad of ways

SP COST 1: Unleash a single blast of energy with a DEX roll. It inflicts ULTIMATE damage, FAR range, and ignores traditional armor properties.
SP COST 2: Fire an unstoppable linear beam of destruction with a DEX roll. It has a range you control up to a half mile, and does ULTIMATE damage to anything in the straight line path.
SP COST 3: Blast energy in all directions, in missiles, a wave or dome. All targets within FAR must roll DEX to find cover, or evade, or take 3D12 damage. Those who succeed still take half the damage.

POWER: FLIGHT

By some means, you can fly with speed and precision. No SP cost for normal MOVES

SP COST 1: Perform a burst of flight speed. Move DOUBLE FAR in a mostly straight line, blasting through obstacles with STR and being HARD to hit.
SP COST 2: Fly with uncanny precision and dynamic trajectory. Describe a wild, fast maneuver such as threading the needle, spinning a turbine, or intercepting a jet. Execute successfully with a STR roll.
SP COST 3: Execute supersonic flight with a STR roll. You can hold this speed, in any environment, until you are injured, STUNNED, or use another POWER.

POWER: GADGETS

You are a rare master of inventions and machines. This may be innate ability or super power, depending on your unique description

SP COST 1: Fix anything mechanical instantly with an INT roll. It is restored to its full function.
SP COST 2: Create wondrous gadgets from scraps instantly with an INT roll. These gadgets have abilities comparable to STARTING LOOT, SHABBY LOOT, WEAPONS and the like.
SP COST 3: Change, combine or modify machines to be remotely controlled by your input device, mental messages or voice commands with an INT roll. The modification takes 1D4 rounds to complete.

POWER: IMMUNITY

You are impervious to a certain kind of harm. Use your description to be as specific as possible

Suggested immunity types: Blades, Bullets, Fire, Ice, Water, Stone, Energy, Punches or blunt force, Poison, Magic, Stun.

SP COST 1: All uses of IMMUNITY cost 1 SP. Any time the specified damage type hits you, choose to be immune or not, and pay SP at that moment.

POWER: INVISIBLE

By degrees, you have incredible stealth

SP COST 1: Vanish right in front of any nearby enemy or onlooker, losing your camouflage in 1 ROUND.
SP COST 2: Become truly invisible, transparent, and detectable only by heat for 1D4 ROUNDS.
SP COST 3: Achieve and maintain true invisibility for you and those CLOSE until you are damaged, STUNNED, or use another POWER .

POWER: KILLSHOT

There is no better shot in the world than you. Choose a single ranged weapon with which this applies

SP COST 1: Hit a target with your weapon with no roll, no matter circumstances or situation.
SP COST 2: Use a ricochet, wind, gravity, multi-shot or other means to hit 1D8 targets with a single motion and no roll.
SP COST 3: With a DEX roll, drop a single target to 0 HP with a single shot. This shot is still subject to the target's immunities or special properties, but not their amount of HEARTS (yes, it's terribly deadly).

POWER: LUCKY

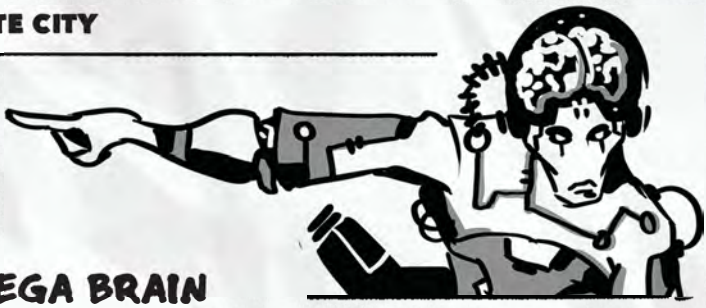
You have a knack for walking away from explosions

SP COST 1: Re-roll any roll, be it ATTEMPT or EFFORT.
SP COST 2: When something bad happens to you, such as STUN, injury, mishap or failure, describe a way in which it aids you or your team.
SP COST 3: If a situation would reduce you to 0 HP, 0 SP, crush you, burn you to ashes or blow you to pieces, find a way to describe how you narrowly avoided all harm, with just a few bruises and a smile.

POWER: MARTIAL ARTS

Your ability to punch, kick or fight with melee weapons is superhuman

SP COST 1: With an EASY STR roll, deliver a crushing attack as if it was a CRITICAL SUCCESS.
SP COST 2: Unleash a flurry of blows with your fists or weapon, using a STR roll. Your target is hit with 1D8 normal hits.
SP COST 3: Deliver a crushing smash with a STR roll. All targets CLOSE are reduced to 0 HP and take your attack's damage as STUN. This attack also destroys concrete, metal, and other structural material. This attack can also be treated as CHUNK damage.



POWER: MEGA BRAIN

Super-intelligence, psychic visions, and mind control

SP COST 1: Make any INT or WIS type ATTEMPT with no roll, gleaning all the details or workings of a situation, person or place.
SP COST 2: Read the thoughts, memories, or intentions of a target with an INT roll. Pay this same cost and use INT to resist such an ATTEMPT against you.
SP COST 3: Extend your mind-reading power, or implant thoughts or verbal messages, in any number of targets within a mile with an INT roll.

POWER: MIND > MATTER

You can use the power of thought to affect physical objects and materials

SP COST 1: Move or alter small objects with no roll.
SP COST 2: With an INT roll, lift, hurl or destroy any object or mass up to a car in size. This POWER can be used to achieve flight by 'hurling' yourself or others. If a target is resisting your power, they can roll against your INT roll.
SP COST 3: Roll INT to describe a wild feat of telekinetic power. Send a bus flying, crumple a tank, topple a house, bring down a helicopter or lift a huge mass of concrete. This effect can be sustained until you are damaged, STUNNED, or use another POWER.

POWER: PHASE

Become immaterial or pass through walls

SP COST 1: Make a NEAR MOVE in phased form, passing through solids.
SP COST 2: Use phasing in combat to avoid an attack. When you are hit, roll CON. Elect to instantly phase, avoiding any damage or STUN.
SP COST 3: With a CON roll on your TURN, extend phase POWER to another person or object up to bus size. With a normal roll, phase it for 1 ROUND. With a HARD roll, phase it for 1D4 ROUNDS. If an enemy is phased into solid matter, they take ULTIMATE damage and are forced outward.

POWER: PLASTIC

Change, stretch, or rebound with a rubber-like body chemistry

SP COST 1: Extend a limb or body part up to 10 times its normal length, then snap back.
SP COST 2: With a CON roll, extend your entire body to 50 times its length. Sustain this extension until damaged, STUNNED, or using another POWER.
SP COST 3: Roll CON to stretch, morph and twist into any single-shaped object you can describe such as a raft, parachute, boulder, giant ball, or sail. Maintain this shape for a number of ROUNDS equal to your CON STAT.

POWER: REGENERATION

You can heal injury and regrow damaged tissue

SP COST 1: Shrug off either the entire HP or SP inflicted on you in the previous ROUND with a CON roll.
SP COST 2: Roll CON to recover to full SP or HP.
SP COST 3: As long as you have 3 SP when killed, dropped, or blown to bits, regrow tissue, broken bones and severed limbs from ANY state of death in 1D6 ROUNDS. Return to action with 1 HP and 1 SP. If your REGENERATION TIMER is longer than your DYING TIMER, this effect cannot take place in time and you die as normal, must roll a natural 20, or need help from an ally to avoid permanent death.

POWER: SONIC

Manipulate sound in destructive or useful ways. Sound is especially useful to inflict STUN

SP COST 1: With a STR roll, blast a single NEAR target with focused sound waves. Inflict your BASIC EFFORT amount in STUN POINTS.
SP COST 2: Roll STR to emit an omni-directional sonic wave. It hits all targets that can hear within FAR range, and inflicts BASIC EFFORT in STUN POINTS. Targets hit can roll CON to halve this STUN amount.
SP COST 3: Roll STR. In 1D4 ROUNDS, unleash a destructive explosion of sonic energy that can vibrate structures, vehicles or terrain to rubble. Any targets that can hear within FAR of this blast automatically absorb 3 STUN damage, and 1D8 buildings, vehicles or terrain features are totally destroyed.

POWER: SUPER SENSES

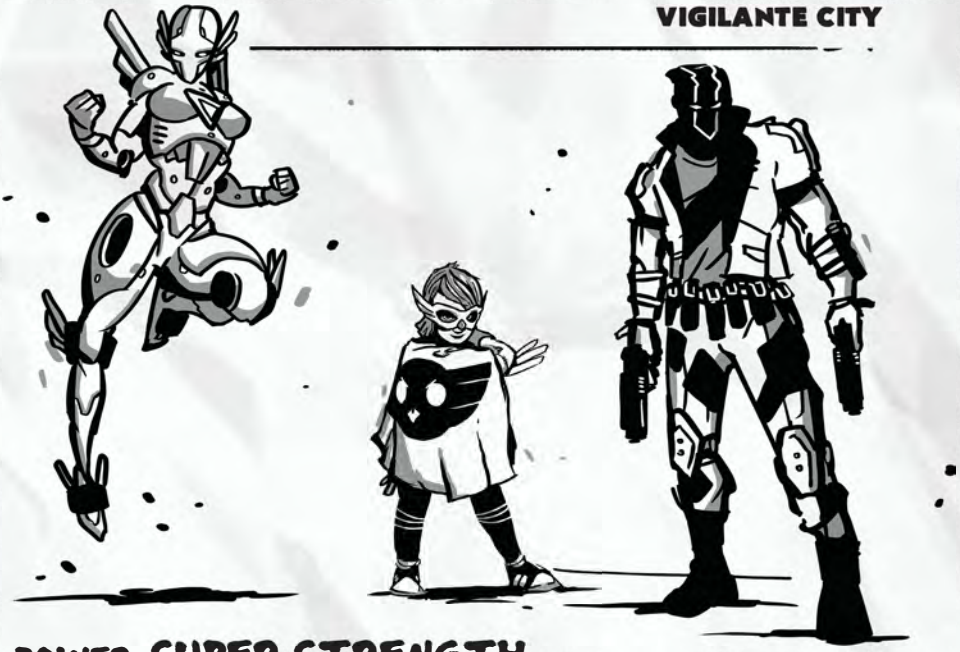
See, smell or hear for miles, or detect subtle details with touch

SP COST 1: See, hear or smell with a WIS roll, but with a range of 5 miles.
SP COST 2: Touch a surface, person or object. With a WIS roll, discern a vast amount of information on that subject by trace evidence.
SP COST 3: Choose one sense to describe this POWER. With that sense only, a WIS roll can be used to sense through solid matter, vast distances, or blocking measures. It is almost impossible to hide from your keen awareness, even in the stars.

POWER: SUPER SPEED

Run or fly at mind-bending speeds

SP COST 1: Rules of distance for movement do not apply to you. MOVE as far as you want on your TURN.
SP COST 2: Move no further than NEAR and take TWO ACTIONS on your TURN.
SP COST 3: Roll DEX. Describe an effect created by the unthinkable speeds at which you take ACTIONS or MOVE. Beware, though... at these speeds, failures and mistakes can be catastrophic.



POWER: SUPER STRENGTH

You are exponentially stronger than any human could ever be

SP COST 1: When you attack with your fists or a melee weapon, roll ULTIMATE + STR damage.
SP COST 2: Roll STR to perform a feat of super strength such as throwing a car, ripping a bus apart, stopping a train or swinging a small boat by its anchor.
SP COST 3: With a STR roll, perform an unbelievable demonstration of strength and leverage. Catch a flying jetliner, knock over a small building, throw a cargo ship, crush a submarine, pull a rocket from orbit, or hold your ground in a huge tsunami.

POWER: TRANSFORM

Change into something, including all of its abilities when you do so. This form can include its own POWERS or even STATS. BE sure to work with your GM to create an alternate form that works

SP COST 1: Become your alternate form with no roll, for 1D4 ROUNDS.
SP COST 2: CON roll, become your alternate form until you are reduced to 0 SP.
SP COST 3: CON roll, become your alternate form until you are reduced to 0 HP.

Reverting from your alternate form is not something you can control at will.

PROPERTIES

PROPERTIES are passive aspects of your hero that make them hard to kill, unpredictable, or unique even among other supers. Choose 3 to match your hero concept below, or trust the dice and devise a story to fit. Not all PROPERTIES will make your hero stronger! Some of them add flavor, oddity or potential story, or can be used to explain or 'balance' other PROPERTIES or POWERS.

CHOOSE OR ROLL 3 HERO PROPERTIES

1: AMMO FOR DAYS

2: BEEN THERE, DONE THAT

3: COSMIC ENEMIES

4: ELECTRO

5: GENETICS

6: IMMORTAL

7: IMPACT RESIST

8: INHUMAN

9: INVENTED

10: JUST A BADASS

11: RELENTLESS

12: RET-CONNED

13: SANCTUM

14: SUPERCAR

15: VOLATILE

16: WAR ZONE

17: WHAT WE FIGHT FOR

18: WEIRD WEAKNESS

19: XENOCHEMICAL

20: X FACTOR: GAIN 1 EXTRA POWER & WEAKNESS

PROPERTY: AMMO FOR DAYS
Super Soldiers have clips and ammunition hidden all over. Any weapon that uses ammo has unlimited capacity in their hands.

PROPERTY: BEEN THERE, DONE THAT
You've been fighting the good fight for years. Seen it all. Start with 3 MASTERY in 2 of your POWERS.

PROPERTY: COSMIC ENEMIES
Your arcane power draws the worst kind of curiosity: demonic and cosmic evil seeks to investigate, destroy, or devour you.

PROPERTY: ELECTRO
Using any source of electrical power, you can restore full SP. If YOUR SP is full, a powerful electrical source can make all your actions ULTIMATE for 1D4 ROUNDS.

PROPERTY: GENETICS
Start with 1 MASTERY in all your POWERS.

PROPERTY: IMMORTAL
You cannot be killed. Even if DEAD or BLOWN TO BITS, you will reconstitute, reform, or mysteriously return from parts unknown in 1D8 days.

PROPERTY: IMPACT RESIST
You do not take damage from any fall, even from the stratosphere, unless the impact occurs while you are STUNNED or DYING, in which case this feature does not function.

PROPERTY: INHUMAN
You are no mortal creature. Humans hate or fear you, the authorities will contain or track you... even friends are frightened of what you may become.

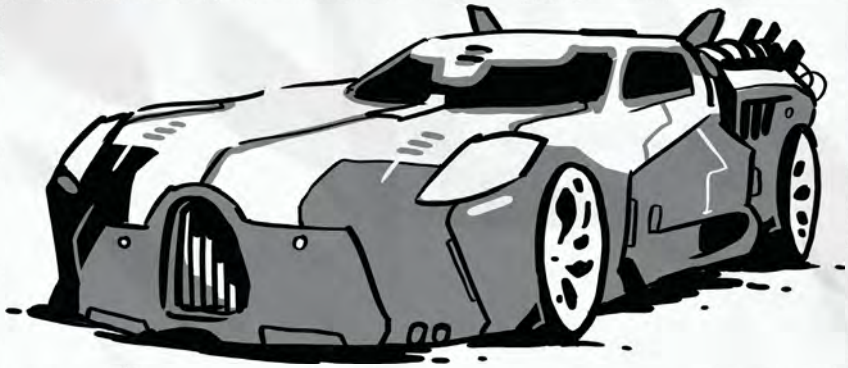
PROPERTY: INVENTED
All your POWERS are the result of oddball inventions and objects. List each on your sheet. You have replacements for each in a safe place, but some fights may rob you of these precious doo-dads.

PROPERTY: JUST A BADASS
Your POWERS, by some explanation, are not POWERS. You have made your way as a superhero with training. Use SP or HP to use POWERS.

PROPERTY: RELENTLESS
You just don't stay down. Roll a 15+ to pop up with 1 HP when DYING.

PROPERTY: RET-CONNED
Veterans like you have had their story lines revamped several times. Any time you encounter a super VILLAIN, you have already battled them, maybe even killed or been killed by them. Your look has been redesigned several times.

PROPERTY: SANCTUM
You have a home base somewhere in the city. It is expertly hidden, contains SUPPLIES, basic adventure equipment, and a crime computer. Supervillains in the city are always searching for this sanctum to take as their own.



PROPERTY: SUPERCAR
You have designed and built an incredible vehicle with weapons, sensors, and astonishing speed. You have a hiding place for it somewhere in the city.

PROPERTY: VOLATILE
Your power can be hard to control, with a destructive will of its own. Any time you roll to use a POWER, and roll a 1 or 2, the GM takes control of you for that ROUND, and may take 3 ACTIONS.

PROPERTY: WAR ZONE
Super Soldiers like you are trained in all forms of military gear, from weapons to vehicles to computer equipment. Their rolls are always EASY when working with any kind of military tech.

PROPERTY: WHAT WE FIGHT FOR
You often become a spiritual or moral anchor for a super team. Your virtue and bravery are infectious. The greatest heroes will make terrible sacrifices to see a kid survive to fight another day.

PROPERTY: WEIRD WEAKNESS
Roll on the weakness table. Some of your foes know this weakness.

PROPERTY: XENOCHEMICAL
Your chemistry is not of earth. You are immune to acid, poison, toxins or viral contagion.

WEAKNESSES

By the same strangeness that human beings become super human, they sometimes carry a crippling weakness that can undo their power, frighten or shrivel them. This is usually an integral part of their back story, and comes to bear at the worst possible times. If a weakness fits your unique hero concept, follow these simple guidelines below, or work with your GM.

You can choose or devise your WEAKNESS, or use the tables below to roll one up.

If you voluntarily take a WEAKNESS without the 'Weird Weakness' PROPERTY, instantly master 1 of your POWERS.

ROLL 1D10 WEAKNESS

1: Substance	If anywhere near you
2: Color	If visible
3: Machines	If touching you
4: Plants	If touching you or pollinating
5: Water	If touching you/submerged
6: Body Part	A limb or spot is vulnerable
7: Magic Relic	If anywhere near you
8: Alien Tech	If activated against you
9: Fear	Of a specific phenomenon
10: Person	If they interact with you

ROLL 1D10 WEAKNESS EFFECT

1: Crippled	Overcome with STR
2: Terrified	Overcome with CHA
3: Mortal	Lose the use of POWERS
4: Blinded	Overcome with CON
5: Dizzy	Overcome with DEX
6: Confused	Attack allies
7: Overload	Use POWERS at SP 3 only
8: Stunned	Drop to 0 SP
9: Exposed	Your ARMOR is gone
10: Revert	Transform into a lesser form

VILLAINS

Our heroes are driven by their adversaries: those who would destroy the city, crave ultimate power, or even darker schemes. Each week in Vigilante City, a new threat appears to challenge the good guys. To get started, use these 3 roll tables. After a few sessions, deeper truths and plots should emerge.

ROLL 1D12 THIS WEEK IN VIGILANTE CITY...

1: UNLIKELY ALLIES: Heroes must team up with a super villain to meet a threat
2: CIVIL WAR: One hero has gone rogue, and must be stopped
3: RISE OF EVIL: A league of evil supers is multiplying daily
4: SUPER KILLER: Someone is assassinating super heroes each night
5: OUTLAWED: The government moves to ban all supers and vigilantes
6: HERALD OF DOOM: An extraterrestrial visitor warns of a terror from space
7: THE SPHERE: A mysterious relic hovers above the city... what does it want?
8: CRAZIES: The asylum is breached, and the criminally insane run wild
9: HOSTAGE: A villain holds the city hostage with a weapon of mass destruction
10: DEPLOYED: The military is outmatched and calls on a team of heroes
11: VIRUS: Something is infecting man and machines in the city
12: OMEGA: An infinitely powerful super has lost control of their powers

Doesn't sound so bad, but wait, there's more. Now that you have your 'This Week' headline, and a few ideas of what it could mean for the heroes, it's time to look closer at the dark shadows of Vigilante City. What's lurking there? An evil scheme, and its diabolical master. It's gonna be a long night.

VILLAINS

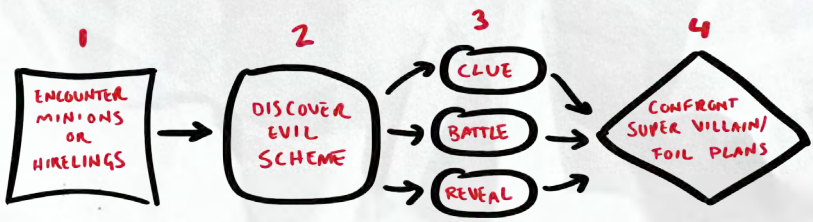
Complete your story concept with these two rolls. Explaining where they all collide should give you plenty to set things in motion and challenge players.

ROLL 1D12 THE EVIL SCHEME...

1: SECOND CRISIS: Build a device that will unleash another wave of mutations
2: REVERSION RAY: Complete a weapon that nullifies all POWERS
3: WINTER SOLDIERS: Find and awaken a group of powerful super soldiers
4: WORLDWIDE: Extend the conditions of Grey Heights to the entire earth
5: AMNESTY DAY: Release all imprisoned super villains on a single day
6: CLEANSING: Humans are a sickness. This plan will end them
7: NEW EDEN: Establish and populate a remote home for super humans
8: THE HIGH TABLE: Eliminate the world's criminals to create a monopoly
9: GATEWAY: Open a cosmic doorway to allow entry for craven forces
10: AREA 43: Acquire and control relics and materials from alien technology
11: HIGH STAKES: Force super humans into a twisted game of survival
12: METEOR: Allow a meteor to hit earth to acquire cosmic minerals

ROLL 1D12 ...AND ITS MASTER

1: BRAIN X: He has devised a foolproof plan with several safeguards
2: DESTROYER: Combat power and survival skill will see his plan done
3: DR. ATOM: Mere mortals can't fathom the dimensions he will fold
4: EZRA EVIL: Hacks city computers to turn heroes against each other
5: GOD'S HAND: Undead Egyptian creatures aid her evil plans
6: GOO JIRA: He randomly rampages to get what he wants
7: GREEN MAN: A web of lies will present dead ends and decoys
8: INCINERATOR: He never speaks. He only burns it all down
9: THE IRON CLAN: They are infinite in number, always vanishing
10: MONSTRO: His plan unfolds, one grisly murder at a time
11: PHARAOH: An untouchable demigod who fears no one
12: RAX: RAX orchestrates his plan from a ship in orbit



VILLAINS: BRAIN X

MIND RAY: A blast of STUN force in all directions. All enemies within FAR roll CON or take 1D12 STUN.

SABOTAGE: INT roll, transmit a jamming beam into any 1 piece of LOOT. That LOOT does not function for 4 ROUNDS.

TRAP: Nano-magnets have been pre-placed by Brain X. All enemies he can see must roll DEX or be stuck in place until making a HARD STR roll to break free.

ION BEAM: Brain X uses his ruby retinas to fire a deadly beam of energy. The beam always does 12 HP damage on a single target he can see.

Brain X is held in a transparent duranium fluid capsule, and can be transported to any cybernetic vessel. His strange intellect has no grasp of human suffering. He fights with lies, trickery, and armies of minions.

VILLAINS: DESTROYER

ASSAULT RIFLES: Both rifles fire in a spray. All targets not in cover, and in front of Destroyer, must roll DEX to evade or take 1D12.

SMART MISSILE: A green laser sight targets 1 creature. As long as the dot is there, target will be hit with a tiny missile each ROUND, rolling CON when hit. A successful roll halves 1D12 HP and 1D12 STUN .

ADAPTIVE SABERS: These melee weapons can overcome any form of superhuman damage immunity. Destroyer attacks with a double melee flurry. The sabers do 1D8 each.

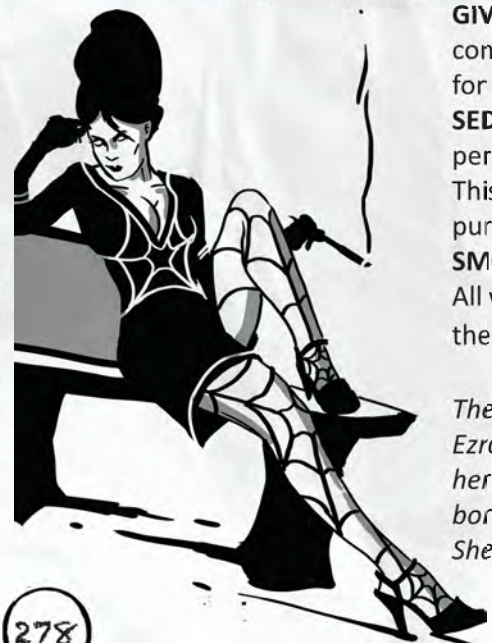
STUN PULSE: All enemies within FAR must roll CON or take 1D12 STUN damage from this sonic attack.

Destroyer works for any employer who can afford him, taking payment only in platinum bars. His origin and purpose are completely unknown. His fighting style is evasive, using cover, vertical surfaces, and speed.

VILLAINS: DR. ATOM

ACCELERATE: Move any current TIMER ahead 1D4 ROUNDS instantly. Time also jumps to whoever won the 'who goes first' roll of the encounter.
ERASE: Any event in the previous ROUND can be undone by this being, but only 1 such event. Effects are unpredictable.
QUANTUM DEFENSE: Dr Atom recovers any previous damage, raises the TARGET by 1
STAFF OF STARS: The being strikes with a cosmic weapon, with no roll. 1 CLOSE target takes 1D12 HP and SP.

DR ATOM is an evil, extragalactic visitor. This being is far darker than any silly doomsday headline. Dr. Atom fights by bending time and gravity, and never showing fear.



VILLAINS: EZRA EVIL

HACK: Any electronically-controlled LOOT or POWERS do not function within FAR of Ezra.
GIVE UP: She sits down and stops whatever conflict may be occurring. Difficult to budge for 1D4 ROUNDS.
SEDUCE: With a CHA roll, Ezra convinces one person of her cause, in all its twisted glory. This person is completely taken with her purpose for 1D4 ROUNDS.
SMOKE: Ezra finds a place to sit and smokes. All who can see her must roll CHA or delay all their plans for 1D4 ROUNDS.

There's goth, there's evil, and then there's Ezra. Her female sadism is matched only by her vast intelligence and sinister wit. She is bored but never boring, a true siren to all. She fights mainly with words.

VILLAINS: GOD'S HAND

BLOOD: All who oppose God's Hand in the Immediate area must roll CON or drop to 1 HP and 1 SP instantly.
STORMS: Tornadoes and lighting storms. Wind fought with STR rolls, lighting strikes in 3 random places per ROUND, doing 3D12 HP and 1D12 SP damage to those hit.
LOCUSTS: Locusts are summoned and get 1 free WEAPON attack on any foes in sight.
DEATH: God's Hand chooses one target. They get a CON roll, or drop dead instantly. This victim is not just at 0 HP, but fully dead, revivable only by resurrection.
Regeneration and immunity do not apply.

God's Hand is a name given to this being, who never speaks. Her power is terrifying, though, and is believed responsible for many biblical events.

VILLAINS: GOO JIRA

SMASH: His fists become giant spiked flails and crush any 1 target or object he attacks to 0 HP. This applies to objects as large as a bus.
PSEUDOPOD: The ooze extends to FAR range and pierces anything in a long, straight line. Targets so pierced must roll DEX or are reduced to 0 HP instantly.
SPLIT: Goo Jira splits into two full selves. Whatever HEARTS he has at that time are divided between the two.
GROW: Goo Jira roars and grows in mass by 50%, gaining 1 HEART and healing to full HP.

Goo Jira was caught in a chemical spill. His unstable form, already a terror at that time, became worse, and he is barely human anymore. He is driven by rage.

VILLAINS: GREEN MAN

THUMPER PISTOL: A pistol WEAPON that never misses and inflicts 3 SP even if resisted
STABBY: Green Man slices and dances around. His target takes 1D4 WEAPON cuts.
ALL TEETH: If very CLOSE, Green Man will bite his enemy's face, ears or nose off.
GREEN GAS: From micro nozzles in his suit, Green Man releases a cloud of poisonous gas.
BRING THE CAR AROUND: With a hidden transmitter, Green Man summons his super-car and 1D8 tuxedo'd henchmen. They arrive instantly.

Green Man is the inevitable lunatic megalomaniac/prankster super criminal driven by some twisted sense of chaotic amusement that is unpredictable, nihilistic, and long winded.

VILLAINS: INCINERATOR

FLAME BURST: With an attack, Incinerator sprays a target with a stream of burning plasma, inflicting 1D12 HP and destroying 1D4 pieces of LOOT instantly.
SMOKE BOMB: This wall of thick smoke obscures all vision, FAR in radius, and dissipates after 1D6 ROUNDS.
JET SLIDE: A DEX roll lets Incinerator dart to any location in the current scene instantly.
RESPIRATOR BOOST: Incinerator injects an adrenaline compound into his breather mask. This heals all his current damage, and adds 1 to all his rolls.

This is the worst kind of pyromaniac: one with prototype military hardware and an endless appetite to see it all burn.

VILLAINS: THE IRON CLAN

WE ARE MANY: With this action, 1D6 more assassins appear, 'cloning' out of others.
ODACHI SLASH: Swords flash.
SHURIKEN: A ranged WEAPON.
SMOKE JUMP: With a quick puff of smoke, an assassin can relocate to any location in the current scene instantly.
UNIFY: Several assassins reform or use visual trickery to combine their numbers.
COLLATERAL DAMAGE: The Iron Clan will cut down power lines, start fires, destabilize buildings, or kill innocents to disrupt and lure their foes.

The Iron Clan is an ancient, silent order of deadly assassins with an unclear purpose. They have no leader, and a seemingly infinite number in their ranks.

VILLAINS: MONSTRO

RAZOR CLAW: ULTIMATE melee attack, no roll, CLOSE range.
SAW SPINES: Poison-tipped barbs that do ULTIMATE SP damage
DART SPITTER: Tiny spine-darts fly in all directions, inflicting WEAPON damage. If the darts are not 'picked out' of the skin, they will do WEAPON damage again every ROUND until removed.
HYDRO RAY: Monstro launches a gout of bio liquid from his unhinged jaw. It corrodes metal doing 1D12 extra damage, and does WEAPON damage to all enemies in front of Monstro .

Part insect, part leech, part sea urchin, part cobra. He fights with savage speed and feral unpredictability.

VILLAINS: PHARAOH

SAND: Pharaoh can conjure, control, shape or destroy sand, concrete or stone in any form.

SNAKES: Pharaoh can summon dozens of snakes, a single gigantic snake, control snakes, or even change his underlings into snakes.

CRUSH: When angry, Pharaoh will smash with his fists. Any victim attacked is dropped to 1 HP and 0 SP instantly.

RAISE DEAD: With a gesture, Pharaoh can raise any dead creatures within his sight, or those nearby below the ground, to do his bidding.

Pharaoh is a demigod, from whom most Egyptian emperors all descended. Moreso, he is a tyrant, moving through centuries to dominate and destroy mankind.

VILLAINS: RAX

CHAIN SWORD: An Imperium WEAPON. Rax attacks with no roll and always does 1D12+4 damage.

ENERGY CANNON: With a ranged attack roll, Rax fires a triple shot energy gun that inflicts 3D8 HP and SP damage on 1-3 targets.

RECOVERY UNIT: Rax recovers 1 HEART with no roll.

DRAIN UNIT: Rax focuses on 1 enemy, grabs them, and drains them. The victim loses 1 HEART, which Rax gains, and 1 POWER, which Rax also absorbs. A CON roll by the victim can recover the POWER.

Imperator Rax is an Imperium Ghost Armor from deep space, known to appear in many forms in various time streams. His arrival is a signal that The Imperium will attack soon.

BE A SUPER-GM

DESIGN VILLAIN HEARTS AND STATS

The bad guys listed here are listed with no STATS or HEARTS. That's for you to decide, based on your campaign. Consider the TIER approach on page 145.

DEVELOP RHYTHM 'TWEEN MOOKS AND TITANS

Yes, the heroes can decimate a battalion of soldiers. All normal human foes are 1 HP and do 1 point of damage when attacking. Then, when they get all gassed up, bring the unstoppable bad-ass. The magic is in variety.

CONSOLIDATE GROUPS OF COMBATANTS

40 ninja can be cumbersome to run. Combine 1 token or mini with a counter. 'This is 10 ninja.' Reinforce the insanity with your descriptions of the chaos.

PUT VILLAINS' FOCUS ON INNOCENTS

The best way to hurt heroes is to crush, threaten, or trap innocents.

CONSIDER THE NO-ROLL ACTION

Give some of your baddies no-roll POWERS. Do lots of STUN damage to frighten players. No roll saves time, scares players, and sets a supers game apart.

OSCILLATE DAMAGE TYPES

Use the elements, STUN, concussion, armor-shattering sound waves, and all kinds of weird damage to keep them guessing. Billy clubs do not impress supers.

STUMP RATHER THAN KILL

Overall, use your hazards moreso to befuddle or immobilize the heroes rather than brutish near-death battles. Pin them down, make them unable to reach the goal, or cause collateral damage to wound them.

BLOOD AND SNOW: A TIME BEFORE TIME

The ice ages have remained shrouded in mystery, even after millennia have unfolded. The ice has a way of wiping away evidence of what took place in those vast epochs of time when mankind was exploring a then-virgin Earth. Imagine the countless adventures of those centuries, whose secrets are lost forever!

Blood and Snow rejects the all-too-common 'caveman' view of our ancestors. This ancient world is one of nuances, and subtleties, languages, religions and wonders... a world wide with silence, but thick with meaning and omens.

Imagine the awe and omens of a world with no true metals, no science, no government. Even familiar tribal and feudal social structures were strangers to folk so closely tied to nature. What could their lives have been like? Their wars? Their treks? Their lost loves?

Great and terrible storms sweep the frozen plains. Vast swaths of snow and ice blanket the mountains. Humankind clings to survival, but stands at the brink of so many new frontiers. This is Blood and Snow.

WAYS TO USE THIS WORLD

As a setting or region for your game…
The continents of the ice age are hidden, unfamiliar, and rife with peril and promise. Blood and Snow can be transplanted as a planet, region, nation or dimension in any game. When the ice stretches on forever, when the wind is as deadly as the claw, when the sun is a pale grey ghost... this is your setting.

Degrading GEAR and DEFENSE...
As an option to give Blood and Snow more character, treat DEFENSE as an ablative, or disposable STAT. When taking damage, mark off 1 DEFENSE permanently. You'll find yourself desperate to repair or find armor. Reinforce this feel by making any natural 1 break the implement or WEAPON being used.

Prehistoric ABILITIES...
Players can never be offered enough options to build and create new heroes. Far-footed wanderers, outlanders, or city-shunning nomads might use these options to construct themselves. You're a Game Master; the conversions are easy. Blood and Snow offers the conceptual roots that can build a truly foreign hero backstory. Let them cherry pick all of it for their own vision!

Let the dice conjure a snowbound campaign...
The table below gets you started. Often, the beginning can be the most puzzling time for both player and Game Master, as there are so many possibilities. Blood and Snow takes a focused, small-scale approach to campaign building. Make it human, make it desperate, make it tangible. As the details of survival play out, the larger story can take form. This is a ruthless world, so with all the gravity I can muster, I say to you: May your dice roll high.

HOW IT ALL BEGAN...

The quiet but difficult life of these survivors in the frozen epoch is interrupted. Something or someone stirs you and your allies from the village to the horizon, from safety to danger, from the daily grind to the rush of adventure. Choose or roll below to find out how it all began for you.

HOW IT ALL BEGAN... ROLL 1D20

1: LOST HUNTERS: You've become lost seeking game for your village

2: KEEPERS OF THE DEAD: Take the chief's ashes to the burial stone

3: THE BANISHED: Inevitable violence gets you cast out to the wastes

4: VENGEANCE: A slain girl needs avenging, and you have chosen to do it

5: LOST HOPE: Your people must relocate, and you must find where

6: MAMMOTH TRACKERS: Starving, desperate, you've tracked too far

7: HOMEWARD: Afield for months, your only goal is to get home

8: THE PROPHECY: The seer has chosen you to pursue a cryptic destiny

9: GREEN DRAGON: The storms in the stars lead you to distant lands

10: THE ENVOY: A young boy must be taken to the Mudmen

11: EAGLE OMEN: Your charge: to follow the great bird to promised lands

12: THE GATHERING: Find and trade with the hundred tribes at Grey Fork

13: SENTINELS: The enemy is coming, and you lead the defenses

14: THE RAID: Find, break, and plunder those who defile your homeland

15: METAL MEN: Rumors of metal-working folk draw your chief's greed

16: CRYSTAL CALL: Defy all you hold dear to answer a strange hum

17: OASIS: A green land is told of in legends. You set out to find it

18: RELIC SEEKERS: You must beg the demigod for a single favor

19: RELIC SEEKERS: You must learn if the Teachers are real

20: RELIC SEEKERS: You must find a way to stop the worsening storms

DESOLATE DISTANCES

In the frozen world of Blood and Snow, death is close. It can be important to forewarn the danger of this world, so they aren't shocked or discouraged. It has been said 'danger is the great unifier.' This is true, but worth mentioning with emphasis. Expect players to lose two or more characters on any one quest. To mitigate this, consider three or more characters per player when embarking. With so many heroes afield, the lifeblood of an entire village can be spent in one sojourn, and so the gravity of this deadly game is revealed.

There are no HEART STONES, resurrections, or healing spells in Blood and Snow. This is due to a larger truth that should chill a player's blood: **there is no magic, in any form**. Beyond this truth, there are a thousand dooms to discover here.

TREKKING

To move from place to place is no small undertaking in this world. **1 DAY OF TRAVEL = 10 MILES TRAVELLED = 1 SUPPLY USED (PER 4 PEOPLE). ROLL 1 HAZARD AND 1 WEATHER PER DAY TRAVELLING.**

LANDSCAPES ENCOUNTERED... ROLL 1D20

1: ICE SHEET: 2D10 miles of ice stand 'tween you and your goal
2: ICE SHEET: Vast 4D10 miles of ice must be crossed to reach your goal
3: BROKEN ICE: Roll 1D4 hazards to cross
4: BROKEN ICE: Roll 1D4 hazards, and travel at 1/10th typical speed
5: SNOW LANDS: 1D10 miles of very deep snow
6: SNOW LANDS: Known trails and way-stops, travel is FAST and EASY here
7: SNOW LANDS: Frontier log fences hold warring TRIBES at bay
8: OUTCROP: A tower of rock. Foraging is HARD, Scouting is EASY
9: OUTCROP: Roll for MEGAFAUNA or warring TRIBES
10: OUTCROP: A camp of warring PEOPLES has made camp here
11: PINE LANDS: Wood and cover are abundant. Ignore STRATOFALL
12: PINE LANDS: 2D10 miles of Pine Lands must be crossed
13: PINE LANDS: Encounter a large hunting camp. Roll for its PEOPLE
14: THAW: Re-roll MEGAFAUNA rolls until a beast is encountered
15: THAW: Re-roll MEGAFAUNA for an encounter, travel 1/4 speed
16: THAW: Travel normally
17: THAW: Travel normally, forage or make camp with EASY rolls
18-20: Navigate to your destination immediately

ICE SHEET
Traveling on the ice sheets is only done as a last resort. Some stretch for a hundred or more uninterrupted miles of perfect desolation. No rock, no plants, no shelter, and the winds here are never ending. Hunting and foraging are utterly impossible here, unless the quarry be other humans.

BROKEN ICE
At the glacier's edge, near lakeshores, or in the low foothills, ice forms and breaks into a baffling landscape of leaning shards, frozen boulders, and bottomless fissures. While not as desolate as the ice sheets, broken ice is far more difficult to traverse, requiring four times the travel time and supply than open ground.

SNOW LANDS
Most common of all landscapes in this world is the snow lands. Snows drift ten to twenty feet deep but are generally between two and eight feet in depth. Elder pines survive here, piercing the snow and forming deep, powdery snow wells. Smaller plant and animal life are common here, too. Where snow lands meet the mountains, cave dwelling beasts and tribes of men make their homes.

OUTCROPS
In all environs besides the ice sheet, jagged knives of stone pierce the white expanse. These are often utilized as shelter by all kinds of creatures and serve as landmarks for travelers. The particularly large ones are valuable territory for any alpha-level predators, including human kind.

PINE LANDS
The rare green jewels of a frozen world are crowded with pine trees, succulent undergrowth, and lichen-coated stones. Flowing water, fish, and small animals of all kinds can be found here. Large enough pine lands are the seats of the largest human tribes and fought over fiercely. When a cave coincides with pine lands, it is an ideal place for a large tribe to set permanent camp. In these places, human technology and culture is the most advanced.

THAW
Even more rare than pine forests are the warm places of the world. These include deciduous woods, grassy lakebeds, and cool-watered peat bogs. Here, some of the strangest beasts make their lairs, like the River Giant or Hook. The insects are horrific, but the value of oil-black peat tar make excursions worthwhile. Sucking tar and other perils make travel here twice as costly and hazardous as open ground.

HAZARDS

Roll once on the table below for each day spent traveling across open land. Players should be thinking up ways to AVOID this roll!

ROLL 1D20 TREKKING HAZARDS

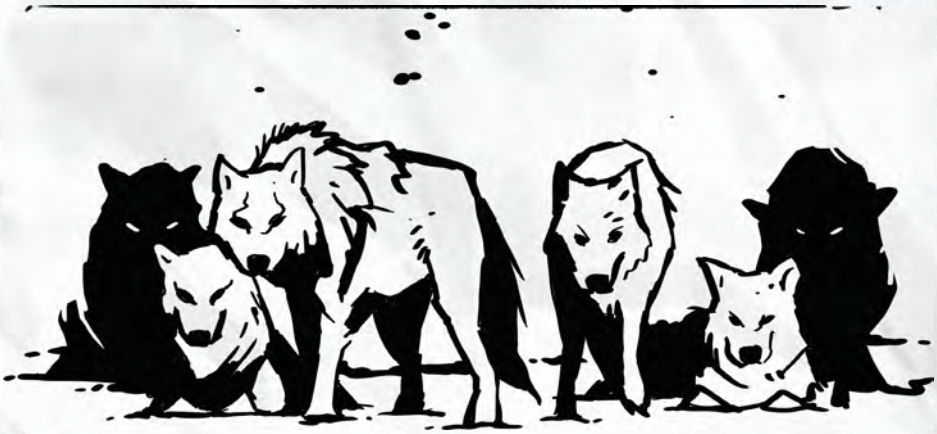
1: WAR BAND ENCOUNTER: 1D10 blood enemies in the wild
2: CRAZED HERD: A column of stampeding beasts slams into your camp
3: SPOOKED GIANT: A River Giant or Mammoth attacks in a confused rage
4: PILFERED! Unseen raiders steal 1D8 pieces of equipment
5: ALPHA PREDATOR: You are hunted by a colossal Sword Tooth or Anacon
6: INJURY: Sprained ankle! Travel at half speed for 1D4 days
7: BAD OMEN: Haunting weirdness in the wild. All rolls are HARD this trek
8: EARTHQUAKE: Cut off! Re-roll your landscape and lose all progress
9: PREDATOR: Your group is stalked by 1D8 Black Wolves each night
10: TRAP: A hunter's trap ensnares one of you! Take 1D6 damage
11: FISSURE: Go around. Expend 3 extra SUPPLY
12: MOLD: Your food is spoiled far too soon. Expend 2 SUPPLY
13: CLUMSY: Oops! Destroy 1 piece of equipment
14: BAD HUNT: No game to hunt out here, expend 1 extra SUPPLY
15: BARREN: Foraging yields nothing
16: HOPELESS: One member of your group is simply gone one morning
17: WRONG WAY: You waste a day looking for the trail
18-20: No Hazard A good day

WEATHER

Roll once on the table below for each day spent traveling across open land. Can also be useful when in shelter. Weather rolls cannot be avoided.

WEATHER AND DEADLY COLD... ROLL 1D20

1: STRATOFALL: Super-chilled air from space. Make a CON roll or drop to 0 HP.
2: ICE STORM: Travel impossible. Take 1D6 damage, expend 2 SUPPLY.
3: HOWLING GALES: Roll twice on the HAZARDS table.
4: HARD FROST: All rolls are HARD. If below 3 hp, lose 1D4 more.
5: BONE CHILLING: Make a STR roll to move in battle, travel max of 1 mile.
6: SNOW STORM: Change current landscape to snow lands, roll 1 HAZARD.
7: STICKY ICE: All equipment is unusable for 1 day.
8: MAGNETICA: A painful hum in the brain. Reverse 1D20 miles of progress.
9: THE GREEN DRAGON: Chase the borealis effect to a new landscape roll.
10: SWARM OF FLIES: A hatch! 1D4 SUPPLY ruined, take 1D4 damage.
11: SUDDEN THAW: Sloppy mud and slush, encounter 1 MEGAFAUNA.
12: SULFUR CLOUD: Geo vents form poison cloud. If at 1 HP, drop to 0 .
13: FOG: Lose 1D10 miles of progress, HUNTING is EASY.
14: SMOKE: Forest fires nearby! Foraging is HARD.
15: SNOW: Light, drifting flakes. HUNTING and STEALTH are EASY.
16: THUNDERSTORM: An amazing display of nature's fury. It is an omen.
17: ECLIPSE: Travel twice your normal distance for this landscape.
18-20: CLEAR SKIES: Bright, calm skies on the steppe.



MEGAFAUNA

The beasts of the Pleistocene, and all ice ages, are enormous. Their size in itself is not deadly, but their savagery has no such qualification. Here listed are the most noted horrors faced on the ice and the dirt between. When rolling on MEGAFAUNA tables, rolling a listed beast indicates a direct confrontation, encounter, or altercation unless specifically mentioned otherwise. *See the full entries for all MEGAFAUNA in the BEASTS section.*

GMs should also consider that defeated or slain MEGAFAUNA are rich sources of SUPPLY and FORAGING. Butchering and processing of animal stuffs is time consuming, attracts predators, including enemy humans. Use the rule of thumb below to make determinations on these matters. **100 LBS. mass = 1 HEART EFFORT TO BUTCHER and YIELDS 1D4 SUPPLY or 1 FORAGED LOOT ROLL.**

MEGAFAUNA ENCOUNTERED... ROLL 1D12

1: SPEAR TOOTH: Solitary hunter, actively stalks and attacks humans.
2: CAVE BEAR: Found near its lair, easily provoked, 1D4 appearing.
3: ANACON: Attacks undetected, re-roll if on Ice Sheet.
4: BLACK WOLVES: Pack hunters, stalk and attack humans, 1D20 Appearing.
5: SNOW BEAR: Solitary nomad, will flee 1D10 miles or until cornered.
6: SKY SHADOW: Hoarder. Will attempt to steal equipment, 1D4 appearing.
7: HOOK: Hateful temper if encountered. Always crazed. 1D4 appearing.
8: MAMMOTH: Passive until provoked, 1D12 appearing.
9: RIVER GIANT: Defends territory, THAW or PINE LANDS, 1D4 appearing.
10: PINE STAG: Performs hit-and-run raids, 1D20 appearing.
11: REROLL 1-10 Spot rolled MEGAFAUNA from a distance.
12: REROLL 1-10 Spot rolled MEGAFAUNA from a distance, undetected.

TRIBES AND SHELTER

Most folk never dare the wilderness expanses between settlements. They stick to a life in the relative safety of the camp, cave, fort, or village. Nevertheless, the challenges continue even for them. This section outlines most aspects of that life, as useful for players as GMs.

SHELTER

The first task of any tribe struggling to survive is to find or build shelter against BEASTS, warring TRIBES, and WEATHER. The following rules apply:

- Even if not TREKKING, roll HAZARDS when not in shelter of some kind
- For each day spent building shelter, it will offer protection for 10 people for 10 days and have 1 HEART of hp
- Spend an additional day to add an additional feature: cavalry spikes, archer perches, well, forge, or cellar
- Consider 'sidedness' when shelters are attacked: caves are best, then forts, then villages

WEALTH AND STATUS

There is no currency in Blood and Snow. Instead, economy is based on trade, rarity, materials, and seasonal need. Take the CHIEF STATUS as a cue for the quality of goods a settlement is willing or capable of trading.

CHIEF AND WEALTH... ROLL 1D12

1: FORAGER: A lowly wretch who has little to offer
2: TYRANT: The people hate their chief, will actively undermine them
3: CANNIBAL: A folk gripped by terror, but holding quality goods
4: HUNTER: Mighty but humble folk who trade fairly with hand crafts
5: HERO: A storied adventurer with odd, unique or rare items
6: HEIR: Offspring of the once-mighty with impressive jewelry
7: WARLORD: Unforgiving and violent, trades mostly in weapons
8: WARLORD: Just and beloved with all kinds of quality goods
9: ANCIENT: An enlightened seer with wonders and relics
10: LEGEND: Everyone knows this chief. Their treasure is epic
11: IMMORTAL: A luminous, inhuman thing with items from the stars
12: CHOOSE: Player's choice from above, or re-roll 1-11

TRIBE PROPERTIES... ROLL 1D20

1: MUD MEN: Frightening feral hunters build huge mud headdresses
2: TATTOOED: A society that uses tattoos to mark the stars and the gods
3: JEWELCRAFTERS: Craft folk who have discovered flourite and ruby
4: CRUELTY: Brutish clan rejects weakness and flogs folk for purification
5: MATRIARCHY: Explorers led by a woman with impressive garb
6: TOTEMIC: Statue-worshippers seeking a spirit or holy mountain
7: FIRE CULT: Masters of fire, also those who revere it as a living thing
8: ASTRONOMERS: Star-gazers, calendar builders predict a great doom
9: MARINERS: Seafaring folk believe a thawed land lays beyond the sea
10: ABUNDANT: A huge tribe, living in a camp of tents and fish racks
11: XENOPHOBIC: A band of hunters who consider all outsiders demons
12: GIANT: These Nordish folk are no less than 8 feet tall
13: ARTISTIC: Cave dwellers who depict hunts with colorful paint
14: SLAGGERS: Soot-coated folk who continually work to refine slagg
15: EXPLORERS: Nomads believe redemption is beyond known lands
16: KIN: This band is one large family, genetics are beginning to decay
17: CANNIBALS: The worst of us
18: SKULL MEN: Those who wear the bones of their dead
19: SNAKE PEOPLE: Anacon worshippers feed and care for the beasts
20: URBAN: A group of building-makers with advanced settlements

HUNTING AND FORAGING

The primary means of survival in the ice age is living off the land in its natural state. Hunting, fishing, and gathering edible plants and fungus are daily work for almost everyone. **1 HUNTING OR FORAGING ROLL = MOMENTS: 1 SUPPLY. HOURS: 1D4 SUPPLY + 1 FORAGED LOOT. DAYS: 1D4 SUPPLY + 1D4 FORAGED LOOT.**

ROLL 1D12 FORAGE RESULT	ROLL 1D12 HUNT RESULT
1: Weird Mushrooms	**1:** No sightings
2: Poisonous Blossoms	**2:** Your prey escapes
3: Edible succulents: Gain 1 HP	**3:** Blunder! Break 1 piece of gear
4: Roots and tubers: Gain 2 HP	**4**: Rodents: Gain 1 HP when cooked
5: Vegetables: Gain 3 HP	**5:** Small Fish: Gain 1 HP when cooked
6: Snowfruit: Entire party gains 1 HP	**6:** Huge Fish: Gain 3 HP when cooked
7: Hardwood: Craft WOODEN gear	**7:** Elk or Deer: Feed a party, 1 HP
8: Chert: Craft STONE gear	**8:** Snowhorse: Feed party, 3 HP
9: SLAGG Ore: Craft METAL gear	**9:** Bear: Gain 3 HP, Craft CLOTHES
10: Artifact: A weird clue	**10:** Bear: Craft ARMOR or CLOTHES
11: Broken Crate: Gain 1 SUPPLY	**11:** Alpha: Gain 2 SUPPLY
12: Intact Chest: Gain 2 SUPPLY	**12:** Giant: Gain 3 SUPPLY, Renown

SPLINTER SPECIES

For a span of millennia, there existed a handful of splinter-species of humankind in frightening parallel. As heroes encounter their human and demihuman enemies, the details below can guide what may happen.

ROCK EATERS

Most primitive of all Splinter Species are the so-called Rock Eaters. For reasons unknown, they remained with minimal language, smaller brains, crude stone technology, and a generally feral or predatory demeanour while other humans progressed.

PONGO

Closest to the great apes, this species is the most physically robust. Their incredible strength, thick bones, and heavy skulls make them durable but sluggish. They are terrified of water. They despise the other species for their use of technology and advanced language.

AKSUM

Bronze-skinned folk of the equatorial lands are resourceful hunters and have complex traditions of astronomy, geology, and technology. Wherever they go, chieftains will trade to learn their omens and opinions on all matters.

NORDS

Tall, pale folk from the great endless plains north of Aksum lands. This species has tremendous variety, but it is more dependent on technology and infrastructure than the others. They are also called 'Mammoth Hunters.'

MOG

This diminutive species is the most reclusive, and near extinction. They are slight in build, with varying skin tones. They have narrow, high features and stand a head or more shorter than most. They are also renowned arrow-makers.

HAWAIKI

Separated from the other branches of humanity by countless miles of ocean, these seafarers have adapted to the currents and seasonal seas of the ice age. They are a thick-skinned folk, identified by complex tattoos and broad backs.

GODS AND OMENS

Remember, there is **no magic** in Blood and Snow. No one knows if the Gods are real, or myth, or rumor, or ritual, or nightmare. There is no 'divine power' or 'calling on the Gods' that has ever been proven, or directly witnessed. Still, strange and subtle phenomena have found their way into the oral tradition of all SNOW FOLK, and few question if the Gods are real or their influence all-powerful.

In Blood and Snow, spirituality takes a naturalistic and psychological form, affecting daily life in the following ways.

GHOSTS

Make no mistake, ghosts are *not* real. Nevertheless, the echoes of terrible events can haunt the human mind in ways that are real enough to terrify or torment. It is commonly believed that tragic events leave some kind of imprint on their surroundings, and the human mind senses this eerie resonance. These phenomena take a few common forms.

OMENS

Being so attuned to natural cycles, prehistoric peoples could see patterns of events coinciding with the stars, lunar events, and the life cycles of the oldest trees. Omens cannot be actively sought or conjured but are simply encountered and interpreted. The accuracy of the interpretation cannot be proven or disproven.

WIZARD'S LOCK

This strange symbol is found in remote areas of the ice age Earth, and remains a total mystery to mortal men. It is simply an odd symbol or carving. On ALFHEIM, it is far more powerful, used to transverse all dimensions, places and times. Use a WIZARD'S LOCK to interconnect your **ICRPG** worlds.

RITUALS

Rituals, divinations, blessings and curses affect the mind and the mind alone. Witnessing such things has a lasting effect on SNOW FOLK. Use WIS to make RITUAL ROLLS over a course of HOURS or DAYS. Designate a desired effect or outcome, and work with your GM to discover what happens next.

THE TEACHERS

Standing stones can be found throughout the prehistoric world, inscribed with cryptic glyphs and writings from lost times. The ability to translate these glyphs into spoken sounds is passed down through oral tradition to a chosen few, or deciphered by the curious.

These incredible artifacts possess no mystical power or supernatural energy. Like all things in Blood and Snow, their origin is far more amazing when discovered in absolute real-world terms. Who or what carved these? Why? How old are they? If players discover a TEACHER, here are a few possible effects, or you can use them as a marker or landmark in your unique story.

- Gain an ABILITY by deciphering writings and finding ancient secrets
- Discover star maps that greatly assist navigation
- Find the next leg of a journey to THE RELIC itself
- Discover a cache of equipment, wonders, or artifacts
- Find shelter from any kind of weather as the TEACHER is precisely located in a thaw area, free of wind or storms

THE RELIC

The most ancient and strange phenomenon of the ice age is the presence of The Relic. This object has evaded explanation for eons. Even its very existence is argued over in countless ages and civilizations.

THREE AS ONE

The Relic is so massive a thing, it has an incredible array of power and influence on the planet Earth. Three primary theories or myths (depending on your perspective) endure above all others.

THE ISLAND OF IRON

In a concrete sense, The Relic is simply a colossal mass of nickle, iron, and other heavy metals lodged in the Earth's lower crust, just above the burning iron of the mantle. It is trillions of tons of solid mass, with a highly disruptive magnetic presence. When it shifts in its deep tomb, the weather and lifeforms on the surface are affected in numerous ways. These shifts have also formed a network of tunnels and cavities deep in the crust.

WEATHER FORCE

The Relic disrupts weather patterns with Stratofall, extreme magnetic and climate shifts, and even polarity reversals. What causes it to move, rotate, shift or tremor is unknown. The most sensitive humans, and some sea mammals, can sense its location below them based on these weather disruptions and subtle vibrations.

PSYCHOLOGICAL FORCE

Like all barely-measureable sonic and magnetic fields, The Relic plays strange games on animals with advanced brains. Feelings of fear, confusion, aggression, sickness or dread are not uncommon in its proximity. This phenomenon explains much of the religious explanation for its presence, but the effects are different from person to person, animal to animal. Some believe The Relic does nothing more than heighten or reveal a being's deeper nature.

SNOW FOLK

As you consider creating your character for Blood and Snow, place your imagination in that time. This is not fantasy, or sci-fi, high adventure or pulpy post-apocalypse. This is a quiet, simple world of very real dangers, and very human heroes. There no spells, no swords, no monsters. There is nature's fury, the almighty sky, and humanity hanging by the thinnest thread. Onto this you stride, and the errand of survival falls to you. The snows are deep, our numbers dwindle, and food is scarce. What will you do?

This is not a time of 'cave men!' This stereotype is not only reductive, but inaccurate. Human culture, language, and intelligence is vastly underestimated by most. Dare to imagine a rich intellectual life, complex and wondrous social structures, refined technology, and spiritual awareness for these ice age folk. Theirs is a mind as intricate as our own, and faced with daunting perils in a frozen world of giant beasts and violent weather. YOU are among them. Find in our ancestors heroic deeds, poetic tragedy, and hard-earned triumph. Much of who we are is reflected in how we see our past, so make it a grand adventure!

SNOW FOLK: CHARACTER CREATION

Let your imagination run wild in this primal world. As you build your character, gain any 3 simple items that fit ice age technology: wood, bone, sinew, leather and the like. Use ALFHEIM STARTING EQUIPMENT to help, avoiding MAGIC.

Blood and Snow can be an unfamiliar world for creating characters. If you're drawing a blank on a backstory or concept, try using the tables below, with special emphasis on the SEEKER STORY, APPEARANCE, and OATH tables. Results on these rolls need not be taken literally! Simply use them to jump-start YOUR idea and create something truly unique. You can describe your SEEKER by combining the APPEARANCE, STORY, and OATH in that order. For example, a Ragged, Chosen Seeker or Savage, Vengeful Watcher.

ROLL OR CHOOSE APPEARANCE, STORY AND OATH
BUILD WITH 10 STAT POINTS
CHOOSE 2 CHARACTER ABILITIES
CHOOSE 2 COMMON EQUIPMENT
CHOOSE 1 STARTER LOOT

SNOW FOLK: APPEARANCE

1: RAGGED	You haven't bathed, cut your hair or fixed clothes in months
2: SAVAGE	Facepaint, dark eyes, and few words give you an ominous look
3: STUNNING	You are beautiful, clear-eyed, and attractive to all
4: SINISTER	A wry grin and shaved head give you an evil appearance
5: ELDER	Grey hairs, sun-cracked skin, and a wise stare define you
6: YOUNG	You are underestimated by most, but only once

SNOW FOLK: STORY

1: CHOSEN	Your people have selected YOU to save the world
2: BANISHED	Your defiance has cost you a home. There's no going back
3: NOMAD	You've no patience for villages and huts
4: HAUNTED	You've always seen ghosts and visions of the dead
5: VENGEFUL	They killed your beloved, chief, people. They must pay
6: THE LAST	You are the final survivor and carry the destiny of your folk

SNOW FOLK: OATH

1: SEEKER	Find THE RELIC, and decipher its relationship to the fate of all
2: ASSASSIN	Choose a specific person. By your life, they must die
3: PROVIDER	Your people will perish if you don't find food and shelter soon
4: DELUSION	The snows have bent your mind. Real and unreal are blending...
5: WATCHER	The elders send you to the frontier to stand watch
6: SAVIOR	You've taken the role of savior on yourself

SNOW FOLK: CHARACTER ABILITIES

In the ice age, humankind do not enjoy the diversity of lifestyles, specializations, social standings, and training as in later epochs. A character is a simple sum of their upbringing, their possessions, their genetics, and their actions.

While STATS represent genetic makeup, ABILITIES describe a character's upbringing, origin, or life-learning. If you were raised by a hunter, you could gain the ARCHER, TRACKER, NATURALIST, or SLAYER ABILITIES, and so on. Start with TWO ABILITIES and earn a new ABILITY at each MILESTONE.

ARCHER	If successful on an EASY bow attack, roll DOUBLE EFFORT
CHIEF	Non-player characters will always hear you out, or stop to listen
COOK	Double the benefits of any FOOD ITEMS you create
CRAFTSMAN	Create WOOD or ANTLER items with 1 hour, INT or WIS roll
DELVER	Rolls to navigate or survive tunnels or caves are always EASY
DREAMER	Visualize revolutionary technology every 1D4 days
FISHERMAN	Yield twice the FOOD or SUPPLY gained from fishing as others
FLAMEKEEPER	You always keep a small firepot going, no matter what
FORAGER	Double the outcome of any sccessful FORAGE roll
HERBALIST	Use a FORAGE roll to find specific plants, roots or fungi
MASON	Building with STONE is never HARD
MENDER	Make REPAIR rolls on any EQUIPMENT
METALURGIST	Create METAL implements with 1 hour and an INT or WIS roll
NATURALIST	Use INT or WIS to recall facts about any BEAST or LANDSCAPE
NAVIGATOR	Ignore BAD WEATHER when making NAVIGATION rolls
RUNIC	Read TEACHER stones with an INT roll
RUNNER	Travel twice the distance per day trekking
SEER	Speak of OMENS or GHOSTS, listeners must roll to disbelieve
SHAPESHIFT	Use hide and bone to disguise yourself as a large animal
SLAYER	Roll ULTIMATE EFFORT on any target you have already injured
SPEARMAN	No roll with a SPEAR is ever HARD
SURVIVOR	When DYING, add 1 to your roll
SWIMMER	Never take damage from deep water, swim twice as fast
TRACKER	Pursuing BEASTS, tracking is EASY
WARRIOR	When fighting other humans, roll DOUBLE EFFORT
WILD	When rolling HAZARDS, roll twice and choose
WISE	Aid an ally on a WIS or INT roll... make it EASY

STARTER LOOT (CHOOSE 1)

LAPIS AMULET, +2 CHA: A prized symbol of sacred power and tribal status. You've worn it long enough to command attention, and leadership suits you.

DELVER'S PACK: 6 SLAGG spikes, 100 feet rope, flame pot, chalk, 10 SUPPLY, signal horn .

POMMEL STONE, +2 WEAPON EFFORT: Attach to any weapon to improve its impact

SPEAR TOOTH PELTS, +2 DEFENSE: Ignore negative effects from extreme cold, even if pelts reduced to 0 ARMOR.

BRACELETS OF ORD, +3 DEFENSE: An age-old craft using antler and leather. REPAIR rolls are always EASY on these bracers, and the MENDER ABILITY is not needed.

CODEX STAFF, +2 INT: A wooden staff carved with truisms. These lessons can be used to decode mysteries. Possession of the codex staff also gives you literacy.

TUSK AXE, +3 WEAPON EFFORT: A vicious weapon made with ivory. On a critical fail, this weapon is NOT broken

SCALE SHIELD, +8 DEFENSE: A bulwark crafted from armadillo hide, and extremely tough.

BIRDMAN CLOAK, +3 DEFENSE: A suit of buzzard feathers and hide. Reduce any damage from falling by half.

POTIONER'S GOURDS ,+2 CON: Hollow shells used to hold odd tinctures and healing oils. Use with a HARD roll to heal 1 HP on yourself or an ally.

SNOW FOLK: PREHISTORIC WOMEN

In the relentless danger of Blood and Snow, a world millennia older than the first farm or sedentary mud hut, all are equal. In this world, men and women stand equal in every way, but still unique and complimentary.

The prehistoric male is somewhat simple to imagine: an accomplished hunter, stalwart protector, and work horse. Women of that time, though, push our imaginations to new ground. Blood and Snow dares you to imagine these formidable women in a new light. Consider four nuances for your female Snow Folk.

PAIN TOLERANCE
Countless examples and modern research have long confirmed the female tolerance for physical pain. It is simply supreme. In the feral world, this is no small capability. When rolling to recover from DYING, women only need a natural 15+ to recover 1 HP.

TRIBAL STATUS
Women in leadership positions are showered with precious treasures. When creating a female with the CHIEF or SEER ABILITY, gain 2 rolls on the ANCIENT LOOT table upon character creation.

EMPATHIC GENIUS
It can't be denied, women have a talent for empathy, care, and human connection. When rolling 'Don't die on me, man!' women roll EASY.

KEEN EYED
Some women have a talent for quieting the mind and seeing the details. Women with the NAVIGATOR ABILITY never roll HARD when scouting or looking for more detail.

MEGAFAUNA

This is a world of primal competition for survival. Just a few creatures are listed here, but with a little research and creativity, you can populate your ice age world with mammoths, wolves, and worse.

As a GM or player, remember that the 'monsters' of this world are beasts only, not murderous abberrations or magical demons. They are driven by natural instincts. Their tactics, abilities, and fury are governed by natural law.

MEGAFAUNA: SPEAR TOOTH

The supreme predator of the frozen epoch is the Spear Tooth, a massive tiger than can kill a mammoth with one terrible, brain-piercing bite. They are made all the more deadly with cunning and stealth.

ROLLS: +2 ALL STATS
ACTIONS (3 per TURN)

POUNCE: A flying leap, FAR range. Victims take ULTIMATE DAMAGE and are pinned down
CRUSHING BITE: A CLOSE ULTIMATE attack aimed at the head or neck
CLAWS: An attack aimed at enemy equipment. Success knocks 1 piece of gear in a random direction to FAR distance
DEAFENING ROAR: All living things within FAR range must make a CHA roll or lose their next turn pertrified or fleeing.
SPRINT: A bounding, reckless run to TRIPLE FAR distance, over any terrain

SNOW STALKER: *The Spear Tooth is a master of tundra stealth and silence. When in any snowy or frozen landscape, WIS rolls to detect it when in stealth are always HARD. Also, Spear Tooth can use Pounce from stealth with no roll. The victim of this vicious ambush must make a DEX roll or drop to 1 HP and be pinned to the ground by the titan.*

DEVIOUS LURE: *Like its lion cousins, the Spear Tooth can mimic some human sounds, specifically a suffering woman or weeping child. Rolls to identify this deception are always HARD.*

MEGAFAUNA: RIVER GIANT

One of the largest mammals to walk the earth, this huge member of the beaver family may be vegetarian, but shortages make it a violent, territorial threat.

ROLLS: +4 ALL STATS
ACTIONS (2 per TURN)

SWAT: Attacks all NEAR enemies in one swipe. Hit targets are thrown FAR through the air and take WEAPON DAMAGE
CRUSH: The beast simply stumbles into or onto foes with its weight. NEAR targets are pinned down and take 10 DAMAGE. HARD STR roll to get free
CHARGE: A single enemy is targeted by a lumbering rush. Roll DEX to leap aside, or fall to 0 HP. Can also destroy a SHELTER
EARTH GOUGER: River Giants can dig trenches, hurl boulders or uproot trees. This action creates an impassable obstacle. NEAR enemies make a CHA ROLL to stand firm, or lose your next TURN doing anything BUT fight the River Beast

MARCH: *River Giants move in large family groups, unless separated by disease or disaster. These groups are 5-10 in number, and they migrate year round. When migrating, they follow a specific trail and can't be swayed from their route.*

GIANT: Standing 40 feet tall, the River Giant destroys all it lumbers through, including human settlements. When in battle, River Giants can smash houses, sink ships, or topple small hills. Be sure to include this element of mass destruction in its battle effects.

MEGAFAUNA: CAVE BEAR

Few beasts are so intelligent and patient as the cave bear. This animal will leave intruders alone in some cases, but it fights to bloody death if young or hibernation are disturbed.

ROLLS: +3 ALL STATS
ACTIONS (1 per TURN)

MAUL: Huge claws rip and ruin flesh and equipment with a CLOSE attack. Do WEAPON DAMAGE and break 1 piece of GEAR.

CHOMP: The bear takes a chunk of flesh, inflicting a WEAPON attack and healing the amount of DAMAGE done.

FLURRY OF CLAWS: A series of wild, chained slashes. For each CLOSE WEAPON attack made successfully, the Cave Bear attacks again.

RAM: A rushing charge to smash targets against rock or trees, crushing them. All enemies in a straight line, FAR, must make a DEX roll or be hit for WEAPON DAMAGE. Use a 1D12 to determine what direction the bear charges.

RECLUSIVE: *Most often, these animals prefer distance from mankind. They steal precious goods and SUPPLIES and haul them off to their lair.*

MASTER OF DARKNESS: *Cave Bears have flawless night vision*

ARCHITECT: *Cave Bears have a destructive method to delving their lairs. They can roar and convulse against cave walls to cause collapses or seal off corridors. Conversely, they can open new tunnels or caverns.*

MEGAFAUNA: ANACON

These giant constrictor snakes have adapted to the cold by breeding under thawed areas in labyrinths of tunnels. They live to terrible old age, becoming highly intelligent and cruel with hunger.

ROLLS: +5 ALL STATS
ACTIONS (3 per TURN)

CONSTRICTOR: After a successful attack, victim must beat the Anacon's STR ROLL to break free. In 1D4 ROUNDS, the victim is crushed to death. STR ROLL contests occur each turn constricted.
VENOM BITE: Inflict ULTIMATE DAMAGE with a NEAR attack. If target fails a CON roll, they take WEAPON DAMAGE for 1D4 additional turns.
SLAM: A sweeping attack. All FAR targets roll DEX or take ULTIMATE DAMAGE.
COIL: At or below 2 HEARTS, the Anacon uses a RECOVERY roll to regenerate a full HEART. It will often combine this tactic with a retreat into tunnels or rocks.

GROUND BREAKER: *Anacons are prolific tunnelers. To avoid the extreme cold of the surface, they dig extensive networks. The tunnels are between a few feet and up to 20 feet in diameter and have no sense of up or down. They are populated by egg clusters, remains of prey, and a single, solitary Anacon resident.*

MASSIVE GRAPPLER: *An Anacon can use its Constrictor ACTION on up to 4 targets at once, by threading its body through the ground. Use a 1D4 each time Constrictor is used to determine its target quantity that ROUND.*

RELIC HUNTERS

Times are grim. The human race faces extinction. You are the last chance, called upon by your tribe to find The Relic and stop the storm that could wipe out all Snow Folk. Time is running out, the people are desperate, the nights grow colder. Go.

GM'S BULLETS

- An omen has told of the Great Storm that will kill the Snow Folk. As the weather worsens, heroes are sent out to seek answers
- Legend tells that an object called THE RELIC has some connection to the deadly storms, and possibly a way to stop them
- The players, chosen as SEEKERS, TREK to find THE RELIC with little information. The fate of all is in their hands
- THE RELIC is no more than a geological phenomenon, but the TREK to find it will transform the SEEKERS into true heroes, or bury them in ice

MANY PATHS

The group moves through the adventure with TREKS and rolled EVENTS, creating different paths each time. The GM decides how long the TREK is. In general, 30 miles is shorter, 40-50 is longer. Two FINAL EVENTS happen once the Seekers reach The Relic.

A HARROWING TREK

Roll 1 LANDSCAPE, 1 HAZARD, and 1 WEATHER at the start of each DAY. Resolve any Trek events, then use the rolled EVENTS table for additional encounters throughout the day. At the end of each day, the Seekers roll NAVIGATE to gauge their progress toward The Relic.

SLAGG ARROWS

(Ammo, Expend on impact, Inflict ULTIMATE damage for 1d4 TURNS after a successful hit, Taints meat of victim)

Each Seeker is granted 1D8 SLAGG ARROWS when they depart on the TREK. If other peoples, especially headmen, see these arrows, they will respond with hostility, distrust, or savage greed. What effect does SLAGG have on your ice age world?

Choose from the following RELIC HUNTERS EVENTS or create your own.

RELIC HUNTERS EVENTS

CORNERED... ***Black wolves trailed you all day, skulking just beyond view, their howls moving closer. Now they circle in for the kill, pressing you back into a jagged escarpment.***

GM'S BULLETS

- Will the Seekers survive? How can they overcome such numbers?
- The escarpment is a narrow, boxed-in canyon. The wolves block any exit and appear in terrible numbers
- Start with 2D20 Black Wolves. 1D6 wolves appear each ROUND
- Players can knock cliff debris free with successful ATTEMPT, creating climbable boulders or slowing the tide of wolves

NORDISH CAMP... ***You come across a remote camp. Tall, pale folk shuffle listlessly through a ramshackle shelter. They are few, lean, wolfish. Broken wood props up their fragile huts.***

GM'S BULLETS

- Can the Seekers appease or trade with the Nords, or will things turn violent?
- The Nords demand a toll. 5 SUPPLY and submission to their chief's authority
- If appeased or befriended, they grant safety and shelter for one night. In a very favorable situation, they even have information on The Relic's location

BLOOD AND SNOW

RELIC HUNTERS EVENTS

DEATH FROM ABOVE... ***Massive shapes blot out the sun. With guttural screams, four Sky Shadows wheel overhead, preparing to dive.***

GM'S BULLETS

- Will the Seekers avoid the Sky Shadows? What is driving these things wild?
- The Sky Shadows try to carry away anyone in the open, dropping them in a nearby crag-top nesting place
- Sky Shadows flee, one at a time, after losing one HEART
- The nest contains 1D4 giant eggs, each treated each as 1 SUPPLY

AVALANCHE... ***A violent crack splits the air, and then growing thunder. A white plume of snow and rocks roars down the slopes, racing to overtake you!***

GM'S BULLETS

- Is there any way to survive the avalanche?
- The avalanche lasts 3 ROUNDS, crushing everything, spreading fast and FAR
- Fleeing SEEKERS make DEX ROLLS, smothered SEEKERS make CON ROLLS
- A Seeker may choose to fail to make the next ROLL EASY for an ally
- If smothered, a SEEKER is treated as DYING

RELIC HUNTERS EVENTS

ROCK EATERS... ***Rock Eater hunters stalk through rocky ice outcroppings with clever predatory tactics. Their leader is a hulking savage, reasoned with only by superior strength.***

GM'S BULLETS

- Can the Seekers avoid the Rock Eaters? Overpower them?
- Each ROUND, heavy gusts of wind will shove characters around unless anchored somehow. A failed STR ROLL causes you to slide FAR in the wind's direction
- Rock Eater hunters launch javelin-like spears from cover
- LOOT: The chief uses a WORN SCALE SHIELD, +4 ARMOR
- Randomly create 1 NPC as a prisoner of the Rock Eaters

NECROSIS... ***A group of mammoths lie dying around a ring of black rocks. Three of the beasts stir suddenly. Bare bone shows through ragged hide. A plague is upon them.***

GM'S BULLETS

- What is driving these peaceful beasts mad with fury? What is killing them? Can they be stopped?
- The dying mammoths each lose one heart every 1D4 ROUNDS, but are treated as 'frenzied' while still alive
- These Mammoth Kin are infected with NECROTIC BACTERIA, which devours flesh and decays the brain causing erratic, violent behavior. The bacteria can be transferred by ingestion of fresh meat or blood and is always fatal. It can be traced back to a cavern complex far to the North, where poisonous spiders feed on carrion. These same spiders can be distilled into a mostly reliable antedote.

RELIC HUNTERS EVENTS

CROWD IN... Stratofall is flash-freezing the air, bringing death closer with each passing moment. The only shelter is the cave before you, but feral eyes gleam within.

GM'S BULLETS

- Between a rock and a hard place, what will they do?
- Roll for what MEGAFAUNA is hiding in the cavern
- Full STRATOFALL occurs in 1D4 ROUNDS. Those not in SHELTER at that time make a CON ROLL or drop to 0 HP each ROUND exposed. Those DYING in STRATOFALL set their DYING ROLL to 1
- LOOT: The cavern holds 1D4 Foraged LOOT items

AKSUM TRADERS... A tribe of bronze-skinned folk huddle around campfires. They tap their foreheads in odd greeting, eyeing your weapons. Their chief approaches with open hands.

GM'S BULLETS

- Can the Seekers gain passage through Aksum lands?
- The chief, Ayala, requests an OMEN in exchange for passage into her lands. If unable to produce, the SEEKERS may also be sent on an errand to prove themselves
- It takes one HEART of CHA Effort to convince her an omen is true
- While struggling to convince Ayala, a rival band of Aksum approach, howling with war cries and bristling with poison spears

SUBMIT OR DIE... A group of Snow Folk approaches from the wastes. They bear the marks of an outcast tribe. Their headman draws a Slagg Arrow and demands you halt.

GM'S BULLETS

- Dramatic question: Can the players defeat or negotiate with the outcasts? What has earned them exile?
- The 6 outcasts believe The Relic must be left alone and never found. They have taken this extreme view after seeing a dream vision
- They attack anyone they realize is a Seeker, while revealing their dire prophecy
- They use a Slagg Arrow every other ROUND (they have 6 total)
- One of their number stands out... a hero you recognize

RELIC HUNTERS CONCLUSION

THE TUNNELS... ***A TEACHER leans at the mouth a shadowy cave in the side of a looming cliff face. Within, maze-like tunnels reach into the dark depths.***

GM'S BULLETS

- Dramatic question: Will the players safely navigate the tunnels?
- Describe a weird, dizzy, magnetic aura as they approach
- The tunnels require two HEARTS to navigate
- 2D6 cave lizards find the players every 1D4 rounds
- Mushrooms can be found with INT roll, HEAL 1 HP

THE RELIC... ***A massive, black pit descends to natural bridges over boiling slagg pools. A giant anacon slithers through the morass, the bones of fallen Seekers snapping beneath it. This is the place you have sought; The Great Anacon will judge you worthy of it.***

GM'S BULLETS

- Dramatic question: Can the players defeat the Anacon?
- The Anacon is half blind and vicious from slagg poisoning
- Relic quake every 1D4 rounds: DEX check or hang from pit edge, fall on the next fail
- Toxic slagg deals 1D6 damage if touched

THE COSMOS CONTAINS COUNTLESS DIMENSIONS

THE SUBSTANCE THAT BINDS THEM ALL

WE CALL MAGIC

REALM OF THE ARCANE

MAGIC plays such a central role in so many tabeltop stories, it demands special attention from player and GM alike. It is a wild, unpredictable power with limitless possibility. How can such a power be described? Over the years, our favorite books, movies and games have given us many answers. In the PLAYER'S GUIDE, **ICRPG** provides a very simple roll-to-cast look at MAGIC.

This section is for the deeper delver, the player who needs more detail in their dark conjurations, or the GM bringing magical mysteries to the next session.

DEEPER SPELL CASTING

Before you create your first advanced MAGIC USER, consider a more in-depth way to use magic in **ICRPG**. This alternate system adds a few key concepts to the simple roll-to-cast foundation described in the PLAYER'S GUIDE section.

SPELL POWER: All spells are cast at 1 of 4 levels of POWER. POWER is a multiplier. If a spell would do 1D10 damage, it will do 4D10 when cast at level 4 and so on. If POWER levels induce special effects, they will be listed with the spell.

SPELL COST: For each level of POWER in a successfully cast spell, the mage will pay 2 Stun Points (SP). Thus, minimum cost is 2 SP and maximum is 8 SP.

- All magic users start with 10 SP as their maximum
- Increase your SP MAX only by receiving STUN POINT(S) as a MILESTONE REWARD or special GM reward.
- Any time you are attacked, damaged, or hit in any way, whether you resist the damage or not, lose 1 STUN POINT
- When you reach 0 SP, you can no longer use spells.
- Unlike super heroes in VIGILANTE CITY, magic-users can only recover SP by resting in safety for several hours, or using other specific, magical, or alchemical means to recover SP.

SPELL TYPE: All spells here are either HOLY, INFERNAL, or ARCANE. HOLY spells use divine power, light, the elements, and healing. INFERNAL spells focus on fire, demonology, destruction, corruption, deception, and death. ARCANE spells cover everything else: utility magic, knowledge, the five senses, written magic, item creation, transformation and esoteric effects.

TYPE MASTERY: Magic-users have an additional MASTERY system to track. Any time a natural 20 is rolled, they can mark either their CLASS mastery (as seen in the PLAYER'S GUIDE) or mark a point of spell casting MASTERY. After 10 points of MASTERY, the magic-user can cast any spell of 1 TYPE at 1 SP per cast, regardless of level. Only one SPELL TYPE can be mastered.

SPELL LEVEL: As a magic-user grows in power, their understanding of MAGIC will unlock greater mysteries. New spells are acquired as MILESTONE REWARDS, GM rewards, or found in books or scrolls during play. To acquire or cast a spell of a certain level, the mage must know 3 spells of the previous level in that SPELL TYPE.

SPELL CASTING: ROLL OR BURN

Sometimes, relying on a dice roll to cast can be too much risk. At moments like these, the BURN rule becomes critical. This expansion of **ICRPG** standards gives magic-users the certainty their burden can demand.

- **ROLL:** Roll INT or WIS against the current TARGET as normal. If you fail, try the exact same cast on your next TURN with an EASY roll. Any other action negates this effect, as you have lost your focus.

- **BURN:** Bypass the roll, getting a *guaranteed cast*, but lose use of this SPELL until a full rest in SAFETY. The exact definitions of SAFETY and rest can rely on many factors between you, your character's situational details and the GM.

MERCURIAL MISHAPS

ANY cast roll of a natural 1 activates a mercurial effect. Choose the table based on the SPELL POWER being attempted. Yikes.

POWER 1-2 FAILURE RESULTS... ROLL 1D12

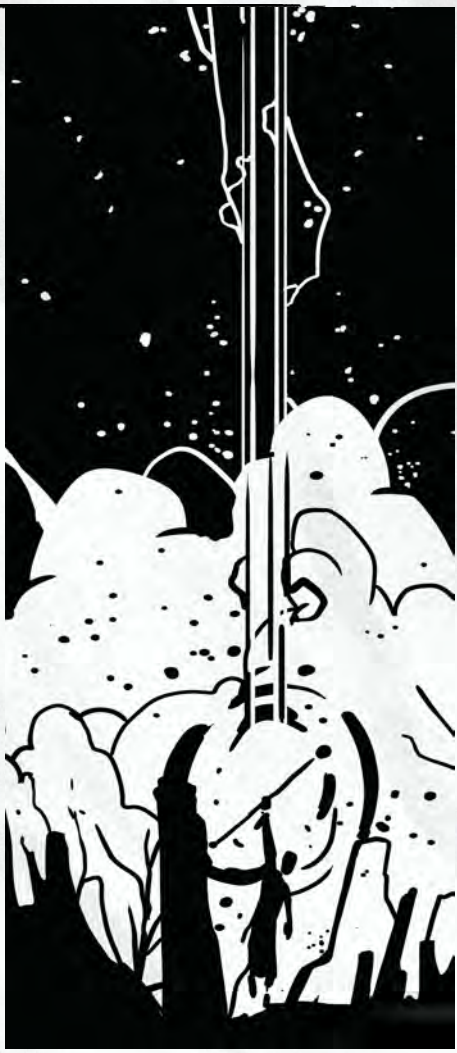
1: Rebuked: Suffer 6 ROUNDS of no magic, including effects from LOOT
2: Spell Burn: Suffer classic 1D4 ROUNDS of Spell Burn, with no roll
3: Weary: Suffer 1 ROUND of no SPELL use, move only CLOSE for 3 ROUNDS
4: Bolt: A ray shoots in a random direction, inflicting MAGIC
5: Ectoplasm: A burst of slime covers and immobilizes you. Roll STR to break free
6: Scream: You cry out with terror and move FAR in a random direction
7: Fear: Glimpse the dark of the stars. Lose all STAT bonuses for 3 ROUNDS
8: Singed: Take MAGIC from within your own mind
9: Misfire: The SPELL fails, and cannot be used for D4 ROUNDS
10: Wild Shot: The SPELL fires, but at a random TARGET
11: Dud: Nothing happens, not even sparkles
12: Comical: You slip, bumble, or otherwise look foolish in your failure

POWER 3-4 FAILURE RESULTS ... ROLL 1D12

1: Disaster: Lose SPELL for D4 days, summon 1D6 monsters, pay your COST
2: Defiled: Arcane forces scorn you. Summon 1 monster
3: Astral Rift: A vortex. 4 ROUNDS. Roll STR or be pulled to it each ROUND
4: Atomized: Randomly choose and destroy 2 pieces of your LOOT
5: Concussed: Become dazed for 2 ROUNDS, suffer Spell Burn with no roll
6: Mutations: Magic twists your body in a hideous way. Crab arm? Giant tongue?
7: Doorway: Cast DOORWAY to a random place you have been in the last hour
8: Arc: Suffer MAGIC. Arcs to metal objects within DOUBLE FAR
9: Scramble: Run! You and all others within FAR move FAR in a random direction
10: Misfire: The SPELL fails, and cannot be used for D8 ROUNDS
11: Wild Shot: The SPELL fires, but at a random TARGET
12: Dud: Nothing happens, not even sparkles

CREATING SPELLS

To create a SPELL, simply state the NAME and EFFECT desired. SPELL creation can be a tricky business, with this in mind, the smart SPELL creator waits until a low TARGET is currently on the table. When SPELL CREATION is being employed, the GM should be sure to pin down very detailed descriptions with mechanical wording from the player. Once these terms are agreed on, get the dice rolling.



CREATING A LEVEL I SPELL: Create these simple SPELLS with a single successful roll. Create simple utility and combat magic with single targets, D4 durations, and short range such as open locked door, heal surface wounds, conjure mundane items, minor divination, minor damage.

CREATING LEVEL II: Make enough rolls to do 1 HEART of EFFORT on your new SPELL. Can only be done once per day. Create SPELLS requiring minimal ritual or research time, D4 durations, up to 6 targets, FAR range, such as teleport on battlefield, alter hours of time, heal grave wounds, conjure rare items, potent divination, major damage.

CREATING LEVEL III: Do 2 HEARTS of EFFORT to create these SPELLS, create only one such SPELL per week. Powerful, complex magic that is seldom created anywhere but the safety of a sanctum. Large scale effects such as flight or long teleport, alter years of time, revive recently dead body, conjure flock of celestial griffons, supreme divination, devastating damage or explosions.

CREATING LEVEL IV: Do 4 HEARTS of EFFORT to create these, create one per month. Supreme magic, dared by the few. Create permaent effects that transcend worlds or cannot be undone such as astral travel, alter centuries of time, resurrect disintegrated dead, conjure black hole, omnipotent divination, rob an object or being of its very existence.

MAGE CREATION: BASICS

Clear your mind and get a mental picture of the magic-user you are about to create. Choose a token or miniature to get your imagination in gear, then build to match. Using the alternate MAGIC system will mean more notes, more flexibility, and more complex play, so consider a mage that emphasizes that theme, such as an elder wizard, barely human necromancer, demonic warlock or age-old witch.

Additionally, consider browsing the entire MAGIC section of this book before creating your new magic-user. There are many hidden synergies and power combos in the spell lists and items here, and they might spark a new or unexpected idea for your latest hero. Go forth, and may the cosmos provide.

ROLL OR CHOOSE STORY AND DESTINY
BUILD WITH 10 STAT POINTS
CHOOSE 1 MAGIC STARTING LOOT
CHOOSE 3 MAGIC EQUIPMENT OR 3 EQUIPMENT FROM ANY WORLD
CHOOSE 3 LEVEL 1 SPELLS

MAGE STORY

When creating a mage, choosing spells, or delving into authentic role play, a clear sense of history is critical. Choose or roll on the table below to start the story wheels turning. If you've chosen or created imagery for your character already, look for the origin story and goal that best fits the look.

MAGE ORIGIN STORY... ROLL 1D12

1: Scholar: A disciplined life of seclusion has revealed cosmic truths
2: Gifted: You were born with innate magical power, and it has defined you
3: Chosen One: Your village has revered you for years. You are the One
4: Abandoned: For reasons you don't know, your parents left you to die
5: Prophecy: Ancient wall frescoes depict YOU at the center of the cosmos
6: Fireborn: A forest or entire town burned to ash. You remained unharmed
7: Meteor: When a star fell to earth 20 years ago, they found you in the crater
8: Inheritance: For generations, an heirloom has carried inevitable duty
9: Avenger: Wrath and hatred have driven you to discover powerful secrets
10: Outcast: Magic has twisted you in a way that civilization finds repulsive
11: Woodling: You were raised by trees, wolves, mice and birds
12: Awakened: You were taken by monks and achieved enlightenment

MAGE DESTINY

No matter what roads your mage may travel, one goal or destiny sits at the core of your motivations. This is the reason you left home. This goal informs your moral choices, confines the time you have for allies or side-quests, or promises resolution to the strife of your origin.

MAGE DESTINY... ROLL 1D12

1: Power: You are driven by a singular desire to be a wizard of terrible might
2: Knowledge: You will not stop until you know all that the Gods may know
3: Revenge: Whatever force or person is in power is the target of your hatred
4: Errand: A great deed must be done, and only you can accomplish it
5: Weapon: A cult has 'created' you as the instrument of their dire purpose
6: Curator: You have been chosen to guard an ancient, secret library
7: Sworn: Your life is bound to another. You will abide their will unto death
8: Keeper: Magical places have guardians such as you, and you are relentless
9: Outer Limits: You cannot rest until you see the edge of the cosmos
10: Peace: After a life of adventure, and war, you seek calm and silence
11: Lord of Hell: You harbor a sick, secret desire to rule the underworld
12: Archon: You will walk the long-foretold path to immortality

MAGE CREATION: MAGIC STARTING LOOT

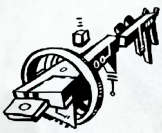
That moment when a mage leaves their past behind and pursues their destiny: that moment is where your story truly begins. Choose 1 STARTER LOOT from the list below. This piece of LOOT cannot be traded or given. It is bound to you, and useless to others.

1: EYE OF AZATOTH: A red crystal 'eye' gem set in a silver amulet, crowned with tentacle and crab-like motifs. ***Cast INFERNAL SPELLS at half COST***

2: MELMAN'S GUIDE: Book, An exhaustive guide to dimensions, planes, portals and ley lines throughout the multiverse.***Make an INT roll to locate a portal, ley line, or dimension gate within 1 mile***

3: EXPLODING RING: Item, This ring allows its wearer, with a verbal command, to explode a single object ***Double the effects of any explosive SPELLS by destroying a target object up to 100 pounds***

4: IRON HEART SHARD: A jagged piece of magical ore. ***Use your INT STAT to roll RECOVERY, then recover CON +1 HP as normal***



5: STARFARER'S KEY: Xenosian doorways can only be opened with this key-like device from deep space. ***Open ANY door instantly with a WIS roll***

6: GRYPHON SCARF: A long, cable-knit scarf of red, gold and black with powerful, hidden magic. ***SPELLS are critical hits on an 18, 19 or 20***

7: DRAGON'S TOOTH: The fang of a youngling dragon, one of Durathrax's offspring. Pray she does not see it on your person. ***Add a POISON effect to any attack. Targets take 1D4 damage for 1D4 ROUNDS***

8: WAND OF WONDERS: A small wooden staff, only three hands long, etched with spiral and antler motifs. ***Cast all SPELLS 1 LEVEL below actual COST***

MAGE CREATION: MAGIC EQUIPMENT

Common EQUIPMENT for a mage could be considered strange to others. **CHOOSE ANY 3** of the following items or items from any WORLD.

ODDS 'N ENDS: CONTAINS 6 RARE INGREDIENTS
Convert 1 SPELL you know into a single use POTION with a single use

SPELL BOOK: MAGIC EFFORT EXPLODES
This book teaches you the art of unlimited power. When casting a SPELL, and rolling MAGIC EFFORT on a D8, if you roll a natural 8, roll MAGIC EFFORT again. There is no limit to how many times you can roll.

ROADMAN'S CLOAK: +2 ARMOR, SHADOWY HOOD
These robes are extra durable, with pockets and padded reinforcement. The hood is also deep and dark, concealing your identity to any passing glance.

SCRIVENER'S KIT: DISCERN AND LEARN SPELLS
With an INT roll, learn any SPELL you see cast by doing 1 HEART of BASIC EFFORT in research. This process bypasses any listed SPELL acquisition requirements.

POWER CRYSTAL: A MAGICAL BOMB
A glowing crystal. Destroy to cause an explosion big enough to destroy a town.

DIMINUTIVE SERVANT: CONJURE FAMILIAR WITH NO ROLL
As large as a bird, mouse or snake. Conjure and command this creature without a roll. If separated by more than 5 miles, it vanishes. The familiar has 1 HP.

ZEKE'S CODEX OF MONSTERS AND MEN: DISCERN DETAILS OF ENEMIES
With an INT roll, discern a key fact, a weakness in any enemy you have experienced. These details are also accessible later from the book with no roll.

GEM OF CHANGES: CHANGE THE ELEMENTALITY OF A SPELL
With an INT roll, change the natural element of a SPELL, such as ice to fire.

NOMAD'S BUNDLE: MEDICAL, CAMPING AND TRAVEL SUPPLIES
This rolled up pack contains: 3 small Healing Potions (1D8 each), 5 SUPPLY, Arrows, 3 torches, a small tent and a 50' length of rope.

A WIZARD'S BLADE: USE YOUR INT TO ROLL ATTACK
This elegant short sword, rapier, dagger or kris knife is balanced for fast, lightweight attacks. If you lose or destroy your Wizard's Blade, make an INT roll on a common WEAPON to enchant it with this property.

UP YOUR GAME

The peak of magic-user play is an exciting, improvised skill with role play. This skill involves assembling, accessing, describing and tracking all the zany details of spell casting. This skill will keep the turns moving quickly, keep your GM informed, and create the moments you're dreaming up.

KNOW YOUR BUILD: Building your character is always fun, but knowing it is a different matter. A skilled mage should exhibit a sort of rhythm as power and weakness ebb and flow. This will help you maximize your effectiveness, and more importantly help your allies understand your role in the group.

ANNOUNCE YOUR CAST: When you cast, include as much data as you can. "I cast ATTRACTOR at POWER III, right here, it lasts 3 ROUNDS, and COSTS me 6 SP." This instantly clears all questions, and reassures everyone playing that all this madness is by the book.

TRACK EVERYTHING: Do your GM a favor! Track every effect, range, radius, and other details of spells. Volunteer to announce expired effects and out-of-range targets. Use dice, digital counters, or index cards to keep it all above table.

BE ARCANE, BE CREATIVE: Anyone can blast skeletons to pieces. You are a strange, mysterious thing! Raw damage output can be fun, but consider ways to bend situations rather than dominate them. Look deeper into solutions no one sees coming. When they think you're weird, go weirder. Repetition is the bastion of the tiny-minded!

HIGHLIGHT OTHERS: The greatest skill a mage can learn is altruism. This isn't dour self-sacrifice alone, but a whole array of support functions to make other characters look and feel awesome. Your wide, cosmic mind sees joy in the triumph of others! That said, when your time comes: unleash.

EVERYTHING IN ITS PLACE

As a magic-user, you may find that managing inventory becomes far more dynamic and messy than with a weapon fighter. You have INT and WIS SPELLS to consider, RARE INGREDIENTS, weapons and equipment, scrolls, and of course RARE INGREDIENTS. The 10 CARRY/10 EQUIP rule should suddenly feel terribly claustrophobic. Here are a series of tips to keep it all from clattering out on the dungeon floor.

RONALD'S BACKWAGON: There are items in the LOOT TABLES designed to offer lots of inventory space. These items could be bought or created with a little luck. This is the old tried and true 'more is better' approach.

STORING SPELLS: Spell stones, scrolls, books, potions, and YOG crystals can be used to store magic to save space or unleash later. Your unique mage may even use enchanted daggers, weird dolls, human teeth, or the ears of his enemies to store magic power. No matter your vessel or style, use the POTION CREATION rules, or an enchantment, to store SPELLS in objects. You'll thank me later.

CREATE STORAGE MAGIC: SPELLS aren't the only thing eating up space. If you can't get your hands on a high end storage item, you'll need to get creative. Pocket dimensions, bottomless bags, unseen servants and more can solve your gear hoarding issues. Work with your GM as you would creating any other magic, and make the roll. Boom, you've got an invisible donkey cart. Remember, COST remains when casting for storage or containment.

USE A JOURNAL: Character sheets are for common folk. You are a wizard. You are a conduit of the cosmos. You need a journal. This approach creates a lovely mess. Don't erase! Just keep scribbling, crossing out, drawing arrows. This journal is your grimoire! By using this method, you will go deeper into the blurry line between yourself as a player and the tangled arcane mind of your character. That's called immersion, and it is awesome.

MAGE CREATION

SPELLS AS POTIONS

Any SPELL can be contained in a consumable, single-use POTION. POTIONS can be very handy, but are easily broken, lost, or spilled. When creating POTIONS, follow the SPELL creation guidelines, but with a few special changes.

- POTIONS require ANY 3 RARE INGREDIENTS to create. Ingredients used are destroyed. Find or buy ingredients during play
- POTION drinkers pay no COST, use no time, and need no roll to activate the effect. A DYING character can drink a POTION if a friend helps
- When creating any POTION, if a natural 1 is rolled, the POTION created is not only a dud, but the creator BELIEVES it is perfect. The drinker enjoys no effects, and must make an immediate MERCURIAL roll. Nasty, nasty stuff

MAGICAL PLANTS AND FUNGI

All the life forms listed below are considered RARE INGREDIENTS. Each has a specific 'pure' use (destroy to activate), or can be used in POTION creation as described above.

ROLL 1D12 RARE INGREDIENT AND ITS PURE USE

1: PORTAL FUNGUS: Open portal to a dimension, lasts 1d4 TURNS
2: MANA BLOSSOM: Gain a disposable HEART usable on any SPELL EFFORT
3: SAPPER VINE: Go to 1 HP to make all effort rolls ULTIMATE on your next spell
4: AMENITA ARCANIA: Mind bending mushroom. Gain +6 INT for 1d4 ROUNDS
5: PSYLOSID SCRYUS: Watch a chosen person or place from afar for 1 ROUND
6: MAGE'S FALF: A cure for magical ills. Undo one curse or magical mutation
7: SILVER PLUME: Gain telepathy with a creature within 1 mile for 1D4 ROUNDS
8: PETRIFIED FROG: Strength powder. Use on creature to make next roll EASY
9: ALBINO BAT: Creepy pink eyes. Destroy to reroll a cast or MERCURIAL roll
10: FRUITS OF LENG: Squeeze in a corpse's mouth, it will talk for 1D4 TURNS
11: BLOOD NETTLE: Place on wounds of a DYING creature and it stops dying
12: SPINY BULLWORT: Burn, breathe the fumes to gain +2 WIS for 1d4 HOURS

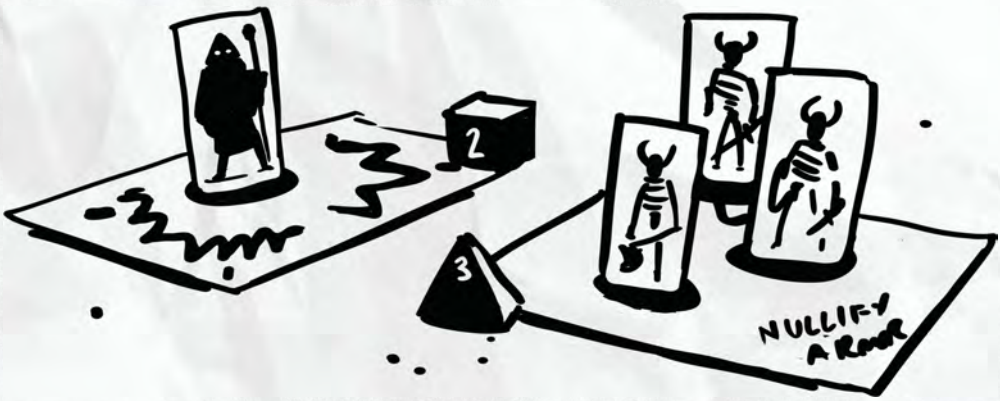
USING INDEX CARDS

When playing a true **ICRPG** magic-user, keep a sharpie, index cards, and a pair of scissors handy at all times. Magic has a way of bending things, doing the unexpected, stretching the imagination. With these simple tools, though, you can build on-the-spot SPELL terrain in seconds.

A drifting gas cloud, mass of tentacles or wall of fire can be crafted and placed within your turn, or as you prepare to roll. With a few simple squiggles, a few cuts, and a folded base you can make cool 3D SPELL effects as you play, and the whole table will be better for it!

Even simpler (and a method we use every session) is to jot down effects, auras, or buffs on a small index card, and toss it on the table until it expires. No drawing skill required! This may seem obvious, but it makes a huge difference for all players to see and *feel* your magical impact on the battle.

Cards and dice can be used in all kinds of ways as SPELL trackers on your table. This example shows an aura surrounding the wizard, with its duration timer. Meanwhile, a NULLIFY ARMOR SPELL is cast among a group of enemies, with a card and die to track its cast location and duration.



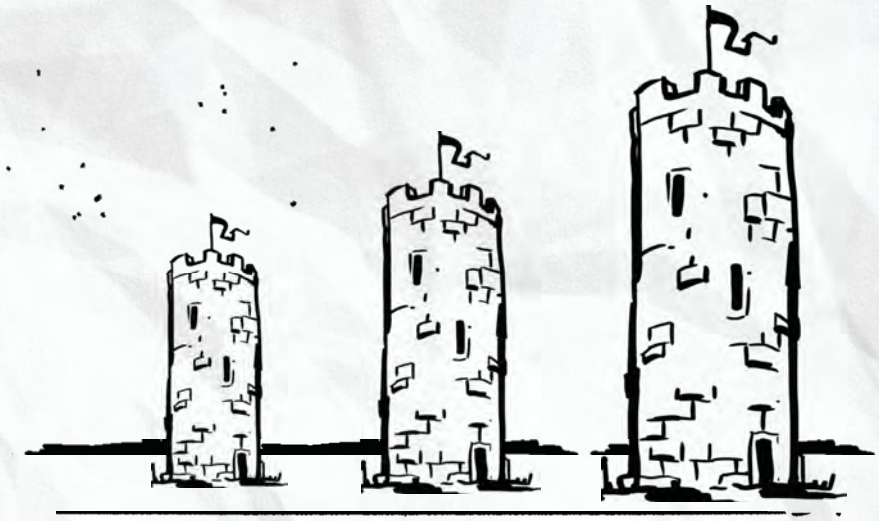
SANCTUM SANCTORUM

The deepest levels of arcane knowledge require time, patience, even fortification. It's lonely at the top, as they say, and many will seek to destroy or unmake you. Build your fortress and deny them the pleasure of your ending.

For every 50 SUPPLY (SUPPLY are 10 COIN each), construct 1 FLOOR of your tower. A FLOOR is the architectural equivalent of a CHUNK: it represents an ability and 10 CHUNK HP. FLOORS have a variety of possible abilities, but no one TOWER can include more than 5. The magic energy simply becomes too much to contain.

Raising a wizard's sanctum is no small task, and has two primary components: SUPPLY and TIME. SUPPLY costs you COIN, and determines what scale you can build. TIME is simply the days it takes to build.

A FLOOR will take 10 days to build. As a GM, be clear with players about the stakes and consequences of spending days away from their heroic goals. 10 days may seem like a blink, but when the world hangs in the balance, every second counts.



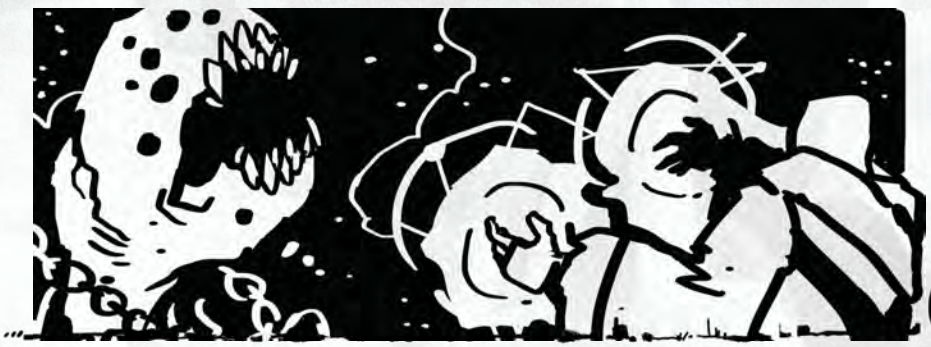
TOWER DEFENSES

Arm your sanctum with the basics to fend off angry mobs, rebels, or thieves. Less important for towers in remote or inaccessible locations, critical for those in plain view.

Never be limited by listed options! If your tower has an astral barrier, force bubble, or flock of bats as its defenses, simply work with your GM to find prices and mechanics for each idea. You haven't come all this way just to build a silly drawbridge! Think big!

ROLL 1D6 TOWER DEFENSES

1: BATTLEMENT: 100 COIN. Scaling walls, hitting targets atop is HARD
2: TRAPS: 50 COIN. Place a portcullis, hidden pit, tripwire arrow, or alarm plate
3: WARDS: 100 COIN. A Level I SPELL. Triggers on enemies NEAR. Resets daily
4: 2 GARGOYLES: 50 COIN. Animate to attack foes. TIER 1 entity that can fly FAR
5: DRAWBRIDGE: 200 COIN. Swim FAR to cross. Includes 4 alligators in a moat
6: BALLISTA: 500 COIN. Requires battlement. Fire 1/ROUND CHUNK damage



WIZARD'S TOWER

A TOWER'S PURPOSE

Various types of floors or sections each have their specific uses...

LIBRARY: Auto-succeed to create or learn SPELLS with STUDY acquisition
LABORATORY: You automatically succeed on rolls to create POTIONS
CIRCLES: You automatically succeed at rolls to summon minions
ATRIUM: Once/DAY, alter weather within 10 miles for 1D4 HOURS
MENAGERIE: You can house up to 3 additional minions
SCRYING: Once per DAY, magically view any location within 100 miles
FONT: Any who spend 1 ROUND in the water are healed to full HP
FORGE: Create metal equipment with a +1 STAT per day and 100 COIN spent
VAULT: Door has 3 HEARTS. If touched, you are alerted no matter distance
DUNGEON: House up to 10 prisoners and 4 monsters with total certainty
FEAST HALL: Building FLOORS only takes 3 days

ENEMIES AT THE GATES

When the world conspires against you or arrives with pitchforks...

ROLL 1D12 ATTACKERS ON YOUR TOWER

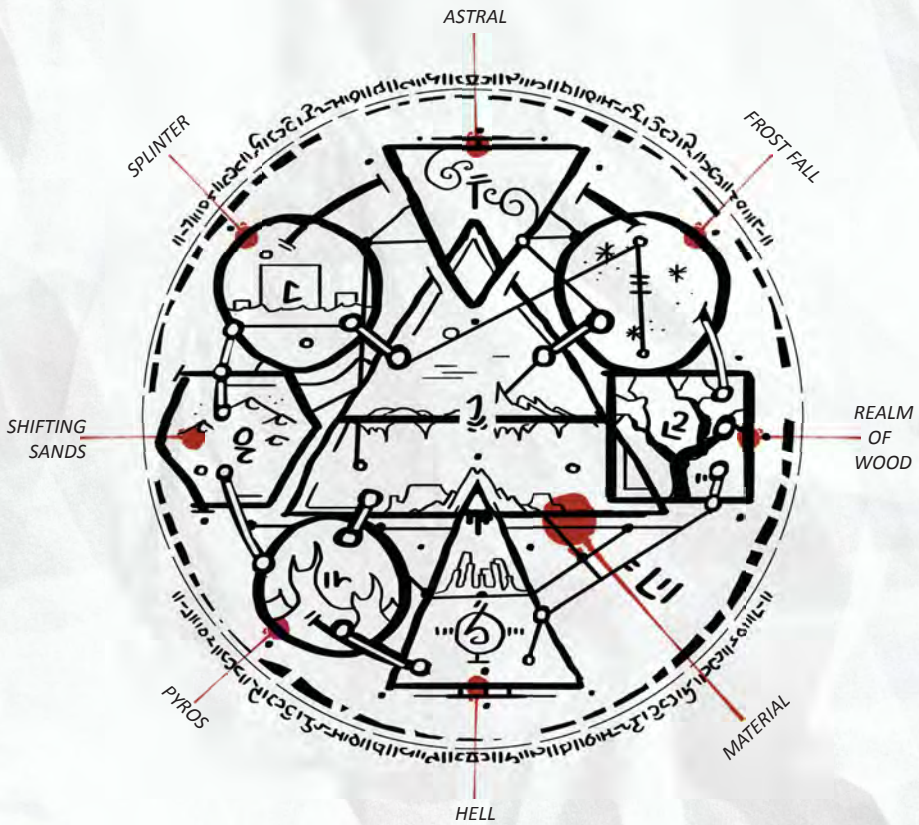
1: THIEVES! 1D6 thieves enter and steal 1D100% of your treasure hoard
2: BETRAYAL: One of your minions turns, goes wild; can you regain its loyalty?
3: INVADERS: Enemies of the kingdom have invaded, demanding you kneel
4: FOILED! A team of "heroes" arrives to stop your magical research
5: ESCORT: A local baron sends 1D100 soldiers to collect you for "a kingly task"
6: RIVAL: A rival wizard spreads rumors that you are to blame for calamities
7: WARLORD: An upstart warlord arrives with 1D100 raiders to take your tower
8: TAX LEVY: You owe the lord of this land 50 COIN per FLOOR in taxes… or else
9: FAMINE: Your minions starve or turn up missing, leaving your tower empty
10: QUAKE: Dimensional rips open a chasm nearby, and all hell is loosed
11: MOB: Angry townsfolk appear demanding you cease all this "witchcraft"
12: LIGHTNING! Nature strikes, destroying 1D4 FLOORS in a single night

REALMS WITHIN REALMS

There are 8 known dimensions in the cosmos. Of these, the ASTRAL PLANE serves as a nexus or nerve center, binding all realms together in time and space. This makes the ASTRAL PLANE a supreme destination for travelers, tower builders, and wizards of supreme power. The map below is the best-known representation, taken from 'The Revelations of Anaxamon.'

DIMENSION AS DISTANCE

At the highest levels of magic power, an entire dimension can serve as the range for a SPELL. No matter the power, though, no magic can cross the dimensional barriers. Even PORTAL and LEY LINE magic can barely form a connection between realms of reality, and are highly unstable forms of magic. For this reason, wizards are often forced to pursue their enemies, or flee their foes into alternate facets of reality.



THE DIMENSIONS

MATERIAL REALM

The mortal coil upon which we humans and our kin delicately survive. Fragile, finite, and threatened. This realm is vast, slow to traverse, and immutable in its physical laws. For this reason, many magical entities and demigods despise it.

REALM OF WOOD

The seat of cosmic life force and home to the forest Gods and their countless offspring. This dimension has very little stone or soil, and is primarily colossal redwood trees drifting through a gigantic cloud of air and water vapor. There is very little gravity here, its denizens have adapted to life in the endless sky.

- Extend all NEAR rules to FAR
- All DEX rolls are HARD
- Tree, druid, plant and weather magic are DOUBLE their normal effects

PYROS

A realm of fire, searing heat, magma and choking smoke. This is the realm of fire elementals, cinder giants, infernals and worse. The central landmass is a shifting, broken mass of dried lava and crumbling basalt spires, crisscrossed by lava flows and volcanic vents. Tread here at your own risk.

- Take 1D4 damage from breathing the air here EVERY ROUND
- Without protection, 1 piece of LOOT will ignite and turn to ash PER ROUND
- Fire magic and fire-based ENTITIES enjoy DOUBLE on all effects and powers

THE SHIFTING SANDS

A desert dimension, but with an infinite plane of dunes. Beneath this lifeless wasteland is a vast network of caverns, occupied by those creatures who seek a truly remote refuge from the bustle of the living cosmos.

- SUPPLY is spent at double its normal rate here
- The deep caverns contain water, and a myriad of cavern life
- Endless dust and sand, even in the caves. All CON rolls are HARD

HELL

Where souls are tormented for eternity by the sadistic judges they conjure. Home to Azael, Vorlac, demons, fiends, and the astral gateways between Alfheim and Ghost Mountain.

- Demons, Infernals, Fiends, Vorlac and Azael re-roll any 1s while here
- Hell never changes, despite timelines and infinite possibilities of other realms
- Spawn 1D6 Flame Kin every ROUND here, no matter where in HELL

FROST FALL

A cold, static place of vast frozen emptiness and translucent blue ice formations. Unlike the world of Blood and Snow, there is very little life here.

- Spend 10 SUPPLY to travel here per day, per person
- All DEX rolls are HARD here, the entire place is covered in ice
- Fire magic does HALF its normal effect

ASTRAL PLANE

The cosmic nexus of all places and times. The entire dimension can be treated as a volatile LEY LINE or raw source of power. Gravity behaves strangely, time can move in loops or zig zags, and the stars wheel overhead.

- Monsters regenerate D8 HP every ROUND
- PORTAL or DOORWAY SPELLS cast here are always EASY
- Double all effects of magic in any form

SPLINTER

A realm created to confine the most devious magical criminals and chaotic wizards. It is a complex, convoluted maze of stairways, helix stone pathways, and iron cells. All this within colossal cubes of marble in an ever-crashing ocean.

- Horrific storms buffet this place at all times
- Unless armed with very special means, MAGIC barely functions here. Any roll involving magic, SPELLS, or magic effects of LOOT is always HARD

SPELL LISTINGS EXPLAINED

TYPE & LEVEL: Each section here covers one spell type. Within that, spells are listed by their level, in alphabetical order. 3 spells of a single type must be acquired to unlock spells of the following level.

TARGET: The target of a spell may be an individual creature, area, multiple creatures, or more abstract things. The targets of SPELLS can also be escalated or increased by casting at higher POWER.

SELF: Can only be cast on the caster
SINGLE VISIBLE: Any ONE TARGET the caster can see
SINGLE TOUCH: A single ally or enemy touched. If an evasive enemy, may require a DEX roll to touch
RANGED ATTACK: Treat as bow or gun shot. Roll DEX
SINGLE CLOSE: Melee range, or less than 5 feet
SINGLE NEAR: Target any 1 thing within NEAR range
SINGLE FAR: Any 1 thing or person within FAR range
ALL CLOSE: Everything within arm's reach is affected
ALL NEAR: Everything within a stone's throw
ALL FAR: A huge area, within a FAR radius is affected by this SPELL
ALL VISIBLE: All the caster sees is subject to her power
ALL IN EARSHOT: Some SPELLS use sound
A MATTER OF MILES: This SPELL has such immense range it is almost infinite

DURATION: Some spells simply pop into existence and vanish, others have lasting effects. Like TARGETS, DURATIONS can be increased by casting at higher POWER.

INSTANT: The effect is instantaneous, and over in a split second
1 TURN: This effect lasts for 1 TURN folling its caster's TURN
1DX TURNS: Use any die, count your way around the table, then end the effect
1 ROUND: At the beginning of your next TURN, the effect disappears
1DX ROUNDS: Use any die. After that many of *your* TURNS, at the beginning of your TURN, the SPELL ends
UNTIL TIMER: When a timer rolled by the GM expires, the SPELL dissipates
FUSE: Set DURATION, within a maximum
HOURS: A trip by horseback, night of camping, or long walk in the woods
DAYS: Use a die, GM ruling, caster roll, or caster decision to determine
FOCUS/CONCENTRATE: Until the caster casts another SPELL or takes damage
PERMANENT: This SPELL never dissipates unless COUNTERSPELL or other removal method is used

ARCANE

I: Player's Guide INT
I: Arc Arrow
I: Attractor
I: Disruptor Ray
I: Fog
I: Mutagen
I: Oubliette
I: Phase
I: Raven Prism
I: Repeat
I: Swiftness
I: Unlock
I: Unravel
I: Zeke's Last Dance
II: Ant Venom
II: Depths
II: Duranium
II: Frogs
II: Growth
II: Lock
II: Olfan's Overture
II: Phase Hold
II: Swarm Self
III: Grasp of the Ogdru
III: Molok's Machines
III: Petrificatum
IV: Glyph of Teleport
IV: Endless Spells
IV: Portal
IV: Reactor
IV: Time Warp
IV: Xanarasath Memoria

HOLY

I: Player's Guide WIS
I: Any Ghost Mtn. HOLY
I: Baffle
I: Breath of Udin
I: Chain Reaction
I: Durandel's Blessing
I: Ice Barrage
I: Lightning Lash
I: Painless
I: Repel
I: Rest the Dead
I: Tongues
I: Unseen
I: Winged Spell Stone
II: Apocalyptica
II: Cleanse the Cursed
II: Illusions and Wonders
II: Love and Lust
II: Moon Changer
II: Ray of Souls
II: Water Wonder
III: Again
III: Astral Flight
III: Life
III: Mind of Metal
III: Murky Wood Melody
III: Winter
IV: Enhance Spell
IV: Temporal Hold
IV: Zeke's Ascension

INFERNAL

I: Ghost Mtn. INFERNAL
I: Animate Dead
I: Bat
I: Bind with Fire
I: Blood Mist
I: Wither
I: Melt
I: Molok's Mutation
I: Plague of Doubts
I: Zeke's Immolation
II: Bind Soul
II: Burning Arrows
II: Driven
II: Flame Blade
II: Garland's Sphere
II: Glyph of Fire
II: Incantation of Fear
II: Possession
II: Shadow Form
II: Skull
II: Summoning Circle
III: Flame Vortex
III: Kill Unseen
III: Learn by Blood
III: Magic Bane
III: Scythe
III: Sound of Silence
III: Transfusion
III: Death
IV: Fire Wonder
IV: Forge
IV: Horns
IV: Vampire

ARCANE SPELLS

1: ANY PLAYER'S GUIDE INT SPELL

Choose any spell from the INT SPELLS list in the PLAYER'S GUIDE. Use common sense or work with your GM to determine effects of casting at higher POWER, amplifying DURATION and TARGET specifics as needed. Your GM may also designate this NOT AN OPTION when using the alternate spell list in this section.

1: ARC ARROW

You enhance 1 ordinary projectile with the ability to skip like rocks. Each time you roll a hit with the enhanced ammunition, make another attack against an additional NEAR enemy. There is no limit to the number of ricochet attacks.

TARGET: TOUCH (1 AMMUNITION/POWER)
DURATION: INSTANT

The supposed record is held by Ivan the Boneless, who skipped an arrow through 16 orc warriors. He did not live to enjoy the holding of that record.

1: ATTRACTOR

Conjure a localized gravity well. All NEAR must pass a STR save or be pulled directly toward it. Colliding creatures take 1D6 WEAPON damage per POWER. Any movement within the area of effect requires a STR check.

TARGET: NEAR RADIUS AT FAR RANGE
DURATION: 1 ROUND/POWER

This spell creates a razor-thin disc of gravity, linked to a black hole. The pull is strong enough to shatter steel, disassemble masonry, or tear arms from sockets.

1: REPEAT

You replicate the very substance of time. Choose a specific event, such as "an arrow struck that orc." For the duration of the SPELL, if that event happens within range, the event repeats itself each TURN.

TARGET: A VISIBLE EVENT
DURATION: 1D4 TURNS/POWER

The door slammed on him once, twice, three times, again… by the end of it, he wished he hadn't even walked in to the Soggy Shingle Tavern.

I: DISRUPTOR RAY

Speak 'DIENDE MORTIFERUM' and a vein of light shoots from your hand, agitating the cosmic field around your victim. For that target, ATTACKING and MOVEMENT are cancelled utterly until the SPELL ends.

TARGET: SINGLE FAR
DURATION: 1 ROUND/POWER

Few things are more infuriating than being held like an infant in an invisible prison, unable to carry out wrath or ruin.

I: FOG

By changing the relationship of air and vapor, you form a mass of cool, opaque fog with an open hand and a sound of air moving. The fog conceals movement, stifles flames, and settles onto surfaces in damp condensation.

TARGET: NEAR RADIUS AT FAR RANGE, +1 CATEGORY RADIUS/POWER
DURATION: 1D4 ROUNDS/POWER

Their party emerged from an unnatural fog on a clear night, stole the crown in the confusion, and vanished with the breeze. Tricksters.

I: MUTAGEN

Create a powerful POTION that amplifies a creature's innate abilities. When consumed, this elixir takes all STAT bonus points and combines them onto a SINGLE STAT of the caster's choice. The target's innate nature becomes exaggerated, all other STATS drop to +0. This is accompanied by physical deformities. The POTION is highly unstable and will spoil after 1 ROUND if unused.

TARGET: CONSUMABLE, SINGLE
DURATION: 2 ROUNDS/POWER

Gunder was always strong, but the mutagen made him a hulking beast, clumsy and dim as a mountain stone, green, lumpy, and always late for breakfast.

ARCANE SPELLS

1: OUBLIETTE

You conjure a small extra-dimensional chamber of stone. Cast this SPELL underground. A locking trapdoor appears, opens to a 20-foot square room. All contents are ejected and the hatch vanishes when the SPELL ends.

TARGET: TOUCH
DURATION: 1D4 HOURS/POWER

In the right moment, a damp hidey-hole is better than a fortified castle. Some say OUBLIETTE was used to escape Splinter, but none know how.

1: PHASE

Your physical form briefly becomes astral. You are invisible, silent, and pass through material objects. Only MAGIC attacks can harm you. If you are inside an object when this SPELL ends, you are ejected and take ULTIMATE damage.

TARGET: SELF
DURATION: 1 ROUND/POWER

A wizard must take great caution while walking in the astral, even for a split second. Often, one does not walk alone in that baffling place.

1: RAVEN PRISM

You summon a raven that is linked to your soul. It flies FAR and can move in and out of the Astral Dimension in wisps of smoke. It has one HEART and disappears if killed. You can treat the raven as yourself when calculating SPELL range.

TARGET: SELF
DURATION: PERMANENT/UNTIL KILLED

The raven is formed from its summoner's shadow and does not cast a shadow of its own, save the darkness of its unearthly gaze.

I: SWIFTNESS

Create 1 use of a speed POTION. Your movement blurs. MOVE twice your normal distance, and make an ATTEMPT on your turn, even after a double MOVE.

TARGET: SELF
DURATION: 1 ROUND/POWER

Swiftness can be learned the old way, or simply by a lightning strike to the brain.

I: UNLOCK

By reversing or advancing a micro-nodule of time, you can move padlocks, bars, gates or other locking type mechanisms to either locked or unlocked states. Larger locks like castle gates require a POWER 3 or higher cast to affect.

TARGET: TOUCH
DURATION: 1 ROUND/POWER

The first SPELL mastered by those who traverse the prison world of Splinter.

I: UNRAVEL

Fast forward the time state for an object, vastly accelerating the effects of wear, rot, rust or decay. Age a thing 25 years per POWER.

TARGET: SINGLE NEAR OBJECT UNDER 50 POUNDS
DURATION: PERMANENT

Time wizards do the strangest things. I once saw a mage turn a table to sawdust by aging it a century in seconds.

I: ZEKE'S LAST DANCE

Dance with bizarre, convulsive movements. Those who see you do so must roll CHA against your INT roll or be ensorcelled, joining in. They can repeat this ATTEMPT on their TURN. If they fail, they can take no other ACTIONS.

DURATION: CONCENTRATION (DANCING)
TARGET: ALL THOSE WHO CAN SEE

His arms waved like mad, like a dying fish. His eyes bugged and his feet slid side to side. It was comical, frightening, and mesmeric.

II: ANT VENOM

Create a terribly potent poison from thin air. Create 1 drop per POWER. Each drop, whether touched or ingested, inflicts 1D6 damage of burning, itching pain. The fluid can be used on knives or arrows, or placed on food.

TARGET: TOUCH OR INGEST
DURATION: INSTANT

Conjured venom is magical in nature, and therefore concentrated.

II: DEPTHS

True darkness awaits in deep water. With this SPELL, create a downward pull on any creature or object in water. The target is pulled down until escaping with STR or hitting the bottom. The pressure, cold, and airless hell of it does the rest.

TARGET: 200 POUNDS OF MASS/POWER
DURATION: UNTIL ESCAPED, KILLED, OR DESTROYED

Whether man, beast, or even sailing ship, the black fathoms crush them all to pulp. It is no surprise the darkest gods dwell on the sea floor.

II: DURANIUM

Rearrange the atomic elements of a non-living object into pure duranium. This is a durable metal that is almost impossible to destroy by non-magical means.

TARGET: SINGLE TOUCH
DURATION: 1 POUND OF MASS/POWER

He revealed a remarkable dagger, with thousands of folds and ripples.

II: FROGS

Create 100 frogs per POWER. They can pour from a crack, fall from the sky, erupt from a bucket etc. They are normal pond frogs, and behave as any frog would.

TARGET: EYESIGHT
DURATION: UNTIL KILLED OR WANDER OFF

Zeke's Guide mentions a secret formula to multiply the number of frogs created by 1,000. Thankfully, this formula has been lost to time.

II: GROWTH

All living things grow, but by accelerating time and expanding its influence, you can grow creatures beyond their normal limits--to enormous scale. Grow 1 creature you can see. Double its size per POWER cast. As an aside, the growth process can be painful.

TARGET: SINGLE EYESIGHT
DURATION: 1D4 ROUNDS

Hinar, the tree man of Grey, was known to cast this SPELL on a dwarven companion. Few terrors in this world rival a 30 foot dwarf.

II: LOCK

Using a wand, dagger, quill or claw, scratch an arcane rune in metal, wood or stone doors, padlocks or gates. That portal OR padlock can only be released with an UNLOCK SPELL of equal or greater POWER. No physical means can release or destroy the locked object.

TARGET: SINGLE TOUCH
DURATION: POWER 1: 1D4 ROUNDS, POWER 2: 1D4 HOURS, POWER 3: 1D4 DAYS, POWER 4: 1D4 YEARS OR UNTIL DISPELLED BY UNLOCK SPELL OF EQUAL POWER

The LOCK spell can be hazardous indeed. Not even the caster can release the manacles so enchanted with the appropriate UNLOCK spell. This exact problem led to the sad case of Herman Zinn, who languished in chains for 4 long years after simply practicing the magic in his laboratory. He was discovered decades later by adventurers, who discovered a lonely skeleton atop a tower of books and relics, lying crumpled next to the inscribed manacles. Magic can be strange and cruel.

II: OLFAN'S OVERTURE

Roll to cast only once, then weave a dwarven folk song by humming, whistling, playing an instrument or singing. As long as you continue to do so, ignore 1D8 damage per POWER each ROUND. If you speak or cast another SPELL, the effect ends.

TARGET: SELF
DURATION: CONCENTRATION (SINGING)

Olfan walked through the fires of Hell, whistling his tune... the flames could not defile him.

II: PHASE HOLD

Block out the interconnections to other dimensions with this SPELL. All creatures you can see can no longer use PHASE, Blip Modules, or any other means to move in and out of common material reality.

TARGET: ALL IN EYESIGHT
DURATION: 1 ROUND/POWER

Phasing drives combatants wild, and gets men killed. By preventing this, even astral demons can be easily contained and destroyed.

II: SWARM SELF

You separate yourself at the molecular level, transforming into a dense swarm of insects. You retain your overall shape if desired, but gain all the abilities of a small swarm. POWER can either prolong this form OR increase its mass to terrible proportions.

TARGET: SELF
DURATION: 1D4 ROUNDS/POWER or 1D4 ROUNDS + 2 X YOUR MASS/POWER

Anaxamon Anaximander cast this spell so frequently, his form eventually became permanent. Those who dared peek under his green hood, or look into his gleaming single eye saw thousands of tiny cicadas.

III: GRASP OF THE OGDRU

The Ogdru are chaotic gods confined in deep space. With this SPELL, you tap their power to conjure tree-like tentacles from water or rock. The tentacles are myriad and ravenous, barely under your control. Treat them as 1 GIANT TENTACLE per POWER.

TARGET: APPEARING RANDOMLY
DURATION: 1 TENTACLE/POWER

Only fools and madmen tangle with the Ogdru. Their formless malice is beyond mortal minds, and craves only chaos and annihilation for all living things.

III: MOLOK'S MACHINES

Molok was known to experiment with all kinds of mechanical monsters. This mutation SPELL changes a target, fusing metal elements into their bodies. Each machine feature, be it pincers, giant shields, or weapon shapes, includes abilities to match.

TARGET: SELF OR SINGLE TOUCH
DURATION: 1 MECHANICAL FEATURE/POWER

His method was precise, patient, complex and brilliant. He was also evil.

III: PETRIFICATUM

This is a concoction that, once ingested, turns its victim to stone. There is no known cure, but the POTION is slow-acting. Casting with more POWER hastens the process by 1 ROUND, from a base of 5 ROUNDS.

TARGET: SINGLE INGEST
DURATION: PERMANENT

This spell, an elixr, can be tricky to use on one's enemies in an up front fashion. That said, if the foe can be deceived into ingesting the mixture, there is no known means to reverse its petrification effect. This is how the famed and ancient 'Likeness of Haruo' statue came to occupy the town square of Gwadan, when a drinking contest went terribly wrong.

IV: GLYPH OF TELEPORT

Etch matching runes in two locations anywhere in the multiverse. With an INT roll, use these glyphs to instantly travel between the two. The runes last until erased or destroyed.

TARGET: TOUCH
DURATION: UNTIL ERASED

One by one we read the runes aloud, and found ourselves on a desolate, twisting world of living stone and spinning stars.

IV: ENDLESS SPELLS

This SPELL is a passive attribute once learned. Using an infinite power source from deep space, channel SPELLS with innate ability. Any time you cast a SPELL with a modified 13 or higher, instantly cast again. This effect also disregards any time limits a SPELL may have.

TARGET: SPELL DEPENDENT
DURATION: INSTANT

Nothing is so destructive as damage using Seekers with the Endless Spells ability. Gods, the chaos.

IV: PORTAL

Open a temporary gateway between dimensions or times. The PORTAL can be used by anyone or anything with no roll as long as it is open. Open the PORTAL for 1 ROUND per POWER. The caster must have detailed knowledge of the destination, anywhere in time or space or alternate realities, but is not required to 'have been there.'

TARGET: EYESIGHT
DURATION: 1 ROUND/POWER

He was the last to jump through, but the doorway snapped shut in a blink, slicing poor Harvin in two cauterized pieces. One here, one in the Astral.

IV: REACTOR

This SPELL changes any form of matter into any other at your touch. This becomes an 'infectious' reaction that will continue until reaching the end of the affected mass, moving at NEAR per POWER cast each ROUND.

TARGET: TOUCH
DURATION: PERMANENT

The stone changed to gold, like a frost spreading on a pond. The reaction continued, crunching and hissing, until the entire wall was solid gold metal.

IV: TIME WARP

With sheer will, and ancient magic, you can bend time itself. Alter 1 ROUND of time per POWER cast. This round can be rewound, skipped, or held still. The effects of this kind of SPELL can be hard to predict, and even create paradoxes.

TARGET: TIME FABRIC
DURATION: ALTER 1 ROUND OF TIME/POWER

It is important to perceive time as a series of parallels, not loops and knots.

IV: XARASANTH MEMORIA

Become a 'memory walker.' Not only do you gain knowledge of infinite timelines and possible universes, you can implant, remove or enhance others' memories of those times and places. Work with 1 memory per POWER cast.

TARGET: 1 TOUCH/POWER
DURATION: 1 MEMORY/POWER

Nature may be infinite, but our perception and memory of it is all we have. To manipulate this solitary link between us and the cosmos is true power.

HOLY SPELLS

1: ANY PLAYER'S GUIDE WIS SPELL

Choose any spell from the WIS SPELLS list in the PLAYER'S GUIDE. Use common sense or work with your GM to determine effects of casting at higher POWER, amplifying DURATION and TARGET specifics as needed. Your GM may also designate this NOT AN OPTION when using the alternate spell list in this section.

1: ANY GHOST MOUNTAIN HOLY SPELL

As above, but using the HOLY SPELLS list in Ghost Mountain (see page 238).

1: BAFFLE

By entering the psyche and unleashing a chaotic stream of gibberish, you blunt even the sharpest mind. Choose INT, WIS, or CHA. The target's bonus in that STAT becomes 0. The target must roll WIS to realize it's under a spell effect.

TARGET: SINGLE CLOSE/POWER
DURATION: 1 ROUND/POWER

In the debauchery of the Unseelie Courts, one never knows if it is wine or magic that addles the courtesans.

1: BREATH OF UDIN

Call upon the All-Father to create a wall of blasting wind in a shape you control. The wind requires a HARD STR roll to penetrate or resist, pushing all objects and creatures away to a NEAR distance.

TARGET: NEAR RADIUS AT NEAR
DURATION: CONCENTRATION

The still air erupted into a sculpted gale, blasting the bandits away, stripping the walls of thatch, and blasting every pebble from where Aldin calmly stood.

1: CHAIN REACTION

This spell is cast on a willing ally. The subject becomes charged with magical momentum, giving them tremendous attack power. For each successful attack by that ally after Chain Reaction is cast, they may attempt another attack, with no upper limit to the number of attacks rolled. Enhance the power of this spell by adding a +1 to the attacks in question per POWER.

TARGET: TOUCHED ALLY
DURATION: UNTIL A FAILED ATTACK IS ROLLED

Olaf was glowing red and orange like fire. The old magic was upon him. Once he unleashed the axe, he did not stop until the battlefield was like a hillside of cut grass. Nothing could stop him.

1: DURANDEL'S BLESSING

By bolstering the natural harmonic vibrations within a living thing, you seal the target's very soul against all magical ill will or injury. The target is immune to all harmful MAGIC. That target can still utilize their own MAGIC or SPELLS.

TARGET: SINGLE TOUCH/POWER
DURATION: 1 ROUND/POWER

For just a moment, the mighty arcana of the cosmos turned a blind eye to my humble soul. No bonds held sway, no missiles pierced me, no demonic blood could poison my veins.

1: ICE BARRAGE

You hurl one volatile shard of ice per POWER, like glassy throwing daggers, into any NEAR surface in a cluster. The shards strobe with energy and explode on fuses you set, dealing MAGIC to ALL targets NEAR that location.

TARGET: VISIBLE SURFACE, EXPLODE NEAR RADIUS
DURATION: INSTANT OR FUSE (3 ROUNDS MAX)

The Yrill shamans' final rite of passage is battling an ice demon. The victor leaves with two frozen horns. One is given as a gift to the master, the other is burned into a magical powder.

HOLY SPELLS

I: LIGHTNING LASH

You conjure a whip of crackling energy. The whip has FAR range and deals 1D8 MAGIC per POWER. It also lashes its victims like a whip. Targets struck are pulled to CLOSE range with a STR contest.

TARGET: 1 WITHIN FAR/POWER
DURATION: INSTANT

It is said that Thoor, son of Udin, taught this battle spell to mankind in the First Age. The God of Lightning has no love of serpent folk.

I: PAINLESS

You draft a gar-like brew that grants temporary immunity to all forms of pain. A creature that drinks this POTION also reduces damage taken by 4 per POWER.

TARGET: SINGLE TOUCH (DRINK)
DURATION: 1D4 ROUNDS

A dash of gar, a pinch of grit, and stir with an iron spike.

I: REPEL

You bend gravity waves into a hyperbolic sphere, creating a powerful repulsor effect around your SPELL's focal point. NOTHING can get CLOSE to that focal point for the DURATION unless the SPELL is cancelled.

TARGET: SIGHT/CLOSE RADIUS SPHERE
DURATION: 1D4 TURNS/POWER

I once saw a wizard cast ATTRACTOR and REPEL on an apple in a Khettish Tavern. The entire building was destroyed.

1: REST THE DEAD

By carving the 'Skaradess' glyph in a corpse's flesh or bones, you can consecrate, release, and protect the deceased. They can never be raised as undead, and their soul will ascend to its destiny, at peace.

TARGET: SINGLE TOUCH
DURATION: PERMANENT/UNTIL GLYPH IS ERASED

The kings of old are guarded, even in death, by powerful magic. No defilers will lay their claws in those hallowed bones.

1: TONGUES

This SPELL expands consciousness, accessing true intent beyond words. The target can fluently speak and understand any language.

TARGET: SINGLE TOUCH
DURATION: 1D4 ROUNDS/POWER

As the magic washed over Tamwell, the Mykonoid's bubbling hiccups transformed into eloquent oration. Their friendship only grew from there.

1: UNSEEN

Cloud the minds of nearby creatures, hiding allies, objects, sounds. The victims invent their own odd excuses for the blank spots in their view.

TARGET: ANY 1 SOUND, ALLY, OBJECT WITHIN FAR/POWER
DURATION: 1 ROUND/POWER

Everyone in the tavern looked right past the statue, as if it was never there at all. The arguments ceased, and folk didn't even have their own confusion to cherish.

HOLY SPELLS

I: WINGED SPELL STONE

Take any SPELL you know and store one guaranteed use of it in a small amber stone. Destroy to cast. The stone will hover near you, using no inventory space.

TARGET: SELF ONLY
DURATION: 1 ROUND/POWER LEVEL

The mightiest wizards found ways to contain their very souls in hovering Spell Stones. What an odd way to spend the afterlife, waiting to pop out.

II: APOCALYPTICA

Use psychic power to implant visions of doom and catastrophic failure into the mind of a creature you can see. They are free to act, but plagued by doubt.

TARGET: SINGLE EYESIGHT
DURATION: 1 ROUND/POWER

Zeke was known to not only crush his enemies, but to let them self-destruct.

II: CLEANSE THE CURSED

Place your hand on the head of the forsaken, cursed, diseased, poisoned or afflicted. Cast this SPELL with a WIS roll, and cleanse up to 4 of the target's conditions instantly.

TARGET: SINGLE TOUCH
DURATION: 1 CONDITION/POWER

There is no better way to win the hearts of common folk than to walk village to village curing the sick. Our world is built on such honest kindness.

II: ILLUSIONS AND WONDERS

Create illusions with detailed, hallucinogenic realism. Add 1 ROUND or 1 target per POWER. Victims break the illusion on their TURN with a WIS roll.

TARGET: ANY 1 WITHIN FAR/POWER
DURATION: 1 ROUND or TARGET/POWER

One of the most versatile, mischievous, infuriating magicks is the most simple: to make others see what isn't there.

II: LOVE AND LUST

Congeal pure love into a glowing red tincture. After the subject drinks the potion, the *next person* they see will capture their heart utterly, to obsession.

TARGET: SINGLE/CONSUME ELIXR
DURATION: 1 DAY/POWER

Love is one thing, but this man was crazed with desire for the priestess.

II: MOON CHANGER

Shift the time state of planets to change the moon's phase. A crescent can become full, or a full moon blotted out to its new stage. The effect is visible to all who look up, and is no illusion.

TARGET: A SINGLE MOON
DURATION: 1 NIGHT/POWER

To meddle with such titanic forces as MOON CHANGER is a foolish, risky thing.

II: RAY OF SOULS

Compress immortal souls into an energy beam of incredible power. The beam erupts as you cry the names of souls you have saved or aided in their ascension throughout your life as a user of HOLY magic. For each point of MASTERY, both in your normal MASTERY track and your HOLY magic track, reduce 1 foe to 0 hp with this beam of energy. The destructive effect moves in a straight line when cast, and cannot harm allies.

TARGET: FAR, ANY IN STRAIGHT LINE
DURATION: INSTANT

There is no fury like a soul giving its last cry before eternal rest. The mage who can harness this power finds the riptide between the role of savior and destroyer.

HOLY SPELLS

II: WATER WONDER

Using any amount of liquid water NEAR you, conjure a being of pure elemental water. The creature grows, adding a HEART each ROUND to 4 HEARTS maximum. It fights for you, with +2 on all rolls. It includes all the behaviors of normal water.

TARGET: ANY NEAR WATER
DURATION: CONCENTRATION

Garland defeated us with his blasted Water Wonders. The things were relentless, and he called them all simply 'Bubbles.'

III: AGAIN

This powerful SPELL can re-fold the substance of time itself. It is the simple, incredible ability to say aloud "it happens again." For each POWER cast, during the following ROUND, at any moment, you can cause an event to repeat itself.

TARGET: EYESIGHT
DURATION: 1 EVENT/POWER

Altering time comes with impossible, disastrous effects. Simply repeating a single moment is miniscule by compare, but effective.

III: ASTRAL FLIGHT

Transform your physical form into an incorporeal astral entity. In this form, you can fly at twice your normal MOVE, penetrate solid matter, see and perceive all around you, but remain invisible, phased, immaterial and silent. Only energy or MAGIC attacks can harm you in this form.

TARGET: SELF ONLY
DURATION: 1 ROUND/POWER LEVEL

It is reported that those who are injured in astral form retain strange multidimensional wounds. These wounds are irritated by ley lines and dimensional gateways

III: LIFE

The power word 'Life' is mighty indeed. Speak this word with fury, and heal 1 HEART per POWER on a creature you can see. The target also adds their CON to the recovery amount.

TARGET: SINGLE EYESIGHT
DURATION: INSTANT

Old Hinar was part treeish. That part of him, even after all the life and death he had seen, could grant a great boon of healing in time of need.

III: MIND OF METAL

Armor your consciousness, or an ally's, with psychic resilience. With this armor in place, make an EASY INT roll any time ARCANE magic or fear effects are used against you. If you succeed, ignore that effect. Gain 1D4 ROUNDS per POWER cast.

TARGET: SELF OR SINGLE TOUCH
DURATION: 1D4 ROUNDS/POWER

It is frightening enough to enter another mind. To be rebuked from that place is even more horrible.

III: MURKY WOOD MELODY

Sing, hum or play one of the oldest songs in existence. This song has the power to show the way. These words take many forms, including navigational beacons, clearing of darkness or fog, or the dispelling of confusing illusions.

TARGET: ALL NEAR ALLIES
DURATION: 1 BENEFIT PER POWER

Olfan whistled like a boy in a parade. As suddenly as we had become lost, the gloom cleared, the spiders scurried from the path. A ray of sunlight drifted down

III: WINTER

Open a micro-doorway to the dimension of Frost Fall. You are immediately surrounded, and emitting a cloud of freezing cold. It will continue to spread as long as you concentrate, with no known limit.

TARGET: SELF/SURROUNDING AREA
DURATION: CONCENTRATION

Some say the ice flows of Olo are the result of a years-long SPELL cast by a long forgotten wizard. He kept the door to Frost Fall open too long.

IV: ENHANCE SPELL

With this cast, upgrade any SPELL you know, effectively creating a new spell of greater effect. Since this is such a wide open set of possibilities, each cast of ENHANCE SPELL must be cleared with the GM. Enhancing a spell may even require certain objects, reagents, or locations to achieve. A small enhancement could be a single roll, whereas a legendary upgrade to a spell could require days of EFFORT.

TARGET: VARIABLE
DURATION: VARIABLE

The most powerful form of magic is that which powers itself, making more from nothing, and expanding the finite to forever.

IV: TEMPORAL HOLD

With divine assistace, you can halt time itself. Freeze 1 ROUND of time per POWER cast. This ROUND can be frozen while you move freely. Objects and beings canbe altered while time is frozen, and they will resume their temporal flow once released. Oh, the possibilities.

TARGET: TIME ITSELF
DURATION: HOLD 1 ROUND OF TIME/POWER

The most effective way to travel in time is step outside of it. A priest who sees this truth will know the faces of the gods.

IV: ZEKE'S ASCENSION

This spell can only be cast with a 'BURN' option. Once cast, its subject recovers full HP and gains +1 to all STATS until the spell is cast again. In addition, the subject gains a temprary HEART of HP that, once depleted, is no longer part of their maximum HP. This spell releases so much HOLY energy that it sends a vertical shaft of light from the subject that can be seen for a mile.

TARGET: SINGLE ALLY TOUCH or SELF
DURATION: INSTANT

Zeke was a cantankerous but altruistic wizard with an odd sense of humor. As keeper of the Tessaract Dagger, he discovered the deepest secrets of magic, but always returned to one central truth: there is no power in the multiverse greater than friendship, so to his allies the true essence of his skill was devoted.

1: ANY GHOST MOUNTAIN INFERNAL SPELL

Choose any spell from the Ghost Mountain INFERNAL list (see page 238). Work with your GM to determine effects of casting this spell at higher POWER. Your GM may deem this option off limits.

1: ANIMATE DEAD

You cause rotted lungs to gasp, skeletal limbs to move. Turn 1 lifeless body into an automaton under your control per POWER. They act on your turn. They are very slow, have 1 HP, and do not eat, breathe, or bleed. The skeletons crumble to grave dust at dawn's light.

TARGET: 1 CORPSE/POWER
DURATION: INSTANT

The only limit to a necromancer's army is the number of bodies lying around, and the ability to pay the cost in blood.

1: BAT

You and your gear transform into a bat. You can fly, navigate in total darkness, and have 1 HP. If you go to zero HP, you transform back into your original shape with your former HP total. You can also revert to normal form at will.

DURATION: UNTIL 0 HP OR REVERT AT WILL
TARGET: SELF

Some sorcerers begin to prefer the shape of a bat and adopt odd nocturnal mannerisms in human form. They eat hanging upside down, prefer a nocturnal life, or even take to drinking blood. Even worse, some simply remain bats forever.

I; BIND WITH FIRE

Fiery bindings appear, restraining and tormenting your foe. The target can't move and takes 1D8 MAGIC per POWER. If the target is from another dimension, it takes ULTIMATE damage instead, unless hailing from PYROS.

TARGET: SINGLE NEAR
DURATION: 1D4 ROUNDS

The fool who binds Flame Kin in such a way will find himself not only mocked, but marked for a smoldering death.

I; BLOODMIST

By conjuring an explosive cloud of corrosive gas, you sap the lifeblood from one creature and give it to another. One target takes 1D8 MAGIC per POWER, and another target within NEAR of it, also enveloped by the cloud, heals that amount.

TARGET: SINGLE NEAR
DURATION: INSTANT

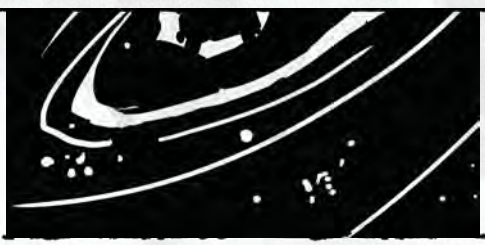
When the red cloud cleared, the mighty and the feeble had traded places. I only saw those glowing, laughing eyes through the clearing mist.

I; WITHER

You extract the lifeblood of a creature, as long as it HAS blood, weakening it terribly. Delete 1 STAT point on your victim per POWER cast. These points can be healed by any normal means of healing, subbing a STAT heal for an HP heal.

TARGET: SINGLE FAR
DURATION: PERMANENT UNTIL HEALED

It is a cruel thing to reduce your foes to hobbling shells, rather than simply kill them.



INFERNAL SPELLS

1: MELT

Vicious waves of heat melt non-living solids. Liquify 100 pounds of mass per POWER. That liquid emits searing heat at NEAR range for 1D4 ROUNDS, then cools into its solid form once again.

TARGET: SINGLE NEAR
DURATION: INSTANT

Fire dwarves use this magic to tunnel networks deep in the heart of simmering volcanoes, or fill casts with liquid mithril.

1: MOLOK'S MUTATION

With volatile, sloppy magic, you curse a creature with horrible deformity. The target must pass a CON save each ROUND or acquire a hideous mutation. The results are permanent. If your spellcasting roll is any odd number, you must also roll a mercurial effect for yourself.

TARGET: SINGLE TOUCH
DURATION: 1 ROUND/POWER

Wizards learning to warp flesh are often their own test subjects. Not even the darkest hood or cloak can hide their myriad eyes and insectoid skin.

1: PLAGUE OF DOUBTS

Those afflicted by this curse can't differentiate between illusion and reality. They see their worst fears in ordinary objects, and terrible deformity in old friends. Any roll the target makes is HARD, and any roll against the target is EASY.

TARGET: SINGLE NEAR
DURATION: 1D4 TURNS/POWER

The crone relished doubt, fear, and pain. She granted boons to those with a talent for inflicting all three.

I: ZEKE'S IMMOLATION

Use your own body as an incendiary weapon, surrounding yourself in blazing fire. CLOSE enemies take MAGICAL damage. Any beinsg still CLOSE to you on the GM's TURN also take 1D6 Ambient Heat damage. Ignites all flammables, terrifies villagers.

TARGET: SELF
DURATION: 1 ROUND/POWER

Zeke was a reckless, violent wizard that could not be contained. His love of fire earned him a place in the Pyros elite.

II: BIND SOUL

Mark a creature with your arcane touch. When this creature dies, their immortal soul becomes yours. It can be used as a RARE INGREDIENT, a bartar with the devil, or be expended to cast any SOUL magic at no COST.

TARGET: SINGLE TOUCH
DURATION: PERMANENT UPON TARGET DEATH

Cold and merciless are those who deal in immortal souls. They take from us more than life, they rob us of cosmic absolution.

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II: BURNING ARROWS

Condense the essence of an open flame into arrowheads. These arrows now do MAGIC, and ignite any flammables. They glow in the quiver, last until used.

TARGET: 1D8 ARROWS/POWER
DURATION: UNTIL FIRED

Merra loosed her barrage, firing arrow after arrow in a glowing blur. When it was over, the behemoth fell to ruin, and we were among a true master.

II: DRIVEN

Boil the blood of your subjects. The target will ravenously attack its current task, disregarding all risk or harm, to the task's completion. They are frantic with it, making INT, WIS and CHA rolls HARD, but making STR, CON and DEX rolls EASY.

TARGET: ANY NEAR
DURATION: 1 CREATURE, 1 ROUND/POWER

The minions of the blood drinkers attack with reckless fury, skewering themselves to obey their dark masters.

II: FLAME BLADE

Choose a melee weapon you can see. Call upon the dimension of Pyros, and bathe the weapon in fire. The weapon now inflicts MAGIC, burns its victims for an additional 1D6 on the next ROUND, and ignites flammables.

TARGET: SINGLE EYESIGHT
DURATION: 1 ROUND/POWER

I lifted Owlbane above me, and Anaxamon sheathed the blade in fire. The goblins fled. The goblins died.

II: GARLAND'S SPHERE

Conjure a lightless hovering sphere, 6 feet in diameter. The sphere can be sent in a straight line, up to FAR, or stay still. Unless all those NEAR it, besides you, make a DEX roll, they are engulfed in a field of anti-magic corrosion. This corrosion saps the magic properties from ALL magic equipment.

TARGET: PROPEL TO FAR/NEAR RADIUS
DURATION: 1 ROUND/POWER

It drifted past us, silent and black as pitch, but swirling and alive with malice. Burning swords were snuffed, relics were made into junk. Damn you, Garland.

I: GLYPH OF FIRE

Etch a glowing amber rune on any surface. Speak a command or condition to this glyph. When those conditions or commands are met, the rune explodes with a plume of flames. It will inflict 1D12 ULTIMATE fire damage per POWER on anything NEAR it.

TARGET: TOUCH
DURATION: PERMANENT

At each doorway, Orvald would etch his little rune. We thought nothing of it. Then all hell's fire was unleashed on our pursuers.

II: INCANTATION OF FEAR

This slow-acting SPELL overcomes its victims with crippling terror. As magic goes, it is an oddity because it creates fear in a location rather than a creature. Place the curse. In 1 ROUND, a NEAR radius area to that spot is filled with racking, hideous fear. Anything entering that area will use its next maximum MOVE to flee.

TARGET: TOUCH/NEAR RADIUS
DURATION: D6 ROUNDS/POWER

The goblins scattered like rats, screaming and screeching, dropping their ragged weapons. We were all baffled, until we saw that sick grin on Zeke's face.

INFERNAL SPELLS

II: POSSESSION

Call upon a lesser demonic spirit, devoid of a body, and place it in your victim's inner mind. This cruel SPELL must not be used lightly, as it can be impossible or fatal to remove the demon from the host via EXORCISM. Attempts to cleanse it must be equal or higher POWER. The effects of possession vary too widely to list here.

TARGET: SINGLE NEAR
DURATION: PERMANENT (UNTIL EXORCISED)

Our holy ritual failed, she spat blood and broke her bonds. We had unleashed something truly terrible on the world that night.

II: SHADOW FORM

Take the form of a smoke-like shadow, able to slide through the air, through tiny cracks, or on walls and ceilings. The shadow is only inhibited by airtight spaces and direct sunlight. Attacks against you are HARD and you become hidden with no rolls.

TARGET: SELF
DURATION: 1D4 ROUNDS/POWER

Stealth is an essential component to the devilish work of assassins and saboteurs. Thus so many of their ranks join with demonic forces.

II: SKULL

Collect, study, and hex the skull of a creature with a SPELL. You must use 1 POWER per creature's MAX HEARTS to hex such a skull. As long as the skull is with you, rolls made regarding that type of creature are EASY. When damaging that type, add another of whatever damage die is in use.

TARGET: SINGLE DECEASED/TOUCH
DURATION: PERMANENT

The skull wizards of Skar carry great belts and necklaces of grim trophies. To steal or destroy these objects invites their wrath as a people.

II: SUMMONING CIRCLE

Draw a glyphic circle on any surface, then speak the name of a creature or monster you have seen. 1 of those appears, per POWER, in 1D4 ROUNDS. The only monster immune to this summons is a LEY WALKER.

TARGET: TOUCH
DURATION: VANISHES AFTER SUMMON

Gods above, the fool summoned four swarms of Imps! Madness!

III: FLAME VORTEX

Create a whirling tornado of pure fire. The vortex is 30 feet in height, and slides randomly around an area, burning anything it touches with MAGICAL heat, 1D8 per POWER cast. It can only be dissipated by a gale of wind, rain, or the absence of air.

TARGET: MOVES RANDOMLY
DURATION: CONCENTRATION

We were fleeing Olfan's hideous library, and the coiling devil of fire kept whirling, burning books and shelves in a spinning hell of fire and ash.

INFERNAL SPELLS

III: KILL UNSEEN

Focus your will on a creature you have touched, and whisper its name. The creature will drop to 0 HP in 1D4 ROUNDS, no matter its location. Kill 1 HEART per POWER cast.

TARGET: ANY KNOWN AND TOUCHED, SINGLE
DURATION: 1 HEART/POWER

The most devious assassin is the one reclining in his sanctum, a hundred leagues away, closing his magical hand 'round his victim's heart.

III: LEARN BY BLOOD

Spare a drop of your blood, and etch new SPELLS into your very soul. When creating a SPELL, roll this instead of conventional SPELL CREATION rolls. Do 1D12 creation EFFORT per POWER cast.

TARGET: SPELL BEING CREATED
DURATION: INSTANT

Garland was a pale, emaciated skeleton of a man. He had given blood to learn many secrets, and never fully recovered from his studies.

III: MAGIC BANE

A forbidden ritual allows you to scratch a malevolent rune in any surface. This rune cancels all magic in a FAR radius until it is destroyed or erased. Devious wizards are known to hide it in key areas of their labyrinths.

TARGET: FAR RADIUS
DURATION: PERMANENT/UNTIL ERASED

Some dwarven warriors of Iradrum have this symbol etched into their helmets by a war mage. Their very presence in battle could break an army's magical defenses.

III: SCYTHE

A reaper's weapon. Materialize a bladed weapon of pure darkness. Any creature hit with a STR attack using this dark blade drops to 0 HP instantly. That target also rolls CON or loses 1D6 STAT points. If it misses, it dissipates instantly.

TARGET: ANY MELEE
DURATION: 1D4 ROUNDS/POWER

The greed to kill with this evil blade consumed our warrior. He became more reaper than man and we feared him in those tunnels.

III: SOUND OF SILENCE

Close your eyes, hear all that surrounds you, and with magical force, bring it all to a flawless silence. This SPELL suppresses ALL sound in an area surrounding you, 1 range category per POWER (1=CLOSE, 2=NEAR, 3=FAR, 4=EYESIGHT). Since so many SPELLS also use words of power, they are suppressed as well.

TARGET: RANGE PER POWER
DURATION: CONCENTRATION

War mages would march in chevron formations, casting silence and counter SPELL magic in waves. Their enemies were deafened and utterly defenseless.

III: TRANSFUSION

Your power over living plasma lets you draw blood from a living creature and transfer it to another. Both subjects must be above 0 HP and NEAR each other. The donor feels terrible pain, and absorbs MAGICAL damage, 1D8 per POWER, that cannot be resisted. The receiver heals for the *twice* the amount.

TARGET: TWO EYESIGHT/BOTH NEAR EACH OTHER
DURATION: INSTANT

The blood pulled through his pores, out his eyes, and 'tween the rings of his chain shirt. It was a hideous thing to behold.

IV: DEATH

Rob a target you can see of its blood, instantly killing it. Drop 1 HEART to 0 HP with each POWER cast. If this SPELL is cast on a creature with 0 HP, they are killed utterly, leaving only a colorless dessicated shell.

TARGET: SINGLE EYESIGHT
DURATION: INSTANT

Those who employ the Death SPELL darken, grow pale, and learn to hate the wholesome light of day.

IV: FIRE WONDER

Choose a living creature you can see. Immolate that creature with magical fire, transforming it into a juggernaut of flame. It becomes a horned beast, covered in fire, with 1 HEART per POWER cast. The beast has +2 to rolls per POWER, and is 6 feet high per POWER. Fire Wonders cannot speak.

TARGET: SINGLE EYESIGHT
DURATION: 1 ROUND/POWER

To enter Pyros in the form of a Fire Wonder makes the condition truly permanent. This is a tormented, burning existence with no end. Terrible.

IV: HORNS

Imbue a creature with pure INFERNAL power, initiating a transformation of demonic strength. The subject sprouts curling horns at first, then over the course of 1D20 days will gain red skin, a spiked tail, black claws, and glowing eyes. They will also be accompanied by a smell of brimstone, and gain +3 to any 3 STATS, an extra HEART, and usage of FIRE MISSILE and RAY OF SOULS.

TARGET: SINGLE TOUCH/POWER
DURATION: PERMANENT AFTER 1D20 DAYS

The boy was half-mad with grief and rage. He begged Olfan to give him the power to avenge his slain lover, at any cost. What Olfan gave that poor boy was pure devilish might. The dead could not easily be counted.

IV: FORGE

Use magic to forge metal weapons and objects with no anvil or hammer. Simply create the implement from a refined metal ingot of any type or quality. The item has +1 to any STAT per POWER. For each +1 placed into an item or weapon, the caster must wait that many days for their hands to cool.

TARGET: METAL INGOT
DURATION: PERMANENT/CREATED WEAPON CANNOT BE DESTROYED

Olfan was famous for making 'Death Blades' for his warriors: swords that could kill an enemy with a single stroke.

IV: VAMPIRE

This SPELL can only be cast at POWER 4. With a cast, convert one living or dead creature you can see into a vampire. Learning this SPELL curses you with vampiricism. This is a permanent condition, with all the details and trappings of the vampire myth and all its forms.

TARGET: SELF OR SINGLE BITE
DURATION: PERMANENT

Most believe that Dragool was the first vampire, but there are far older monsters in the darkest places, and they carry a hideous gift.

THE PATH IS NOT CRAFTED JUST FOR US

IT IS OF ITS OWN DESIGN

THE DICE ARE AMBIVALENT GODS

THIS YOU CAN TRUST

Trusting the dice is a central element of any exciting RPG session. The dice represent the world as it is BEYOND player and GM intention. They represent randomness despite desire, challenge despite fatigue, delight in surprise!

Using dice to select monsters, terrain, hero aspects, and especially LOOT not only creates a unique set of details for your game, but reminds players that they stand against a world outside themselves. The game is not simply a bespoke 'ride' crafted for their amusement. Here are the TABLES to get you started.

LOCATIONS

D20 ALFHEIM LOCATIONS

1: A grassy plain of rolling hills and rivers, rising to barely-visible mountains in the distance
2: Ageless grey stone ruins, punctuated by standing pillars and strange round gateways
3: A field of erratic, massive boulders at the foot of a flat-topped granite crag
4: The blasphemous, forgotten halls of a serpent-made underground labyrinth
5: Windswept dunes above a crashing shore, broken only by the masts of mist-hidden shipwrecks
6: Deep drifts and hard packed snow on a high, rocky ledge
7: Narrow, colossal canyons cut with oversized doorways and hidden grottoes
8: A forgotten, soggy, sagging dock at the dark-watered shore
9: High-arched sea caves below the towers and streets of castle city-state
10: A thatched village surrounding a rocky river
11: Among the towering buttresses and arches of an abandoned abbey high in the mountains
12: A valley of dense-packed foliage and underbrush, all choked in white-flowered vines
13: The primordial curved sandstone of wind-hewn rock formations in sweltering heat
14: 'Tween the scattered round huts of a nomadic traders' guild
15: At the feet of towering humanoid statues, their features scoured away by ages
16: A plateau of tusk-braced long halls and spiked barricades...the work of Hill men
17: On a precipice of ragged igneous rock above a river of gooey orange magma flowing in a river of death
18: Among the silent, ghostly doorways of a long dead town
19: In the tangled, baffling hustle of a port city...buffeted by merchants, drunks, and wenches
20: At the black-walled immensity of some evil fortress, far above the clouds and peaks

D20 WARP SHELL LOCATIONS

1: Among the many-armed colossi of a vine-wrapped Zurin temple
2: A cloud of vapor and breathable gas in space, punctuated by floating trees and globs of water
3: The massive hallways and bulkheads of a derelict space hulk
4: The crater-scarred vacuum of a planet-fragment, skewered with huge metal girders and twisted wreckage
5: The gold-domed utopia of a megacity, hovering above the clouds on silent grav engines
6: In a sea of glowing gas and proto-stars, far beyond the gleam of the nearest visible sun
7: An expanse of mind-crushing nothingness between the galaxies
8: The bridge of a barely functional freighter ship
9: A dizzying chamber housing the rune-scribed hyperdrive of some long-lost race
10: An endless vertical tube lined with weird fluid-filled gelatinous pods
11: The innards of a planet-sized computer
12: Splintering canyons and crumbling peaks on a seismic ice moon
13: The immense, brass-winged balustrades of an Imperium Doom Hall
14: A bizarre, inverted, twisted alien husk tumbling through deep space in a cloud of red dust
15: A hive-carved mountain range of nests and tunnels
16: The endless thunderstorms in the upper atmosphere of an ocean giant
17: A molten hellscape of liquid stone at the center of a dense gas megaplanet
18: On the seething spiral-etched surface of the Devourer itself
19: In the featureless stone tunnel-ways of a Xevosian undershrine
20: Among the massive heads and effigies of a basalt necropolis in the eerie light of a shatterstar

D20 ALFHEIM OBSTACLES

1: A rickety, rotted old bridge over a swampy mire...weird, carnivorous vines stir in the muck
2: A huge, fortified wall of stone and spikes from some long lost war
3: Three ravenous Ogres, out hunting for meat, treasure, or something to torture
4: A ragtag bunch of Gerblin road-tollers and their poorly made barricade
5: Krod the Butcher! You killed his cousin, and he wants payback. You didn't kill his cousin?
6: A sequence of devious floor traps, dart launchers, poison gas, and bladed pendula
7: A crazed Brain Horror and its legion of mutated Bog folk
8: A rune-locked door of the ancients, ever watched by the ghosts of their faithful
9: An impossible climb down, and over, and through
10: The endless bombardments of siege engines and fire-hurlers
11: The endless fury of Durax, the spawn of Hydranax, a Black Drake
12: An army of skeletal warriors marching forever in search of futile revenge
13:The trampling madness of the Agnar riders and their shamanic Chief
14: An endless, tangled dark of dead trees and scorched thorn bushes
15: A roving pack of Shadow Lashers, driven wild by some unseen plague or sickness
16: A smoke-choked mass of spinning spikes and toothed cogs, all churning with power
17: A pitch black chamber orbited by Slime Cubes and the animated remains of their prisoners
18: A vast, open chasm of swirling mist and howling voices
19: The crushing path of destruction wrought by a Behemoth from outer space
20: An entire tribe of Flaming Skulls, gathered by some black spell or horrid rite

D20 WARP SHELL OBSTACLES

1: The countless legion of three-eyed Imperium automatons
2: A squad of augmented, undead Imperium Raiders in full power armor
3: A spinning oak: a gravity-defying radial tree the size of a small moon, hovering impossibly in your path
4: The misguided rage of a malfunctioning War Bot, built to incredible size with salvaged weapons
5: A space-faring Gargoleth, hybridized with a star drive and weapon systems
6: A high-power energy field, preserved by a four-piece, rune-encrypted crystal lock
7: The explosive waves of hellfire emitted from a dying star
8: A hive of Bore Worms, driven to murderous aggression by a devilish, disembodied Brain
9: Space Cannibals! The monsters have a Ravager galleon and mean to make dinner of you all!
10: A highly trained unit of Reptoid Assassins employing outlawed stealth tech
11: A mote of the dead...one vast, twisting river of corpses coiling through low gravity
12: Sabotage! Xill drill bombs tear the place to shreds, blocking your way
13: A shapeless, faceless automated sentinel from a lost epoch
14: The seemingly invincible, ever-changing mind powers of a spoiled boy prince
15: The indomitable advance of a planet-eater
16: A series of unexplained malfunctions and systems failures wreaking havoc
17: The suicidal members of a cult whose aim is to summon the Devourer
18: A drug crazed lunatic called Krome, rampaging in a supermodified Imperium Fighter
19: The swarming hellions of a sun scorched world, who navigate only by sound
20: A baffling series of dimension doorways, becoming more unstable by the moment

GOALS

D20 ALFHEIM GOALS

1: Escape the relentless pursuit of the Red Mage, who made you this way in the Grey Hill fire
2: Destroy the eldritch green gem that drives the Ape men mad with frenzy
3: Send the Serpent-Lich, Vexx, back to his dusty tomb before he reaches full power
4: Deliver the Royal Decree of King Henryk to the ship builders of Gilhelm
5: Rescue Princess Arana
6: Cripple the Khettish siege force before they reach their fortifications
7: Purify the tomb of Lion Sword with a bolt of elusive red lightning
8: Recover the most legendary weapon in Alfheim: Angrid, the Lawgiver
9: Solve the gloomy curse on Gwadan's folk, putting their ghosts to rest at last
10: Kill the abomination called Agolath, a hybrid monstrosity of the under realm
11: Follow the shaman's map to the treasure of Count Undin, and earn a king's fortune!
12: Garfest! Make it to the Khyber peaks before Garfest ends in a ruckus of foam and laughter
13: Earn a place in the ranks of the Iron Knights by passing their infamous trials
14: Seal the magic gate that holds the Black Castle imprisoned, before Azael's hordes can escape
15: Heal the temporal rift slowly destroying the Primordius
16: Reset the cosmic clock on Aphos before the entire island sinks into the abyss
17: Dare the depths of Daggun's grave, and seal that watery tomb forever
18: Assassins! Eliminate Kirash the Knife and his mock-court of thugs and murderers
19: Realign the glow-stones of Duros, and end the tremors that threaten the under mountain
20: Set sky sails for the Maelstrom Watch, and aid the monks in their ritual before the storm tears reality apart

D20 WARP SHELL GOALS

1: Stop, strip, and salvage an Imperium Broadsword-class cruiser
2: Survive a crash landing on a Xill planet fragment
3: Repair a damaged power station on the Psyker frontier
4: Set massive terraformers in motion on a remote Primal world before it tears itself apart
5: Lizards! Find a way to halt a Reptoid invasion fleet before it gains any more momentum
6: Retrieve the plans to a Psyker doomsday weapon that utilizes mind control
7: Explore an uncharted sector of space for clues to stop the Devourer
8: Locate and return a missing Zurin freighter carrying an experimental hyperdrive
9: Eliminate Hal Dagger and his gang of space junkies before they kill the Yrin Emperor's daughter
10: Find a way off a primitive backwater planet
11: Attune to the largest YOG crystal fragment ever found
12: Slay a gargantuan Bugbeast and claim mining rights on the corpse
13: Track a mysterious transmission claiming the Imperium is gathering to full strength
14: Fulfill a lucrative contract to bring in the Xill pirate Skall Grick...dead or alive
15: Transport a cluster of occupied hypersleep pods to a classified destination, but do NOT wake them up
16: Gather scientific data on an imploding star in a remote corner of space, beyond any comms
17: Travel back in time to find clues on the Devourer's origin
18: Wage a risky mining op to retrieve a droplet of dark matter from a dead star
19: Find Waylan Diggs before the Imperium does
20: Stage the most daring heist in centuries: stealing the Imperial signet from the Emperor himself

HERO ORIGINS

D20 ALFHEIM HERO ORIGINS

1: A ragtag band of merry adventurers suddenly mistaken for mighty heroes
2: Anointed dragonslayers bound by a sacred oath
3: Hapless captives of some unseen mastermind, plunged into a fight for survival
4: An elite squad of Iron Knights tasked with sealing the under realm forever
5: Immortal heroes fallen from the Iron Heart to aid Alfheim against the rising serpent empire
6: Anonymous do-gooders set to make right the grim life of the poor
7: Farmers and goat-herds who alone survive to avenge their village
8: The crew of a black-sailed pirate ship, set to plunder and wench their way around the globe
9: A team of combat-ready mushroom-men (Mykonoids) sent to make allies on the surface before their realm is destroyed
10: Strangers brought together by a mysterious runic birthmark that glows with weird power
11: Wizard's apprentices yanked from their studies by a cosmic cataclysm
12: A band of bloodthirsty raiders and reavers who demand their piece of the world
13: Youngsters who have come of age and are sent into the wilderness to prove their strength
14: All that remain of a doomed army in a hostile land, just trying to get home
15: Haggard, washed up warriors posted on a remote frontier
16: The greatest trophy hunters in Alfheim, assembled for the greatest hunt of their lives
17: A Goblin journey-band, wandering the wide world for thrills and glory
18: The last of the Priesthood of Rel, searching for the site of their monastery fortress
19: Dimension-travelers from the outer rings, searching the multiverse for Milo Underbottom
20: A family of dragon-touched mutants fleeing the hatred of all folk

D20 WARP SHELL HERO ORIGINS

1: A cash-strapped band of hard boiled mercs looking for work
2: Xevosian chosen ones ceremonially bound to a WARP SHELL and blipped into the unknown
3: A Zurin master and his entourage of aspirants and good friends
4: An elite scientific research team and their somewhat psycho security detail
5: Fugitive junkers scavenging the spaceways for high end salvage
6: A cadre of Xill defectors and the freedom fighters hiding them
7: A crack military commando unit that has been to hell and back
8: A family of lost spacers cast way off course by a hyperdrive malfunction
9: Cloned super soldiers searching for their mysterious origin
10: Slaves held by the Reptoids, planning a daring escape
11: Ragtag rebels set to infiltrate and destroy whatever remains of the Imperium
12: A weird group of souls drawn inexorably to the crystal hum of YOG fragments
13: Clueless hypersleep passengers awoken by a massive ship malfunction
14: Ages-old primitive warriors preserved for some devious scheme, now awakened
15: A group of survivors from a doomed future, returned to undo their fate
16: Mechanical beings bound together on a search for their maker
17: Psyker gene splicers probing the cosmos for new species to tinker with
18: Imperium terror troops with orders to decimate the free systems
19: An enclave of Zurin monks, sent on a mission of peace to a war-torn galaxy
20: The crew of the last known WARP SHELL still in space, desperately seeking answers to stop the Devourer

HERO ESSENTIALS

D20 ALFHEIM HERO

1: **Elf Archer:** The essence of Elven tradition: deadly, precise. Build for DEX and MAGIC
2: **Dwarf Guardian:** Toughest metal-clad fighters in Alfheim. Build for CON and DEFENSE
3: **Small Folk Thief:** Fast, invisible footpads and cat burglars at their best. Build for DEX and BASIC EFFORT
4: **Human Fighter:** A versatile fighter with the heart of a lion. Build for WEAPON DAMAGE and STR
5: **Hill Folk Hero:** Walls of muscle, with a love of nature. Build for HP and BASIC EFFORT
6: **Elf Assassin:** The merciless dagger of our time. Build for DEX and WEAPON DAMAGE
7: **Dwarf Soldier:** Stout hammer-wielders who stand firm. Build for WEAPON DAMAGE and CON
8: **Small Folk Archer:** Where did that arrow come from? There! In the trees! Build for DEX and WIS
9: **Human Wizard:** Scholars and sages drawn to arcane knowledge. Build for INT and MAGIC
10: **Hill Folk Scout:** A bear-like, wolfish, or even elken creature. Build for WIS and BASIC EFFORT
11: **Elf Mage:** Elder beings with dark secrets and darker hearts. Build for INT and ULTIMATE
12: **Dwarf Commander:** No warrior holds so firm to valor. Build for CHA and DEFENSE
13: **Small Folk Priest:** A wee faithful one but large of soul. Build for WIS and MAGIC
14: **Human Leader:** Strategic, shrewd, and proven in war. Build for CHA and WEAPON EFFORT
15: **Hill Folk Priest:** Gentle giants who use the power of trees and stones. Build for WIS and STR
16: **Elf Scout:** Swift-footed acrobats. Build for DEX and WIS
17: **Dwarf Outsider:** The grey Dwarves are hard as iron. Build for DEFENSE and BASIC EFFORT
18: **Small Folk Scout:** Here is a fleet, stealthy runner. Build for DEX and WEAPON EFFORT
19: **Human Archer:** A rapid firing death machine. Build for DEX and ULTIMATE
20: **Hill Folk Nomad:** Beasts! Cave men! Good friends. Build for CON and BASIC EFFORT

D20 ALFHEIM HERO STORY

1: Born in war, bound by blood, sworn to revenge
2: Last of the Aphosian discus masters and chosen envoy of those folk
3: A refugee of Ynsmuth's atrocities but still touched by the Deep One
4: Once a Khettish slave, now an under spoken avenger
5: Born in Dur Olo and as cold-blooded as a giant squid
6: The last son of a decimated house North of Gwadan, where Bore Worms have taken the land
7: Haunted by a kind of introspective madness but driven by a cruel oath
8: On a desperate, never-ending search for family and kin, uncovering dark secrets
9: An outlander of the high steppes, wandered down to see what all the fuss is about
10: A troubled trapper, waylayed from the trade routes by intrigue and death
11: Trained at sea but marooned on Xenos for years, where the madness came
12: A child of Iridess, haunted by the skinless ghosts of that hell
13: Proud stone worker on the wall of Duros Tem
14: Soot-covered delver of the Unalaya mines and loyal to The Hawk
15: One of the Ire ape-killers, now fed up with Norburg politics
16: A Kathic outlander, driven from ancestral jungle by the temples of Ogdru
17: Last of a race of child soldiers of Ardenmoor, eager to cleanse that tarnished name
18: Pupil of the Gilhelm ship makers, with wide eyes on a wider world
19: A greedy pauper looking to sucker the far-lookers for coin
20: A retired General seeking some few moments of peace before the end

D20 ALFHEIM HERO GEAR

1: **Soldier**: Short Sword, Common Shield, Armor Kit, Supplies, Common armor
2: **Dabbler**: Book of Secrets, Staff, Dagger, Fire Stone, Spyglass
3: **Nomad**: Longbow, Common Armor, Supplies, Trapper's Gear, Dagger, Staff, Weapon Kit
4: **Siege**: Long Spear, Crossbow, Weapon Kit, Common Shield, Rope & Hook
5: **Caster**: Dagger, Spell Book, Tools (scrivener), Spyglass, Book of Secrets
6: **Hunter**: Long bow, Spear, Knife, Trapper's Gear, Common Armor, Supplies, Trusty Mug
7: **War Arrow:** Long bow, Magic Ammo, Long sword, Supplies, Common Armor, Tools (fletcher)
8: **Crusher**: Battle axe, Spear, Common Shield, Common Armor, Ring of Might, Pouch of Coin
9: **Outcast**: Meditation Beads, Walking stick
10: **Thief**: Greedy Gloves, Rope and Hook, Dagger, Short Bow, Tools (locksmith), Common Armor
11: **Miner**: War Pick, Throwing Axe, Common Shield, Common Armor, Miner's Gear, Berserk Ring
12: **Mender:** Staff, Dagger, Meditation Beads, Tools (medic), Instrument (lute)
13: **Wizard:** Long sword, Fire Stone, Spell Book, Supplies, Tools (navigator)
14: **Warrior:** Long sword, Short sword, Battle axe, Common Shield, Common Armor, Ring of Might
15: **Marksman:** Crossbow, Long bow, Sling, Masterful Boots, Rope and Hook, Magic Ammo
16: **Lunatic:** Club, Masterful Coats, Spell Book, Instrument (flute), Miner's Gear
17: **Wanderer:** No weapons, Berserk Ring, Supplies
18: **Duelist:** Rapier, Weapon Kit, 50 Coin, Tools (weaponsmith), Common Armor
19: **Prisoner:** No gear
20: **Highborn:** Ring of Might, Firestone, Enchanted Long sword, Spell Book, Masterful Coats

D20 ALFHEIM HERO QUOTE

1: "By my life, if it be possible, you WILL survive."
2: "This is my fight. I'll not be denied my red day."
3: "So this is all the villain can conjure? Ha! Then let's be done with it!"
4: "They call these monsters? Play things!"
5: "Off to the castle! Eh? We're going underground? Off to the dungeon!"
6: "A sword is more than a weapon. It is an extension of your will."
7: "A true dwarf always drains his mug and never drops his shield!"
8: "You'd do well to step back, stranger, if you value your life."
9: "We're doomed!"
10: "50 coins and a dead man's chest, yo ho ho and a bottle of rum!"
11: "If we fail, Alfheim will fail. I cannot let that happen."
12: "Sure, I'll go on your damned crusade, but I want payment UP FRONT."
13: "Goblins? No! Water? Like a bridge? Vines?! No! We'll never make it!"
14: "I've had a vision. The Gods themselves summon us."
15: "Beyond time, there is a space of pure magical power. From there I have come."
16: "The Iron Heart glows hotter than ever, to the doom of all. To battle."
17: "Ahh, the warm glow of a sunset, cool golden gar, and the company of friends. Huzzah!"
18: "My kind and yours have ever been enemies. No more."
19: "I am the last of my folk."
20: "Which way to the dragon?"

HERO ESSENTIALS

D20 WARP SHELL HERO

1: **Mecha Tank:** Reinforced, bullet-proof, and afraid of nothing. Build for HP and DEFENSE
2: **Reptoid Ronin:** Gadget-clad assassins with few qualms. Build for WEAPON EFFORT and DEX
3: **Ghost Armor Thief:** An emotionless killer hidden in digital cloak. Build for MAGIC EFFORT and WEAPON EFFORT
4: **Geno Gunner:** Classic blaster rifle badass, just trying to survive. Build for DEX and ULTIMATE
5: **Xill Explorer:** A shifting confusion of magic power. Build for INT and MAGIC EFFORT
6: **Mecha Scout:** Some Mecha are built for speed. Build for DEX and WIS
7: **Reptoid Marksman:** Lizards with railguns. Not good. Build for ULTIMATE and WEAPON EFFORT
8: **Ghost Armor Elder:** Gasseous ancient ones. Build for INT and BASIC EFFORT
9: **Geno Titan:** The old blood still makes some men strong. Build for STR and DEFENSE
10: **Xill Outsider:** What...is...that...THING? Build for ULTIMATE and INT
11: **Kitt Priest:** A humble one with access to vistas of truth. Build for WIS and CHA
12: **Reptoid Tank:** More scales than flesh. Build for DEFENSE and WEAPON EFFORT
13: **Kitt Farseeker:** A gadgeteer and time traveler in one. Build for DEX and INT
14: **Geno Merc:** Men can have the blackest hearts.... Build for WEAPON EFFORT and STR
15: **Xill Tank:** A sort of chitin mass. Hard to hit and harder to kill. Build for DEFENSE and INT
16: **Mecha Titan:** The noblest of the mechanical guardians. Build for WIS and DEFENSE
17: **Reptoid Priest:** Quieting the Reptoid mind is no small thing. Build for WIS and MAGIC EFFORT
18: **Geno Wanderer:** Outcast from their own kind. Build for DEX and WEAPON EFFORT
19: **Geno Survivor:** Somehow, they survived the singularity. Build for WIS and ULTIMATE
20: **Xill Priest:** What beauty in ugliness have these scholars! Build for CHA and ULTIMATE

D20 WARP SHELL HERO STORY

1: Raised in the halls of Xevos, bred to attune with a WARP SHELL, trained by the Psyker elite.
2: Found shivering and near death in an Imperium ruin, among a pile of bodies.
3: A mysterious sleep pod made landfall on Yrin Prime. When you woke up, the Zurin were there.
4: Jettisoned by the Xill when their exo planet was devoured.
5: Sworn to cleanse the universe of the Imperium once and for all.
6: Just a duranium miner looking for honest work and a mug of red gar.
7: A member of The Hidden, sent to Bastion to warn them of the Xill incursion.
8: A malfunction in your AI has left you barely operational and alone.
9: An accomplished smuggler, salvager, and fugitive looking for the one big score to retire.
10: One of 10 clones separated at birth, ever drawn to those lost siblings....
11: You were supposed to be a Zurin sage, but your itchy curiosity led you into deep space and high adventure!
12: Most people don't even believe in the Time Benders, but you're that fast. You can do it.
13: Those bastards will pay for their crimes, and you'll lay down the sentence.
14: Curious, the many life forms of this dimension. Be among them, and know.
15: A refugee from a future decimated by The Devourer, sent back with a portent of doom.
16: Just another day in the droid assembly line! No adventures here, just steady employment!
17: Your WARP SHELL was torn to pieces in Phase Sector 471. Next thing you know, you're here...
18: The Archons of Aster have chosen you as their champion. Go, and take a talisman to the stars.
19: Rain. You hate rain. Another damned murder case? Bad pay and worse clients on these jobs.
20: Space! Let's go there and find things! Let's get some flicks and show our buddies back home!

D20 WARP SHELL HERO GEAR

1: **Soldier**: Duranium Sword, Common Shield, Armor Kit, Supplies, Common armor
2: **Dabbler**: Book of Secrets, Machete, Blast Pistol, Fire Stone, Spyglass
3: **Nomad**: Chem Rail, Common Armor, Supplies, Trapper's Gear, Dagger, Duranium Sword, Weapon Kit
4: **Siege**: Arc Spear, Particle Gun, Weapon Kit, Common Shield, Rope & Hook
5: **Caster**: Blast Pistol, Spell Book, Tools (mechanic), Spyglass, Book of Secrets
6: **Hunter**: Energy bow, Blast Rifle, Machete, Trapper's Gear, Common Armor, Supplies
7: **War Arrow:** Energy bow, Magic Ammo, Rip Saw, Supplies, Common Armor, Tools (hacker)
8: **Crusher**: Energy Blade, Blast Sword, Common Shield, Common Armor, Ring of Might
9: **Outcast**: Meditation Beads, Walking stick
10: **Thief**: Greedy Gloves, Rope and Hook, Energy Blade, Gauss Launcher, Tools (locksmith)
11: **Miner**: War Pick, Throwing Axe, Common Armor, Miner's Gear, Berserk Ring
12: **Mender**: Blast Pistol, Dagger, Meditation Beads, Tools (medic), Instrument (spinbow)
13: **Wizard**: Energy Blade, Fire Stone, Spell Book, Supplies, Tools (navigator)
14: **Warrior**: Duranium Great Sword, Blast Rifle, Common Shield, Common Armor, Ring of Might
15: **Marksman**: Chem Rail, Blast Pistol, Gun Blade, Masterful Boots, Rope and Hook, Magic Ammo
16: **Lunatic**: Pipe, Masterful Coats, Spell Book, Instrument (keys), Talking Doll
17: **Wanderer**: No weapons, Berserk Ring, Supplies
18: **Duelist**: Energy Blade, Weapon Kit, 50 Coin, Tools (weaponsmith), Common Armor
19: **Prisoner**: No gear
20: **Highborn**: Ring of Might, Firestone, Enchanted Duranium Sword, Spell Book, Masterful Coats

D20 WARP SHELL HERO QUOTE

1: "We have been chosen by this WARP SHELL. We are one."
2: "Another one bites the dust. Let's move."
3: "There is room for all in the spaceways, even YOU."
4: "I knew I'd find something out here among the stars, but I never imagined this...."
5: "The Imperium has fallen, and I was there to see it done."
6: "Ever have we worked to mend the wounded universe. Now we face one final task."
7: "Are those guns? Those are awesome!"
8: "Now you see me, now you don't. Now, you're dead."
9: "Man the helm and buckle your butts, mates. We're going in."
10: "The only true language in all dimensions is science, and we are the ambassadors of that truth."
11: "Let's just get the pay and get out. No heroics this time!"
12: "The sleeper will awaken!"
13: "I've seen things you men wouldn't believe...."
14: "Nothing beats a piece of steel and a firm grip. All this tech is just a distraction."
15: "Filly skot and borple mead, stars on fire and lizards in twede! Grab ya rope, biggles!"
16: "Those who say much know little."
17: "So, you're the big thing everyone is so afraid of. I'm not impressed."
18: "Stand by me!"
19: "Someday, we'll find it, the supernova connection."
20: "It's all one, man. I've seen it. It's all unified, and it's good."

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**** Alternate entries for each monster are the creation of the GM. The same monster is used, augmented with the **Monster Upgrade** table or GM creativity for greater challenge.*

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**** Alternate entries for each monster are the creation of the GM. The same monster is used, augmented with the **Monster Upgrade** table or GM creativity for greater challenge.*

MONSTER MAKER

D20 MONSTER STATE

1: **Tormented**: Being experimented on or tortured for some awful purpose
2: **Imprisoned**: Chained or caged by its masters to control its fury
3: **Raging**: The thing is already going wild with anger. You make it worse
4: **Augmented**: They've implanted THINGS in this beast...deadly things
5: **Dying**: It's barely alive but still refuses to relent
6: **Swarming**: They are many, and something has them convulsing in a frenzy
7: **Feeding**: This is a very bad time to interrupt it
8: **Dormant**: It slumbers. We should be able to creep by undetected
9: **Cybernetic**: Are those HYDRAULICS?
10: **Rune-Etched**: Some magic has hewn glowing symbols into the beast's flesh
11: **Mutated**: I thought the last one was ugly!
12: **Confused**: This monster is baffled, frantically searching for answers or relief from its vertigo
13: **Hungry**: Default state of all living things
14: **Hiding**: It springs from its hidey hole, pouncing on prey, usually targeting the small or weak
15: **Camouflaged**: They're coming out of the damn walls!
16: **On Fire:** Either by its own power or some freak malfunction, this creature is on fire, igniting all it touches
17: **Dividing**: Some kind of cellular metagenesis...but HOW?
18: **Crashing In**: Boom! The thing breaks through a gate, wall, or door
19: **Changing**: One creature is turning into another and for a time has both sets of abilities
20: **Undead**: Someone already killed it, and some damned fool brought it back

D20 MONSTER MOTIVATION

1: **Feed**: It will seek any edible material at any location
2: **Search for Intruders:** It patrols a fixed area
3: **Lie in Wait**: It will not move until triggered by passers-by
4: **Escape**: It just wants out! It will bash, gnaw, or claw its way to freedom
5: **Find an Object**: No matter where the object goes, it is drawn there
6: **Torture**: Sadistic instincts are not confined to the 'higher life forms' of our world
7: **Baffle**: It toys with its prey, confusing and frightening
8: **Imitate**: This creature can take the form of others and uses its form to separate the foolish
9: **Cripple**: It craves not death but only disables its prey and moves on
10: **Recon**: Far-roaming beasts sent to watch or listen for their masters
11: **Guard**: It will stand its ground in one spot and never waiver
12: **Kill**: One target is on its mind, and it will hunt until slain
13: **Hoard**: It steals things, finds things, and piles them in a dark lair somewhere
14: **Reproduce**: It ignores all concerns besides making more of itself, as fast as possible
15: **Survive**: This creature can be very hard to kill, as it only wants to live another day
16: **Grow**: Driven to spend moments straining and swelling to immense size, even when in peril
17: **Attach**: A parasitic beast whose only concern is latching on to a victim and doing whatever it does next
18: **Play Dead:** A primordial tactic, yet still effective
19: **Hibernate**: This tired creature seeks a private, quiet, safe place. Things in its way be warned
20: **Nest**: The beast is creating a home and has the upper hand there in all regards

MONSTER MAKER

D20 MONSTER ABILITIES

1: **Grappler**: Tentacles, hooks, and grubby fingers. Victims use STR checks to avoid or break free
2: **Tactical**: How can it cut the power? It's an animal! Create and/or destroy terrain to move
3: **Metal Eater**: My blast rifle is toast! Any damage done beyond 7 destroys one piece of GEAR
4: **Tough**: Thud. Cannot be harmed with blunt weapons
5: **Toxic**: Venomous. Injured heroes continue taking 1D4 each round until making a CON check
6: **Smart**: It's looking right at me! Creature makes EASY WIS checks to spot party weakness
7: **Terrifying**: What in blazes? Any hero at CLOSE range must check with CHA or flee for their turn
8: **Wild**: Run! Monster darts about at random, using rolls to choose what to do, and where
9: **Fast**: Look out! Move FAR as if NEAR. If you roll this ability twice, add phasic speed
10: **One Weakness:** Roll 1D6: 1: Silver, 2: Magic, 3: Fire, 4: Ice, 5: Missiles, 6: Melee
11: **Volatile**: Don't stab it! When killed, explodes, doing ULTIMATE to all within NEAR range
12: **Confusing**: Where'd it go? Attackers must roll WIS checks to spot its actual location
13: **Devour**: It ate Carl! If a hero takes 10+ damage, they are engulfed by the thing
14: **Spawner**: Oh God, they're hatching. Spawn 1D4 parasitic 'mooks' per round
15: **Firestarter**: Don't stand in the fire! Monster leaves areas of flame behind wherever it attacks
16: **Hellion**: Back to the pit! Monster always targets the holy or innocent but subject to holy rites
17: **Fort**: Shoot at that wall of junk! It will gather local materials to hide itself/deflect missiles
18: **Pursuit**: Flee! If heroes flee, it will pursue to the death
19: **Stalker**: They're in the damn ceiling! It will wait patiently for an opportune moment to strike
20: **Two Abilities:** Roll Another Ability

D20 MONSTER UPGRADE

1: **Hearts**: This thing is beefy! Add 1D4 HEARTS, or add 1 HEART per PC party member
2: **Stat Rolls:** Adapting! Add 1D8 to ALL ROLLS, or add 1D12 to one STAT and 1D6 to all other rolls
3: **Weapon Damage:** Razor sharp, barbed, and toothy. Add 1D6, throwing out a 1
4: **Magic Effect:** Glowing with some arcane hex. Add 1D6, throwing out a 1
5: **Ultimate**: When it locks on, it crushes bones and steel alike. Add 1D6, throwing out a 1
6: **Add Ability:** What will it do next? Roll twice on the ABILITIES table
7: **Devious Intelligence:** We're being watched. It will retreat, use line of sight, or utilize ROOM TREATS to win
8: **Legion**: Gods! There are more! There are 1D6 of them, throw out a 1
9: **Alpha**: The leader of the pack. Its WEAPON attacks are MAGICAL
10: **Gigantic**: It's destroying the city! Monster cannot be damaged by human-sized creatures or conventional WEAPONS
11: **Charging**: When it moves, anything in its path makes a DEX check or takes ULTIMATE damage
12: **Rider**: Something is controlling it! Can only be defeated by killing the rider
13: **Armored**: It's tough as iron! Ignore any damage below 5
14: **Illusory**: Where the blazes is the real one! All attacks against it are HARD
15: **Part-Human:** Faces! Faces in the skin! +5 CHA when persuading or beseeching enemies
16: **Metagen**: It just keeps healing. Recover 5 HP per round
17: **Nova**: Take cover! Every 1D4 ROUNDS, it damages all within FAR range, DEX or CON to avoid
18: **Infinite**: There's too many! When one is killed, another appears
19: **Ancient**: What have we done? Roll twice on this table, ignoring a 19 or 20
20: **Nightmare**: A demigod of death. Roll Three times on this table, ignoring a 19 or 20

TABLES

ANCIENT LOOT

1: Moldy Buns: Food, Heal 5 HP but tastes simply awful
2: Levitation: INT Spell, Enchant a target to float up to 6 feet high for 1D4 ROUNDS
3: Identify: INT Spell, Give a target +3 on an INT/Investigate roll, No Attempt needed to cast
4: 10 Magic Arrows: Item, Magical Damage with a bow shot, can be retrieved, broken on crit fail
5: Speedy Snack: Food, Gain a bonus MOVE after your next MOVE
6: Spider Bites: Food, Heal 2D6 HP but you're pretty much eating a bug
7: Feast o' Fingers: Food, Heal all allies 1D8 if they are at CLOSE range
8: Armor of Faith: WIS Spell, Give a target +3 DEFENSE for 1 Turn
9: Silver Sword: Weapon, +1 Effort, Silver properties
10: Spiked Net: Weapon, STR check to escape, Entangled, Move NEAR only and all checks HARD
11: Disguise Kit: Item, Whenever deceiving a stranger Do ULTIMATE effort and EASY checks
12: Mithril Vest: Armor, Subtract 2 from all Weapon Damage done against you
13: Aegis Amulet: Item, Roll 1D8 when dying
14: Iradrum Heart: Food, For 24 hours after eating if you drop to 0 HP instantly recover to 1 HP
15: Ire Bacons: Food, Heal 3D12
16: Fin Boots: Armor, +1 DEFENSE, double effort and range when swimming
17: Red Gar: Food, Heal to full HP, absorb the next attack unharmed
18: Cloak of Shadows: Armor, +1 DEFENSE, roll EASY checks when sneaking
19: Lion Shield: Armor, +2 DEFENSE, Allies that are NEAR also get +2 DEFENSE
20: Demon Helmet: Armor, +1 DEFENSE, +3 CHA when intimidating
21: Healing Touch: WIS Spell, Touch to heal an ally with Magical Effort
22: Healing Nova: WIS Spell, Heal all NEAR allies with double Magical Effort
23: Grapple Vine: WIS Spell, Pull a NEAR monster or ally with you, Opposing STR to resist
24: Lightning Bolt: INT Spell, Burn 1-12 HP, add to a magic blast, double against metal-clad
25: Ice Blast: INT Spell, Inflict magical damage and immobilize target for 1 turn
26: Arcane Bomb: INT Spell, A glowing orb, in 1D4 ROUNDS explodes for 2D12, NEAR range
27: Ragged Battleaxe: Weapon, -2 to Attempts but roll ULTIMATE effort every time
28: Fireball: INT Spell, Blast any targets within NEAR range of a location
29: Claw Boots: Armor, Walk on any surface in any direction without a Check
30: Heart Stone: Item, add 1 Heart to your max
31: Enchanting: WIS Spell, Enchant item to do magical effort and a +1 per Heart of Effort spent
32: Enchanted Grimoire: Item, Consider a natural 19+ a critical hit when casting spells
33: Warrior's Amulet: Item, Use magical effort with any weapon
34: Divine Shield: WIS Spell, Enchant a target you can see to absorb the next 10 Effort done to it
35: Staff of Elements: Item, Triple any elemental Magical Effort you do with INT SPELLS
36: Cloak of Aras: Armor, Deflect 1 Weapon attack against you per turn
37: Silver Gauntlets: Armor, +3 STR when gripping or grappling, silver properties
38: The Iron Hook: Weapon, Use a turn to pull a target to your location, FAR range
39: Turn Undead: WIS Spell, For 1 ROUND, repel 1D8 undead, They cannot get within NEAR
40: Terror Shard: Item, Hold aloft, living things must resist with WIS or flee for a turn
41: Resurrection: WIS Spell, HARD roll, In 4 ROUNDS deceased target touched revives with 1 HP
42: Dragon Orb: Item, Blast 4D12 Magical Fire damage, FAR range, The item is destroyed
43: Dragon Helmet: Armor, +2 DEFENSE, Wearer immune to damage inflicted by fire
44: Ring of Ghosts: Item, Roll INT to create a clone NEAR that performs the same attack or action
45: Crown of Madness: Item, Make a target take a random action (GM's roll)
46: Smoked Roc Wings: Food, Fly for 4 ROUNDS
47: Black Gar: Food, +10 DEFENSE for 4 ROUNDS
48: Queen's Kiss: Food, Your next action is an automatic critical success
49: Sharpening: INT Spell, Add +2 Effort to a weapon, Once per weapon
50: Spiked Shield: Armor, Failed enemy attacks are answered with Weapon Damage (no bonuses)

ANCIENT LOOT

51: Bow of Eagles: Weapon, Use an extra turn aiming to do double Damage
52: Swarm: WIS Spell, Cast on a seen area, CLOSE targets Magically Damaged for 1D4 ROUNDS
53: Mender: INT Spell, Repair a ruined item or weapon instantly
54: Skull Shield: Armor, +2 DEFENSE, Can also be used as a Magical Weapon
55: Silver Spear: Weapon, Magical, +3 to DEX Attempt when thrown, silver properties
56: Dwarven Anvil: Item, Once / 1D12 days, create a weapon with +3 Attempt OR Effort bonuses
57: Book of Skills: Item, With any 3 successes, earn a permanent +1 to a specific type of Attempt
58: Ring of Fire: Item, Double all fire Damage inflicted
59: Flaming Sword: Weapon, Magical, Add 1D4 Burn damage for 1D4 ROUNDS to hit targets
60: Ringlet of Genius: Item, Use ULTIMATE effort with any successful INT roll
61: Goblet of Udin: Item, Double effects from any Food consumed
62: Ring of Aras: Item, When recovering, fill a HEART in addition to your normal RECOVERY
63: Heart Stone: Item, add 1 Heart to your max
64: Translocate: INT Spell, Swap places with an ally you can see
65: Mask of Mofune: Armor, +1 DEFENSE, Roll ULTIMATE effort when intimidating
66: Ring of Power: Item, Double all MAGIC EFFORT
67: King's Signet: Item, Have final say on group decisions, and be loved for it
68: Dwarvish Hammer: Weapon, MAGIC Weapon, roll Double ULTIMATE on natural 20s
69: Thieves' Picks: Item, +3 Attempt AND Double Effort when opening chests
70: Ring of Giants: Item, +1 STR, +1 DEFENSE
71: Masterful Boots: Item, +1 DEX
72: King's Mug: Item, +1 CON
73: Amulet of Secrets: Item, +1 INT
74: Meditation Beads: Item, +1 WIS
75: Masterful Coats: Item, +1 CHA
76: Armor Kit: Item, +2 DEFENSE
77: Fire Stone: Item, +1 MAGIC Effort
78: Weapon Kit: Item, +2 Weapon Effort
79: Diamond Spyglass: Item, +6 WIS on Scouting attempts
80: Berserk Ring: Item, +3 on ULTIMATE effort
81: Holy Bulwark: WIS Spell, Touch an ally, they are immune to non-Magic Effort for 4 ROUNDS
82: Storm: WIS Spell, Everything with FAR range blasted with hail for MAGIC
83: Shire Jerky: Food, Regenerate 1D12 HP for the next 4 ROUNDS
84: Adamantine Hauberk: Armor, +4 DEFENSE
85: Lifedrinker: Weapon, Magic weapon, Heal half of any Damage done to living targets
86: Wristlets of Might: Armor, DEFENSE +1, Roll 1D8 for any Basic Effort
87: Iron Gut Belt: Armor, +1 DEFENSE, If you fail a CON roll, try one more time
88: Ale of Death: Food, Return from death with 10 HP. Wasted if unused within 1 day of drinking
89: Ale of Life: Food, Drink in battle. Any ally who touches you heals 1D12 HP once
90: Gadgeteer's Goggles: Armor, +1 DEFENSE, Creating or repairing machines is always EASY
91: Feather of Falling: Item, You cannot be hurt by damage from a fall at any height
92: Timebender: Item, If the GM rolls a timer, roll it again. The second roll will be final
93: Mace of Thunder: Weapon, Magical, Any target struck is stunned on its next TURN
94: Lightning Steed: Item, Summon a flying steed. What would take a day, takes 1 ROUND
95: Ring of Weird Luck: Item, If you roll a 1 twice, your blunder causes something beneficial
96: Spellslinger Ring: Item, If you roll a critical when casting, Attempt another spell instantly
97: Boots of Haste: Armor, DEFENSE +1, After an action, you may then also Move again
98: Ring of Slayers: Item, If you make a successful Weapon attack, attack again for ULTIMATE
99: Astral Crown: Armor, +2 DEFENSE, On a critical spell cast, cast through an ally
100: Feast of Kings: Food, All allies restore full HP and receive one Chest

TABLES

SHABBY LOOT

1: Soldier's Rations: Food, Heal 1D4 HP
2: Captain's Rations: Food, Heal 1D6 HP
3: Coin Pouch: 1D10 Coin
4: Coin Satchel: 2D10 Coin
5: Common Sword: Weapon, Standard Steel blade with heavy use
6: Used Shield: Armor, +2 DEFENSE, Heavily worn, will break on 3rd hit
7: Mechanic's tools: Item, Hammer, spanner, roll EASY checks on mechanical tasks
8: Common Helmet: Armor, +1 DEFENSE
9: Worker's Clothes: Armor, +1 DEFENSE, Durable coveralls, gloves and hat
10: Coin Box: 3D12 Coin
11: Lantern: Item, Easy-light box lantern, lights all within NEAR range
12: Climber's Spikes: Item, Climb a route as normal. Any who follow roll EASY
13: 50' Rope: Item, 50 feet of sturdy fiber rope coiled up
14: Pry Bar: Item, A 3 foot iron bar with one hooked end, roll EASY when forcing doors
15: First Aid Kit: Item, Bandages for field dressing, consume to give a dying ally 1 HP
16: Ladder: Item, A wooden ladder with 12 rungs, 12 feet high
17: Wool Cloak: Armor, +1 DEFENSE, A typical hooded cape for winter wear
18: Skin of Stale Gar: Food, Consume to make your next roll EASY
19: Hunting Snare: Item, Reusable spring-loaded trap, will immobilize, do 1 damage
20: Dusty Gem: Worth 1D100 Coin
21: Torch: Item, An oil soaked stick wrapped in cloth, illuminates NEAR for D8 ROUNDS
22: Rivet Kit: Item, A small hammer and awl to press rivets through leather or wood
23: Smoke Canister: Item, Create a cloud of smoke with NEAR radius for 1D4 ROUNDS
24: Turkey Leg: Food, Heal 1D10 HP
25: Stimulant Elixir: Food, On your next turn move FAR as if it was NEAR
26: Blank Book: Item, A blank journal-style book with sheathed pen
27: Metal Cutters: Item, A snip for cutting bars, roll ULTIMATE Effort when doing so
28: Small Tent: Item, Houses 3 individuals, packs into small bundle
29: Canvas Tarp: Item, A durable cloth square NEAR long on each side
30: Worn Parachute: Item, Deploy when falling to nullify damage, 1% chance of failure
31: Coin Stash: 2D100 Coin
32: Worn Long Bow: Weapon, Has 10% chance of breaking when used
33: Common Ammo: Standard ammunition, 10 count, roll for type
34: Common Dagger: Weapon, Thrown, Piercing, Fast
35: Pikeman's Spear: Weapon, Has NEAR reach, cannot be thrown
36: Ferry Pole: Item, A sturdy pole that can reach FAR, very difficult to carry
37: Fishing Gear: Item, Standard low-cost fishing tackle and rod
38: Cooking Set: Item, Pot, plates, spices. Heal 5 HP OVER HEART max when camping
39: Large Magnet: Item, Powerful magnet that can hold 100 pounds
40: Hacksaw: Item, used to very slowly cut metal or wood with precision
41: Traveler's Meal: Food, Heal up to 5 people for 1 HEART
42: Fur-lined Coat: Armor, +1 DEFENSE, Disregard negative effects of extreme cold
43: Corrosion-Proof Gloves: Armor, +1 DEFENSE, Leather immune to Acid or corrosion
44: War Banner: Item, A canvas banner mounted on a 10 foot pole, unmarked
45: Anchor: Item, An iron anchor and 50 foot chain used on medium sized boats
46: Highborn Clothes: Armor, +1 DEFENSE, One set of high-end, tailored formal wear
47: Jug of Junk Oil: Item, Leftovers from mechanical work, highly flammable, slick
48: Bullhorn: Item, A conical horn with pistol grip, transmit a yell to DOUBLE FAR range
49: Ratchet Winch: Item, A chain bisected by a lever, pull VERY HEAVY objects
50: Armor Spike Kit: Item, Add spikes to any armor, attackers take 1 HP when hitting

SHABBY LOOT

51: Mastercraft Arrows: Item, Double Weapon Effort on a hit, 3 count
52: Jug of Flies: Item, A large glass jug filled with flies, remnant of science work
53: Side of Beef, Roasted: Food, Heal 3 people 1D12
54: Deformed Skull: Item, A weird artifact kept by some oddball
55: Wheeled Dolly: Item, A metal platform with four small wheels, used to truck cargo
56: Carved Tankard: Item, a uniquely crafted drinking mug, huge
57: Luminous Gem: Worth 3D100 Coin
58: Forgeman's Boots: Armor, +1 DEFENSE, Immune to fire or hot surfaces walked on
59: Signal Flare: Item, A magnesium flare that burns bright yellow, even under water
60: Signal Horn: Item, When sounded can be heard for 1 mile
61: Hard Gar Cider: Food, Ignore the next 10 Damage done to you
62: Glass Scope: Item, Attach to one ranged weapon, +1 DEX when using that weapon
63: Huge Cargo Pulley: Item, Used with rope to easily hoist huge objects
64: Lode Stone: Item, An incredibly heavy cube of solid iron with a hoop on top
65: Steel Rod: Item, Leftover from some machine, 3 feet long, almost unbreakable
66: Frogman Gear: Item, Mask, fins, and air bladder, 4 ROUNDS underwater, reusable
67: Mining Tools: Item, Make EASY rolls when excavating
68: Gold Chain: Item, Once worn by the wealthy, worth 1D100 x 5 Coin
69: Cask of Golden Gar: Food, 2 HP for up to 50 people, once tapped sours in 1 day
70: Bird Suit: Armor, +1 DEFENSE, A theatrical feather-suit and mask for festive occasions
71: Shovel: Item, A sturdy steel and wood shovel
72: Padlock and Key: Item, Reinforced steel lock
73: Gilly Cloak: Armor, +1 DEFENSE, A leafy cape, Roll EASY stealth in natural surrounds
74: Rapid Crossbow: Weapon, Has 10% chance of firing a second BOLT when fired
75: Phial of Acid: Item, A few ounces of concentrated hydrochloric acid
76: Scout's Pouch Harness: Armor, +1 DEFENSE, Extend carry capacity to 12 LOOT
77: Hunter's Bait: Item, A non-perishable gunk that draws wildlife for up to 1 mile
78: Forgeman's Bellows: Item, Huge, bellows to stoke a fire to incredible temperatures
79: Pouch of Ball Bearings: Item, A small sack of stainless steel spheres ranging in size
80: Goat Bell: Item, A leather collar with iron bell, adjustable size
81: Medic Stretcher: Item, Carry a fallen ally with no STR checks
82: Arming Jacket: Armor, +1 DEFENSE, Increase maximum wearable Armor to 11
83: A Fine Steak: Food, Heal to full HP
84: Float Vest: Item, Used to avoid swimming fatigue or drowning in rough water
85: Deck of Cards: Item, Play numerous games or perform parlor tricks
86: Butchery Kit: Item, A rolled cloth with numerous knives, hooks, and cleavers
87: Farmer's Bug Sprayer: Item, A hand operated pump filled with vinegar mixture
88: Riding Tack: Item, Leather harnesses, saddle for any number of beast-mounts
89: Armor Repair Kit: Item, Reusable supplies and tools to fix any armor
90: Navigation Gear: Item, Scopes and charts for navigating, EASY navigation rolls
91: Holy Silver Amulet: Item, Silver properties, an inspiring symbol of the good
92: Cosmic Gem: Worth 1000 Coin
93: Elemental Elixir: Food, When enchanting, consume to add an elemental property
94: Martial Arts Manual: Item, When fighting with bare hands, do Weapon Damage
95: Locale Map: Item, Glean all pertinent locations in a 25 mile radius
96: Phial of Resolve: Food, Drink to add ULTIMATE Effort to your next successful Attempt
97: Alchemist's Kit: Item, Do 1 HEART of effort to produce a random 1-use Potion
98: Imperium Signet: Armor, +1 DEFENSE, The sign of a ranking member of cosmic order
99: Runestone: Item, If you are killed in battle, return from Asgard...but how?
100: Light of the Gods: Item, Destroy this gem to raise a DYING ally to full HP

TABLES

CURSED LOOT

1: Seaweed Sandwich: Food, Heal 3 HP, Smell like seawater and bilge for 1 week
2: Arn's Hex: INT Spell, Rot a target with 1 Damage / round / 1 day, also suffer the rot
3: Mind Trap: INT Spell, Once learned, lose 1 INT, Touch a target to cast same effect
4: 10 Terrible Arrows: Item, Magical Arrows, NEVER hit target, boomeranging on a 1
5: Toe Rot Waybread: Food, Heal 3 HP, Move only NEAR for 1D4 of your ROUNDS
6: Raw Hatchlings: Food, Take 3 HP, CON Check or vomit, hate eggs for 1 month
7: Wrigglers: Food, Heal 2D6 HP, All CON Checks are now HARD for 24 hours
8: Cloven Sword: Weapon, +2 Attempts / Effort, can't put down, slowly become a goat
9: Turtle Shield: Armor, +3 DEFENSE, HARD CON roll to put down, Occupies 3 slots
10: Crown of Memories: Item, HARD INT to take off, devours wearer's best memories
11: Skullcrusher Helm: Trap, Slams shut for Weapon Damage, Damage again to remove
12: Handshake from Hell: Trap, Hand sculpture, when touched grabs with a STR +5 grip
13: Ring of Tears: Item, -1 WIS, To remove the ring a willing recipient must be found
14: Ravager Axe: Weapon, +1 STR, Once fighting, you are compelled to finish the kill
15: Agnar Liver Paste: Heal 2D12, NEAR Allies roll CON or take 1 stink damage
16: Hag's Eye: Item, Look through to locate evil, for 1 week, see evil hiding everywhere
17: Locust Urn: Trap, If opened, release a 2 HEART Swarm of Locusts
18: Cloak of Crushing Weight: Armor, +1 DEFENSE, Hard STR to remove, all rolls HARD
19: Shield of Teeth: Armor, +3 DEFENSE, If you make a kill, the shield will eat the remains
20: Needle Glove: Trap, A metal gauntlet with poison finger needles, 5 HP damage
21: Magic Bomb: Trap, If looted, gas cloud FAR range, gas nullifies magic 1D4 ROUNDS
22: Fish Boots: Armor, +1 DEFENSE, Swim up to DOUBLE FAR, slowly grow gills
23: Helm of Toads: Armor, -3 CHA, HARD STR remove, Croak if speaking, Talk to Toads
24: Bow of Hatred: Weapon, Magical, HARD WIS put down, misses hit random target
25: Freezing Blade: Weapon, Magical, HARD WIS and 2D6 cold damage to put down
26: K'Tuul Parasite: Trap, Attach to face, controls you utterly, HARD CON remove
27: K'Tuul Egg Layer: Trap, Blasts cloud of spores, in 1D8 ROUNDS, they hatch in you
28: K'Tuul Spine: Trap, A black spine of sticks through your hand for 1D6 Damage
29: K'Tuul Breather: Armor, -2 CHA, Breathe anywhere, if worn 3 ROUNDS, permanent
30: Tentacle Glove: Item, +2 STR, -3 CHA, A hideous barbed whip replaces one arm
31: Sticky Ice: Trap, Looter is stuck to a frozen chest, immobilized until chest destroyed
32: Drunk's Tankard: Item, HARD CON and -1 CON to put down, Constant thirst for Gar
33: Amulet of Certainty: Item, HARD CHA to remove, +1 CHA, Stride into danger as if invincible
34: Crow's Foot: Item, Natural 20 to put down, Covet the Crow's Foot over all else, even allies
35: Staff of Serpents: Item, +3 CHA, user is drawn to sadistic uses of magic
36: Cloak of Vapor: Armor, +2 DEFENSE, Stealth Checks EASY, If worn 1D8 days become vapor
37: War Axe of Skulls: Weapon, Magical, HARD CHA to put down, forces you to collect skulls
38: Mask of Horrors: Trap, A hideously deformed human face, -5 CHA, 2D12 damage to remove
39: Fungus Burger: Food, Heal 1 HP, Lose -2 HP per round, CON Checks HARD until healed to full
40: Vision of Fear: Trap, An illusory presence of fear, Looter must flee FAR in a random direction
41: A Lovely Box: Trap, HARD CHA to put down, Never open it, NO ONE can ever open it! Mine!
42: Ugly Stick: Weapon, Magical Staff, Do -1 CHA damage the first time you hit a target
43: Hungry Bread: Food, Heal 1D6 HP, Become ravenously, insatiably hungry for 1D6 days
44: Liar's Dice: Item, For the next 3 rolls, lie to your group about what you rolled, then destroy
45: Ring of Betrayal: Item, HARD CON remove, Choose an ally, be convinced they hate you
46: Necklace of Decay: Item, HARD CON to remove, Age 10 years every round
47: Ring of Flame: Item, Add 1D6 Fire to attacks, Flammable items on your person burn away
48: Woodbane Crown: Item, Double EFFORT against anything wood, your wood items fall apart
49: Mira's Broach: Trap, HARD CON remove, Gem sucks 2 HP per successful attack
50: Belt of Burdens: Trap, HARD STR remove, A crushing weight, Occupies 5 gear slots

CURSED LOOT

51: Glowcap Mushroom: Food, Heal 1 HEART, Experience bonzo hallucinations for 1D4 days
52: Fel Armor: Armor, +6 DEFENSE, No other armor can be Equipped, take on evil habits / look
53: Fel Cleaver: Weapon, Magical, HARD STR put down, When you kill, attack random NEAR target
54: Helm of the Dead: Armor, +2 DEFENSE, Gain properties of undead, Remove only when DYING
55: Flower Demon: Trap, Unleashes a demon, everywhere it goes choked with vines / flowers
56: Gnomish Gar: Food, Drop to 1 HP, If healed become Grey Gnome, -3 CHA, -2 STR for 1D4 days
57: Book of Lies: Item, HARD INT to break free, Convinced of falsehoods, all INT checks are HARD
58: Magnetic Crossbow: Weapon, +2 Attempts / Effort, HARD STR to separate from metal armor
59: Liar's Compass: Trap, HARD INT to put down, Become convinced the worst way is the best way
60: Giggles: Trap, A cute monkey doll, CHA 18 to put down, Giggle constantly at awful things
61: Swamp Gar: Food, Lose 3 HP, Mucky mud beer makes you UNABLE TO EAT for 1D6 days
62: Spider Pack: Item, A bag that won't let go, STR 15 to remove, -5 CHA, Reduce Carry to 5
63: Black Heart Stone: Trap, You only have 1 HEART for 1D4 days, no matter your actual max
64: Aazul's Conjuration: INT Spell, Summon 1D4 imp demons who crave living flesh
65: Ring of Death Wish: Item, HARD INT to remove, A sudden and potent will to die with glory
66: Effigy of Azatoth: Trap, A fiendish statue, Touched: for 1D4 days blood loss spawns a tentacle
67: Hunter Orb: Trap, A relentless orb flies out and hunts you and allies, 3 HEARTS, Magic
68: Impaler's Spear: Weapon, Magical, HARD CHA to put down, Be compelled to pike your victims
69: Whispering Amulet: Item, HARD CHA to remove, It won't shut up, All Stealth checks HARD
70: Pouch of 100 Counterfeit Coin: Merchants and others hate you for duping them
71: Agnar Helmet: Armor, +2 DEFENSE, HARD STR to remove, Gain half of any benefit from FOOD
72: Dead Man's Mug: Item, HARD CHA to put down, Invert any benefits from drink into harm
73: Book of Forgetting: Trap, Falls apart when read, Lose ONE EQUIPPED LOOT for 1D4 days
74: Gar Swill: Food, 6 sips, Take 2 damage with each sip, but be hopelessly addicted for 1D4 days
75: Reaver's Scythe: Weapon, Magical, HARD CHA put down, You are now forbidden to heal allies
76: Fool's Armor Kit: Trap, When used, deduct 1 from your DEFENSE total
77: Fool's Weapon Kit: Trap, The weapon you modify will BREAK on its next failed attack
78: Exploding Thorn Whips: Trap, LOOTED, you and all NEAR ALLIES immobilized for 1D4 ROUNDS
79: Rotted Pipeweed: Item, HARD INT to put down, Addictive, Nullify INT bonus for 1D4 hours
80: Dizzy Gas: Trap, Looter breathes a poof of purple mist, All DEX rolls are HARD for 1D4 days
81: Eye Mites: Trap, A colony of tiny mites explodes into your eyes, go BLIND for 1D4 hours
82: Dagger of Spite: Weapon, HARD CHA put down, Anytime you are persuaded, stab that person!
83: Skull Bracelet: Item, HARD INT to put down, When worn, re-roll DYING if above 3
84: Blade of Greed: Weapon, Magical, HARD CHA put down, Go after EVERY CHEST
85: Cloak of Despair: Armor, +1 DEFENSE, HARD CHA remove, Constantly nay-say your allies' plans
86: Pure Beauty: Trap, HARD CHA to look away once opened, If others look, same escape required
87: Ray of Death: Trap, Make a CON check or be instantly reduced to 0 HP by a black ray of magic
88: Cap of Madness: Item, HARD INT remove, All INT checks HARD, Go completely bonkers
89: Bloodwine: Food, Lose 4 HP, You are unable to heal any HP until you drink human blood once
90: Feral Fur Coat: Armor, +3 DEFENSE, HARD CHA remove, Be animalistic in action and thought
91: Beltstone: Item, HARD INT to remove, When worn, take double damage from any fall
92: Timeslip: Trap, Whatever the DM's timer reads when LOOTED, accelerate it by 1
93: Booby-trapped Arrow: 1 Ammo, When fired, do Magical Damage to anything within FAR range
94: Blade of Azatoth: Weapon, Magical, A tentacle sword, Be convinced The Devourer must arise
95: Cuirass of Rising: Armor, +3 DEFENSE, to remove, Any dead things NEAR you arise as undead
96: Berserk Helm: Armor, +2 DEFENSE, Double WEAPON EFFORT bonus, choose targets randomly
97: Olive Branch: Item, HARD CHA to put down, Refuse to hurt any living thing
98: Stink Bomb: Trap, You and your allies smell awful, -5 CHA and smell for 1 mile for 1D4 days
99: Cold Iron Cross: Item, HARD WIS to remove, You cannot use WIS Spells
100: Key of the Ogdru: Item, If used, a keyhole appears, widens, summons 1D8 Giant Tentacles

TABLES

SCI FI LOOT

1: Heart Stone: Add 1 HEART to your max
2: Shield Projector: Item, Drop to emit a NEAR energy wall with 14 DEFENSE and 2 HEARTS
3: Sentry Turret: Item, Build with Effort, Fires twice per round within FAR, 12 DEFENSE, 1 HEART
4: Fusion Cell: Food, MECHA only, Heal 1D12, DEX and STR checks are EASY for 1D4 ROUNDS
5: Plasma Rifle: Weapon, Magical, Never reload, Always does ULTIMATE when used in vacuum
6: Incinerator: Weapon, High-pressure flame unit, Can't use in vacuum, Ignites targets NEAR
7: Grav Anchor: Item, A gravity spike that sticks with immense power, +10 STR on any surface
8: Nano-Winch: Item, 100' cable, Free slack or wind-in, +10 STR when pulling, Cable has 1 HEART
9: Imperium Power Armor: Armor, +2 DEFENSE, +2 STR, Use 1 of 3 fuel to 2X stats 1D4 ROUNDS
10: Xill Armor: Armor, +3 DEFENSE, +1 DEFENSE per failed attack against you, null once hit
11: Zurin Robes: Item, +2 WIS, Command moves robe to any NEAR ally and absorbs next attack
12: Cyber Lenses: Item, Eye replacements, +1 WIS, Only fail scouting or spotting on a 1
13: Zurin Flute: Item, Play for a turn to heal all who can hear for 1D8 OR make recovery EASY
14: Plasteel Helmet: Armor, +2 DEFENSE, Ignore any effect that would blind or deafen you
15: Rip Saw: Weapon, Magical, Fusion-powered chainsaw, ULTIMATE against structures / objects
16: Ion Sword: Weapon, Magical, Does not occupy a slot, Highly concealable, ULTIMATE on 18+
17: Duranium Hammer: Weapon, Indestructible, Magnetics do MAGIC when thrown, returns
18: Micro-Jet: Item, a tiny, super powered thruster that can move up to 50 tons
19: Rask Omnitool: Item, Useful and versatile, any Attempt or Check that could use tools EASY
20: Remote Unit: Item, Attach to any Weapon or Item to trigger or use from up to 1 mile away
21: Hack Bug: Item, Tiny stick-on module that decodes passwords or locked doors in 1 round
22: Particle Grenade: Weapon, 3 count, Instant or 1 round fuse, Explodes for ULTIMATE, NEAR
23: Mono Filament: Item, Micro-thin cable for snares, Invisible, Does ULTIMATE used as garrote
24: Wood Beast Gel: Food, A small blob of goo, Heal 1D12 for 3 ROUNDS, Causes searing pain
25: Power Pill: Food, 3 count, Move FAR twice in one turn AND take an action
26: Smoke Armor: Item, +2 DEFENSE, Be detected by others ONLY with a HARD scouting check
27: Laser Cutter: Item, Do ULTIMATE effort against structures and objects within FAR range
28: Arc Cannon: Weapon, Arcing energy leaps to a target, Magical, DOUBLE if target is metal clad
29: Nano-Swarm: Item, 10,000 tiny machines penetrate small spaces, doing a tiny task
30: Nitro Putty: Item, Sticky, Explodes when ignited or fired on, DOUBLE ULTIMATE / NEAR
31: Medi Foam: Food, 2 uses, Heal to full HP, Regenerate 3 HP per round for 1D4 ROUNDS
32: Grav Chute: Item, Cradle of dense blue energy, Slow the fall of all NEAR objects or ALLIES
33: AI Module: Item, A portable personality that can perform INT, WIS, CHA checks at a location
34: Imperium Uniform: Armor, +1 DEFENSE, Captain rank with sidearm and full outfit
35: Mark of the Devourer: Item, A sign of the evil, +1 INT, Intuit imminent danger with INT roll
36: Gauss Piercer: Weapon, Magnetic needle, If you hit, do ULTIMATE on shots done afterward
37: Energy Bow: Weapon, Magical, No ammo needed, choose Ice or Fire bolt properties
38: Rapid Fire Module: Item, Attach to any ranged weapon, If you score a hit, fire again
39: Plasma Mortar: Weapon, Lobs a round high up, Impact in 1D4 ROUNDS, ULTIMATE to target
40: Soul Harness: Item, If you roll a 6 when DYING, instantly pop up with 1 HP
41: Nano Gar: Food, Nanite-infused beer, Heal to full HP, only fail your next check with a 1
42: Titan Blade: Weapon, only CARRY other weapons when equipped, Huge, ULTIMATE on 15+
43: Stun Gun: Weapon, Target can roll CON to resist, otherwise STUNNED for 2 ROUNDS
44: Mutate: INT SPELL, Grant 1 minor biological modification such as gills, fins, claws, or fur
45: Drain: INT SPELL, Drain MAGICAL EFFORT from a target, and convert into HP
46: Mind Link: INT SPELL, Gain a target's thought contents OR roll ULTIMATE when convincing
47: Spike: INT SPELL, Hurl a bolt of impaling energy, Hits all targets in a straight line up to FAR
48: Hack: INT SPELL, Enter any computer system for 2 ROUNDS, +5 INT and ULTIMATE inside
49: Smoke: INT SPELL, Take the form of smoke for a number of ROUNDS equal to your INT
50: Blessing of the Void: WIS Spell, Grant one ally a guaranteed success on next roll

SCI FI LOOT

51: Lifegiver: WIS Spell, Give your life for another, Drop to 0 HP, Raise DYING ally to full HP
52: Freeze: WIS Spell, Emit cloud of freezing cold to NEAR, Immobilize enemies 1D4 ROUNDS
53: Elemental Air: WIS Spell, Emit a blast of air, Push objects and targets with +5 STR
54: Iron Palm: WIS Spell, Your next 1D4 unarmed attacks are +3 ATTEMPT and ULTIMATE
55: Crystal Talisman: Item, Mark 1 enemy, attacks against that target add MAGIC EFFORT
56: Mag Boots: Armor, +1 DEFENSE, Walk on any surface if metallic with no DEX checks
57: Duranium Hauberk: Armor, +3 DEFENSE, Ignore all ranged attacks that use projectiles
58: Telekinetic Module: Item, Move objects up to 5 pounds FAR range
59: Astro Chip: Item, All piloting, starship navigation, or maneuver checks are EASY
60: Sharpshooter's Goggles: Armor, +1 DEFENSE, +5 to attacks when at FAR range
61: Teleport Pads (pair of 2): Item, Place the pads, blip between them, Active for 1D4 ROUNDS
62: Book of Stars: Item, +1 INT, Locate yourself anywhere in the cosmos with an EASY INT check
63: Book of Moons: Item, EASY INT check to know the history of any Moon in the cosmos
64: Book of Beasts: Item, Make an EASY WIS check to know details about any creature you see
65: Hagro Biscuit: Food, Heal all allies NEAR you for 1D12
66: Tentacle Pod: Item, Activate to summon a GIANT TENTACLE for 1D4 ROUNDS
67: Vogon Poetry, Volume 3: Item, If read aloud, creatures who hear make a CON or 1D4 damage
68: Utility Arm: Armor, +2 DEFENSE, A compact hydraulic arm, STR checks EASY, EQUIP 12 slots
69: Motion Tracker: Item, Huge, Takes 3 Equip slots, Detect ALL movement within DOUBLE FAR
70: Grav Bike: Item/Vehicle, A hyperspeed micro bike, Seats 2, Subsonic, Foldable to 3 Carry slots
71: Superspark: Item, Jump-start any engine, hyperdrive, stardrive, or other motor
72: EM Spool: Item, Activate in 4 ROUNDS, electronics within FAR disabled 4 ROUNDS
73: Mag Snare: Item, Place to set magnetic trap, NEAR Metals pinned for 4 ROUNDS
74: Immunity Pill: Food, +5 CON until your next meal
75: Flash Virus: Item, Implant one infectious, indomitable COMMAND into a computer system
76: Runaway: Item, A fast-moving robot drone that can retrieve or recon within a half mile
77: Repair Spider: Item, Regenerate 1 HP per round, Repair any damaged LOOT in 1D4 ROUNDS
78: Collapse-Pole: Weapon, Magical, A metal staff, shrink to 1 inch or extend up to FAR length
79: Illumidrone: Item, a small hovering orb that casts a beam of white light to FAR range
80: Suppressor Foam: Item, 3 uses, Instantly suppress any fire within FAR range
81: Ammo Brick: Ammo, Micronized ammo, 50 count, for any weapon, takes NO CARRY SLOT
82: Sonic Nullifier: Item, Nullify ALL SOUND within FAR range upon activation, lasts 1D4 ROUNDS
83: Reptoid Pheromone: Food, Repel or attract biological life form with +10 CHA, lasts 4 ROUNDS
84: Duranium Chain Gun: Weapon, Magical, Use 1D4 ROUNDS to spin up, fire 6 Attacks in 1 turn
85: G Card: Item, 1,000 Coin of credit
86: Stubing's Ace: Item, A worn out Ace of Spades, redeemed for a junk starship...somewhere...
87: Reptoid Symbiote: Item, Cannot be removed, gain the BONUSES and quirks of a Reptoid
88: Xevosian Crown: Item, +2 CHA, includes rank and title of a Xevos elder
89: Crystal Pill: Food, All MAGICAL EFFECTS are ULTIMATE for 4 ROUNDS
90: Friendly Heart Stone: Add 1 HEART to any ally's max
91: Hydraulic Barricade: Item, Install on any physical door, Becomes a 3 HEART challenge to open
92: Energy Grapple: Item, Attach to any object within 2 miles, Tethered for 1D4 ROUNDS
93: EVA Suit: Armor, +3 DEFENSE, Breathe, Immune to fire, radiation, cold, and bio-agents
94: Ring of Sol: Item, When worn, any fire damage HEALS you for that amount instead
95: Whiskey Gar: Food, Heal to full HP, become invulnerable for 1D4 ROUNDS
96: Heart Stone: Add 1 HEART to your max
97: Prophecy: INT SPELL, If a TIMER is rolled, glean its meaning
98: Dominate Machine: WIS Spell, Utterly control any 1 machine for 1D4 ROUNDS
99: Pocket Dimension Unit: Item, A doorway to a tiny realm, holds 50 LOOT and up to 10 people
100: Polarity Inverter: Item, Feasibly reverse ANY energy-based effect with an INT roll

TABLES

EPIC LOOT

1: Heart Stone: Add 1 HEART to your max
2: Fighter's Girdle: Armor, +1 DEFENSE, When DYING, add 2 to your roll
3: King's Coins: Gain 3 HERO COINS that can be given to OTHER PLAYERS for heroic deeds
4: Chain Energy Gem: Item, Attach to a weapon, Make Magical, Effort hits all CLOSE enemies
5: Gemini Jewel: Item, Attune to any INT SPELL, That spell casts twice when used
6: Salamander Wristlet: Item, Regenerate 1 HP each round, unless DYING
7: Frost Bracers: Armor, +3 DEFENSE, Become immune to any damage done or ill effects of cold
8: Acid Whetstone: Item, Sharpen a bladed weapon, attacks with that weapon destroy 1 gear
9: Helmet of Udin: Armor, +4 DEFENSE, +3 CHA, Allies NEAR you gain +1 DEFENSE
10: Ring of Invisibility: Item, Make a WIS check to activate, remain invisible for 1D4 ROUNDS
11: Crown of Goblins: Item, Command all Goblins with absolute authority, even if they hate you
12: Illusory Self: INT SPELL, Conjure a very realistic mirror-clone of yourself
13: Dimension Jump: INT SPELL, Warp to any location you can see or can accurately remember
14: Antlers of the Storm: Armor, +3 DEFENSE, WIS check command weather when outdoors
15: Hand of Resurrection: Item, Raise 1 dead back to full HP, roll 1D4, if a 1 / 2 item is destroyed
16: Dire Bear: WIS Spell, Become a huge bear for 1D4 ROUNDS, Add 1 HEART, Double bonuses
17: Iron Skin: WIS Spell, Your DEFENSE is 20 for 1D4 ROUNDS
18: Hoppy Gar: Food, Heal to Full HP, All checks are EASY for 1D4 ROUNDS
19: Dwarven Bomb: Weapon, Fuse burns for 1D4 ROUNDS, Explodes doing 4D12 to NEAR
20: Hood of Fear: Armor, +3 DEFENSE, enemies who see you WIS check or flee on their turn
21: Diamond Tiara: Item, A crown worth more than a small city
22: Ivory Rose: Item, Bestow this on one person, that person will guard you with their life
23: Tooth of the Agnar: Item, Attach to 1 Weapon, weapon does ULTIMATE on any roll of 15+
24: Magma Coil: Item, Give off smoke and fire to make STR check EASY or STR EFFORT Ultimate
25: Frog Boots: Armor, +2 DEFENSE, When moving FAR, leap with ease
26: Heroic Tabard: Item, When you cry "Huzzah!" those who cry "Huzzah!" roll EASY next turn
27: Song of the Mountain: INT SPELL, Sing! Enemies within FAR are -5 CHA to resist persuasion
28: Harpoon Gun: Weapon, Magical, Attack to grapple a foe with a +5 STR if they try to escape
29: Bow of Seeking: Weapon, Magical, If know a target's name, you never miss
30: Pet Slime Cube: Item, This tiny Slime Cube has imprinted on you as parent, 3" on a side
31: Pet Goblin: Item, This hapless, gearless runt has sworn never to leave your side
32: Fire Blade: Weapon, Magical, +3 Attempts/Effort, Ignites flammables, 1D4 for 1D4 ROUNDS
33: Wave of Fury: WIS Spell, If NEAR ocean, call forth a massive wave, impacts in 1D4 ROUNDS
34: Gravity Inversion: INT SPELL, Invert gravity within FAR range for 1D4 ROUNDS
35: Brain Horror Helm: Armor, +3 DEFENSE, Gain 'It shows you things' property of a Brain Horror
36: Gunner's Tripod: Item, Gain +5 Attempts/Effort when firing at targets beyond FAR
37: Watcher: Item, A small glass eye, place anywhere and see through it within 1 mile
38: Dobbs' Cheddar: Food, 3 Count, Add to any FOOD to double that FOOD's effects
39: Yalfonso's Disc: Item, A frictionless, levitating disc of energy that holds up to 200 pounds
40: Ramthas Battle Harness: Armor, +1 DEFENSE, Gain 3 more slots in EQUIPPED gear
41: Ronaldo's Backwagon: Item, Gain 10 more slots in CARRIED gear
42: Call of Aram: Item, A mighty war horn, Sound a call heard for 5 miles, with a +3 CHA
43: Genetic Soup: Food, changes the eater into a random new BIO-FORM instantly
44: Runic Rope: Item, ANY roll using this rope is EASY, 50'
45: Thoor's Stone: Item, Only the looter is able to lift or move it, a baseball-sized cube
46: Gnomish Beam Goggles: Armor, +2 DEFENSE, Fires a ray of ULTIMATE damage
47: Feral Claws: Weapon, Magical, +3 Attempts, Retractable blades, Roll EFFORT TWICE on a hit
48: Belt of Guzzling: Armor, +4 DEFENSE, Never fail another CON check
49: Book of Infinity: Item, You have perfect recall of every fact you have ever encountered
50: Amulet of Thunder: Item, When rolling ULTIMATE, re-roll anything less than a 6

EPIC LOOT

51: Lemninkainen's Wondrous Sack: Item, Increase your CARRIED gear slots to 20
52: Akintu: Item, An odd tiki statue that brings good luck, When you roll a 19, treat it as a 20
53: Enchanted Sandwich: Food, Never spoils, 5 bites, 1 Bite = 1D8 HP, When finished gain +1 CON
54: Cloud Buffalo: A steed that descends from the sky, carries 8 people and 10 LOOT
55: Red Fang: Weapon, Magical Great Sword, damage you do with Red Fang, heal half that
56: Crystal Darts: Ammo, 3 Count, Magical, Immobilize target, in 1D4 ROUNDS explode for 2D12
57: Earth's Heart: Item, A massive ruby, the biggest, most rare jewel in all the world
58: Gnomish Metal Melter: Item, 1D4 ROUNDS reach full power, vaporizes NEAR metal objects
59: Ghost Trap: Item, Holds 5 non-corporeal beings: place, wait, trigger, Target gets DEX check
60: Adamantium Armor: Armor, +8 DEFENSE, Ignore any Damage below 3, Occupies 5 slots
61: Clockwork Arm: Item, Prosthetic, +3 STR, all STR checks are EASY, -1 CHA
62: Juice of Sapho: Food, +8 INT, Triple the EFFORT of your next SPELL
63: Styll Suit: Armor, +4 DEFENSE, Wear no other armor, Breathe anywhere, heal 1 HP / ROUND
64: Bracelet of Thoor: Item, +2 STR
65: Ring of Quickness: Item, +2 DEX
66: Drunken Hauberk: Armor, +2 DEFENSE, +2 CON, Never fail a test involving Gar
67: Sage's Crystal: Item, +2 INT
68: Effigy of Osric: Item, +2 WIS
69: Gleaming Gorget: Armor, +1 DEFENSE, +2 CHA
70: Dagger of the Unseen: Weapon, Magical, If attack undetected, human-sized victim to 0 HP
71: Headsman's Shovel: Weapon, Magical, On a 20, behead any human-sized target
72: The Hidden: INT SPELL, Allies NEAR are invisible for 1D4 ROUNDS, visible if move away
73: Slayer's Helm: Armor, +2 DEFENSE, +6 Weapon Effort
74: Eye of Idimmu: Item, Amulet, +6 Magical Effort
75: Boon of the Gods: Item, Grant one OTHER PLAYER Milestone Reward of their choice, one use
76: Timecap Mushroom: FOOD, SKIP the next DM's turn
77: Roll Twice on the ANCIENT LOOT table
78: Shrink Ray: INT SPELL, Reduce one target to 1/100th its size for 1D4 ROUNDS
79: Giant Growth: WIS Spell, Grow one target to 5x its size for 1D4 ROUNDS
80: Osric's Bulwark Wall: WIS Spell, Form a massive castle wall from boulders or cobbles
81: Destroy the Dead: INT SPELL, Annihilate 1 Undead per 1 HP burned, FAR range
82: Ghost Ship: Item, Conjure a black galleon, no crew, that will last 1D4 weeks before dissipating
83: Dragon's Blood: Food, Grow wings and breathe fire for 1D4 ROUNDS
84: Gungnir: Weapon, Magical, Spear, Pass final judgment, +10 CHA for 1 mile
85: Cosmic Gateway: Item, Open a door, access ANY world in the cosmos, 8 HP to walk through
86: Invulnerability: WIS Spell, Anoint target with touch, cannot be harmed for 1D8 ROUNDS
87: Sherherezazahd: Item, A ghostly sword, add Magical Weapon effort to all attacks
88: Time Doorway: Item, Access ANY time at current location, age 10 years to go through
89: Stench Gar: Food, Release a poisonous belch, Reduce one NEAR creature to 1 HEART
90: Lifewalker: Item, Leave a trail of flowers wherever you go, those within heal 2 HP per round
91: Hammer of Hell: Weapon, Magical, All EFFORT with this weapon affects all NEAR enemies
92: Wings of Gabriel: Armor, +5 DEFENSE, Foldable, Fly at will, 2X your maximum move range
93: Wishing Well: Item, Immovable once used, Make 1 WISH per YEAR, comes true in 1D4 days
94: Book of Mastery: Item, 3 pages, Learn 1 Milestone Reward per page
95: Star of Unadai: Food, Gain +1 to all STATS
96: Vision of Perfection: Trap, Reveal to one EVIL being, HARD CHA check or it becomes GOOD
97: Water of Life: Food, Die, Return to life 1D4 ROUNDS later with 2 additional HEARTS
98: Mead of Udin: Food, All who drink awake the next day with an additional HEART
99: Shield of Angels: Armor, +6 DEFENSE, You and all NEAR allies ignore any damage of 5 or less
100: Necronomicon: Item, Create 1 INT SPELL / WIS Spell with HARD INT

TABLES

BIZARRE LOOT

1: Translator Tapeworm: Item, Increases appetite, Speak and understand all spoken languages
2: You Doll: Item, Perfectly resembles owner, INT roll to ask it any question, get true answer
3: Monkey Root: Food, 1 Use, +5 DEX for 4 ROUNDS, Make monkey noises when you try to speak
4: Sedated Runner Bird: Item, Sleepy bird has been drugged and goes berserk when it awakes
5: Boomerang Whip: Weapon, A 12' bull whip, leather, that can be thrown and caught again
6: Finful Ring: Item, +1 DEFENSE, A ring wreathed in wiggling fins. Swim at triple normal speed
7: Bag o' Fingers: Item, A leather sack filled with 2D20 fingers from various bio-forms
8: Lizard Head Hat: Armor, +1 DEFENSE, A leather hat crafted to resemble a lizard, Convincing
9: Dud Beer Cask: Food, 5 uses, Gar that has been brewed wrong and has no alcohol
10: Mushroom Gar: Food, 5 uses, Gar brewed with fungus. Glow slightly / delirious 1D4 Hours
11: Glooby Trap: Item, A glob of ultra-sticky putty. Touched, only a HARD STR roll can set you free
12: Eyeball Ball: Item, A wacky, energetic bouncing eyeball toy. See through it with an INT roll
13: Gag Plank: Item, A plank of wood for building, but made hollow to break under little force
14: Blade of Skepticism: Weapon, Trap, HARD STR put down, Talking sword doubts every move
15: Giant Egg: Item, Use warmth and time to hatch. Spawn 1 random monster, bonds to you
16: Eargantua's Ears: Item, A pair of giant ears that can be worn, only fail a hearing roll with a 1
17: Soggy Bottoms Banjo: Item, A weird stringed instrument, entertain any small crowd
18: Azael's Blood Dice: Item, Roll these red dice. Enemies fascinated with them for 1D4 ROUNDS
19: Bowby Trap: Weapon, Gag bow, when shot roll acts against the user, and the arrow backfires
20: Chatty Skull: Item, A human skull that just won't shut up. If disposed, will pop up elsewhere
21: Robes of Kazghat: Armor, +2 DEFENSE, Immune to effects caused by time travel / distortion
22: Time Tube: Item, A small tube. Pass item through. It arrives in the past at moment chosen
23: Beauty Bacon: Food, 3 uses, enjoy +10 CHA for 1D4 ROUNDS. You look, and smell, delicious
24: Bomb Roach: Item, A mechanical insect. Set it in motion, it will explode as it runs in 1 TURN
25: Sandwich of Love: Food, 1 use, Whoever eats falls in love with a person of your choice
26: Faber Mortiferum: Book, Ask the GM any question with HARD INT, receive an honest answer
27: Tunic of Generosity: Armor, +5 DEFENSE, Nat 20 remove, Compelled to give gear to friends
28: Grim's Boot: Item, Use on a rope or line to fish, You are guaranteed a major catch
29: Knot Rope: Item, A 300 foot length of rope tangled in inextricable knots
30: Towel, Green: Item, A green towel
31: Ship in a Bottle: Item, 1 use, Shatter bottle to reveal a full galleon, weapons and supplies
32: Death's Eye: Item, A crystal sphere, Look within to see the moment of your death
33: Blood Spider: Item, Spider crawls on you, heals 1 HP per ROUND unless you are DYING
34: Spectrum Silk: Item, A bolt of slick fabric that seethes with a myriad of vibrant colors
35: Glider Parasite: Item, Arthropod, HARD STR to remove, Allows you to glide when falling
36: See Me Torch: Item, A torch that will burn as long as at least 1 person is looking directly at it
37: Expanding Slime Cube: Item, A tiny slime cube which continuously grows once released
38: Wind of Saras: Item, A bottle of air, which bellows out like wind whenever uncorked
39: Tectura Infinitessema: Item, A tiny, malevolent, sentient dungeon
40: Note to Self: Item, A letter written from you in alternate dimension, addressed to you
41: Martin's Left Hand: Item, This is Martin's left hand. Martin wants it back
42: Lil Stool: Item, A fully functional toilet, 2 inches tall
43: Magician's Hoop: Item, A steel ring that can 'hook into' any other ring or circle with a whack
44: Phial of Demon's Tears: Food, 1 use, Take the form of a demon for 1D4 days
45: Crab Arm: Armor, DEFENSE +2, A crab claw arm that attaches to your shoulder permanently
46: Jarred Silk Worm: Item, A jar containing a worm. Produces 1' of unbreakable thread per day
47: Cockroach Pinata: Item, A paper globe containing 10,000 hungry cockroaches
48: Lantern of Sett: Item, A candle-lit lantern. When lit, it emits pitch black darkness NEAR
49: Really Ugly Stick: Weapon, Inflict 5 or more damage on a target, give it a permanent -5 CHA
50: Handsy Hands: Armor, DEFENSE+1, Your hands has 10 fingers, each functioning as two hands

BIZARRE LOOT

51:Spores of Chang: Item, A jar of spores. Inhaled, sense of smell is 1,000 times normal acuity
52: Bag o' Keys: Item, Each time you reach in, extract a key. 5% chance it's the key you want
53: Portable Footprints: Item, Place paper-thin footprints anywhere, they look perfectly realistic
54: Xylobone: Item, A musical instrument of bone. The music can make some men crave death
55: Rope Incense: Item, 5 uses, The smoke from this incense can be climbed, lasts 1D4 ROUNDS
56: Pipes of Dawn: Item, magical flute. When played with a CHA, the sun will rise
57: Mini Mimic: Item, A tiny mimic that can imitate any object the size of a cantaloupe or smaller
58: Chokemeat: Food, 1 use, When eaten, this jerky will choke and gag eater until they pass out
59: Comical Toot: Item, Attach this tassle to headgear. Causes laughter for those who see it
60: Sifter of All Things: Item, A culinary sifter. Things inside become other things
61: Teeth of Krynn: Item, A necklace of 8 teeth from beasts, each still hungry for its favored prey
62: Hungry Emerald: Item, An emerald with a hard-to-notice mouth. It eats COINS when possible
63: Here, Fishy, Fishy: Item, A simple horn. When used, summon a fish from ANY mass of water
64: Cozy Hat: Armor, DEFENSE +2, This fluffy fur hat is so warm and cozy, be immune to cold
65: Dry Ring: Item, You can never be wet or touched by liquid
66: Portable Fissure: Item, Place this crack on an object, and it will be cracked
67: Sponge Stone: Item, A rock that can absorb up to 100 gallons of liquid
68: Ring of Mirrors: Item, When worn, interact with objects and structures as if reversed
69: Frog Pellets: Item, Green blobs. When touching moisture, each becomes D20 frogs
70: Bug Bait: Food, 3 uses, Insects within 1 mile are drawn to it
71: Erratic Power: A weird bolt of energy leaps forth! A random character receives 2 STAT points
72: Dimensional Map: Item, Unroll this map. Becomes a 3D, moving version of surroundings
73: Volatile Goggles: Armor, DEFENSE +1, When rolling ULTIMATE, roll twice. If a 1, negate both
74: Hand-on-a-Stick: Item, Can be used to open chests or doors, or test trapped items
75: Dragon Wine: Food, 3 uses, After drinking, you sound, smell, and intimidate just like a Drake
76: Monkey Drummer: Item, When set down, begins drumming a tiny drum. Stops when stored
77: Tattoo Collection: Items, A small pirate's chest filled with tattooed skin pieces
78: Rubber Treasure: Items, A collection of fake COINS, jewels, and baubles made of resin
79: Deathbraid: Weapon, A huge braid of hair that whips and moves like a WEAPON, MAGICAL
80: Vortex in a Bottle: Item, A powerful vortex in glass. If released, sucks everything FAR
81: Larry: Item, A small creature who owes you his life. It cannot be determined what he is
82: Creepy Coconut: Item, A hideous coconut that resembles a human face
83: If playing in ALFHEIM, roll once on the SCI FI LOOT TABLE
84: If playing in WARP SHELL, roll once on the ANCIENT LOOT TABLE
85: God's Blood: Food, 1 use, Increase any STAT by 2
86: Wheel-mobile: Vehicle, 1 CHUNK, A one-wheeled gadget that can hold up to 5 passengers
87: Beard Birds: Item, A family of birds that live in the nearest beard, but move to follow you
88: Bees: Bees. So many bees. Thousands of bees. These bees are mad
89: Magnetic Plank: Item, A plank of wood for building but with a +5 STR magnetic pull
90: The Best Tobacco Ever Known: Food, 10 uses, Simply the best tobacco in the universe
91: Limb Seed: Food, 1 use, Apply to a severed limb or stump to grow a new limb in 1D4 days
92: A Single Truth: 1 use, Tell or describe a single Truth, any Truth. It is now true
93: Soul of a King: Item, A glowing spark in glass. This is the everlasting soul of a long lost King
94: Infinity Banner: Item, A huge billowing flag which can display anything you choose
95: Kelligan's Cube: Item, A cubic puzzle. The cubes align in colors and symbols, bending reality
96: Skin Suit: Armor, A suit of hide that fits under your armor, granting you 10 disposable HP
97: Wand of Genders: Item, With a touch, change any creature's gender
98: Cold Box: Item, A small chest. Inside is always freezing cold
99: Folding Road: Item, Unfold 1 mile of wagon-width road at any location
100: Roll twice on this TABLE

TABLES

GHOST MOUNTAIN LOOT

1: Rattler Venom, FOOD, 5 uses, use as antidote OR poison
2: Silver Crucifix, ITEM, take half damage from any supernatural entities that would harm you
3: Jug o' Moonshine, FOOD, 10 uses, 1 swig gets you drunk, use as flammable or antiseptic
4: Undertaker's Shovel, WEAPON, If you bring a target to 0 HP with this, it DIES instantly
5: Saddle Blanket, DEFENSE +3, place on any animal, all rolls with that animal are EASY
6: Fingerbone Bracelet, ITEM, rolls to control, destroy or resist SKELETONS are EASY
7: Necklace of Seven Fangs, ITEM, If doing 5 or more damage with a KNIFE, roll damage again
8: Hepawa Warbonnet, DEFENSE +1, a crown of feathers, +5 CHA when interacting with Hepawa
9: Hidden Pistol, WEAPON, 1 shot, 1 TURN reload, only used CLOSE, target rolls WIS to spot
10: Silver Bullets, AMMO, MAGICAL, 6 count, Double damage against supernatural creatures
11: Hungry Medallion, ITEM, Gain the maximum benefit of FOOD consumed
12: Master Musket, WEAPON, ATTEMPT of 10+ do max damage, 2 SHOTS, 2 TURNS to reload
13: Armored Duster, DEFENSE +3, Gunshots from FAR range only inflict 1 point of damage
14: Piggin' Strings, ITEM, Any object, animal or person tied with these CANNOT shake loose
15: Butter Rum Tobacco, FOOD, 3 uses, Ask the GM any question, get a true answer
16: Canuska Bone Armor, DEFENSE +5, All rolls when interacting with the Canuska are EASY
17: Black Skull, ITEM, No evil entity may come within NEAR of this powerful object
18: Rusty Leg Irons, ITEM, Bind a person at the ankles, on a HARD STR roll, they can break free
19: Iron Bolo, WEAPON, FAR, Targets hit rolls HARD DEX or falls prone, immobile for 1D4 ROUNDS
20: Jawbone Club, WEAPON, MAGICAL, When struck, targets also lose 3 STR for 4 ROUNDS
21: Viper Boots, DEFENSE +1, You cannot be poisoned, these boots are also fire and acid proof
22: Gambler's Vest, ITEM, A vest with hidden pockets, EQUIP 15 pieces of GEAR, 5 secretly
23: Obsidian Tomahawk, WEAPON, THROWN, Reroll DAMAGE dice below 5, take best result
24: Antler Knives, WEAPON, MAGICAL, Do double EFFORT against animals, wood, or stone
25: The Devil's Dice, ITEM, Reroll any 1 die once per TURN, Be compelled to do Lucifer's will
26: Chemical Lantern, ITEM, A sulphur-magnesium lamp, illuminate up to double FAR
27: Spyglass, ITEM, +3 WIS when rolling to scout, navigate or spot
28: Cavalry Saber, WEAPON, RARE, Targets hit for 8 or more DAMAGE roll CON or fall to 0 HP
29: Chloroform Flask, FOOD, 3 uses, Breathe this in to appear dead for 1D4 hours
30: Bundle of TNT, EXPLOSIVE, 1D4 ROUND fuse, Inflict 4D12 damage to all NEAR
31: Blacksmith's Friend, ITEM, All rolls when repairing, building, or using tools are EASY
32: Lucky Horseshoe, ITEM, Any natural roll of 18+ counts as a CRITICAL success
33: Red Eye Whiskey, FOOD, 5 uses, who knows what it'll do to ya
34: Snake Oil, FOOD, 3 uses, cures any CONDITION
35: Arcane Gun Kit, ITEM, Attach to 1 firearm, that gun is now MAGICAL
36: Lucky Poker Chip, ITEM, When using cards, draw twice and take the better draw
37: Cloth Bandage Kit, ITEM, Heal 1 HP when succeeding at "don't die on me, man!"
38: Cactus Juice, FOOD, 5 uses, Replaces 1 day of SUPPLIES for a group of people
39: Sawed-off Shotgun (WEAPON, See weapons list
40: Death Mask, DEFENSE +2, Bronze shaped into a face, terrify townsfolk, 3 damage if removed
41: Wolf Totem, ITEM, Wolves are drawn to you, and consider you one of their own
42: Barbed Bullwhip, WEAPON, A working grappler bullwhip that also does WEAPON EFFORT
43: Harpoon Gun, WEAPON, Functions as ELEPHANT RIFLE, grapples its target for 4 ROUNDS
44: Ruby Ring, ITEM, Worth 2,000 COIN, Reveal to mesmerize or entrance the greedy
45: Ebon Hemp Robe, ITEM, cannot be cut, burned, ripped or damaged in any way
46: Ivory Broach, ITEM, An old portrait, Give to someone to bind them to one OATH forever
47: Greensteel Katana, WEAPON, RARE, SHARP, Any foe killed grants you its SOUL
48: Hangin' Judge's Gavel, ITEM, Point and slam, all those in sight see target as GUILTY
49: Cossak Sash, ITEM, Be avoided by bandits, outlaws, and criminals who can see the sash

GHOST MOUNTAIN LOOT

50: Amulet of Azael, ITEM, IMMUNE to attacks from Azael, he knows your location
51: Dazzling Sapphire, ITEM, Worth 10,000 COIN, Can be bartered for twice its value
52: Devil's Pitchfork, WEAPON, MAGICAL, Spear, Can be consumed in flames on command
53: Sharp Obsidian Shard, ITEM, Replace the blade on a WEAPON, becomes as deadly as a gun
54: Bear Burgers, FOOD, 3 uses, +5 STR for 4 ROUNDS, Heal to full HP
55: Bar o' Lard, ITEM, Apply to any surface to make it super slick, flammable and waterproof
56: Beacon of Hell, ITEM, All demons and infernals within 1 mile are drawn to it until put away
57: Blowgun, WEAPON, SILENT, Includes 8 darts, POISON a target with no detection
58: Range Rider's Trench Coat, DEFENSE +1, Use half SUPPLIES, All mounted rolls are EASY
59: True Skeleton Key, ITEM, Open ANY locked door
60: Crossbones Eyepatch, ITEM, On command, you have limited X-RAY type vision to FAR
61: Brawler's Gloves, WEAPON, Fight unarmed as if with a WEAPON, DEFENSE +3
62: Golden Lariat, ITEM, MAGICAL, Any target grappled must tell the truth, immobilized
63: Pouch of Gold Dust, ITEM, 1 Use, Sprinkle on any object to make it MAGICAL
64: Bottle of Holy Water, FOOD, 3 uses, Sprinkle in a threshold, supernatural evil cannot pass
65: Cane Sword, WEAPON, Requires a HARD WIS roll to spot
66: Hexar Almanis, BOOK, A massive book of magic rites, Learn and cast 5 SPELLS of any type
67: Smoke Bullets, AMMO, 12 count, These bullets will hit targets with the SMOKE condition
68: Urn of Angels, ITEM, Burn a dead creature, place its ashes here, it will be reborn in 1D4 days
69: Scrounger's Pack, ITEM, Make a WIS roll once per location, find an object you seek there
70: Ring of Slayers , ITEM, On an attack roll of 15+ roll again, if 2nd roll hits, it does ULTIMATE
71: Critter in Need, SPECIAL, You find a small animal that imprints on you as its best friend
72: Diamond Whetstone, ITEM, Sharpen a bladed WEAPON, that WEAPON is +3 EFFORT
75: Spiral Locket, ITEM, EFFORT done with HOLY SPELLS is +3
76: Signet of the Righteous, ITEM, Earns you membership of the elite gunslinger cult
77: Ezra's Wedding Band, ITEM, Ezra's ghost haunts you for all time, roll a natural 20 to remove
78: Dagger of Ruins, WEAPON, Does TRIPLE ULTIMATE against structures, doors, or vehicles
79: Staff of Spirits, ITEM, MAGICAL, Learn and cast any 5 WIS SpellS
80: Ghost Drum, INSTRUMENT, MAGICAL, Supernatural entities are terrified of this sound
81: Bag o' Money, ITEM, Contains 5d10 x 1,000 COIN in bonds, cash and gold
82: Blue Cactus Peaches, FOOD, 2 uses, Heal 1D12 HP, Cure all CONDITIONS
83: Black Spade Revolver, WEAPON, MAGICAL, Never needs AMMO
84: Raven's Claw, ITEM, Shapeshift into a raven with a WIS roll, stay as long as you choose
85: Bullet Arrows, AMMO, 20 count, Use firearm rules when firing with a bow
86: Demon Deck, ITEM, Replaces a Gambler's Deck, Treat every card as if it were one card better
87: Devil's Deck, ITEM, Replaces Gambler's Deck, Re draw on any non-face card
88: Turban of Futures, ITEM, With a HARD INT roll, see into a specific future
89: Golden Mattock, ITEM, Roll WIS underground, find a YOG splinter, gold nugget, or tunnel
90: Azael's Cleaver, WEAPON, MAGICAL, When you hit a target, they roll CON or drop to 0 HP
91: Chest of Wonders, CHEST, Take 3 total LOOT rolls, These can be rolled on any TABLE
92: Owl Headdress, DEFENSE +5, You cannot be harmed by bladed WEAPONS
93: Chain Claw, ITEM, With a DEX roll, fly to any FAR point instantly
94: Dr. Warstein's Amazing Machine, ITEM, this machine takes a form designated by the GM
95: Ghost Gun, WEAPON, MAGICAL, This pistol cannot miss and never needs to be reloaded
96: Lightning Coil, ITEM, Use lever, 1D4 ROUNDS everything within FAR takes 3D12 damage
97: Cross of Santiago, ITEM, INFERNAL SPELLS cannot harm you
98: Gueras Malefectorum, BOOK, Melee attacks on Infernals are CRITICAL and MAGICAL
99: Ghost Bullets, ITEM, 20 count, Shoot these through any material up to FAR
100: Ring of Falling Stars, ITEM, Make a wish. It will come to be. There may be consequences

TABLES

MAGIC LOOT

1: Walking Stick, Item, Move FAR and still take an action
2: Spell Mirror, Item, Reflect a SPELL cast against you in a random direction with an INT roll
3: Crown of Eye, +1 DEFENSE, The wearer of this refractive band cannot be surprised
4: Manual of Persuasion, Tool, +3 CHA to any ATTEMPT utilizing language or speech
5: Blood Pebble, Item, Cast rolls HARD, if you succeed, pay 1 level less than its POWER COST
6: Nightbringer, Dagger, Any victim injured by this MAGICAL blade is blinded for 1D4 ROUNDS
7: Doomsayer Snare, Trap, Tripped with common wire, Release APOCALYPTICA at POWER 4
8: Ice Dagger, Kris Knife, If injured with 6+ damage with this blade, frozen solid for 1D4 ROUNDS
9: Red Tinted Glasses, Item, If you see a primary red object, ignite that object with an INT roll
10: Gyroscope of Falling, Item, When falling roll CON to change your gravity field for 1 ROUND
11: Shards of Ka'a, 3 Arrowheads, An arrowhead that explodes for DOUBLE ULTIMATE on impact
12: Proto Artifact, Item, 2 Uses, Reach into this strange object and withdraw 1 random LOOT
13: Critter Cloak, +2 DEFENSE, Become a small animal, +5 DEX, remain or return at will
14: The DawnStorm, Staff, Use DEX to cast any ranged attack SPELL at POWER 1 for 2 SP cost
15: Flute of Forgetting, Instrument, Play a tune, listeners forget where they are for 1D4 ROUNDS
16: Zeke's Wooden Slippers, +1 DEFENSE, Comfy, always add an extra +3 to your RECOVERY rolls
17: Doorway Chalk, Item, 3 uses, Draw a doorway, it leads to another door... anywhere
18: Mirror Prison, Item, Trap, See your reflection and be imprisoned for 1D4 ROUNDS
19: Spell Stealer Gloves, +2 DEFENSE, With a DEX roll steal a SPELL cast on you last ROUND
20: Presto's Hat, +2 DEFENSE, Once per location, pull out a BIZARRE LOOT roll
21: Jar of Flame Pixies, Item, 10 Pixies, fast-flying fireballs with 1 HP that fight for you
22: Wand of Disarming, Wand, Blast an enemy you see with DEX to send their WEAPON flying
23: Dragonslayer, Spear, NEAR reach, ULTIMATE, damage of natural 8+ explode vs. dragons
24: Phylactery, SPELL, Store your immortal soul in a small object. If object intact, you cannot die
25: Garland's Ear, Item, A golden ear horn that allows you to hear EVERYTHING within 1 mile
26: Fabric of Shadows, +2 DEFENSE, Create a garment. INT roll, become perfectly flat, any color
27: Dragon Fireworks, Item, 5 Uses, Amaze a village of folk into awe or gleeful excitement
28: Ghost Chess, SPELL, Control 1D6 enemies as if they were pieces on a board for 1D4 ROUNDS
29: Sphere of Projectiles, SPELL, Create a crystal sphere. Projectiles attracted for 1D6 ROUNDS
30: Potioner's Kit, Tools, Make potions with a single RARE INGREDIENT rather than 3
31: Ingara's Luck Ring, Item, 6 Uses, Turn a failed roll into a success
32: Herald's Trumpet, Item, 2 Uses, Summon an Angel to fight on your side for 1D4 ROUND
33: Stick of Stickery, Staff, Turn any object into solid wood for 1D4 ROUNDS
34:Kaleido Arcanum, Book, Pages align in cosmic ways. Answer any question about color
35: Scroll of Shame, Scroll, A creature you see becomes instantly dumbstruck and embarrassed
36: Crystal Symbiote, Item, +8 DEFENSE, A Green crystal that hovers CLOSE to intercept attacks
37: Dial of Stretching, Item, Turn this dial and stretch a target you see twice its length
38: Amulet of Dragons, +1 DEFENSE, No dragon can harm you while wearing this talisman
39: Garland's Amulet, Item, For a roll where you don't get a bonus, get +2 to that roll instead
40: Mana Root, Food, 3 uses, Consume to grant 10 HP usable only to absorb SPELL casting COST
41: Clockworks, Item, Use healing magic on mechanical beings as if they were alive
42: Wicker Mushroom Kreel, Item, Contains 15 RARE INGREDIENTS
43: Ghost Candle, Item, 5 uses, Light this candle to attract and reveal GHOSTS within 1 mile
44: Olfan's Hymnal Hurdy Gurdy, Instrument, Cast any SPELLS that boost allies at no COST
45: Lasher Tooth, Item, You are always partly phased, any roll to evade an attack is always EASY
46: Breathing Bell, Item, A diving bell that allows 3 people to breathe in any airless environment
47: Star of Aras, Weapon, A glaive that damages multiple enemies and returns
48: Witch's Skull, Item, Reveal it's face to unleash a terrifying scream, Roll CHA to resist the fear
49: Krellian Chain Mace, Weapon, A massive spiked ball on 8 feet of chain, +6 WEAPON EFFORT
50: Gnomish Brain Stick, Wand, Alter your voice, lighting, and noises to bewilder those who see

MAGIC LOOT

51: Rod of Rot, Wand, Plague a structure with moss, mold, and decay. Collapses in 1D4 days
52: Dead Sword, MAGICAL, Ghosts, specters, and wraiths follow your commands, still hate you
53: Blood of an Archfiend, 12 RARE INGREDIENTS that can be used to make POTIONS
54: Iradrum Shield Machine, Item, A sentient shield. Absorbs 20 damage per location
55: Necklace of Tides, Item, Call a massive wave or rapids to your location with a CHA roll
56: Boots of Wall Running, +4 DEFENSE, Use a vertical surface for movement, when moving FAR
57: Globe of Blades, Item, You are surrounded by hovering knives, Attackers take WEAPON dmg
58: Alacar's Ink, Item, 3 uses, Draw anything, it becomes real in every way for 2D4 ROUNDS
59: Robe of Many Pockets, +2 DEFENSE, Magical LOOT takes no space in your inventory
60: Fire Caltrops, Item, 3 uses, Scatter spikes ignite anything that touches them, then burn away
61: Spore Sentry, Creature, Mykonoid warrior who can't move, but fight with a spear, speaks
62: Demon Powder, Item, 5 uses, Ignite this flammable dust to conjure a DEMON instantly
63: Collar of Balthus, +5 DEFENSE, A locking neck ring which binds its wearer to obey you
64: Vestments of Mastery, +5 DEFENSE, Gain 3 MASTERY in any SPELL TYPE as long as you wear
65: Ankh of Sett, Item, If you roll a natural 20 to pop up from DYING, return to life with full HP
66: Dwarven War Anvil, Item, A wheeled anvil and tools, Create any metal item with STR
67: Antoine's Quill, Item, Write any SPELL you know on parchment for anyone to cast once
68: Javelin Bridge, Weapon, Throw to form a 30' bridge 6' wide, collapse with a command
69: Libram of Gum, Book, Set as a trap. If read, reader is stuck in that spot for 1D8 ROUNDS
70: Cloak of Embers, +4 DEFENSE, Cast any SPELL that uses fire at no cost
71: Arcane Fuse, Item, 5 Uses, SPELLS cast on this thin cord take effect in 1D4 ROUNDS
72: Heavy Water Vial, Item, Use your HEALING TOUCH SPELL to create bottled healing POTIONS
73: Ring of Resolve, +3 DEFENSE, Ignore any attack against you of 5 or less
74: Wigglers, Food, 10 uses, Pupae of pine toad, Eat with CON roll for full HP, if failing gain 1 HP
75: Faber Infinitum, Book, Read with an INT roll and gain floorplans on your current location
76: Minish Cap, +3 DEFENSE, A wide-brimmed wizard's hat, pockets, you have no inventory limit
77: Ring of Gehenna, Item, +1 all STATS, Summon a doorway to The Arcane Library
78: Book of Commonalities, Book, When awarded MASTERY by the GM, apply it to any TYPE
79: Libram Mortiferum, Book, The methods of death. Any victim you reduce to 5 HP drops to 0
80: Skolari's Almanac, Book, PORTALS stay open 1 extra ROUND for you
81: Tobin's Spirit Guide, Book, Know the details of any monster you encounter with an INT roll
82: Tome of Timelines, Book, Retain knowledge of alternate times no matter what
83: Skull of Vincent Aligeeri, Item, A ventriloquist skull functions as your voice from any distance
84: Render, Great Sword, ULTIMATE, The damage done with this weapon also affects DEFENSE
85: Il-Zah'red, Scimitar, Magical, A weapon, so perfect, so sharp, you attack with no roll
86: Myre Manuscript, Book, Gain all the abilities and properties of a Brain Horror
87: Scroll of Finding, Item, 1 Use, Looking for something? Destroy this scroll and find it instantly
88: Windchaser, Vehicle, Miniature boat grows to full size instantly, 20 SUPPLY, holds 8 crew
89: Olfan's Dousing Fork, Item, Roll INT to find 1D6 RARE INGREDIENTS anywhere
90: Oil of Redemption, Food, 3 uses, Evil creatures that consume this become good
91: Tube of Scrolls, Item, A tube of 5 SPELL SCROLLS, the GM will select what SPELLS
92: Littleton Township, Item, A tiny town of 500 folk, all contained in a glass bottle
93: Bone Collector's Case, Luggage, Burn bones instead of your SP as COST, includes 16 bones
94: Ironbrand, Shield, +8 DEFENSE, Allies CLOSE to you also gain this DEFENSE bonus
95: Hoodria Petrificatum, +4 DEFENSE, Pull the hood up on this cloak and become solid stone
96: Crystal Scatter Prism, Item, Refract any SPELL, it is tripled in whatever way you devise
97: Proto Matter, Substance, 1 use, Form this blob of goo into any ITEM on any LOOT TABLE
98: Spellstar, Item, When you BURN a SPELL, pay no COST and regenerate the SPELL
99: Zeke's Magnificent Entitizer, Item, Grant any creature the power to phase for 1D8 days
100: Ring of Power, +5 DEFENSE, +2 STATS, Leave no footprints, Cast all Level I SPELLS at no cost

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